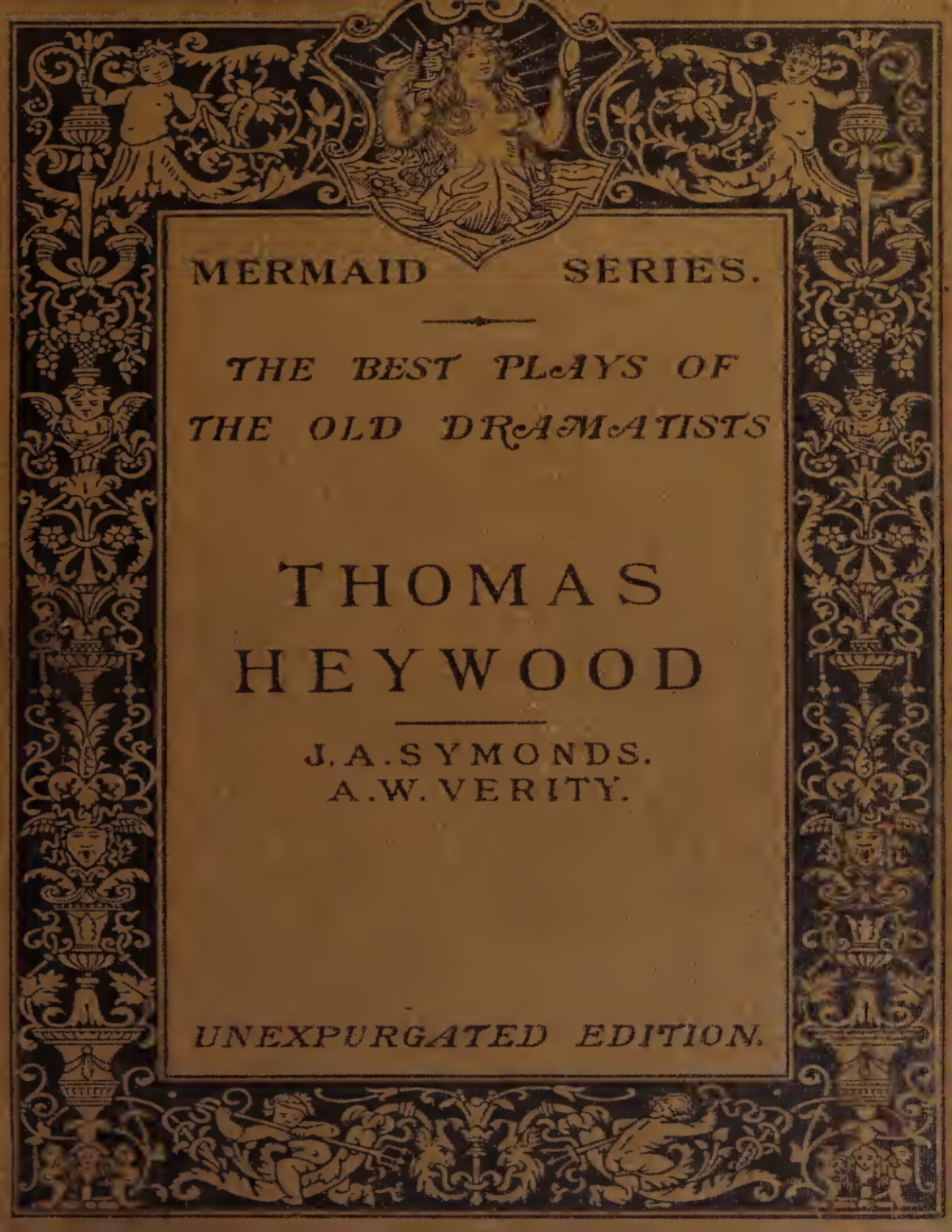




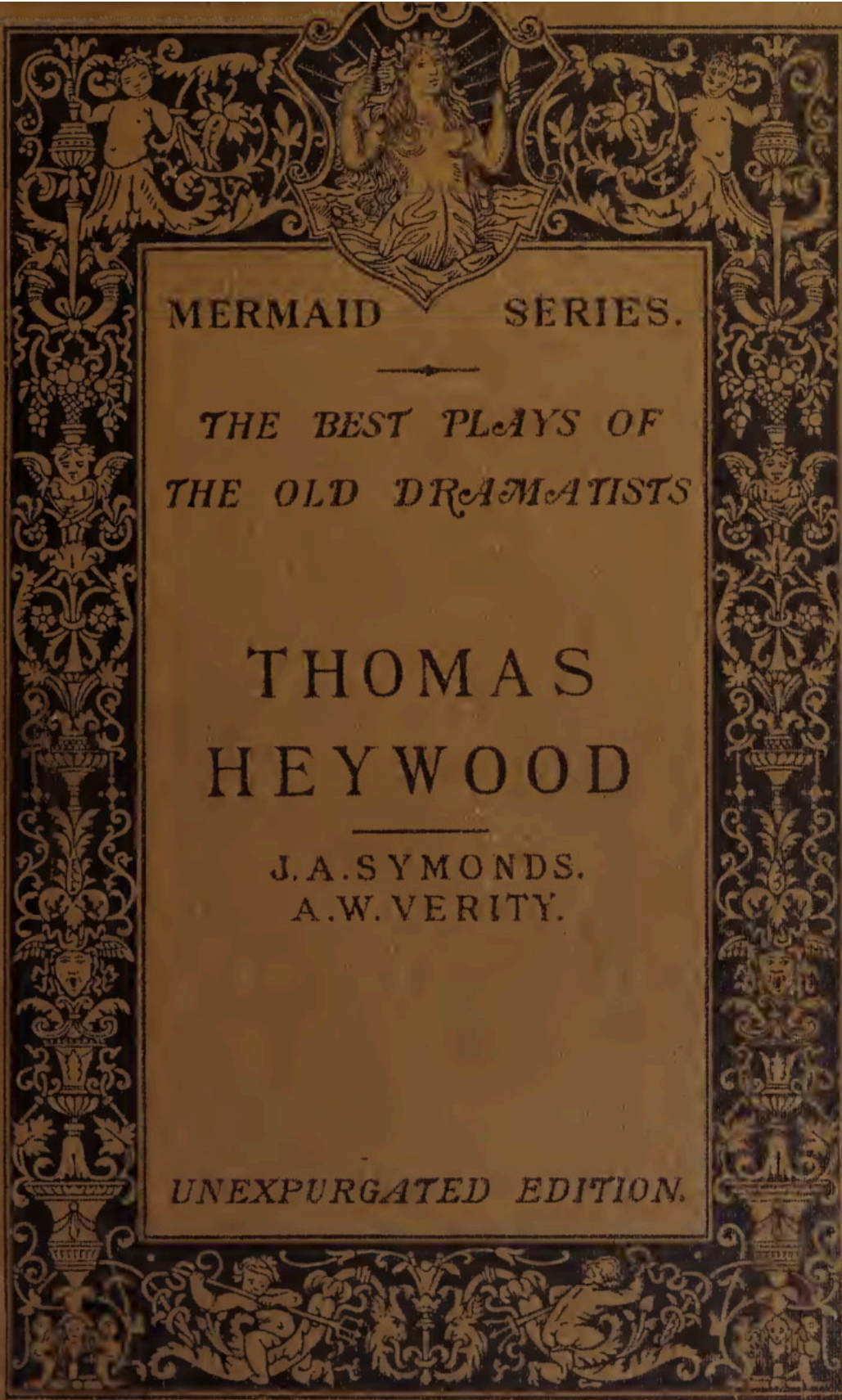
MERMAID SERIES.

THE BEST PLAYS OF
THE OLD DRAMATISTS

THOMAS
HEYWOOD

J.A.SYMONDS.
A.W.VERITY.

UNEXPURGATED EDITION.



MERMAID SERIES.

THE BEST PLAYS OF
THE OLD DRAMATISTS

THOMAS
HEYWOOD

J.A.SYMONDS.
A.W.VERITY.

UNEXPURGATED EDITION.

The Project Gutenberg eBook of Thomas Heywood

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: Thomas Heywood

Author: Thomas Heywood

Author of introduction, etc.: John Addington Symonds

Editor: A. W. Verity

Release date: January 28, 2022 [eBook #67267]

Most recently updated: October 18, 2024

Language: English

Original publication: United Kingdom: VIZETELLY & CO., 1888

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/67267

Credits: an anonymous Project Gutenberg volunteer

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THOMAS
HEYWOOD ***



*INSIDE THE RED BULL PLAYHOUSE.
From the frontispiece to Kirkman's "Drolls." 1672.*

THE MERMAID SERIES
THE BEST PLAYS OF THE OLD DRAMATISTS.

THOMAS HEYWOOD

EDITED BY A. WILSON VERITY:

WITH AN INTRODUCTION

BY J. ADDINGTON SYMONDS.

“I lie and dream of your full Mermaid wine.”—*Beaumont.*

UNEXPURGATED EDITION.

LONDON:
VIZETELLY & CO., 16, HENRIETTA STREET,
COVENT GARDEN.
1888.

“What things have we seen
Done at the Mermaid! heard words that have been
So nimble, and so full of subtle flame,
As if that every one from whence they came
Had meant to put his whole wit in a jest,
And had resolved to live a fool the rest
Of his dull life.”

Master Francis Beaumont to Ben Jonson.

“Souls of Poets dead and gone,
What Elysium have ye known,
Happy field or mossy cavern,
Choicer than the Mermaid Tavern?”
Keats.

LONDON:
BRADBURY, AGNEW, & CO., PRINTERS, WHITEFRIARS.

CONTENTS.

THOMAS HEYWOOD

THE RED BULL THEATRE

A WOMAN KILLED WITH KINDNESS

THE FAIR MAID OF THE WEST

THE ENGLISH TRAVELLER

THE WISE WOMAN OF HOGSDON

THE RAPE OF LUCRECE

FOOTNOTES

INTRODUCTION

A WOMAN KILLED WITH KINDNESS

THE FAIR MAID OF THE WEST

THE ENGLISH TRAVELLER

THE WISE WOMAN OF HOGSDON

THE RAPE OF LUCRECE

The world's a theatre, the earth a stage,^[1]
Which God and nature doth with actors fill:
Kings have their entrance in due equipage,
And some their parts play well, and others ill.
The best no better are (in this théâtre),
Where every humour's fitted in his kind;
This a true subject acts, and that a traitor,
The first applauded, and the last confined;
This plays an honest man, and that a knave,
A gentle person this, and he a clown,
One man is ragged, and another brave:
All men have parts, and each one acts his own.
She a chaste lady acteth all her life;
A wanton courtesan another plays;
This covets marriage love, that nuptial strife:
Both in continual action spend their days:
Some citizens, some soldiers, born to adven-
Shepherds, and sea-men. Then our play's begun
When we are born, and to the world first enter,
And all find exits when their parts are done.
If then the world a theatre present,
As by the roundness it appears most fit,
Built with star-galleries of high ascent,
In which Jehove doth as spectator sit,
And chief determiner to applaud the best,
And their endeavours crown with more than merit;
But by their evil actions dooms the rest
To end disgraced, whilst others praise inherit;
He that denies then theatres should be,
He may as well deny a world to me.

THOMAS HEYWOOD.^[2]

THOMAS HEYWOOD.

“IF I were to be consulted as to a reprint of our old English dramatists,” says Charles Lamb, “I should advise to begin with the collected plays of Heywood. He was a fellow actor and fellow dramatist with Shakespeare. He possessed not the imagination of the latter, but in all those qualities which gained for Shakespeare the attribute of gentle, he was not inferior to him—generosity, courtesy, temperance in the depths of passion; sweetness, in a word, and gentleness; Christianity, and true hearty Anglicism of feelings, shaping that Christianity, shine throughout his beautiful writings in a manner more conspicuous than in those of Shakespeare; but only more conspicuous, inasmuch as in Heywood these qualities are primary, in the other subordinate to poetry.” In another note Lamb calls Heywood a “prose Shakespeare.” Allowing for the exaggeration with which an enthusiastic love for our then neglected minor dramatists charged the criticism of Charles Lamb, this verdict is in many points a just one. Heywood, while he lacks the poetry, philosophy, deep insight into nature, and consummate art of Shakespeare—those qualities, in a word, which render Shakespeare supreme among dramatic poets—has a sincerity, a tenderness of pathos, and an instinctive perception of nobility, that distinguish him among the playwrights of the seventeenth century. Like Dekker, he wins our confidence and love. We keep a place in our affection for his favourite characters; they speak to us across two centuries with the voices of friends; while the far more brilliant masterpieces of many contemporary dramatists stir only our aesthetic admiration.^[3]

Heywood, unlike many of his contemporaries, and in this respect notably unlike Dekker, seems to have kept tolerably free from joint composition. Of twenty-four plays, only two, *The Late Lancashire Witches* and *Fortune by Land and Sea*, were produced by him in collaboration, the former with Brome, and the latter with W. Rowley. Of all the playwrights of that period he was the most prolific. In 1633 he owned to having “had either an entire hand or at least a main finger” in two hundred and twenty dramas; and after that date others were printed, which may perhaps be reckoned in

augmentation of this number. His literary fertility is proved by his *Nine Books of Various History concerning Women*, a folio of 466 pages, which appeared in 1624 with this memorandum: "Opus excogitatum inchoatum, explicitum, et typographo excusum inter septemdecem septimanas." Kirkman, the book-seller, in his advertisement to the reader at the end of the second edition of his catalogue of plays, observes of Heywood that "he was very laborious; for he not only acted almost every day, but also obliged himself to write a sheet every day for several years together." Besides composing dramas, he delighted in the labour of compilation, and had for some time on hand a Biographical Dictionary of all the poets, from the most remote period of the world's history down to his own time. The loss of his MS. collections for this book is greatly to be regretted, since there was no man of that century better qualified by geniality and honesty of purpose for the task than the old playwright, who put into the lips of Apuleius:—

"Not only whatsoever's mine,
But all true poets' raptures are divine."

Even as it is, the few lines in Heywood's *Hierarchy of Angels* on the nicknames of the poets of his day are among the raciest scraps of information which we possess about those dramatists. The miscellaneous nature of Heywood's literary labours justifies us in classing him, together with Robert Greene, among the earliest professional *littérateurs* of our language. His criticism is often quite as valuable as his dramatic poetry. The whole of the running dialogue between Apuleius and Midas in *Love's Mistress*, for example, contains a theory of the relation of poets to the public, while the prologues to *A Challenge for Beauty* and *The Royal King and Loyal Subject* are interesting as showing to what extent the dramatists of the Elizabethan age pursued their art with conscious purpose and comparison.

We may notice how careless, in common with many of his contemporaries, Heywood was concerning the fate of his dramatic writings. Plays, and comedies in particular, were written, not to be read and studied, but to be acted. This we should never forget while passing judgment upon the unequal work of the Elizabethan playwrights. In the Address to the Reader, prefixed to the *English Traveller*, Heywood complains that this tragi-comedy had been published without his consent, and apologises for

coming forward to father it before the world, adding, not without a sly poke at Jonson and his school:—

“True it is that my plays are not exposed unto the world in volumes, to bear the title of works (as others); one reason is, that many of them by shifting and change of companies had been negligently lost; others of them are still retained in the hands of some actors, who think it against their peculiar profit to have them come in print; and a third that it never was any great ambition in me to be in this kind voluminously read.”

In the preface to the *Rape of Lucrece* he repeats his complaints against the clandestine and unauthorised publication of his plays, with this declaration of his own habit of dealing with them:—

“It hath been no custom in me of all other men (courteous readers) to commit my plays to the press; the reason, though some may attribute to my own insufficiency, I had rather subscribe, in that, to their severe censure, than, by seeking to avoid the imputation of weakness, to incur greater suspicion of honesty; for though some have used a double sale of their labours, first to the stage, and after to the press; for my own part I here proclaim myself ever faithful to the first, and never guilty of the last.”

He then proceeds to show that the pirated editions of his plays in mangled copies have forced him to right himself before the public by superintending the issue of a certain number of his works. In the prologue to *If you Know not Me, you Know Nobody*, the same apology is reiterated in terms which throw a curious light upon the short-hand reporters of plays for the press, employed by piratical booksellers to the prejudice of authors and theatre managers:—

“Some by stenography drew
The plot; put it in print (scarce one word true):
And in that lameness it hath limped so long,
The author now to vindicate that wrong
Hath took the pains, upright upon its feet
To teach it walk, so please you sit, and see’t.”

Of the twenty-three plays in Mr. Pearson's collection, four—namely, the two parts of *Edward IV.* and the two parts of *If you Know not Me, you Know Nobody*—are histories of the old-fashioned sort, rudely dramatised from English chronicles, and seasoned with comic and pathetic episodes. Of the two series, *Edward IV.* has in it more of Heywood's special quality; the interlude of the Tanner of Tamworth and the romance of Mistress Shore displaying his double power of dealing with drollery and passion in the simplest and most natural style. In truth, the second part of *Edward IV.*, which begins with a dull, confused account of that king's wars in France, becomes a romantic drama on the legend of Jane Shore. This is chiefly remarkable for the way in which Heywood sustains the character of Master Shore, who is the very mirror of sound English middle-class Christianity. The erring wife's portrait is touched with striking, if somewhat sentimental, appeals to natural sympathy. Both are excellent examples of the dramatist's homely art and honest humanity, though nothing can be balder and more artless than the manner of their death together on the stage. *If you Know not Me, you Know Nobody* is a chronicle of the reign of Queen Elizabeth, including her early dangers and the late glories of the defeat of the Armada. The whole series of scenes breathes the strongest English patriotism and the most enthusiastic Protestant feeling. It is a pity that, hastily and clumsily pieced together, a drama so interesting in its matter should almost be valueless as a work of art. It was published as a companion to S. Rowley's *When you See Me, you Know Me*, which has been reprinted by Dr. Karl Elze.

The *Lancashire Witches* and the *Wise Woman of Hogsdon* are comedies of English life, without that element of romantic interest which Heywood usually added to the domestic drama. The plot of the latter play turns upon the quackeries and impostures of a professed fortune-teller; but to mention it in the same breath with Jonson's *Alchemist* would be ridiculous. The *Lancashire Witches*, though it attempts, in one scene at least, to touch the deeper interest of witchcraft, deals for the most part only with the vulgar and farcical aspects of the subject. It has nothing in common with *The Witch of Edmonton* or Middleton's *Witch*. A household turned topsy-turvy, a coursing-match spoiled, a farm-servant changed into a gelding, and a bridegroom bewitched with a charmed codpiece-point upon his wedding night, are among its insipid drolleries. In *Fortune by Land and Sea*, *The English Traveller*, *The Fair Maid of the Exchange*, and both parts

of *The Fair Maid of the West*, Heywood displays to better advantage his predilection for homespun stories, dealing chiefly with the incidents of country life and the adventures of English captains on the high seas. Pure comedy and pure tragedy were neither of them suited to his genius. He required a subject in which the familiar events of English domestic life might be contrasted with the romantic episodes of sea-roving and of foreign travel. To interweave these motives with the addition of pathos and sentiment, was just what he could do successfully. No dramatist has painted more faithful *home* pictures. None have thrown more natural light upon the pursuits of English gentlemen in the first half of the seventeenth century. The merit of all these five plays is considerable. It would have been impossible even for Fletcher to realise a difficult scene with greater ease and delicacy than are displayed in the interview between young Geraldine and Wincott's wife in *The English Traveller*. A pair of lovers, who have been parted, meet again and renew their old vows in the bedroom of the girl just made a wife. The calm strength and honourable feeling displayed by this Paolo and his Francesca in their perilous interview are the result of unsuspecting innocence and sweetness. If the situation is almost unnatural and disagreeable, the poet has contrived to invest it with the air of purity, reality, sincerity, and health. *Fortune by Land and Sea* is richer in scenes which reveal Heywood at his best. The opening of this play is one of his most vigorous transcripts from contemporary English country life. Frank Forrest, a daring and high-blooded youngster, evades his careful father, and flies off to a neighbouring tavern, less for the sake of drinking than in order to meet spirited companions. One of them picks a quarrel with him about his respect for his old father, and the boy is killed. The grief of old Forrest, the challenge given by the brother to Frank's murderer, the duel that ensues, and young Forrest's escape, are all set forth with photographic reality and force. Event huddles upon event, and the whole proceeds with the simplicity of truth. These scenes only form a prelude to the play, which, like most of Heywood's, contains a double plot; but at the same time they are its salt. The *Fair Maid of the West*, a romantic drama in two parts, sets forth the adventures of the Devonshire Captain Spencer and his love Bess Bridges, who is introduced to us as the mistress of a Plymouth inn. It may be said in passing, that few tavern-scenes in our Elizabethan drama, not even those of Dekker, are better painted than those which form the introduction to Act I. Battles with pirates, slavery in Fez, and adventures in

Florence form the staple of the drama, which must have presented many attractions to an English audience of the age of Stukeley, Sherley, and Drake. The *Fair Maid of the Exchange* is another play belonging to what the Germans style *das bürgerliche Drama*. To my mind its sentiment is sickly, and its story, in spite of many beautiful passages, disagreeable. Phillis is the Fair Maid; and the real hero of the piece is a cripple, who saves her from a ruffianly assault, and who falls in love with her. She returns his love; but Heywood had not the courage to develop this situation. Therefore he makes the cripple plead the cause of another suitor to the Fair Maid, who at the end of the play transfers her affections with a levity and a complacency that would be offensive in real life. The charm of this comedy consists in a certain air of April-morning freshness; it has, moreover, one of Heywood's most exquisite songs, a lyric that deserves to rank with Dekker's, and which is made for music: "Ye little birds that sit and sing."

The seven plays on English domestic subjects which I have now enumerated, are all of them eclipsed in their own kind by Heywood's masterpiece, *A Woman Killed with Kindness*. Leaving that, the finest bourgeois tragedy of our Elizabethan literature, for future comment, we come to another group of Heywood's plays, which may perhaps be best described as romances. Of these, *The Four Prentices of London*, a juvenile performance of the poet, is both the least interesting, and by far the most extravagant. Guy, Eustace, Tancred, and Godfrey, the four sons of the Duke of Boulogne, and at the same time 'prentices in London shops, start off like Paladins, and win their laurels in the first Crusade. Whether this absurd play was intended, like Fletcher's *Knight of the Burning Pestle*, for a parody of chivalrous romances, or whether, as its dedication to "the Honest and High-spirited 'Prentices, the Readers" seems to imply, it was meant for a hyperbolical compliment to the courage of London counter-jumpers, is not a very important matter. The latter is the more probable supposition. The plot is a tissue of sanguinary and sentimental adventures, with a certain admixture of good-humoured sarcasm on the London cits, that may have gratified their 'prentice-lads. The old quarto has for frontispiece a curious woodcut of the four knightly shop-boys. *The Royal King and Loyal Subject* is a drama with an ideal intention. Pretending to be founded upon English history, it really sets forth the contest of generosity between a monarch and one of his great nobles. In the course of this play Heywood has used some of the motives that add pathos to *Patient Grissil*; the King of England

exposes the Lord Marshal to a series of humiliations and studied insults before, as a climax to the favour he intends to heap upon him, he unites his own family and that of his subject by a triple bond of marriage. The whole situation is better in conception than in execution. I take it to be one of Heywood's earlier dramatic essays. *A Challenge for Beauty* tells the tale of a proud Portuguese Queen, who thinks herself the fairest woman of the world, but who is brought at the end of the play to admit that she is vanquished as much in beauty by an English lady as her husband's captains are surpassed in courage and courtesy by English gentlemen. The most interesting portion of the drama is subordinate to the subject which supplies the title. The contest of generosity between a noble Spaniard, Valladaura, and an English captain, Montferrers, who has been sold into slavery together with a friend that he dearly loved, displays all that innate gentleness and chivalry which Lamb recognized as the fairest of Heywood's characteristics. Valladaura finds his old enemy Montferrers in the slave-market, pays down his price, and sets him free. Montferrers cannot accept freedom while his friend remains a slave. Valladaura buys them both, taking Montferrers with him to remain, an honoured guest, in his own house. Now begins the duel of courtesy between the two men. Valladaura loves a lady, Petrocella, and beseeches the Englishman to plead his suit with her. Montferrers executes the task, though he also loves Petrocella, and discovers in the course of his wooing that she returns his passion. The use he makes of her avowal is to bind her over to accept the Spaniard's suit. But Valladaura is no whit less chivalrous. He resigns the lady to the man who has deserved her best. Those who have not studied the working out of such strained situations in the *Lustspiele* of Heywood or of Fletcher, can hardly imagine what flesh and blood reality these poets gave to almost inconceivable improbabilities. The vigorous and natural play of passions under strange disguises and painful conditions—the hesitations of divided allegiance—confusions of sex—contradictory emotions, pleased our play-going ancestors; and the dramatists had the skill to display the truth of human nature beneath the mask and garb of romantic fantasies. Under other hands, or in an age of less directness, such motives would have been ridiculous or offensive. *A Maidenhead well Lost*, is a romance of this type with Italian characters. While challenging comparison with similar comedies by Fletcher, Ford, Massinger, and others, it is but a tasteless and feeble production. Heywood was so thorough an Englishman that, for the

full exercise of his poetic faculty, he needed a subject smacking of his native soil.

Having now described Heywood's Histories, Domestic Dramas, and Romances, it remains for me to speak of the fourth group into which his plays may be divided. At the same time, I should observe that these divisions are, after all, but incomplete and artificial. Many of those which I have classified as Domestic Dramas, for example, borrow largely from the element of romance, while two of them are virtually comedies of farcical intrigue. The *Golden, Silver, Brazen, and Iron Ages* form a series of four plays, in which Heywood has dramatised antique legends, following principally Homer and Ovid in the selection of his material. Though there are many passages of graceful poetry and of humorous burlesque in these long-winded mythologies, they cannot be said to have much value either as dramas or as descriptive poems. That Heywood felt a natural predilection for this kind of composition may be seen in the rhyming versions he has made of Lucian's Dialogues. Some of these, especially the conversations of Jupiter with Ganymede, and of Juno with Jupiter, deserve attention for their plain, straightforward rendering into racy English of the witty Greek. *Love's Mistress*, which is a dramatic translation of Apuleius's tale of Cupid and Psyche, is written in the same mood. It takes the form of a long allegorical masque; and here the poetry is sustained throughout at a higher level. Last of all these classic dramas in my list comes the *Rape of Lucrece*. Here Heywood quits the epical or allegorical treatment of classical subject-matter for the domain of tragedy. Yet he has given to this episode of ancient Roman history more the form of a chronicle-play than of the legitimate drama.

It cannot be denied that the effects of negligence in composition and over-strained fertility are traceable in all that Heywood wrote. He has produced no masterpiece, no thoroughly sustained flight of fancy, no play perfect in form, and very few absolutely self-consistent characters. His finest passages seem to flow from him by accident, as the result of a temporary exaltation of his talent, rather than of settled purpose. His best scenes are improvised. Nor is it possible to evade the conclusion, quaintly phrased by Kirkman, that "many of his plays being composed loosely in taverns, occasions them to be so mean." These defects, indeed, Heywood shared in common with his contemporaries. Not many dramatic compositions of the seventeenth century can boast of classical finish or of

artistic unity. Yet there is in the best works of such men as Marlowe, Webster, Ford, and Fletcher, a natural completeness, an unstudied singleness of effect, which Heywood almost invariably misses. With all our affection for him, we are forced to admire his poetry in fragments and with reservations. Perhaps he shows to best advantage in the extracts made by Lamb.

No dramatist ever used less artifice. The subjects which he chose are either taken straight from real life, or else adopted crudely from the legends of ancient Greece and Rome. In each case Heywood's manner and method are the same. He uses simple, easy English, and sets forth unaffected feeling. The scenes have no elaborate connexion. They cohere by juxtaposition. The language is never high-flown or bombastic; rarely rising to the height of poetical diction, and attaining to intensity only when the passion of the moment is overwhelming, it owes its occasional force to its sincerity.

His means of reaching the heart are of the simplest; yet they are often deep and effectual. He depends for his tragic effects upon no Até, no midnight horrors, no sarcastic knave. Yet his use of some mere name—*Nan, Nan!*—and his allusions to Christ and our religion, go straight to the very soul. His men are all gentlemen; and it may be said in passing that he had more understanding of men, especially high-spirited young men, than of women. Nothing could be finer than the bearing, for example, of young Forrest when he challenges Rainsford, or of Valladaura and Montferrers, or again of Frankford and Sir Charles Mountford in *A Woman Killed with Kindness*. Now and then he touches the spring of true poetic language, as in these phrases:—

“Oh, speak no more!
For more than this I know and have recorded
Within the red-leaved table of my heart.”

Or again:—

“My friend and I
Like two chain bullets side by side will fly
Thorough the jaws of death.”

Or yet again:—

“Astonishment,
Fear, and amazement beat upon my heart,
Even as a madman beats upon a drum.”

The last line of this quotation is a splendid instance of the way in which the old dramatists heightened horror by connecting one terrific image with another of a different sort, yet no less terrible. The fury of a lunatic hideously rattling his drum with fantastic gestures rushes across our mind without distracting our attention from the anguish of the man who speaks the words. The simile does but add force to his bewilderment.

Though not a lyrist in any high sense of the word, Heywood at times produced songs remarkable for purity and freshness. To one of these in the *Fair Maid of the Exchange* I have already called attention. Not less beautiful is a morning ditty, which begins “Pack, clouds away,” in the *Rape of Lucrece*. The patriotic war-song in the First Part of *King Edward IV.*, “Agincourt, Agincourt, know ye not Agincourt?” is full of fire; while a humorous catch, “The Spaniard loves his ancient slop,” must have been a favourite with the groundlings, since it occurs in both *The Rape of Lucrece* and *A Challenge for Beauty*. There is plenty of proof that Heywood could write good words for street melodies. That his English style is generally free, flowing, and vernacular admits of no question; yet such were the contradictions of the age in which he lived, that he must needs at intervals display his erudition by the pedantic coinage of new phrases. Such words as “trifurk,” to “diapason,” “sonance,” “cathedral state,” “tenebrous,” “mœchal,” “monomachy,” “obdure” for “obdurate,” all of which occur in *The Rape of Lucrece*, demand for their inventor the emetic which Jonson in *The Poetaster* administered to Marston, and prove conspicuously how a little learning on the lips of an honest playwright is a dangerous thing.

The Rape of Lucrece, as I have before hinted, is nothing but the narrative of Livy divided into tableaux with no artistic consistency. It contains the whole story of Tullia’s ambition and the death of Servius, the journey of Brutus to Delphi, the fulfilment of the oracle, the betrayal of Gabii, the camp at Ardea, the crime of Tarquin, the rising of the Roman nobles, the war with Porsena, and the stories of Horatius and Scevola. The characters are devoid of personal reality. Lucrece herself is more a type of innocence than a true woman. Of the minor characters which fill out the play, by far the most original is Valerius. His part must have been a favourite with the London audience, for on the title-page we read: “with the

several songs in their apt places by Valerius, the merry lord among the Roman peers.” Instead of fooling, sulking, or gaming, as the other nobles do beneath the Tarquin tyranny, he does nothing but sing. It is impossible to extract from him a word of sense in sober prose. But love songs, loose songs, drinking songs, dirges, street cries, a Scotch song, a Dutch song, and pastoral ditties, with rhymes on the names of public houses, public women, ale, wine, and so forth, flow from him in and out of season. He is the most striking instance of the licence with which the poets of the time were forced to treat their subjects for the sake of the gallery. Some of his verses are full of exquisite feeling; others are grossly coarse; some are comical, and others melancholy; but all are English. When Valerius first hears of the outrage offered to Lucrece, he breaks out into a catch of the most questionable kind, together with Horatius Cocles and a Clown. The whole matter is turned to ridicule, and it is difficult after this musical breakdown to read the tragedy except as a burlesque.

Love’s Mistress is a Masque in five acts rather than a play proper. In its day it enjoyed great popularity, for it was represented before James I. and his queen three times within the space of eight days. Its three prologues and one epilogue are remarkable even among the productions of that age for their fulsome flattery. The story of Cupid and Psyche, on which the Masque is founded, could not have failed to yield some beauties even to a far inferior craftsman than Heywood; and there are many passages of delicate and tender poetry scattered up and down the piece. Indeed, the whole is treated with an airy grace that has peculiar charm, while its abrupt contrasts and frequent changes must have made it a rare spectacle under the wise conduct of

“that admirable artist, Mr. Inigo Jones, master-surveyor of the king’s work, &c., who to every act, nay, almost to every scene, by his excellent inventions gave such an extraordinary lustre—upon every occasion changing the stage, to the admiration of all the spectators—that, as I must ingenuously confess, it was above my apprehension to conceive.”

Still, even in *Love’s Mistress*, Heywood betrays that lack of the highest artistic instinct, which we discover in almost all his work. He cannot manage the Court pageant with that exquisite tact which distinguishes the

Endimion and the *Sapho* of Lyly. The whole play has a running commentary of criticism and exposition, conveyed in a dialogue between Apuleius, the author of the legend, and Midas, who personates stupidity. Apuleius explains the allegory as the action proceeds; Midas remains to the end the dull unappreciative boor, who “stands for ignorance,” and only cares for dancing clowns, or the coarse jests of buffoons. Apuleius is the type of the enthusiastic poet, whose wit is “aimed at inscrutable things beyond the moon.” Midas is the gross conceited groundling, who, turning everything he touches to dross, prefers Pan’s fool to Apollo’s chorus, and drives the god of light indignantly away. Both of them wear asses’ heads: Midas, because he grovels on the earth; Apuleius, because all human intellect proves foolish if it flies too far. There is much good-humoured irony in this putting of donkey’s ears on the poet’s head. This contrast between art and ignorance is paralleled by a series of subtle antitheses that pervade the play. Immortal Erôs finds a balance in the stupid clown, who boasts that Apollo has given him music, Cupid love, and Psyche beauty; but who remains untunable, unlovable, and hideous to the end. The juxtaposition of heaven and hell within our souls, the aspirations and the downfalls of our spirit, the nobility and the vileness of men around us, the perpetual contradiction between the region toward which we soar in our best moments, and the dull ground over which we have to plod in daily life: such are the metaphysical conceptions which underlie the shifting scenes and many-twinkling action of the masque. It would be unfair to institute any comparison between *Love’s Mistress* considered as a poem, and the delicate version of the legend in the *Earthly Paradise*. Yet there are touches of true poetry here and there throughout the play. The haunted house of Love which receives Psyche and where Echo and Zephyrus are her attendants, the visit of her three sisters, and the midnight awaking of wrathful Cupid, are all conceived with light and airy fancy. Cupid in his anger utters this curse on women:—

“You shall be still rebellious, like the sea,
And, like the winds, inconstant; things forbid
You most shall covet, loathe what you would like
You shall be wise in wishes, but, enjoying,
Shall venture heaven’s loss for a little toying.”

There is another aspect under which *Love’s Mistress* may be viewed—as a very early attempt at classical burlesque. Cupid, for example, is the

naughty boy of Olympus. He describes Juno's anger against Ganymede:—

“The boy by chance upon her fan had spilled
A cup of nectar: oh, how Juno swore!
I told my aunt I'd give her a new fan
To let Jove's page be Cupid's serving-man.”

Vulcan appears at his forge with more orders than he knows how to deal with:—

“There's half a hundred thunder-bolts bespoke;
Neptune hath broke his mace; and Juno's coach
Must be new-mended, and the hindmost wheels
Must have two spokes set in.”

He thinks of making Venus “turn she-smith,” but

“She'd spend me more
In nectar and sweet balls to scour her cheeks,
Smudged and besmeared with coal-dust and with smoke,
Than all her work would come to.”

This is, of course, very simple fooling. Yet it contains the germ of those more thorough-going parodies in which the present age delights.

The play in which Heywood showed for once that he was not unable to produce a masterpiece is *A Woman Killed with Kindness*. All his powers of direct painting from the English life he knew so well, his faculty for lifting prose to the border-ground of poetry by the intensity of the emotion which he communicates, his simple art of laying bare the very nerves of passion, are here exhibited in perfection. This domestic tragedy touches one like truth. Its scenes are of everyday life. Common talk is used, and the pathos is homely; not like Webster's, brought from far. Tastes may differ as to the morality or the wholesomeness of the sentiment evolved in the last act. None, however, can resist its artless claim upon our sympathies. The story may be briefly told. Mr. Frankford, a country gentleman of good fortune, marries the sister of Sir Francis Acton, and receives into his house an agreeable gentleman of broken means called Wendoll. They live together happily till Wendoll, trusted to the full by Frankford, takes advantage of his absence to seduce his wife. Nicholas, a servant, who, with the instinct of a faithful dog, has always suspected the stranger, discovers and informs

Frankford of his dishonour. Frankford obtains ocular proof of his wife's guilt, and punishes her by sending her to live alone, but at ease, in a manor that belongs to him. There she pines away and dies at last, after a reconciliation with her injured husband.[4]

In the *genre* Heywood had predecessors, but none of his rivals surpassed him. The chief interest of the play centres in the pure, confiding, tender-hearted character of Frankford. His blithe contentment during the first months of marriage, and the generosity with which he opens his doors to Wendoll, form a touching prelude to the suspicions, indignantly repelled at first, which grow upon him after he has weighed the tale of his wife's infidelity related by Nicholas. He resolves to learn the truth, if possible, by actual experience. Here is interposed an admirable scene, in which Frankford and his wife, with Wendoll and another gentleman, play cards. The dialogue is a long *double entendre*, skilfully revealing the tortures of a jealous husband's mind and his suspicious misinterpretation of each casual word. When they rise from the card-table, Frankford instructs Nicholas to get him duplicate keys for all his rooms. Then he causes a message to be delivered to him on a dark and stormy evening, and sets off with his servant, intending to return at midnight unnoticed and unexpected. His hesitation on the threshold of his wife's chamber is one of the finest turning-points of the dramatic action. At last he summons courage to enter, but returns immediately:—

“O me unhappy! I have found them lying
Close in each other's arms and fast asleep.
But that I would not damn two precious souls,
Bought with my Saviour's blood, and send them, laden
With all their scarlet sins upon their backs,
Unto a fearful judgment, their two lives
Had met upon my rapier.”

Then, with a passionate stretching forth of his desire toward the impossible, which reveals the whole depth of his tenderness, he cries:—

“O God! O God! that it were possible
To undo things done; to call back yesterday!
That Time could turn up his swift sandy glass,
To untell the days, and to redeem these hours!
Or that the sun
Could, rising from the west, draw his coach backward,
Take from the account of time so many minutes,
Till he had all these seasons called again,
Those minutes, and those actions done in them,
Even from her first offence; that I might take her
As spotless as an angel in my arms!
But oh! I talk of things impossible,
And cast beyond the moon. God give me patience!
For I will in and wake them.”

The following scene, in which Frankford pleads with his guilty and conscience-stricken wife, is full of pathos. Its passion is simple and homefelt. Each question asked by Frankford is such as a wronged husband has the right to ask. Each answer given by the wife is broken in mere monosyllables more eloquent than protestation. We feel the whole, because not a word is strained or far-fetched, because the tenderness of Frankford is not merely sentimental, because he does not rave or tear his passion to tatters; finally, because in the profundity of his grief he still can call his wife by her pet name.

Mrs. Frankford is no Guinevere, nor, again, like Alice in *Arden of Feversham*, is she steeled and blinded by an overwhelming passion. Heywood fails to realise her character completely, producing, as elsewhere in his portraits of women, a weak and vacillating picture. She changes quite suddenly from love for her newly-wedded lord to light longing for Wendoll, and then back again to the remorse which eats her life away. Wendoll is drawn more powerfully. We see the combat in his soul between the sense of duty to his benefactor and the love which invades him like an ocean, drowning all the landmarks he had raised to warn him from the perilous ground. Adultery has been three times treated by Heywood. In *The English Traveller* Mrs. Wincott sins with the same limp and unexplained facility as Mrs. Frankford. In *Edward IV*. Jane Shore is meant to raise the same sentimental pity as Mrs. Frankford on her death-bed.

Thomas Heywood was a Lincolnshire man, presumably of good family, though I cannot find that the Visitations of that county record any pedigree of his name. No poet of his age showed a more intimate acquaintance with the habits of country gentlemen, and none was more imbued with the spirit of true gentleness. He was a Fellow of Peter House, Cambridge, where he probably acquired that learning which sat upon him so lightly. He began to write for the stage as early as 1596, and in 1598 we find him engaged as an actor and a sharer in Henslowe's company. Little else is known about his life, and, though it is certain that he lived to a ripe age, we are ignorant of the date of his death. Like many authors of his period, he adopted a motto for his works, to which he adhered, placing on his title-pages, *Aut prodesse solent aut delectare*. We may still say, with truth, that what he has written almost invariably succeeds in both these aims. His plays are defiled with very few unpardonably coarse scenes, those to be found in *A Royal King and Loyal Subject* being an exception to prove the rule. While concluding these introductory remarks, I can only express my regret that the editor has not been able to include more pieces of Heywood in the Mermaid Series; for Heywood is essentially an author whom we love the better the more we read of him. It is impossible to rise from the perusal of his plays without being refreshed and invigorated. May the five here presented, out of the twenty-four which bear his name, induce students to carry their researches further. They will, I feel confident, discover that three other sets of five plays are no less worthy of perusal than the five here chosen for their recreation.

JOHN ADDINGTON SYMONDS.

∴ The text of four of the plays contained in this volume is substantially that of Pearson's reprint (1874); the exception is *The Fair Maid of the West*, reprinted from the edition by Collier, though I have felt it necessary to dissent from Collier's readings in several places. For the convenience of the reader I have attempted to indicate the changes of scene in the whole of the plays, marking also the probable locality of each scene, and altering the rather vague and unsatisfactory stage directions of the old copies. My thanks are due to Mr. S. W. Orson for many valuable suggestions.

A. W. V.

THE RED BULL THEATRE.

HEYWOOD'S PLAYS were frequently acted on the stage of the Red Bull Theatre, of which Kirkman supplied an illustration in his collection of *Drolls and Farces*. This illustration has been reproduced as a frontispiece to the present volume. The theatre was one of the oldest in London; originally it was, as the name indicates, an inn yard, converted into a regular theatre during Elizabeth's reign, and, like several contemporary playhouses, often used for other amusements; it was never considered a high-class theatre, but it was very popular. Its site was on a plot of ground, between the upper end of St. John Street and Clerkenwell Green, during the eighteenth century still called Red Bull Yard, and named Woodbridge Street at the beginning of the present century. In 1819 a writer who carefully investigated the matter could find no trace of the theatre; though he indicated a field of search by suggesting that its exact position might perhaps be set forth in existing leases.

Various companies played at the Red Bull at different times. In 1623 the Queen's company (under the jurisdiction of the "now Earl of Leicester, then Lord Chamberlain of the Household of the said late Queen Anne of Denmark") gave place to the Prince's, so called after Prince Charles. In 1629, women actors (who also appeared at other theatres) played at the Red Bull. In 1639 the Red Bull Company got into trouble. A complaint was made to the king "that the stage-players of the Red Bull have lately, for many days together, acted a scandalous and libellous play, wherein they have audaciously reproached, and in a libellous manner traduced and personated, not only some of the Aldermen of the City of London and other persons of quality, but also scandalised and defamed the whole profession of Proctors belonging to the Court of Civil Law, and reflected upon the Government." For this they received "exemplary punishment." In the following year the company which had been playing at the Fortune Theatre changed to the Red Bull.

This was the only theatre that lived on until Restoration times, though not without many difficulties. Such items of information as the following

(1655) are not uncommon:—"At the playhouse this week many were put to the rout by the soldiers." "The actors, too," Kirkman writes, "were commonly not only stripped, but many times imprisoned, till they paid such ransom as the soldiers should impose upon them." Although the Red Bull survived the Commonwealth it succumbed soon after the Restoration. In 1660 Charles II. issued an order (not very rigorously carried out) for their suppression, as a concession to civic authorities. In 1661 Pepys wrote that "the clothes are very poor, and the actors but common fellows." Better and more modern theatres arose, and in 1663 Davenant declared that "the Red Bull stands empty for fencers: there are no tenants in it but spiders."

A WOMAN KILLED WITH KINDNESS.

FROM two entries in Henslowe's Diary the date when *A Woman Killed with Kindness* was written can be fixed with remarkable certainty. One entry runs:—"Paid, at the appointment of the Company, the 6th of March, 1603, unto Thomas Heywood, in full payment for his play, called *A Woman Killed with Kindness*, the sum of ... £3;" and the other—"Paid, at the appointment of Thomas Blackwood, the 7th of March, 1603, unto the tailor which made the black satin suit for the *Woman Killed with Kindness* the sum of ... 10s." The earliest printed notice of the piece occurs in Middleton's *The Blacke Booke*, 1604, where it is coupled with the *Merry Devil of Edmonton*:—"And being set out of the shop, ... she, by thy instructions, shall turn the honest simple fellow off at the next turning, and give him leave to see the *Merry Devil of Edmonton*, or *A Woman Killed with Kindness*, when his mistress is going herself to the same murder." In 1607 the play was published, and a third edition appeared in 1617. It may be worth while to note that the title of the piece was a proverbial expression: compare, for instance, *The Taming of the Shrew* (to which Professor Dowden assigns the date 1597), iv. 1. 221:—

"This is a way to kill a wife with kindness."

Professor Ward (*English Dramatic Literature*, ii. 114) refers also to Fletcher's *The Woman's Prize*, iii. 4:—

"Some few,
For those are rarest, they are said to kill,
With kindness and fair usage."

An interesting point in the history of this drama is the fact that it was quite recently revived by the Society of Dramatic Students, and revived, I believe, with signal success. Perhaps the only weak element in the five acts is the readiness with which the wife falls. I may add that the division of the

play into acts and scenes is here attempted for the first time, at least in any edition of the piece.

THE PROLOGUE.

I COME but like a harbinger, being sent
To tell you what these preparations mean:
Look for no glorious state; our Muse is bent
Upon a barren subject, a bare scene.
We could afford this twig a timber tree,
Whose strength might boldly on your favours build;
Our russet, tissue; drone, a honey-bee;
Our barren plot, a large and spacious field;
Our coarse fare, banquets; our thin water, wine;
Our brook, a sea; our bat's eyes, eagle's sight;
Our poet's dull and earthy Muse, divine;
Our ravens, doves; our crow's black feathers, white:
But gentle thoughts, when they may give the foil,
Save them that yield, and spare where they may spoil.

DRAMATIS PERSONÆ.

Sir FRANCIS ACTON, Brother of Mistress FRANKFORD.

Sir CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Master FRANKFORD.

Master WENDOLL, Friend to FRANKFORD.

Master MALBY, Friend to Sir FRANCIS.

Master CRANWELL.

SHAFTON, a False Friend to Sir CHARLES.

OLD MOUNTFORD, Uncle to Sir CHARLES.

TIDY, Cousin to Sir CHARLES.

SANDY.

RODER.

Servants to FRANKFORD:

NICHOLAS,

JENKIN,

ROGER BRICKBAT,

JACK SLIME,

SPIGOT, a Butler,

Sheriff.

A Serjeant, a Keeper, Officers, Falconers, Huntsmen, a Coachman,
Carters, Servants, Musicians.

Mistress FRANKFORD.

SUSAN, Sister of Sir CHARLES.

CICELY, Maid to Mistress FRANKFORD.

Women Servants.

SCENE—THE NORTH OF ENGLAND.

A WOMAN KILLED WITH KINDNESS.

ACT THE FIRST.

SCENE I.—*A Room in FRANKFORD'S House.*

Enter Master FRANKFORD, Mistress FRANKFORD, Sir FRANCIS ACTON, Sir CHARLES MOUNTFORD, Master MALBY, Master WENDOLL, *and* Master CRANWELL.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Some music there: none lead the bride a dance?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Yes, would she dance “The Shaking of the Sheets;”[\[1\]](#)
But that’s the dance her husband means to lead her.

WENDOLL.

That’s not the dance that every man must dance,
According to the ballad.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Music, ho!
By your leave, sister;—by your husband’s leave,
I should have said: the hand that but this day
Was given you in the church I’ll borrow: sound!
This marriage music hoists me from the ground.

FRANKFORD.

Ay, you may caper, you are light and free:
Marriage hath yoked my heels; pray then pardon me.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

I'll have you dance too, brother.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Master Frankford,
You are a happy man, sir; and much joy
Succeed your marriage mirth! you have a wife
So qualified, and with such ornaments
Both of the mind and body. First, her birth
Is noble, and her education such
As might become the daughter of a prince:
Her own tongue speaks all tongues, and her own hand
Can teach all strings to speak in their best grace,
From the shrillest treble to the hoarsest base.
To end her many praises in one word,
She's beauty and perfection's eldest daughter,
Only found by yours, though many a heart hath sought her.

FRANKFORD.

But that I know your virtues and chaste thoughts,
I should be jealous of your praise, Sir Charles.

CRANWELL.

He speaks no more than you approve.

MALBY.

Nor flatters he that gives to her her due.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I would your praise could find a fitter theme
Than my imperfect beauties to speak on:
Such as they be, if they my husband please,
They suffice me now I am married:
His sweet content is like a flattering glass,
To make my face seem fairer to mine eye;
But the least wrinkle from his stormy brow
Will blast the roses in my cheeks that grow.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

A perfect wife already, meek and patient:
How strangely the word “husband” fits your mouth,
Not married three hours since! Sister, ’tis good;
You, that begin betimes thus, must needs prove
Pliant and duteous in your husband’s love.—
Gramercies, brother, wrought her to’t already;
Sweet husband, and a curtsey, the first day!
Mark this, mark this, you that are bachelors,
And never took the grace of honest man;
Mark this, against you marry, this one phrase:
“In a good time that man both wins and woos,
That takes his wife down in her wedding shoes.”[2]

FRANKFORD.

Your sister takes not after you, Sir Francis;
All his wild blood your father spent on you:
He got her in his age, when he grew civil:
All his mad tricks were to his land entailed,
And you are heir to all; your sister, she
Hath to her dower her mother’s modesty.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Lord, sir, in what a happy state live you!
This morning, which to many seems a burden
Too heavy to bear, is unto you a pleasure.
This lady is no clog, as many are:
She doth become you like a well-made suit,
In which the tailor hath used all his art;
Not like a thick coat of unseasoned frieze,
Forced on your back in summer. She’s no chain
To tie your neck, and curb you to the yoke;
But she’s a chain of gold to adorn your neck.
You both adorn each other, and your hands,
Methinks, are matches: there’s equality
In this fair combination; you are both
Scholars, both young, both being descended nobly.
There’s music in this sympathy; it carries

Consort, and expectation of much joy,
Which God bestow on you, from this first day
Until your dissolution; that's for aye.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

We keep you here too long, good brother Frankford.
Into the hall; away! go cheer your guests.
What, bride and bridegroom both withdrawn at once?
If you be missed, the guests will doubt their welcome,
And charge you with unkindness.

FRANKFORD.

To prevent it,
I'll leave you here, to see the dance within.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

And so will I.

[Exeunt FRANKFORD and Mistress FRANKFORD.]

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

To part you, it were sin.
Now, gallants, while the town-musicians
Finger their frets[3] within; and the mad lads
And country-lasses, every mother's child,
With nosegays and bridelaces in their hats,
Dance all their country measures, rounds, and jigs,
What shall we do? Hark, they are all on the hoigh;[4]
They toil like mill-horses, and turn as round,—
Marry, not on the toe. Ay, and they caper,
Not without cutting; you shall see, to-morrow,
The hall-floor pecked and dinted like a mill-stone,
Made with their high shoes: though their skill be small,
Yet they tread heavy where their hob-nails fall.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Well, leave them to their sports. Sir Francis Acton,
I'll make a match with you; meet to-morrow

At Chevy-chase, I'll fly my hawk with yours.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

For what? For what?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Why, for a hundred pound.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Pawn me some gold of that.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Here are ten angels;[5]

I'll make them good a hundred pound to-morrow

Upon my hawk's wing.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

'Tis a match, 'tis done.

Another hundred pound upon your dogs;

Dare ye, Sir Charles?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

I dare: were I sure to lose,

I durst do more than that: here is my hand,

The first course for a hundred pound.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

A match.

WENDOLL.

Ten angels on Sir Francis Acton's hawk;

As much upon his dogs.

CRANWELL.

I am for Sir Charles Mountford; I have seen

His hawk and dog both tried. What, clap you hands?

Or is't no bargain?

WENDOLL.

Yes, and stake them down:

Were they five hundred, they were all my own.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Be stirring early with the lark to-morrow;[\[6\]](#)

I'll rise into my saddle ere the sun

Rise from his bed.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

If there you miss me, say

I am no gentleman: I'll hold my day.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

It holds on all sides. Come, to-night let's dance,

Early to-morrow let's prepare to ride;

We had need be three hours up before the bride.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—A Yard.

Enter NICHOLAS, JENKIN, JACK SLIME, *and* ROGER BRICKBAT, *with*
Country Wenches, *and two or three* Musicians.

JENKIN.

Come, Nick, take you Joan Miniver to trace withal; Jack Slime, traverse you with Cicely Milk-pail: I will take Jane Trubkin, and Roger Brickbat shall have Isbel Motley; and now that they are busy in the parlour, come, strike up; we'll have a crash[7] here in the yard.

NICHOLAS.

My humour is not compendious; dancing I possess not, though I can foot it; yet, since I am fallen into the hands of Cicely Milk-pail, I consent.

SLIME.

Truly Nick, though we were never brought up like serving courtiers, yet we have been brought up with serving creatures, ay, and God's creatures too; for we have been brought up to serve sheep, oxen, horses, hogs, and such like: and, though we be but country fellows, it may be in the way of dancing we can do the horse-trick as well as serving-men.

BRICKBAT.

Ay, and the cross-point too.

JENKIN.

O Slime, O Brickbat, do not you know that comparisons are odious? now we are odious ourselves too, therefore there are no comparisons to be made betwixt us.

NICHOLAS.

I am sudden, and not superfluous;
I am quarrelsome, and not seditious;
I am peaceable, and not contentious;
I am brief, and not compendious.

SLIME.

Foot it quickly: if the music overcome not my melancholy, I shall quarrel; and if they do not suddenly strike up, I shall presently strike them down.

JENKIN.

No quarrelling, for God's sake: truly, if you do, I shall set a knave between ye.

SLIME.

I come to dance, not to quarrel. Come, what shall it be? "Rogerero?"[\[8\]](#)

JENKIN.

"Rogerero!" no; we will dance "The Beginning of the World."

CICELY.

I love no dance so well as "John come kiss me now."

NICHOLAS.

I, that have ere now deserved a cushion, call for the "Cushion-dance."

BRICKBAT.

For my part, I like nothing so well as "Tom Tyler."

JENKIN.

No; we'll have "The Hunting of the Fox."

SLIME.

"The Hay," "The Hay;" there's nothing like "The Hay."

NICHOLAS.

I have said, I do say, and I will say again—

JENKIN.

Every man agree to have it as Nick says.

ALL.

Content.

NICHOLAS.

It hath been, it now is, and it shall be—

CICELY.

What, Master Nicholas, what?

NICHOLAS.

“Put on your smock a’ Monday.”

JENKIN.

So the dance will come cleanly off. Come, for God’s sake agree of something: if you like not that, put it to the musicians; or let me speak for all, and we’ll have “Sellenger’s round.”

ALL.

That, that, that.

NICHOLAS.

No, I am resolved, thus it shall be:
First take hands, then take ye to your heels.

JENKIN.

Why, would ye have us run away?

NICHOLAS.

No; but I would have you shake your heels.
Music, strike up!

[They dance. NICHOLAS whilst dancing speaks stately and scurvily, the rest after the country fashion.]

JENKIN.

Hey! lively, my lasses! here’s a turn for thee!

[Exeunt.]

SCENE III.—*The Open Country.*

Horns wind. Enter SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD, SIR FRANCIS ACTON,
MALBY, CRANWELL, WENDOLL, Falconers, *and* Huntsmen.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

So; well cast off: aloft, aloft! well flown!
Oh, now she takes her at the sowse,[\[9\]](#) and strikes her
Down to the earth, like a swift thunder-clap.

WENDOLL.

She hath struck ten angels out of my way.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

A hundred pound from me.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

What, falconer!

FALCONER.

At hand, sir.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Now she hath seized the fowl, and 'gins to plume her,
Rebeck her not: rather stand still and check her.
So, seize her gets,[\[10\]](#) her jesses,[\[11\]](#) and her bells:
Away!

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

My hawk killed too.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Ay, but 'twas at the querre,[\[12\]](#)
Not at the mount, like mine.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Judgment, my masters.

CRANWELL.

Yours missed her at the ferre.

WENDOLL.

Ay, but our merlin[\[13\]](#) first had plumed the fowl,
And twice renewed her from the river too;
Her bells, Sir Francis, had not both one weight,
Nor was one semi-tune above the other:
Methinks these Milan bells do sound too full,
And spoil the mounting of your hawk.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

'Tis lost.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

I grant it not. Mine likewise seized a fowl
Within her talons; and you saw her paws
Full of the feathers: both her petty singles,
And her long singles gripped her more than other;
The terrials of her legs were stained with blood:
Not of the fowl only, she did discomfit
Some of her feathers; but she brake away.
Come, come, your hawk is but a rifler.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

How!

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Ay, and your dogs are trindle-tails and curs.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

You stir my blood.
You keep not one good hound in all your kennel,
Nor one good hawk upon your perch.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

How, knight!

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

So, knight: you will not swagger, sir?

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Why, say I did?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Why, sir,

I say you would gain as much by swaggering,

As you have got by wagers on your dogs:

You will come short in all things.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Not in this:

Now I'll strike home.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Thou shalt to thy long home,

Or I will want my will.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

All they that love Sir Francis, follow me.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

All that affect Sir Charles, draw on my part.

CRANWELL.

On this side heaves my hand.

WENDOLL.

Here goes my heart.

[They divide themselves. Sir CHARLES MOUNTFORD, CRANWELL, Falconer, and Huntsman, fight against Sir FRANCIS ACTON, WENDOLL, his Falconer, and Huntsman; and Sir CHARLES's side gets the better, beating the others away, and killing both of Sir FRANCIS's men. Exeunt all except Sir CHARLES.]

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

My God! what have I done? what have I done?
My rage hath plunged into a sea of blood,
In which my soul lies drowned. Poor innocents,
For whom we are to answer! Well, 'tis done,
And I remain the victor. A great conquest,
When I would give this right hand, nay, this head,
To breathe in them new life whom I have slain!
Forgive me, God! 'twas in the heat of blood,
And anger quite removes me from myself:
It was not I, but rage, did this vile murder;
Yet I, and not my rage, must answer it.
Sir Francis Acton he is fled the field;
With him all those that did partake his quarrel,
And I am left alone with sorrow dumb,
And in my height of conquest overcome.

Enter SUSAN.

SUSAN.

O God! my brother wounded 'mong the dead!
Unhappy jest, that in such earnest ends:
The rumour of this fear stretched to my ears,
And I am come to know if you be wounded.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Oh! sister, sister, wounded at the heart.

SUSAN.

My God forbid!

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

In doing that thing which He forbad,
I am wounded, sister.

SUSAN.

I hope not at the heart.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Yes, at the heart.

SUSAN.

O God! a surgeon there!

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Call me a surgeon, sister, for my soul;
The sin of murder it hath pierced my heart,
And made a wide wound there: but for these scratches,
They are nothing, nothing.

SUSAN.

Charles, what have you done?
Sir Francis hath great friends, and will pursue you
Unto the utmost danger of the law.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

My conscience is become mine enemy,
And will pursue me more than Acton can.

SUSAN.

Oh, fly, sweet brother.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Shall I fly from thee?
Why, Sue, art weary of my company?

SUSAN.

Fly from your foe.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

You, sister, are my friend;
And, flying you, I shall pursue my end.

SUSAN.

Your company is as my eye-ball dear;
Being far from you, no comfort can be near;

Yet fly to save your life: what would I care
To spend my future age in black despair,
So you were safe? and yet to live one week
Without my brother Charles, through every cheek
My streaming tears would downwards run so rank,
Till they could set on either side a bank,
And in the midst a channel; so my face
For two salt-water brooks shall still find place.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Thou shalt not weep so much, for I will stay
In spite of danger's teeth; I'll live with thee,
Or I'll not live at all. I will not sell
My country and my father's patrimony,
Nor thy sweet sight, for a vain hope of life.

Enter Sheriff, with Officers.

SHERIFF.

Sir Charles, I am made the unwilling instrument
Of your attach^[14] and apprehension:
I'm sorry that the blood of innocent men
Should be of you exacted. It was told me
That you were guarded with a troop of friends,
And therefore I come thus armed.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

O, Master Sheriff,
I came into the field with many friends,
But see, they all have left me: only one
Clings to my sad misfortune, my dear sister.
I know you for an honest gentleman;
I yield my weapons, and submit to you;
Convey me where you please.

SHERIFF.

To prison then,
To answer for the lives of these dead men.

SUSAN.

O God! O God!

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Sweet sister, every strain
Of sorrow from your heart augments my pain;
Your grief abounds, and hits against my breast.

SHERIFF.

Sir, will you go?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Even where it likes you best.

[Exeunt.]

ACT THE SECOND.

SCENE I.—FRANKFORD'S *Study*.

Enter FRANKFORD.

FRANKFORD.

How happy am I amongst other men,
That in my mean estate embrace content!
I am a gentleman, and by my birth,
Companion with a king; a king's no more.
I am possessed of many fair revenues,
Sufficient to maintain a gentleman.
Touching my mind, I am studied in all arts;
The riches of my thoughts, and of my time,
Have been a good proficient; but the chief
Of all the sweet felicities on earth,
I have a fair, a chaste, and loving wife;
Perfection all, all truth, all ornament:
If man on earth may truly happy be,
Of these at once possessed, sure I am he.

Enter NICHOLAS.

NICHOLAS.

Sir, there's a gentleman attends without
To speak with you.

FRANKFORD.

On horseback?

NICHOLAS.

Yes, on horseback.

FRANKFORD.

Entreat him to alight, I will attend him.
Know'st thou him, Nick?

NICHOLAS.

Know him! yes, his name's Wendoll:
It seems he comes in haste: his horse is booted
Up to the flank in mire, himself all spotted
And stained with plashing. Sure he rid in fear,
Or for a wager: horse and man both sweat;
I ne'er saw two in such a smoking heat.

FRANKFORD.

Entreat him in: about it instantly. [*Exit* NICHOLAS.
This Wendoll I have noted, and his carriage
Hath pleased me much: by observation
I have noted many good deserts in him:
He's affable, and seen [\[15\]](#) in many things,
Discourses well, a good companion;
And though of small means, yet a gentleman
Of a good house, though somewhat pressed by want:
I have preferred him to a second place
In my opinion, and my best regard.

Enter WENDOLL, Mistress FRANKFORD, *and* NICHOLAS.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

O Master Frankford, Master Wendoll here
Brings you the strangest news that e'er you heard.

FRANKFORD.

What news, sweet wife? What news, good Master Wendoll?

WENDOLL.

You knew the match made 'twixt Sir Francis Acton
And Sir Charles Mountford.

FRANKFORD.

True, with their hounds and hawks.

WENDOLL.

The matches were both played.

FRANKFORD.

Ha! and which won?

WENDOLL.

Sir Francis, your wife's brother, had the worst,
And lost the wager.

FRANKFORD.

Why, the worse his chance:
Perhaps the fortune of some other day
Will change his luck.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Oh, but you hear not all.
Sir Francis lost, and yet was loth to yield:
At length the two knights grew to difference,
From words to blows, and so to banding sides;
Where valorous Sir Charles slew in his spleen
Two of your brother's men; his falconer,
And his good huntsman, whom he loved so well:
More men were wounded, no more slain outright.

FRANKFORD.

Now, trust me, I am sorry for the knight;
But is my brother safe?

WENDOLL.

All whole and sound,
His body not being blemished with one wound:
But poor Sir Charles is to the prison led,
To answer at the assize for them that's dead.

FRANKFORD.

I thank your pains, sir; had the news been better
Your will was to have brought it, Master Wendoll.

Sir Charles will find hard friends; his case is heinous,
And will be most severely censured on[16]:
I'm sorry for him. Sir, a word with you;
I know you, sir, to be a gentleman
In all things; your possibilities but mean:
Please you to use my table and my purse,
They are yours.

WENDOLL.

O Lord, sir, I shall never deserve it.

FRANKFORD.

O sir, disparage not your worth too much:
You are full of quality and fair desert:
Choose of my men which shall attend on you,
And he is yours. I will allow you, sir,
Your man, your gelding, and your table, all
At my own charge; be my companion.

WENDOLL.

Master Frankford, I have oft been bound to you
By many favours; this exceeds them all,
That I shall never merit your least favour:
But, when your last remembrance I forget,
Heaven at my soul exact that weighty debt!

FRANKFORD.

There needs no protestation; for I know you
Virtuous, and therefore grateful. Prythee, Nan,
Use him with all thy loving'st courtesy.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

As far as modesty may well extend,
It is my duty to receive your friend.

FRANKFORD.

To dinner, come, sir; from this present day,
Welcome to me for ever: come, away.

[*Exeunt* FRANKFORD, Mistress FRANKFORD, *and* WENDOLL.

NICHOLAS.

I do not like this fellow by no means:
I never see him but my heart still yearns:
Zounds! I could fight with him, yet know not why:
The devil and he are all one in my eye.

Enter JENKIN.

JENKIN.

O Nick, what gentleman is that comes to lie at our house? my master allows him one to wait on him, and I believe it will fall to thy lot.

NICHOLAS.

I love my master; by these hilts I do!
But rather than I'll ever come to serve him,
I'll turn away my master.

Enter CICELY.

CICELY.

Nich'las, where are you, Nich'las? you must come in, Nich'las, and help the young gentleman off with his boots.

NICHOLAS.

If I pluck off his boots, I'll eat the spurs,
And they shall stick fast in my throat like burs.

CICELY.

Then, Jenkin, come you.

JENKIN.

Nay, 'tis no boot for me to deny it. My master hath given me a coat here, but he takes pains himself to brush it once or twice a day with a holly-wand.

CICELY.

Come, come, make haste, that you may wash your hands again, and help to serve in dinner.

JENKIN.

You may see, my masters, though it be afternoon with you, 'tis but early days with us, for we have not dined yet: stay a little, I'll but go in and help to bear up the first course, and come to you again presently.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—A Room in the Gaol.

Enter MALBY and CRANWELL.

MALBY.

This is the sessions-day; pray can you tell me
How young Sir Charles hath sped? Is he acquit,
Or must he try the law's strict penalty?

CRANWELL.

He's cleared of all, spite of his enemies,
Whose earnest labour was to take his life:
But in this suit of pardon he hath spent
All the revenues that his father left him;
And he is now turned a plain countryman,
Reformed in all things. See, sir, here he comes.

Enter Sir CHARLES and Keeper.

KEEPER.

Discharge your fees, and you are then at freedom.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Here, Master Keeper, take the poor remainder
Of all the wealth I have: my heavy foes
Have made my purse light; but, alas! to me
'Tis wealth enough that you have set me free.

MALBY.

God give you joy of your delivery!
I am glad to see you abroad, Sir Charles.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

The poorest knight in England, Master Malby:
My life hath cost me all my patrimony
My father left his son: well, God forgive them

That are the authors of my penury.

Enter SHAFTON.

SHAFTON.

Sir Charles! a hand, a hand! at liberty?
Now, by the faith I owe, I am glad to see it.
What want you? wherein may I pleasure you?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

O me! O most unhappy gentleman!
I am not worthy to have friends stirred up,
Whose hands may help me in this plunge of want.
I would I were in Heaven, to inherit there
The immortal birth-right which my Saviour keeps,
And by no unthrift can be bought and sold;
For here on earth what pleasures should we trust?

SHAFTON.

To rid you from these contemplations,
Three hundred pounds you shall receive of me;
Nay, five for fail. Come, sir; the sight of gold
Is the most sweet receipt for melancholy,
And will revive your spirits: you shall hold law
With your proud adversaries. Tush, let Frank Acton
Wage with his knighthood like expense with me,
And he will sink, he will. Nay, good Sir Charles,
Applaud your fortune, and your fair escape
From all these perils.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

O sir, they have undone me.
Two thousand and five hundred pound a year
My father, at his death, possessed me of;
All which the envious Acton made me spend.
And, notwithstanding all this large expense,
I had much ado to gain my liberty:
And I have only now a house of pleasure,

With some five hundred pounds, reserved
Both to maintain me and my loving sister.

SHAFTON.

[*Aside.*] That must I have, it lies convenient for me:
If I can fasten but one finger on him,
With my full hand I'll gripe him to the heart.
'Tis not for love I proffered him this coin,
But for my gain and pleasure. [*Aloud.*] Come, Sir Charles,
I know you have need of money; take my offer.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Sir, I accept it, and remain indebted
Even to the best of my unable power.
Come, gentlemen, and see it tendered down.

[*Exeunt.*]

SCENE III.—A Room in FRANKFORD'S House.

Enter WENDOLL melancholy.

WENDOLL.

I am a villain if I apprehend
But such a thought: then, to attempt the deed,—
Slave, thou art damned without redemption.
I'll drive away this passion with a song.
A song! ha, ha: a song! as if, fond man,
Thy eyes could swim in laughter, when thy soul
Lies drenched and drownèd in red tears of blood.
I'll pray, and see if God within my heart
Plant better thoughts. Why, prayers are meditations;
And when I meditate (O God, forgive me!)
It is on her divine perfections.
I will forget her; I will arm myself
Not to entertain a thought of love to her:
And, when I come by chance into her presence,
I'll hale these balls until my eye-strings crack,
From being pulled and drawn to look that way.

[*Enter over the stage, FRANKFORD, Mistress FRANKFORD, and NICHOLAS.*]

[17]

O God! O God! with what a violence
I'm hurried to mine own destruction.
There goest thou, the most perfectest man
That ever England bred a gentleman;
And shall I wrong his bed? Thou God of thunder!
Stay in thy thoughts of vengeance and of wrath,
Thy great, almighty, and all-judging hand
From speedy execution on a villain:
A villain, and a traitor to his friend.

Enter JENKIN.

JENKIN.

Did your worship call?

WENDOLL.

He doth maintain me, he allows me largely
Money to spend——

JENKIN.

By my faith, so do not you me; I cannot get a cross of you.

WENDOLL.

My gelding, and my man——

JENKIN.

That's Sorrell and I.

WENDOLL.

This kindness grows of no alliance 'twixt us——

JENKIN.

Nor is my service of any great acquaintance.

WENDOLL.

I never bound him to me by desert:
Of a mere stranger, a poor gentleman,
A man by whom in no kind he could gain,
He hath placed me in the height of all his thoughts,
Made me companion with the best and chiefest
In Yorkshire. He cannot eat without me,
Nor laugh without me: I am to his body
As necessary as his digestion,
And equally do make him whole or sick:
And shall I wrong this man? Base man! ingrate!
Hast thou the power straight with thy gory hands
To rip thy image from his bleeding heart?
To scratch thy name from out the holy book
Of his remembrance; and to wound his name
That holds thy name so dear? or rend his heart
To whom thy heart was knit and joined together?

And yet I must: then, Wendoll, be content;
Thus villains, when they would, cannot repent.

JENKIN.

What a strange humour is my new master in! pray God he be not mad: if he should be so, I should never have any mind to serve him in Bedlam. It may be he's mad for missing of me.

WENDOLL.

[*Seeing JENKIN.*] What, Jenkin, where's your mistress?

JENKIN.

Is your worship married?

WENDOLL.

Why dost thou ask?

JENKIN.

Because you are my master; and if I have a mistress, I would be glad, like a good servant, to do my duty to her.

WENDOLL.

I mean Mistress Frankford.

JENKIN.

Marry, sir, her husband is riding out of town, and she went very lovingly to bring him on his way to horse.[\[18\]](#) Do you see, sir? here she comes, and here I go.

WENDOLL.

Vanish.

[*Exit JENKIN.*]

Re-enter Mistress FRANKFORD.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

You are well met, sir; now, in troth, my husband,
Before he took horse, had a great desire

To speak with you: we sought about the house,
Hollaed into the fields, sent every way,
But could not meet you: therefore he enjoined me
To do unto you his most kind commends.
Nay, more; he wills you, as you prize his love,
Or hold in estimation his kind friendship,
To make bold in his absence, and command
Even as himself were present in the house:
For you must keep his table, use his servants,
And be a present Frankford in his absence.

WENDOLL.

I thank him for his love.—
Give me a name, you whose infectious tongues
Are tipped with gall and poison: as you would
Think on a man that had your father slain,
Murdered your children, made your wives base strumpets,
So call me, call me so: print in my face
The most stigmatic title of a villain,
For hatching treason to so true a friend. [*Aside.*]

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Sir, you are much beholding[\[19\]](#) to my husband;
You are a man most dear in his regard.

WENDOLL.

[*Aside.*] I am bound unto your husband, and you too.
I will not speak to wrong a gentleman
Of that good estimation, my kind friend:
I will not; zounds! I will not. I may choose,
And I will choose. Shall I be so misled?
Or shall I purchase to my father's crest
The motto of a villain? If I say
I will not do it, what thing can enforce me?
What can compel me? What sad destiny
Hath such command upon my yielding thoughts?
I will not—Ha! some fury pricks me on,

The swift Fates drag me at their chariot-wheel,
And hurry me to mischief. Speak I must;
Injure myself, wrong her, deceive his trust.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Are you not well, sir, that you seem thus troubled?
There is sedition in your countenance.

WENDOLL.

And in my heart, fair angel, chaste and wise.
I love you: start not, speak not, answer not.
I love you: nay, let me speak the rest:
Bid me to swear, and I will call to record
The host of Heaven.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

The host of Heaven forbid
Wendoll should hatch such a disloyal thought!

WENDOLL.

Such is my fate; to this suit I was born,
To wear rich pleasure's crown, or fortune's scorn.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

My husband loves you.

WENDOLL.

I know it.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

He esteems you
Even as his brain, his eye-ball, or his heart.

WENDOLL.

I have tried it.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

His purse is your exchequer, and his table

Doth freely serve you.

WENDOLL.

So I have found it.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

O! with what face of brass, what brow of steel,
Can you, unblushing, speak this to the face
Of the espoused wife of so dear a friend?
It is my husband that maintains your state;
Will you dishonour him that in your power
Hath left his whole affairs? I am his wife,
It is to me you speak.

WENDOLL.

O speak no more!
For more than this I know, and have recorded
Within the red-leaved table of my heart.
Fair, and of all beloved, I was not fearful
Bluntly to give my life into your hand,
And at one hazard all my earthly means.
Go, tell your husband; he will turn me off,
And I am then undone. I care not, I;
'Twas for your sake. Perchance in rage he'll kill me:
I care not, 'twas for you. Say I incur
The general name of villain through the world,
Of traitor to my friend; I care not, I.
Beggary, shame, death, scandal, and reproach,
For you I'll hazard all: why, what care I?
For you I'll live, and in your love I'll die.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

You move me, sir, to passion and to pity.
The love I bear my husband is as precious
As my soul's health.

WENDOLL.

I love your husband too,

And for his love I will engage my life:
Mistake me not, the augmentation
Of my sincere affection borne to you
Doth no whit lessen my regard of him.
I will be secret, lady, close as night;
And not the light of one small glorious star
Shall shine here in my forehead, to bewray
That act of night.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

What shall I say?
My soul is wandering, and hath lost her way.
Oh, Master Wendoll! Oh!

WENDOLL.

Sigh not, sweet saint;
For every sigh you breathe draws from my heart
A drop of blood.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I ne'er offended yet:
My fault, I fear, will in my brow be writ.
Women that fall, not quite bereft of grace,
Have their offences noted in their face.
I blush and am ashamed. Oh, Master Wendoll,
Pray God I be not born to curse your tongue,
That hath enchanted me! This maze I am in
I fear will prove the labyrinth of sin.

Re-enter NICHOLAS behind.

WENDOLL.

The path of pleasure, and the gate to bliss,
Which on your lips I knock at with a kiss.

NICHOLAS.

[*Aside.*] I'll kill the rogue.

WENDOLL.

Your husband is from home, your bed's no blab.
Nay, look not down and blush.

[Exeunt WENDOLL and Mistress FRANKFORD.]

NICHOLAS.

Zounds! I'll stab.
Ay, Nick, was it thy chance to come just in the nick?
I love my master, and I hate that slave:
I love my mistress, but these tricks I like not.
My master shall not pocket up this wrong;
I'll eat my fingers first. What say'st thou, metal?
Does not the rascal Wendoll go on legs
That thou must cut off? Hath he not ham-strings
That thou must hough? Nay, metal, thou shalt stand
To all I say. I'll henceforth turn a spy,
And watch them in their close conveyances.
I never looked for better of that rascal,
Since he came miching[20] first into our house:
It is that Satan hath corrupted her,
For she was fair and chaste. I'll have an eye
In all their gestures. Thus I think of them,
If they proceed as they have done before:
Wendoll's a knave, my mistress is a—— *[Exit.]*

ACT THE THIRD.

SCENE I.—*A Room in Sir CHARLES MOUNTFORD's House.*

Enter Sir CHARLES MOUNTFORD and SUSAN.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Sister, you see we are driven to hard shift
To keep this poor house we have left unsold;
I am now enforced to follow husbandry,
And you to milk; and do we not live well?
Well, I thank God.

SUSAN.

O brother, here's a change,
Since old Sir Charles died, in our father's house!

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

All things on earth thus change, some up, some down;
Content's a kingdom, and I wear that crown.

Enter SHAFTON with a Serjeant.

SHAFTON.

Good morrow, morrow, Sir Charles: what, with your sister,
Plying your husbandry?—Serjeant, stand off.—
You have a pretty house here, and a garden,
And goodly ground about it. Since it lies
So near a lordship that I lately bought,
I would fain buy it of you. I will give you——

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

O, pardon me: this house successively
Hath 'longed to me and my progenitors
Three hundred years. My great-great-grandfather,

He in whom first our gentle style began,
Dwelt here; and in this ground, increased this mole-hill
Unto that mountain which my father left me.
Where he the first of all our house began,
I now the last will end, and keep this house,
This virgin title, never yet deflowered
By any unthrift of the Mountfords' line.
In brief, I will not sell it for more gold
Than you could hide or pave the ground withal.

SHAFTON.

Ha, ha! a proud mind and a beggar's purse!
Where's my three hundred pounds, besides the use?
I have brought it to an execution
By course of law: what, is my money ready?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

An execution, sir, and never tell me
You put my bond in suit! you deal extremely.

SHAFTON.

Sell me the land, and I'll acquit you straight.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Alas, alas! 'tis all trouble hath left me
To cherish me and my poor sister's life.
If this were sold, our names should then be quite
Razed from the bed-roll^[21] of gentility.
You see what hard shift we have made to keep it
Allied still to our own name. This palm, you see,
Labour hath glowed within: her silver brow,
That never tasted a rough winter's blast
Without a mask or fan, doth with a grace
Defy cold winter, and his storms outface.

SUSAN.

Sir, we feed sparing, and we labour hard,
We lie uneasy, to reserve to us

And our succession this small plot of ground.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

I have so bent my thoughts to husbandry,
That I protest I scarcely can remember
What a new fashion is; how silk or satin
Feels in my hand: why, pride is grown to us
A mere, mere stranger. I have quite forgot
The names of all that ever waited on me;
I cannot name ye any of my hounds,
Once from whose echoing mouths I heard all music
That e'er my heart desired. What should I say?
To keep this place I have changed myself away.

SHAFTON.

[*To the Serjeant.*] Arrest him at my suit. Actions and actions
Shall keep thee in perpetual bondage fast:
Nay, more, I'll sue thee by a late appeal,
And call thy former life in question.
The keeper is my friend, thou shalt have irons,
And usage such as I'll deny to dogs:
Away with him!

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

[*To SUSAN.*] You are too timorous:
But trouble is my master,
And I will serve him truly.—My kind sister,
Thy tears are of no force to mollify
This flinty man. Go to my father's brother,
My kinsmen and allies; entreat them for me,
To ransom me from this injurious man,
That seeks my ruin.

SHAFTON.

Come, irons, irons! come away;
I'll see thee lodged far from the sight of day.

[*Exeunt* SHAFTON *and* Serjeant *with* Sir CHARLES.

SUSAN.

My heart's so hardened with the frost of grief,
Death cannot pierce it through. Tyrant too fell!
So lead the fiends condemnèd souls to hell.

Enter Sir FRANCIS ACTON and MALBY.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Again to prison! Malby, hast thou seen
A poor slave better tortured? Shall we hear
The music of his voice cry from the grate, [\[22\]](#)
“Meat for the Lord’s sake”? No, no, yet I am not
Thoroughly revenged. They say he hath a pretty wench
Unto his sister: shall I, in mercy-sake
To him and to his kindred, bribe the fool
To shame herself by lewd dishonest lust?
I’ll proffer largely; but, the deed being done,
I’ll smile to see her base confusion.

MALBY.

Methinks, Sir Francis, you are full revenged
For greater wrongs than he can proffer you.
See where the poor sad gentlewoman stands.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Ha, ha! now will I flout her poverty,
Deride her fortunes, scoff her base estate;
My very soul the name of Mountford hates.
But stay, my heart! oh, what a look did fly
To strike my soul through with thy piercing eye!
I am enchanted; all my spirits are fled,
And with one glance my envious spleen struck dead.

SUSAN.

Acton! that seeks our blood. [*Runs away.*]

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

O chaste and fair!

MALBY.

Sir Francis, why, Sir Francis, zounds! in a trance?
Sir Francis, what cheer, man? Come, come, how is't?

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Was she not fair? Or else this judging eye
Cannot distinguish beauty.

MALBY.

She was fair.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

She was an angel in a mortal's shape,
And ne'er descended from old Mountford's line.
But soft, soft, let me call my wits together.
A poor, poor wench, to my great adversary
Sister, whose very souls denounce stern war,
One against other. How now, Frank? turned fool
Or madman, whether? But no; master of
My perfect senses and directest wits.
Then why should I be in this violent humour
Of passion and of love; and with a person
So different every way, and so opposed
In all contractions, and still-warring actions?
Fie, fie; how I dispute against my soul!
Come, come; I'll gain her, or in her fair quest
Purchase my soul free and immortal rest.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—A Sitting-Room in FRANKFORD'S House.

Enter Serving-Men, one with a voider and a wooden knife[23] to take away; another with the salt and bread; another with the table-cloth and napkins; another with the carpet:[24] JENKIN follows them with two lights.

JENKIN.

So, march in order, and retire in battle array. My master and the guests have supped already, all's taken away: here, now spread for the serving-men in the hall. Butler, it belongs to your office.

BUTLER.

I know it, Jenkin. What d'ye call the gentleman that supped there to-night?

JENKIN.

Who, my master?

BUTLER.

No, no; Master Wendoll, he's a daily guest: I mean the gentleman that came but this afternoon.

JENKIN.

His name's Master Cranwell. God's light, hark, within there, my master calls to lay more billets upon the fire. Come, come! Lord, how we that are in office here in the house are troubled! One spread the carpet in the parlour, and stand ready to snuff the lights; the rest be ready to prepare their stomachs. More lights in the hall there. Come, Nich'las.

[Exeunt all but NICHOLAS.]

NICHOLAS.

I cannot eat, but had I Wendoll's heart
I would eat that; the rogue grows impudent.
Oh, I have seen such vile notorious tricks,

Ready to make my eyes dart from my head.
I'll tell my master, by this air I will!
Fall what may fall, I'll tell him. Here he comes.

*Enter FRANKFORD, brushing the crumbs from his clothes with a napkin,
as newly risen from supper.*

FRANKFORD.

Nicholas, what make you here? why are not you
At supper in the hall among your fellows?

NICHOLAS.

Master, I stayed your rising from the board,
To speak with you.

FRANKFORD.

Be brief, then, gentle Nicholas;
My wife and guests attend me in the parlour.
Why dost thou pause? Now, Nicholas, you want money,
And, unthrift-like, would eat into your wages
Ere you have earned it: here, sir, 's half a crown;
Play the good husband,[\[25\]](#) and away to supper.

NICHOLAS.

By this hand, an honourable gentleman! I will not see him wronged.—
Sir, I have served you long; you entertained me seven years before your
beard.[\[26\]](#) You knew me, sir, before you knew my mistress.

FRANKFORD.

What of this, good Nicholas?

NICHOLAS.

I never was a make-bate[\[27\]](#) or a knave;
I have no fault but one: I'm given to quarrel,
But not with women. I will tell you, master,
That which will make your heart leap from your breast,
Your hair to startle from your head, your ears to tingle.

FRANKFORD.

What preparation's this to dismal news?

NICHOLAS.

'Sblood, sir! I love you better than your wife;
I'll make it good.

FRANKFORD.

You are a knave, and I have much ado
With wonted patience to contain my rage,
And not to break thy pate. Thou art a knave:
I'll turn you, with your base comparisons,
Out of my doors.

NICHOLAS.

Do, do: there is not room
For Wendoll and for me both in one house.
Oh master, master, that Wendoll is a villain.

FRANKFORD.

Ay, saucy!

NICHOLAS.

Strike, strike; do, strike; yet hear me: I am no fool,
I know a villain, when I see him act
Deeds of a villain. Master, master, that base slave
Enjoys my mistress, and dishonours you.

FRANKFORD.

Thou hast killed me with a weapon whose sharp point
Hath pricked quite through and through my shivering heart:
Drops of cold sweat sit dangling on my hairs,
Like morning's dew upon the golden flowers,
And I am plunged into strange agonies.
What didst thou say? If any word that touched
His credit or her reputation,
It is as hard to enter my belief
As Dives into heaven.

NICHOLAS.

I can gain nothing;
They are two that never wronged me. I knew before
'Twas but a thankless office, and perhaps
As much as is my service, or my life
Is worth. All this I know; but this and more,
More by a thousand dangers, could not hire me
To smother such a heinous wrong from you.
I saw, and I have said.

FRANKFORD.

[*Aside.*] 'Tis probable; though blunt, yet he is honest:
Though I durst pawn my life, and on their faith
Hazard the dear salvation of my soul,
Yet in my trust I may be too secure.
May this be true? O, may it, can it be?
Is it by any wonder possible?
Man, woman, what thing mortal may we trust,
When friends and bosom wives prove so unjust?—
[*To NICHOLAS.*] What instance hast thou of this strange report?

NICHOLAS.

Eyes, eyes.

FRANKFORD.

Thy eyes may be deceived, I tell thee:
For, should an angel from the heavens drop down,
And preach this to me that thyself hast told,
He should have much ado to win belief;
In both their loves I am so confident.

NICHOLAS.

Shall I discourse the same by circumstance?

FRANKFORD.

No more! to supper, and command your fellows
To attend us and the strangers. Not a word,
I charge thee on thy life: be secret then,

For I know nothing.

NICHOLAS.

I am dumb; and, now that I have eased my stomach,
I will go fill my stomach.

FRANKFORD.

Away; be gone. [*Exit NICHOLAS.*
She is well born, descended nobly;
Virtuous her education, her repute
Is in the general voice of all the country
Honest and fair; her carriage, her demeanour,
In all her actions that concern the love
To me her husband, modest, chaste, and godly.
Is all this seeming gold plain copper?
But he, that Judas that hath borne my purse,
And sold me for a sin!—O God! O God!
Shall I put up these wrongs? No. Shall I trust
The bare report of this suspicious groom,
Before the double-gilt, the well-hatched ore
Of their two hearts? No, I will lose these thoughts:
Distraction I will banish from my brow,
And from my looks exile sad discontent,
Their wonted favours in my tongue shall flow;
Till I know all, I'll nothing seem to know.
Lights and a table there! Wife, Master Wendoll,
And gentle Master Cranwell.

*Enter Mistress FRANKFORD, WENDOLL, CRANWELL, NICHOLAS, and
JENKIN, with cards, carpets, stools, and other necessities.*

FRANKFORD.

O Master Cranwell, you are a stranger here,
And often baulk my house: faith, y'are a churl:
Now we have supped, a table, and to cards.

JENKIN.

A pair of cards,[\[28\]](#) Nicholas, and a carpet to cover the table. Where's Cicely with her counters and her box? Candles and candlesticks there! Fie, we have such a household of serving creatures! unless it be Nick and I, there's not one amongst them all can say bo to a goose. Well said,[\[29\]](#) Nick.

[They spread a carpet, set down lights and cards.]

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Come, Master Frankford, who shall take my part?

FRANKFORD.

Marry, that will I, sweet wife.

WENDOLL.

No, by my faith, sir; when you are together I sit out: it must be Mistress Frankford and I, or else it is no match.

FRANKFORD.

I do not like that match.

NICHOLAS.

[Aside.] You have no reason, marry, knowing all.

FRANKFORD.

'Tis no great matter neither. Come, Master Cranwell, shall you and I take them up?

CRANWELL.

At your pleasure, sir.

FRANKFORD.

I must look to you, Master Wendoll, for you will be playing false; nay, so will my wife too.

NICHOLAS.

[Aside.] Ay, I will be sworn she will.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Let them that are taken playing false, forfeit the set.

FRANKFORD.

Content; it shall go hard but I'll take you.

CRANWELL.

Gentlemen, what shall our game be?

WENDOLL.

Master Frankford, you play best at noddy.[\[30\]](#)

FRANKFORD.

You shall not find it so; indeed you shall not.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I can play at nothing so well as double ruff.

FRANKFORD.

If Master Wendoll and my wife be together, there's no playing against them at double hand.

NICHOLAS.

I can tell you, sir, the game that Master Wendoll is best at.

WENDOLL.

What game is that, Nick?

NICHOLAS.

Marry, sir, knave out of doors.

WENDOLL.

She and I will take you at lodam.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Husband, shall we play at saint?

FRANKFORD.

My saint's turned devil. No, we'll none of saint:
You are best at new-cut, wife; you'll play at that.

WENDOLL.

If you play at new-cut, I am soonest hitter of any here, for a wager.

FRANKFORD.

'Tis me they play on. Well, you may draw out.
For all your cunning, 'twill be to your shame;
I'll teach you, at your new-cut, a new game.
Come, come.

CRANWELL.

If you cannot agree upon the game, to post and pair.

WENDOLL.

We shall be soonest pairs; and my good host,
When he comes late home, he must kiss the post.

FRANKFORD.

Whoever wins, it shall be thy cost.

CRANWELL.

Faith, let it be vide-ruff, and let's make honours.

FRANKFORD.

If you make honours, one thing let me crave:
Honour the king and queen; except the knave.

WENDOLL.

Well, as you please for that. Lift who shall deal.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

The least in sight: what are you, Master Wendoll?

WENDOLL.

I am a knave.

NICHOLAS.

[*Aside.*] I'll swear it.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I a queen.

FRANKFORD.

[*Aside.*] A quean[31] thou shouldst say. [*Aloud.*] Well, the cards are mine;
They are the grossest pair that e'er I felt.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Shuffle, I'll cut: would I had never dealt.

FRANKFORD.

I have lost my dealing.

WENDOLL.

Sir, the fault's in me:
This queen I have more than mine own, you see.
Give me the stock.

FRANKFORD.

My mind's not on my game.
Many a deal I have lost; the more's your shame.
You have served me a bad trick, Master Wendoll.

WENDOLL.

Sir, you must take your lot. To end this strife,
I know I have dealt better with your wife.

FRANKFORD.

Thou hast dealt falsely, then.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

What's trumps?

WENDOLL.

Hearts: partner, I rub.

FRANKFORD.

[*Aside.*] Thou robb'st me of my soul, of her chaste love;
In thy false dealing thou hast robbed my heart.

[*Aloud.*] Booty you play; I like a loser stand,
Having no heart, or here or in my hand.
I will give o'er the set; I am not well.
Come, who will hold my cards?

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Not well, sweet Master Frankford!
Alas, what ail you? 'Tis some sudden qualm.

WENDOLL.

How long have you been so, Master Frankford?

FRANKFORD.

Sir, I was lusty, and I had my health,
But I grew ill when you began to deal.
Take hence this table. Gentle Master Cranwell,
You are welcome; see your chamber at your pleasure.
I'm sorry that this meagrim takes me so,
I cannot sit and bear you company.
Jenkin, some lights, and show him to his chamber.

[*Exeunt CRANWELL and JENKIN.*]

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

A night-gown for my husband; quickly there:
It is some rheum or cold.

WENDOLL.

Now, in good faith, this illness you have got
By sitting late without your gown.

FRANKFORD.

I know it, Master Wendoll.
Go, go to bed, lest you complain like me.
Wife, prythee, wife, into my bed-chamber;
The night is raw and cold, and rheumatic:
Leave me my gown and light; I'll walk away my fit.

WENDOLL.

Sweet sir, good night.

FRANKFORD.

Myself, good night.

[Exit WENDOLL.]

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Shall I attend you, husband?

FRANKFORD.

No, gentle wife, thou'lt catch cold in thy head;
Prythee, be gone, sweet; I'll make haste to bed.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

No sleep will fasten on mine eyes, you know,
Until you come.

FRANKFORD.

Sweet Nan, I prythee go.— *[Exit Mistress FRANKFORD.]*
I have bethought me: get me, by degrees,
The keys of all my doors, which I will mould
In wax, and take their fair impression,
To have by them new keys. This being compassed,
At a set hour a letter shall be brought me,
And, when they think they may securely play,
They nearest are to danger. Nick, I must rely
Upon thy trust and faithful secrecy.

NICHOLAS.

Build on my faith.

FRANKFORD.

To bed then, not to rest:
Care lodges in my brain, grief in my breast.

[Exeunt.]

ACT THE FOURTH.

SCENE I.—A Room in Old MOUNTFORD'S House.

Enter SUSAN, Old MOUNTFORD, SANDY, RODER, and TIDY.

OLD MOUNTFORD.

You say my nephew is in great distress:
Who brought it to him, but his own lewd life?
I cannot spare a cross.[\[32\]](#) I must confess
He was my brother's son: why, niece, what then?
This is no world in which to pity men.

SUSAN.

I was not born a beggar, though his extremes
Enforce this language from me: I protest
No fortune of mine own could lead my tongue
To this base key. I do beseech you, uncle,
For the name's sake, for Christianity,
Nay, for God's sake, to pity his distress:
He is denied the freedom of the prison,
And in the hole is laid with men condemned;
Plenty he hath of nothing but of irons,
And it remains in you to free him thence.

OLD MOUNTFORD.

Money I cannot spare; men should take heed;
He lost my kindred when he fell to need. *[Exit.*

SUSAN.

Gold is but earth, thou earth enough shalt have,
When thou hast once took measure of thy grave.
You know me, Master Sandy, and my suit.

SANDY.

I knew you, lady, when the old man lived;
I knew you ere your brother sold his land;
Then you sung well, played sweetly on the lute;
But now I neither know you nor your suit. [*Exit.*

SUSAN.

You, Master Roder, was my brother's tenant,
Rent free he placed you in that wealthy farm,
Of which you are possessed.

RODER.

True, he did;
And have I not there dwelt still for his sake?
I have some business now; but, without doubt,
They that have hurled him in will help him out. [*Exit.*

SUSAN.

Cold comfort still: what say you, cousin Tidy?

TIDY.

I say this comes of roysting, swaggering.
Call me not cousin: each man for himself.
Some men are born to mirth, and some to sorrow.
I am no cousin unto them that borrow. [*Exit.*

SUSAN.

O charity! why art thou fled to heaven,
And left all things upon this earth uneven?
Their scoffing answers I will ne'er return;
But to myself his grief in silence mourn.

Enter Sir FRANCIS ACTON and MALBY.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

She is poor, I'll therefore tempt her with this gold.
Go, Malby, in my name deliver it,
And I will stay thy answer.

MALBY.

Fair mistress, as I understand, your grief
Doth grow from want, so I have here in store
A means to furnish you, a bag of gold,
Which to your hands I freely tender you.

SUSAN.

I thank you, Heavens! I thank you, gentle sir:
God make me able to requite this favour!

MALBY.

This gold Sir Francis Acton sends by me,
And prays you——

SUSAN.

Acton! O God! that name I am born to curse:
Hence, bawd! hence, broker! see, I spurn his gold;
My honour never shall for gain be sold.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Stay, lady, stay.

SUSAN.

From you I'll posting hie,
Even as the doves from feathered eagles fly. [*Exit.*

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

She hates my name, my face: how should I woo?
I am disgraced in every thing I do.
The more she hates me, and disdains my love,
The more I am rapt in admiration
Of her divine and chaste perfections.
Woo her with gifts I cannot, for all gifts
Sent in my name she spurns: with looks I cannot,
For she abhors my sight; nor yet with letters,
For none she will receive. How then, how then?
Well, I will fasten such a kindness on her
As shall o'ercome her hate and conquer it.

Sir Charles, her brother, lies in execution
For a great sum of money; and, besides,
The appeal is sued still for my huntsman's death,
Which only I have power to reverse:
In her I'll bury all my hate of him.
Go seek the keeper, Malby, bring him to me:
To save his body, I his debts will pay;
To save his life, I his appeal will stay.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—A Prison Cell.

Enter Sir CHARLES MOUNTFORD, with irons, his feet bare, his garments all ragged and torn.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Of all on the earth's face most miserable,
Breathe in this hellish dungeon thy laments,
Thus like a slave ragged, like a felon gyved.
What hurls thee headlong to this base estate?
O unkind uncle! O my friends ingrate!
Unthankful kinsmen! Mountford's all too base,
To let thy name be fettered in disgrace!
A thousand deaths here in this grave I die;
Fear, hunger, sorrow, cold, all threat my death,
And join together to deprive my breath.
But that which most torments me, my dear sister
Hath left to visit me, and from my friends
Hath brought no hopeful answer: therefore I
Divine they will not help my misery.
If it be so, shame, scandal, and contempt
Attend their covetous thoughts; need make their graves!
Usurers they live, and may they die like slaves!

Enter Keeper.

KEEPER.

Knight, be of comfort, for I bring thee freedom
From all thy troubles.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Then I am doomed to die;
Death is the end of all calamity.

KEEPER.

Live: your appeal is stayed; the execution

Of all your debts discharged; your creditors
Even to the utmost penny satisfied.
In sign whereof, your shackles I knock off;
You are not left so much indebted to us
As for your fees; all is discharged, all paid.
Go freely to your house, or where you please;
After long miseries, embrace your ease.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Thou grumblest out the sweetest music to me
That ever organ played. Is this a dream?
Or do my waking senses apprehend
The pleasing taste of these applausive news?
Slave that I was, to wrong such honest friends,
My loving kinsmen, and my near allies.
Tongue, I will bite thee for the scandal breathed
Against such faithful kinsmen: they are all
Composed of pity and compassion,
Of melting charity, and of moving ruth.
That which I spake before was in my rage;
They are my friends, the mirrors of this age,
Bounteous and free. The noble Mountford's race,
Ne'er bred a covetous thought, or humour base.

Enter SUSAN.

SUSAN.

I can no longer stay from visiting
My woful brother: while I could, I kept
My hapless tidings from his hopeful ear.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Sister, how much am I indebted to thee,
And to thy travel!

SUSAN.

What, at liberty?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Thou seest I am, thanks to thy industry:
Oh! unto which of all my courteous friends
Am I thus bound? My uncle Mountford, he
Even of an infant loved me: was it he?
So did my cousin Tidy; was it he?
So Master Roder, Master Sandy too:
Which of all these did this high kindness do?

SUSAN.

Charles, can you mock me in your poverty,
Knowing your friends deride your misery?
Now, I protest I stand so much amazed
To see your bonds free, and your irons knocked off,
That I am rapt into a maze of wonder:
The rather for I know not by what means
This happiness hath chanced.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Why, by my uncle,
My cousins, and my friends: who else, I pray,
Would take upon them all my debts to pay?

SUSAN.

O brother, they are men all of flint,
Pictures of marble, and as void of pity
As chased bears. I begged, I sued, I kneeled,
Laid open all your griefs and miseries,
Which they derided; more than that, denied us
A part in their alliance; but, in pride,
Said that our kindred with our plenty died.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Drudges too much—what did they? oh, known evil!
Rich fly the poor, as good men shun the devil.
Whence should my freedom come? of whom alive,
Saving of those, have I deserved so well?
Guess, sister, call to mind, remember [\[33\]](#) me:

These I have raised; they follow the world's guise;
Whom rich in honour, they in woe despise.

SUSAN.

My wits have lost themselves, let's ask the keeper.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Gaoler!

KEEPER.

At hand, sir.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Of courtesy resolve me one demand.
What was he took the burthen of my debts
From off my back, stayed my appeal to death,
Discharged my fees, and brought me liberty?

KEEPER.

A courteous knight, one called Sir Francis Acton.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Ha! Acton! O me, more distressed in this
Than all my troubles! hale me back,
Double my irons, and my sparing meals
Put into halves, and lodge me in a dungeon
More deep, more dark, more cold, more comfortless.
By Acton freed! not all thy manacles
Could fetter so my heels as this one word
Hath thrall'd my heart; and it must now lie bound
In more strict prison than thy stony gaol.
I am not free; I go but under bail.

KEEPER.

My charge is done, sir, now I have my fees;
As we get little, we will nothing leese.[\[34\]](#) *[Exit.*

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

By Acton freed, my dangerous opposite!
Why, to what end? on what occasion? ha!
Let me forget the name of enemy,
And with indifference balance this high favour:
Ha!

SUSAN.

[*Aside.*] His love to me? upon my soul 'tis so:
That is the root from whence these strange things grow.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Had this proceeded from my father, he
That by the law of nature is most bound
In offices of love, it had deserved
My best employment to requite that grace:
Had it proceeded from my friends or him,
From them this action had deserved my life:
And from a stranger more; because from such
There is less expectation^[35] of good deeds.
But he, nor father, nor ally, nor friend,
More than a stranger, both remote in blood
And in his heart opposed my enemy,—
That this high bounty should proceed from him,—
Oh, there I lose myself! What should I say,
What think, what do, his bounty to repay?

SUSAN.

You, wonder, I am sure, whence this strange kindness
Proceeds in Acton. I will tell you, brother:
He dotes on me, and oft hath sent me gifts,
Letters and tokens: I refused them all.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

I have enough, though poor; my heart is set,
In one rich gift to pay back all my debt.

[*Exeunt.*]

SCENE III.—A Room in FRANKFORD'S House.

Enter FRANKFORD, and NICHOLAS with keys.

FRANKFORD.

This is the night that I must play my part
To try two seeming angels. Where's my keys?

NICHOLAS.

They are made according to your mould in wax:
I bade the smith be secret, gave him money,
And here they are. The letter, sir.

FRANKFORD.

True, take it, there it is; [*Gives him letter.*
And when thou seest me in my pleasant'st vein,
Ready to sit to supper, bring it me.

NICHOLAS.

I'll do't, make no more question but I'll do't. [*Exit.*

Enter Mistress FRANKFORD, CRANWELL, WENDOLL, and JENKIN.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Sirrah, 'tis six o'clock already struck!
Go bid them spread the cloth and serve in supper.

JENKIN.

It shall be done, forsooth, mistress. Where's Spigot, the butler, to give us
out salt and trenchers? [*Exit.*

WENDOLL.

We that have been a-hunting all the day
Come with prepared stomachs. Master Frankford,
We wished you at our sport.

FRANKFORD.

My heart was with you, and my mind was on you.
Fie, Master Cranwell! you are still thus sad?
A stool, a stool. Where's Jenkin, and where's Nick?
'Tis supper-time at least an hour ago.
What's the best news abroad?

WENDOLL.

I know none good.

FRANKFORD.

But I know too much bad. [*Aside.*

Enter JENKIN and Butler with a table-cloth, bread, trenchers, and salt.

CRANWELL.

Methinks, sir, you might have that interest
In your wife's brother, to be more remiss
In his hard dealing against poor Sir Charles,
Who, as I hear, lies in York Castle, needy,
And in great want.

[*Exeunt JENKIN and Butler.*

FRANKFORD.

Did not more weighty business of my own
Hold me away, I would have laboured peace
Betwixt them, with all care; indeed I would, sir.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I'll write unto my brother earnestly
In that behalf.

WENDOLL.

A charitable deed,
And will beget the good opinion
Of all your friends that love you, Mistress Frankford.

FRANKFORD.

That's you for one; I know you love Sir Charles,
And my wife too, well.

WENDOLL.

He deserves the love
Of all true gentlemen; be yourselves judge.

FRANKFORD.

But supper, ho! Now as thou lov'st me, Wendoll,
Which I am sure thou dost, be merry, pleasant,
And frolic it to-night. Sweet Master Cranwell,
Do you the like. Wife, I protest my heart
Was ne'er more bent on sweet alacrity.
Where be those lazy knaves to serve in supper?

Re-enter NICHOLAS.

NICHOLAS.

Here's a letter, sir.

FRANKFORD.

Whence comes it? and who brought it?

NICHOLAS.

A stripling that below attends your answer,
And, as he tells me, it is sent from York.

FRANKFORD.

Have him into the cellar; let him taste
A cup of our March beer: go, make him drink. [*Reads the letter.*]

NICHOLAS.

I'll make him drunk, if he be a Trojan.

FRANKFORD.

My boots and spurs! where's Jenkin? God forgive me,
How I neglect my business! Wife, look here;
I have a matter to be tried to-morrow

By eight o'clock, and my attorney writes me,
I must be there betimes with evidence,
Or it will go against me. Where's my boots?

Re-enter JENKIN with boots and spurs.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I hope your business craves no such despatch
That you must ride to-night.

WENDOLL.

[*Aside.*] I hope it doth.

FRANKFORD.

God's me! no such despatch!
Jenkin, my boots. Where's Nick? Saddle my roan,
And the grey dapple for himself. Content ye,
It much concerns me. Gentle Master Cranwell,
And Master Wendoll, in my absence use
The very ripest pleasures of my house.

WENDOLL.

Lord! Master Frankford, will you ride to-night?
The ways are dangerous.

FRANKFORD.

Therefore will I ride
Appointed well; and so shall Nick my man.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I'll call you up by five o'clock to-morrow.

FRANKFORD.

No, by my faith, wife, I'll not trust to that;
'Tis not such easy rising in a morning
From one I love so dearly: no, by my faith,
I shall not leave so sweet a bedfellow,
But with much pain. You have made me a sluggard

Since I first knew you.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Then, if you needs will go
This dangerous evening, Master Wendoll,
Let me entreat you bear him company.

WENDOLL.

With all my heart, sweet mistress. My boots there!

FRANKFORD.

Fie, fie, that for my private business
I should disease [\[36\]](#) my friend, and be a trouble
To the whole house! Nick!

NICHOLAS.

Anon, sir.

FRANKFORD.

Bring forth my gelding.—*[Exit NICHOLAS.]*—As you love me, sir,
Use no more words: a hand, good Master Cranwell.

CRANWELL.

Sir, God be your good speed!

FRANKFORD.

Good night, sweet Nan; nay, nay, a kiss and part.
[Aside.] Dissembling lips, you suit not with my heart. *[Exit.]*

WENDOLL.

How business, time, and hours, all gracious prove,
And are the furtherers to my new-born love!
I am husband now in Master Frankford's place,
And must command the house. My pleasure is
We will not sup abroad so publicly,
But in your private chamber, Mistress Frankford.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

O, sir, you are too public in your love,
And Master Frankford's wife——

CRANWELL.

Might I crave favour,
I would entreat you I might see my chamber;
I am on the sudden grown exceeding ill,
And would be spared from supper.

WENDOLL.

Light there, ho!
See you want nothing, sir; for, if you do,
You injure that good man, and wrong me too.

CRANWELL.

I will make bold: good night. [*Exit.*]

WENDOLL.

How all conspire
To make our bosom sweet, and full entire!
Come, Nan, I prythee let us sup within.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Oh, what a clog unto the soul is sin!
We pale offenders are still full of fear;
Every suspicious eye brings danger near,
When they whose clear hearts from offence are free
Despise report, base scandals do outface,
And stand at mere defiance with disgrace.

WENDOLL.

Fie, fie! you talk too like a puritan.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

You have tempted me to mischief, Master Wendoll:
I have done I know not what. Well, you plead custom;
That which for want of wit I granted erst,
I now must yield through fear. Come, come, let's in;

Once o'er shoes, we are straight o'er head in sin.

WENDOLL.

My jocund soul is joyful above measure;

I'll be profuse in Frankford's richest treasure.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE IV.—*Another part of the House.*

Enter CICELY, JENKIN, and Butler.

JENKIN.

My mistress and Master Wendoll, my master, sup in her chamber to-night. Cicely, you are preferred from being the cook to be chambermaid: of all the loves betwixt thee and me, tell me what thou thinkest of this?

CICELY.

Mum; there's an old proverb,—when the cat's away, the mouse may play.

JENKIN.

Now you talk of a cat, Cicely, I smell a rat.

CICELY.

Good words, Jenkin, lest you be called to answer them.

JENKIN.

Why, God make my mistress an honest woman! are not these good words? Pray God my new master play not the knave with my old master! is there any hurt in this? God send no villainy intended! and, if they do sup together, pray God they do not lie together! God make my mistress chaste, and make us all His servants! what harm is there in all this? Nay, more; here is my hand, thou shalt never have my heart unless thou say Amen.

CICELY.

Amen, I pray God, I say.

Enter Serving-man.

SERVING-MAN.

My mistress sends that you should make less noise, to lock up the doors, and see the household all got to bed: you, Jenkin, for this night are made the porter to see the gates shut in.

JENKIN.

Thus, by little and little, I creep into office. Come, to kennel, my masters, to kennel; 'tis eleven o'clock, already.

SERVING-MAN.

When you have locked the gates in, you must send up the keys to my mistress.

CICELY.

Quickly, for God's sake, Jenkin, for I must carry them. I am neither pillow nor bolster, but I know more than both.

JENKIN.

To bed, good Spigot; to bed, good honest serving-creatures; and let us sleep as snug as pigs in pease-straw.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE V.—*Outside FRANKFORD'S House.*

Enter FRANKFORD and NICHOLAS.

FRANKFORD.

Soft, soft; we have tied our geldings to a tree,
Two flight-shot[\[37\]](#) off, lest by their thundering hoofs
They blab our coming back. Hear'st thou no noise?

NICHOLAS.

Hear! I hear nothing but the owl and you.

FRANKFORD.

So; now my watch's hand points upon twelve,
And it is dead midnight. Where are my keys?

NICHOLAS.

Here, sir.

FRANKFORD.

This is the key that opes my outward gate;
This is the hall-door; this the withdrawing chamber;

But this, that door that's bawd unto my shame,
Fountain and spring of all my bleeding thoughts,
Where the most hallowed order and true knot
Of nuptial sanctity hath been profaned;
It leads to my polluted bed-chamber,
Once my terrestrial heaven, now my earth's hell,
The place where sins in all their ripeness dwell.
But I forget myself: now to my gate.

NICHOLAS.

It must ope with far less noise than Cripple-gate, or your plot's dashed.

FRANKFORD.

So, reach me my dark lanthorn to the rest;
Tread softly, softly.

NICHOLAS.

I will walk on eggs this pace.

FRANKFORD.

A general silence hath surprised the house,
And this is the last door. Astonishment,
Fear, and amazement play against my heart,
Even as a madman beats upon a drum.
Oh, keep my eyes, you Heavens, before I enter,
From any sight that may transfix my soul;
Or, if there be so black a spectacle,
Oh, strike mine eyes stark blind; or, if not so,
Lend me such patience to digest my grief
That I may keep this white and virgin hand
From any violent outrage or red murder!
And with that prayer I enter.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE VI.—*The Hall of FRANKFORD's House.*

NICHOLAS *discovered.*

NICHOLAS.

Here's a circumstance.
A man be made cuckold in the time
That he's about it. An the case were mine,
As 'tis my master's,—'sblood that he makes me swear!—
I would have placed his action, entered there;
I would, I would.

Enter FRANKFORD.

FRANKFORD.

Oh! oh!

NICHOLAS.

Master, 'sblood! master! master!

FRANKFORD.

O me unhappy! I have found them lying
Close in each other's arms, and fast asleep.
But that I would not damn two precious souls,
Bought with my Saviour's blood, and send them, laden
With all their scarlet sins upon their backs,
Unto a fearful judgment, their two lives
Had met upon my rapier.

NICHOLAS.

'Sblood, master, what, have you left them sleeping still? let me go wake them.

FRANKFORD.

Stay, let me pause a while.
O God! O God! that it were possible

To undo things done; to call back yesterday!
That Time could turn up his swift sandy glass,
To untell the days, and to redeem these hours!
Or that the sun
Could, rising from the west, draw his coach backward,
Take from the account of time so many minutes,
Till he had all these seasons called again,
Those minutes, and those actions done in them,
Even from her first offence; that I might take her
As spotless as an angel in my arms!
But, oh! I talk of things impossible,
And cast beyond the moon.[\[38\]](#) God give me patience!
For I will in and wake them. *[Exit.*

NICHOLAS.

Here's patience perforce;[\[39\]](#)
He needs must trot afoot that tires his horse.

Enter WENDOLL, running over the stage in a night-gown, FRANKFORD after him with a sword drawn; a Maid-servant in her smock stays his hand, and clasps hold on him. FRANKFORD pauses for a while.

FRANKFORD.

I thank thee, maid; thou, like the angel's hand,
Hast stayed me from a bloody sacrifice.[\[40\]](#) *[Exit Maid-servant.*
Go, villain, and my wrongs sit on thy soul
As heavy as this grief doth upon mine!
When thou record'st my many courtesies,
And shalt compare them with thy treacherous heart,
Lay them together, weigh them equally,
'Twill be revenge enough. Go, to thy friend
A Judas: pray, pray, lest I live to see
Thee, Judas-like, hanged on an elder-tree.

Enter Mistress FRANKFORD in her night attire.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Oh, by what word, what title, or what name,

Shall I entreat your pardon? Pardon! oh!
I am as far from hoping such sweet grace
As Lucifer from heaven. To call you husband—
O me, most wretched! I have lost that name,
I am no more your wife.

NICHOLAS.

'Sblood, sir, she swoons.

FRANKFORD.

Spare thou thy tears, for I will weep for thee:
And keep thy countenance, for I'll blush for thee.
Now, I protest, I think 'tis I am tainted,
For I am most ashamed; and 'tis more hard
For me to look upon thy guilty face,
Than on the sun's clear brow. What wouldst thou speak?

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I would I had no tongue, no ears, no eyes,
No apprehension, no capacity.
When do you spurn me like a dog? when tread me
Under your feet? when drag me by the hair?
Though I deserve a thousand thousand fold
More than you can inflict: yet, once my husband,
For womanhood, to which I am a shame,
Though once an ornament—even for His sake
That hath redeemed our souls, mark not my face,
Nor hack me with your sword; but let me go
Perfect and undeformed to my tomb.
I am not worthy that I should prevail
In the least suit; no, not to speak to you,
Nor look on you, nor to be in your presence.
Yet, as an abject, this one suit I crave;
This granted, I am ready for my grave. [*Kneels.*]

FRANKFORD.

My God, with patience arm me! Rise, nay, rise,
And I'll debate with thee. Was it for want

Thou playedst the strumpet? Wast thou not supplied
With every pleasure, fashion, and new toy,
Nay, even beyond my calling?

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I was.

FRANKFORD.

Was it then disability in me;
Or in thine eye seemed he a properer man?

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Oh, no.

FRANKFORD.

Did not I lodge thee in my bosom?
Wear thee here in my heart?

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

You did.

FRANKFORD.

I did, indeed; witness my tears I did.
Go, bring my infants hither.

[Enter Servant with two Children.]

O Nan! O Nan!

If neither fear of shame, regard of honour,
The blemish of my house, nor my dear love
Could have withheld thee from so lewd a fact,
Yet for these infants, these young harmless souls,
On whose white brows thy shame is characterized,
And grows in greatness as they wax in years,—
Look but on them, and melt away in tears.
Away with them! lest, as her spotted body
Hath stained their names with stripe of bastardy,
So her adulterous breath may blast their spirits
With her infectious thoughts. Away with them!

[*Exeunt Servant and Children.*]

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

In this one life I die ten thousand deaths.

FRANKFORD.

Stand up, stand up; I will do nothing rashly;
I will retire a while into my study,
And thou shalt hear thy sentence presently. [*Exit.*]

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

'Tis welcome, be it death. O me, base strumpet,
That, having such a husband, such sweet children,
Must enjoy neither! Oh, to redeem my honour,
I would have this hand cut off, these my breasts seared,
Be racked, strappadoed, put to any torment:
Nay, to whip but this scandal out, I would hazard
The rich and dear redemption of my soul.
He cannot be so base as to forgive me;
Nor I so shameless to accept his pardon.
O women, women, you that yet have kept
Your holy matrimonial vow unstained,
Make me your instance: when you tread awry,
Your sins, like mine, will on your conscience lie.

Enter CICELY, JENKIN, and all the serving-men as newly come out of bed.

ALL.

O mistress, mistress, what have you done, mistress?

NICHOLAS.

'Sblood, what a caterwauling keep you here!

JENKIN.

O Lord, mistress, how comes this to pass? My master is run away in his shirt, and never so much as called me to bring his clothes after him.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

See what guilt is! here stand I in this place,
Ashamed to look my servants in the face.

Enter FRANKFORD and CRANWELL, whom seeing she falls on her knees.

FRANKFORD.

My words are registered in Heaven already,
With patience hear me. I'll not martyr thee,
Nor mark thee for a strumpet; but with usage
Of more humility torment thy soul,
And kill thee even with kindness.

CRANWELL.

Master Frankford——

FRANKFORD.

Good Master Cranwell. Woman, hear thy judgment.
Go make thee ready in thy best attire;
Take with thee all thy gowns, all thy apparel;
Leave nothing that did ever call thee mistress,
Or by whose sight, being left here in the house,
I may remember such a woman by.
Choose thee a bed and hangings for thy chamber;
Take with thee every thing that, hath thy mark,
And get thee to my manor seven mile off,
Where live; 'tis thine; I freely give it thee.
My tenants by shall furnish thee with wains
To carry all thy stuff, within two hours,—
No longer will I limit thee my sight.
Choose which of all my servants thou likest best,
And they are thine to attend thee.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

A mild sentence.

FRANKFORD.

But, as thou hopest for Heaven, as thou believest

Thy name's recorded in the book of life,
I charge thee never, after this sad day,
To see me, or to meet me, or to send
By word or writing, gift, or otherwise,
To move me, by thyself, or by thy friends;
Nor challenge any part in my two children.
So, farewell, Nan! for we will henceforth be
As we had never seen, ne'er more shall see.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

How full my heart is, in mine eyes appears;
What wants in words, I will supply in tears.

FRANKFORD.

Come, take your coach, your stuff; all must along;
Servants and all, make ready; all be gone.
It was thy hand cut two hearts out of one.

[Exeunt.]

ACT THE FIFTH.

SCENE I.—*The Entrance to Sir FRANCIS ACTON's House.*

Enter Sir CHARLES MOUNTFORD, and SUSAN, both well dressed.

SUSAN.

Brother, why have you tricked me like a bride,
Bought me this gay attire, these ornaments?
Forget you our estate, our poverty?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Call me not brother, but imagine me
Some barbarous outlaw, or uncivil kern;[\[41\]](#)
For if thou shutt'st thy eye, and only hearest
The words that I shall utter, thou shalt judge me
Some staring ruffian, not thy brother Charles.
O sister!——

SUSAN.

O brother, what doth this strange language mean?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Dost love me, sister? wouldst thou see me live
A bankrupt beggar in the world's disgrace,
And die indebted to my enemies?
Wouldst thou behold me stand like a huge beam
In the world's eye, a bye-word and a scorn?
It lies in thee of these to acquit me free,
And all my debt I may out-strip by thee.

SUSAN.

By me! why, I have nothing, nothing left;
I owe even for the clothes upon my back;
I am not worth——

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

O sister, say not so;
It lies in you my downcast state to raise,
To make me stand on even points with the world.
Come, sister, you are rich; indeed you are;
And in your power you have, without delay,
Acton's five hundred pound back to repay.

SUSAN.

Till now I had thought you had loved me. By my honour
(Which I have kept as spotless as the moon),
I ne'er was mistress of that single doit
Which I reserved not to supply your wants;
And do you think that I would hoard from you?
Now, by my hopes in Heaven, knew I the means
To buy you from the slavery of your debts
(Especially from Acton, whom I hate),
I would redeem it with my life or blood.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

I challenge it; and, kindred set apart,
Thus, ruffian-like, I lay siege to your heart.
What do I owe to Acton?

SUSAN.

Why some five hundred pounds; towards which, I swear,
In all the world I have not one denier.[\[42\]](#)

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

It will not prove so. Sister, now resolve[\[43\]](#) me:
What do you think (and speak your conscience)
Would Acton give, might he enjoy your bed?

SUSAN.

He would not shrink to spend a thousand pound,
To give the Mountfords' name so deep a wound.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

A thousand pound! I but five hundred owe;
Grant him your bed, he's paid with interest so.

SUSAN.

O brother!

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

O sister! only this one way,
With that rich jewel you my debts may pay.
In speaking this my cold heart shakes with shame;
Nor do I woo you in a brother's name,
But in a stranger's. Shall I die in debt
To Acton, my grand foe, and you still wear
The precious jewel that he holds so dear?

SUSAN.

My honour I esteem as dear and precious
As my redemption.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

I esteem you, sister,
As dear, for so dear prizing it.

SUSAN.

Will Charles
Have me cut off my hands, and send them Acton?
Rip up my breast, and with my bleeding heart
Present him as a token?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Neither, sister:
But hear me in my strange assertion.
Thy honour and my soul are equal in my regard;
Nor will thy brother Charles survive thy shame.
His kindness, like a burthen hath surcharged me,
And under his good deeds I stooping go,
Not with an upright soul. Had I remained
In prison still, there doubtless I had died:

Then, unto him that freed me from that prison,
Still do I owe this life. What moved my foe
To enfranchise me? 'Twas, sister, for your love.
With full five hundred pounds he bought your love,
And shall he not enjoy it? Shall the weight
Of all this heavy burthen lean on me,
And will not you bear part? You did partake
The joy of my release; will you not stand
In joint-bond bound to satisfy the debt?
Shall I be only charged?

SUSAN.

But that I know
These arguments come from an honoured mind,
As in your most extremity of need
Scorning to stand in debt to one you hate,—
Nay, rather would engage your unstained honour
Than to be held ingrate,—I should condemn you.
I see your resolution, and assent;
So Charles will have me, and I am content.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

For this I tricked you up.

SUSAN.

But here's a knife,
To save mine honour, shall slice out my life.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Ay! know thou pleasest me a thousand times
More in that resolution than thy grant.—
Observe her love; to soothe it to my suit,
Her honour she will hazard, though not lose:
To bring me out of debt, her rigorous hand
Will pierce her heart. O wonder! that will choose,
Rather than stain her blood, her life to lose.—
Come, you sad sister to a woful brother,
This is the gate: I'll bear him such a present,

Such an acquittance for the knight to seal,
As will amaze his senses, and surprise
With admiration all his fantasies.

SUSAN.

Before his unchaste thoughts shall seize on me,
'Tis here shall my imprisoned soul set free.

Enter Sir FRANCIS ACTON and MALBY.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

How! Mountford with his sister, hand in hand!
What miracle's afoot?

MALBY.

It is a sight
Begets in me much admiration.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Stand not amazed to see me thus attended:
Acton, I owe thee money, and being unable
To bring thee the full sum in ready coin,
Lo! for thy more assurance, here's a pawn,—
My sister, my dear sister, whose chaste honour
I prize above a million: here, nay, take her;
She's worth your money, man; do not forsake her.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

I would he were in earnest!

SUSAN.

Impute it not to my immodesty:
My brother being rich in nothing else
But in his interest that he hath in me,
According to his poverty hath brought you
Me, all his store; whom howsoe'er you prize
As forfeit to your hand, he values highly,
And would not sell, but to acquit your debt,

For any emperor's ransom.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Stern heart, relent;
Thy former cruelty at length repent.
Was ever known, in any former age,
Such honourable wrested courtesy?
Lands, honours, life, and all the world forego,
Rather than stand engaged to such a foe. [*Aside.*]

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Acton, she is too poor to be thy bride,
And I too much opposed to be thy brother.
There, take her to thee: if thou hast the heart
To seize her as a rape, or lustful prey;
To blur our house, that never yet was stained;
To murder her that never meant thee harm;
To kill me now, whom once thou savedst from death,
Do them at once: on her all these rely,
And perish with her spotted chastity.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

You overcome me in your love, Sir Charles;
I cannot be so cruel to a lady
I love so dearly. Since you have not spared
To engage your reputation to the world,
Your sister's honour, which you prize so dear,
Nay, all the comforts which you hold on earth,
To grow out of my debt, being your foe,
Your honoured thoughts, lo! thus I recompense:
Your metamorphosed foe receives your gift
In satisfaction of all former wrongs.
This jewel I will wear here in my heart;
And, where before I thought her for her wants
Too base to be my bride, to end all strife,
I seal you my dear brother, her my wife.

SUSAN.

You still exceed us: I will yield to fate,
And learn to love, where I till now did hate.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

With that enchantment you have charmed my soul,
And made me rich even in those very words:
I pay no debt, but am indebted more;
Rich in your love, I never can be poor.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

All's mine is yours; we are alike in state,
Let's knit in love what was opposed in hate.
Come! for our nuptials we will straight provide,
Blest only in our brother and fair bride.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—A Room in FRANKFORD'S House.

Enter CRANWELL, FRANKFORD, and NICHOLAS.

CRANWELL.

Why do you search each room about your house,
Now that you have despatched your wife away?

FRANKFORD.

O sir, to see that nothing may be left
That ever was my wife's. I loved her dearly,
And when I do but think of her unkindness,
My thoughts are all in hell; to avoid which torment,
I would not have a bodkin or a cuff,
A bracelet, necklace, or rebato[44] wire;
Nor any thing that ever was called hers,
Left me, by which I might remember her.
Seek round about.

NICHOLAS.

'Sblood, master! here's her lute flung in a corner.

FRANKFORD.

Her lute! O God! upon this instrument
Her fingers have run quick division,
Sweeter than that which now divides our hearts.
These frets have made me pleasant, that have now
Frets of my heart-strings made. O Master Cranwell,
Oft hath she made this melancholy wood,
Now mute and dumb for her disastrous chance,
Speak sweetly many a note, sound many a strain
To her own ravishing voice, which being well strung,
What pleasant strange airs have they jointly rung!
Post with it after her. Now nothing's left;
Of her and hers, I am at once bereft.

NICHOLAS.

I'll ride and overtake her; do my message,
And come back again. [*Exit.*

CRANWELL.

Mean time, sir, if you please,
I'll to Sir Francis Acton, and inform him
Of what hath passed betwixt you and his sister.

FRANKFORD.

Do as you please. How ill am I bested,
To be a widower ere my wife be dead!

[*Exeunt.*

SCENE III.—*A Country Road.*

Enter Mistress FRANKFORD, *with* JENKIN, CICELY, *a* Coachman, *and three* Carters.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Bid my coach stay: why should I ride in state,
Being hurled so low down by the hand of fate?
A seat like to my fortunes let me have;
Earth for my chair, and for my bed a grave.

JENKIN.

Comfort, good mistress; you have watered your coach with tears already:
you have but two mile now to go to your manor. A man cannot say by my
old master Frankford as he may say by me, that he wants manors; [\[45\]](#) for
he hath three or four, of which this is one that we are going to now.

CICELY.

Good mistress, be of good cheer; sorrow, you see, hurts you, but helps
you not: we all mourn to see you so sad.

CARTER.

Mistress, I spy one of my landlord's men
Come riding post: 'tis like he brings some news.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Comes he from Master Frankford, he is welcome;
So are his news because they come from him.

Enter NICHOLAS.

NICHOLAS.

[Presenting lute.] There.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I know the lute; oft have I sung to thee:
We both are out of tune, both out of time.

NICHOLAS.

Would that had been the worst instrument that e'er you played on. My master commends him to ye; there's all he can find that was ever yours: he hath nothing left that ever you could lay claim to but his own heart, and he could afford you that. All that I have to deliver you is this: he prays you to forget him, and so he bids you farewell.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I thank him: he is kind, and ever was.
All you that have true feeling of my grief,
That know my loss, and have relenting hearts,
Gird me about, and help me with your tears
To wash my spotted sins: my lute shall groan;
It cannot weep, but shall lament my moan.

Enter WENDOLL.

WENDOLL.[\[46\]](#)

Pursued with horror of a guilty soul,
And with the sharp scourge of repentance lashed,
I fly from my own shadow. O my stars!
What have my parents in their lives deserved,
That you should lay this penance on their son?
When I but think of Master Frankford's love,
And lay it to my treason, or compare
My murdering him for his relieving me,
It strikes a terror like a lightning's flash
To scorch my blood up. Thus I, like the owl,
Ashamed of day, live in these shadowy woods,
Afraid of every leaf or murmuring blast,
Yet longing to receive some perfect knowledge
How he hath dealt with her. *[Sees Mistress FRANKFORD.]* O my sad fate!
Here, and so far from home, and thus attended!
O God! I have divorced the truest turtles
That ever lived together; and, being divided
In several places, make their several moan;
She in the fields laments, and he at home.

So poets write that Orpheus made the trees
And stones to dance to his melodious harp,
Meaning the rustic and the barbarous hinds,
That had no understanding part in them:
So she from these rude carters tears extracts,
Making their flinty hearts with grief to rise,
And draw down rivers from their rocky eyes.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

[To NICHOLAS.] If you return unto your master, say
(Though not from me; for I am all unworthy
To blast his name so with a strumpet's tongue)
That you have seen me weep, wish myself dead:
Nay, you may say too, for my vow is passed,
Last night you saw me eat and drink my last.
This to your master you may say and swear;
For it is writ in Heaven, and decreed here.

NICHOLAS.

I'll say you wept: I'll swear you made me sad.
Why how now, eyes? what now? what's here to do?
I'm gone, or I shall straight turn baby too.

WENDOLL.

I cannot weep, my heart is all on fire:
Curst be the fruits of my unchaste desire!

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Go, break this lute upon my coach's wheel,
As the last music that I e'er shall make;
Not as my husband's gift, but my farewell
To all earth's joy; and so your master tell.

NICHOLAS.

If I can for crying.

WENDOLL.

Grief, have done,

Or like a madman I shall frantic run.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

You have beheld the wofullest wretch on earth;
A woman made of tears: would you had words
To express but what you see! My inward grief
No tongue can utter; yet unto your power
You may describe my sorrow, and disclose
To thy sad master my abundant woes.

NICHOLAS.

I'll do your commendations.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Oh no:
I dare not so presume; nor to my children:
I am disclaimed in both; alas, I am.
Oh, never teach them, when they come to speak,
To name the name of mother; chide their tongue,
If they by chance light on that hated word;
Tell them 'tis naught; for, when that word they name,
Poor pretty souls! they harp on their own shame.

WENDOLL.

To recompense her wrongs, what canst thou do?
Thou hast made her husbandless and childless too.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

I have no more to say. Speak not for me;
Yet you may tell your master what you see.

NICHOLAS.

I'll do't. [*Exit.*]

WENDOLL.

I'll speak to her, and comfort her in grief.
Oh! but her wound cannot be cured with words.
No matter though, I'll do my best good-will

To work a cure on her whom I did kill.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

So, now unto my coach, then to my home,
So to my death-bed; for from this sad hour
I never will nor eat, nor drink, nor taste
Of any cates that may preserve my life:
I never will nor smile, nor sleep, nor rest;
But when my tears have washed my black soul white,
Sweet Saviour, to Thy hands I yield my sprite.

WENDOLL.

O Mistress Frankford—

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Oh, for God's sake fly!
The devil doth come to tempt me ere I die.
My coach! this fiend, that with an angel's face
Conjured mine honour, till he sought my wrack,
In my repentant eyes seems ugly black.

[Exeunt all, except WENDOLL and JENKIN; the Carters whistling.]

JENKIN.

What, my young master that fled in his shirt! How come you by your clothes again? You have made our house in a sweet pickle, ha' ye not, think you? What, shall I serve you still, or cleave to the old house?

WENDOLL.

Hence, slave! away with thy unseasoned mirth!
Unless thou canst shed tears, and sigh, and howl,
Curse thy sad fortunes, and exclaim on fate,
Thou art not for my turn.

JENKIN.

Marry, an you will not, another will: farewell, and be hanged! Would you had never come to have kept this coil[\[47\]](#) within our doors; we shall ha' you run away like a sprite again. *[Exit.]*

WENDOLL.

She's gone to death; I live to want and woe;
Her life, her sins, and all upon my head.
And I must now go wander, like a Cain,
In foreign countries and remotest climes,
Where the report of my ingratitude
Cannot be heard. I'll over first to France,
And so to Germany and Italy;
Where when I have recovered, and by travel
Gotten those perfect tongues,[\[48\]](#) and that these rumours
May in their height abate, I will return:
And I divine (however now dejected)
My worth and parts being by some great man praised,
At my return I may in court be raised. [*Exit.*

SCENE IV.—*Before the Manor.*

Enter SIR FRANCIS ACTON, SUSAN, SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD, CRANWELL,
and MALBY.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Brother, and now my wife, I think these troubles
Fall on my head by justice of the Heavens,
For being so strict to you in your extremities:
But we are now atoned.[\[49\]](#) I would my sister
Could with like happiness o'ercome her griefs,
As we have ours.

SUSAN.

You tell us, Master Cranwell, wondrous things,
Touching the patience of that gentleman,
With what strange virtue he demeans his grief.

CRANWELL.

I told you what I was a witness of;
It was my fortune to lodge there that night.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

O that same villain Wendoll! 'twas his tongue
That did corrupt her; she was of herself
Chaste, and devoted well. Is this the house?

CRANWELL.

Yes, sir, I take it here your sister lies.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

My brother Frankford showed too mild a spirit
In the revenge of such a loathèd crime;
Less than he did, no man of spirit could do:
I am so far from blaming his revenge,
That I commend it. Had it been my case,

Their souls at once had from their breasts been freed:
Death to such deeds of shame is the due need.

[They enter the house.]

SCENE V.—A Room in the Manor.

*Enter Sir FRANCIS ACTON, SUSAN, Sir CHARLES MOUNTFORD, CRANWELL,
and MALBY; JENKIN and CICELY following them.*

JENKIN.

O my mistress, my mistress, my poor mistress.

CICELY.

Alas that ever I was born! what shall I do for my poor mistress?

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Why, what of her?

JENKIN.

O Lord, sir, she no sooner heard that her brother and his friends were come to see how she did, but she, for very shame of her guilty conscience, fell into such a swoon, that we had much ado to get life into her.

SUSAN.

Alas that she should bear so hard a fate!
Pity it is repentance comes too late.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Is she so weak in body?

JENKIN.

O sir, I can assure you there's no hope of life in her, for she will take no sustenance: she hath plainly starved herself, and now she is as lean as a lath. She ever looks for the good hour. Many gentlemen and gentlewomen of the country are come to comfort her.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE VI.—Mistress FRANKFORD's *Bedchamber*.

Mistress FRANKFORD *in bed; enter* Sir CHARLES MOUNTFORD, Sir FRANCIS ACTON, MALBY, CRANWELL, *and* SUSAN.

MALBY.

How fare you, Mistress Frankford?

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Sick, sick, oh, sick. Give me some air, I pray you.
Tell me, oh, tell me where is Master Frankford?
Will not he deign to see me ere I die?

MALBY.

Yes, Mistress Frankford: divers gentlemen,
Your loving neighbours, with that just request
Have moved, and told him of your weak estate:
Who, though with much ado to get belief,
Examining of the general circumstance,
Seeing your sorrow and your penitence,
And hearing therewithal the great desire
You have to see him ere you left the world,
He gave to us his faith to follow us,
And sure he will be here immediately.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

You have half revived me with those pleasing news:
Raise me a little higher in my bed.
Blush I not, brother Acton? Blush I not, Sir Charles?
Can you not read my fault writ in my cheek?
Is not my crime there? tell me, gentlemen.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Alas! good mistress, sickness hath not left you
Blood in your face enough to make you blush.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Then sickness, like a friend, my fault would hide.
Is my husband come? My soul but tarries
His arrive, then I am fit for Heaven.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

I came to chide you; but my words of hate
Are turned to pity and compassionate grief.
I came to rate you; but my brawls, you see,
Melt into tears, and I must weep by thee.
Here's Master Frankford now.

Enter FRANKFORD.

FRANKFORD.

Good-morrow, brother; morrow, gentlemen:
God, that hath laid this cross upon our heads,
Might (had He pleased) have made our cause of meeting
On a more fair and more contented ground;
But He that made us, made us to this woe.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

And is he come? Methinks that voice I know.

FRANKFORD.

How do you, woman?

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Well, Master Frankford, well; but shall be better,
I hope, within this hour. Will you vouchsafe,
Out of your grace and your humanity,
To take a spotted strumpet by the hand?

FRANKFORD.

This hand once held my heart in faster bonds
Than now 'tis gripped by me. God pardon them
That made us first break hold!

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Amen, amen.

Out of my zeal to Heaven, whither I'm now bound,
I was so impudent to wish you here;
And once more beg your pardon. O good man,
And father to my children, pardon me,
Pardon, oh, pardon me! My fault so heinous is,
That if you in this world forgive it not,
Heaven will not clear it in the world to come.
Faintness hath so usurped upon my knees
That kneel I cannot, but on my heart's knees
My prostrate soul lies thrown down at your feet
To beg your gracious pardon. Pardon, oh, pardon me!

FRANKFORD.

As freely, from the low depth of my soul,
As my Redeemer hath forgiven His death,
I pardon thee. I will shed tears for thee, pray with thee;
And, in mere pity of thy weak estate,
I'll wish to die with thee.

ALL.

So do we all.

NICHOLAS.

So will not I;
I'll sigh and sob, but, by my faith, not die.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

O Master Frankford, all the near alliance
I lose by her shall be supplied in thee:
You are my brother by the nearest way;
Her kindred hath fallen off, but yours doth stay.

FRANKFORD.

Even as I hope for pardon at that day
When the great Judge of Heaven in scarlet sits,
So be thou pardoned. Though thy rash offence

Divorced our bodies, thy repentant tears
Unite our souls.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Then comfort, Mistress Frankford;
You see your husband hath forgiven your fall;
Then rouse your spirits, and cheer your fainting soul.

SUSAN.

How is it with you?

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

How do ye feel yourself?

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Not of this world.

FRANKFORD.

I see you are not, and I weep to see it.
My wife, the mother to my pretty babes!
Both those lost names I do restore thee back,
And with this kiss I wed thee once again:
Though thou art wounded in thy honoured name,
And with that grief upon thy death-bed liest,
Honest in heart, upon my soul, thou diest.

MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Pardoned on earth, soul, thou in Heaven art free.
Once more: [\[50\]](#) thy wife dies thus embracing thee. [*Dies.*]

FRANKFORD.

New married, and new widowed. Oh! she's dead,
And a cold grave must be her nuptial bed.

SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.

Sir, be of good comfort; and your heavy sorrow
Part equally amongst us: storms divided
Abate their force, and with less rage are guided.

CRANWELL.

Do, Master Frankford: he that hath least part
Will find enough to drown one troubled heart.

SIR FRANCIS ACTON.

Peace with thee, Nan. Brothers, and gentlemen,
All we that can plead interest in her grief,
Bestow upon her body funeral tears.
Brother, had you with threats and usage bad
Punished her sin, the grief of her offence
Had not with such true sorrow touched her heart.

FRANKFORD.

I see it had not: therefore on her grave
Will I bestow this funeral epitaph,
Which on her marble tomb shall be engraved.
In golden letters shall these words be filled,[\[51\]](#)
“Here lies she whom her husband’s kindness killed.”

EPILOGUE.

AN honest crew, disposèd to be merry,
Come to a tavern by, and called for wine:
The drawer brought it, smiling like a cherry,
And told them it was pleasant, neat, and fine.
“Taste it,” quoth one. He did so. “Fie!” quoth he;
“This wine was good; now’t runs too near the lee.”

Another sipped, to give the wine his due,
And said unto the rest it drunk too flat;
The third said, it was old; the fourth, too new;
Nay, quoth the fifth, the sharpness likes me not.
Thus, gentlemen, you see how, in one hour,
The wine was new, old, flat, sharp, sweet, and sour.

Unto this wine we do allude our play;
Which some will judge too trivial, some too grave:
You as our guests we entertain this day,
And bid you welcome to the best we have.
Excuse us, then: good wine may be disgraced,
When every several mouth hath sundry taste.

THE FAIR MAID OF THE WEST. *PART I.*

The Fair Maid of the West, or a Girl worth Gold, “as it was lately acted before the king and queen with approved liking,” was first published (both parts) in 1631: it had been acted as early as 1617, and from the title-page we may conclude that it held the stage for some time. It probably represents the dramatisation of some already-existent story-book or ballad. “We should be sorry,” remarks Mr. Saintsbury,[\[1\]](#) “to lose *The Fair Maid of the West*, with its picture of Devonshire sailors, foreign merchants, kings of Fez, bashaws of various parts, Italian dukes, and what not. The two parts make anything but a good play, but they are decidedly interesting.” Only the first has here been given, as it is complete in itself, and the second part is of less value.

I have marked the changes of scene, and in one or two places have made trifling corrections in the text. For instance, in scene iv. of the first act, by reading “your hopes deceased,” and changing the punctuation, we get a very fair sense where Collier (who edited the play for the Shakespeare Society) was inclined to think that a line had dropped out.

THE EPISTLE DEDICATORY.

To the much worthy and my most respected
JOHN OTHOW, Esquire,
Counsellor at Law, in the noble Society of Gray's Inn.

SIR,

EXCUSE this my boldness, I entreat you, and let it pass under the title of my love and respect, long devoted unto you; of which, if I endeavour to present the world with a due acknowledgement, without the sordid expectation of reward or servile imputation of flattery, I hope it will be the rather accepted. I must ingenuously acknowledge, a weightier argument would have better suited with your grave employment; but there are retirements necessarily belonging to all the labours of the body and brain. If in any such cessation you will deign to cast an eye upon this weak and unpolished poem, I shall receive it as a courtesy from you, much exceeding any merit in me, my good meaning only excepted. Thus wishing you healthful ability in body, untroubled content in mind, with the happy fruition of both the temporal felicities of the world present, and the eternal blessedness of the life future, I still remain as ever,

Yours, most affectionately devoted,

THOMAS HEYWOOD.

To the READER.

COURTEOUS Reader, my plays have not been exposed to the public view of the world in numerous sheets and a large volume, but singly, as thou seest, with great modesty and small noise. These comedies, bearing the title of *The Fair Maid of the West*, if they prove but as gracious in thy private reading as they were plausible in the public acting, I shall not much doubt of their success. Nor need they, I hope, much fear a rugged and censorious brow from thee, on whom the greatest and best in the kingdom have vouchsafed to smile. I hold it no necessity to trouble thee with the argument of the story, the matter itself lying so plainly before thee in acts and scenes, without any deviations or winding indents.

Peruse it through, and thou mayst find in it
Some mirth, some matter, and, perhaps, some wit.
He that would study thy content,

T.H.

PROLOGUE.[\[2\]](#)

AMONGST the Grecians there were annual feasts,
To which none were invited, as chief guests,
Save princes and their wives. Amongst the men,
There was no argument disputed then,
But who best governed; and, as't did appear,
He was esteemed sole sovereign for that year.
The queens and ladies argued at that time
For virtue and for beauty which was prime,
And she had the high honour. Two here be,
For beauty one, the other majesty,
Most worthy (did that custom still persever)
Not for one year, but to be sovereigns ever.

DRAMATIS PERSONÆ.

Gentlemen:

SPENCER,

CARROL,

FAWCETT,

Captain GOODLACK, SPENCER'S Friend.

ROUGHMAN, [\[3\]](#) a swaggering Gentleman.

CLEM, a Vintner's Apprentice.

Two Captains.

The Mayor of Foy.

An Alderman.

MULLISHEG, King of Fez.

Bashaw ALCADE.

Bashaw JOFFER.

A Spanish Captain.

An English Merchant.

A French Merchant.

An Italian Merchant.

A Surgeon.

A Preacher.

Drawers, Sailors, Spaniards, Moors.

Servants, Chorus.

BESS BRIDGES, the Fair Maid of the West.

A Kitchenmaid.

Mutes personated: [\[4\]](#)

The EARL OF ESSEX,

The Mayor of Plymouth,

Petitioners,

SCENE—ENGLAND, THE AZORES, MOROCCO.

**THE
FAIR MAID OF THE WEST.**

ACT THE FIRST.

SCENE I.—*A Street in Plymouth.*

Enter CARROL and two Captains.

1ST CAPTAIN.

When puts my lord[5] to sea?

2ND CAPTAIN.

When the wind's fair.

CARROL.

Resolve me, I entreat; can you not guess
The purpose of this voyage?

1ST CAPTAIN.

Most men think
The fleet's bound for the Islands.[6]

CARROL.

Nay, 'tis like.
The great success at Cales,[7] under the conduct
Of such a noble general, hath put heart
Into the English: they are all on fire
To purchase from the Spaniard. If their carracks[8]
Come deeply laden, we shall tug with them
For golden spoil.

2ND CAPTAIN.

Oh, were it come to that!

1ST CAPTAIN.

How Plymouth swells with gallants; how the streets
Glisten with gold! You cannot meet a man
But tricked in scarf and feather, that it seems
As if the pride of England's gallantry
Were harboured here. It doth appear, methinks,
A very court of soldiers.

CARROL.

It doth so.
Where shall we dine to-day?

2ND CAPTAIN.

At the next tavern by; there's the best wine.

1ST CAPTAIN.

And the best wench, Bess Bridges; she's the flower
Of Plymouth held: the Castle needs no bush,[\[9\]](#)
Her beauty draws to them more gallant customers
Than all the signs i' the town else.

2ND CAPTAIN.

A sweet lass,
If I have any judgment.

1ST CAPTAIN.

Now, in troth,
I think she's honest.

CARROL.

Honest, and live there!
What, in a public tavern, where's such confluence
Of lusty and brave gallants! Honest, said you?

2ND CAPTAIN.

I vow she is, for me.

1ST CAPTAIN.

For all, I think.
I'm sure she's wondrous modest.

CARROL.

But withal
Exceeding affable.

2ND CAPTAIN.

An argument
That she's not proud.

CARROL.

No; were she proud, she'd fall.

1ST CAPTAIN.

Well, she's a most attractive adamant:[\[10\]](#)
Her very beauty hath upheld that house,
And gained her master much.

CARROL.

That adamant
Shall for this time draw me too: we'll dine there.

2ND CAPTAIN.

No better motion. Come to the Castle then.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—*In front of the Castle Tavern.*

Enter SPENCER and Captain GOODLACK.

GOODLACK.

What, to the old house still?

SPENCER.

Canst blame me, captain?
Believe me, I was never surprised till now,
Or caught upon the sudden.

GOODLACK.

Pray resolve me;
Why, being a gentleman of fortunes, means,
And well revenued, will you adventure thus
A doubtful voyage, when only such as I,
Born to no other fortunes than my sword,
Should seek abroad for pillage?

SPENCER.

Pillage, captain!
No, 'tis for honour; and the brave society
Of all these shining gallants, that attend
The great lord-general, drew me hither first,
No hope of gain or spoil.

GOODLACK.

Ay, but what draws you to this house so oft?

SPENCER.

As if thou knew'st it not.

GOODLACK.

What, Bess?

SPENCER.

Even she.

GOODLACK.

Come, I must tell you, you forget yourself,
One of your birth and breeding thus to dote
Upon a tanner's daughter! why, her father
Sold hides in Somersetshire, and, being trade-fallen,
Sent her to service.

SPENCER.

Prithee speak no more;
Thou tell'st me that which I would fain forget,
Or wish I had not known. If thou wilt humour me,
Tell me she's fair and honest.

GOODLACK.

Yes, and loves you.

SPENCER.

To forget that were to exclude the rest:
All saving that were nothing. Come, let's enter.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE III.—*A Room in the Castle Tavern.*

Enter SPENCER, Captain GOODLACK, *and* two Drawers.

1ST DRAWER.

You are welcome, gentlemen.—Show them into the next room there.

2ND DRAWER.

Look out a towel, and some rolls, a salt and trenchers.

SPENCER.

No, sir, we will not dine.

2ND DRAWER.

I am sure ye would, if you had my stomach. What wine drink ye, sack or claret?

SPENCER.

Where's Bess?

2ND DRAWER.

Marry, above, with three or four gentlemen.

SPENCER.

Go call her.

2ND DRAWER.

I'll draw you a cup of the neatest wine in Plymouth.

SPENCER.

I'll taste none of your drawing. Go call Bess.

2ND DRAWER.

There's nothing in the mouths of these gallants but "Bess, Bess."

SPENCER.

What say y', sir?

2ND DRAWER.

Nothing, sir, but I'll go and call her presently.

SPENCER.

Tell her who's here.

2ND DRAWER.

The devil rid her out of the house, for me!

SPENCER.

Say y', sir?

2ND DRAWER.

Nothing but anon, anon, sir.

Enter BESS BRIDGES.

SPENCER.

See, she's come!

BESS.

Sweet Master Spencer, y'are a stranger grown.
Where have you been these three days?

SPENCER.

The last night
I sat up late at game. Here, take this bag,
And lay't up till I call for't.

BESS.

Sir, I shall.

SPENCER.

Bring me some wine.

BESS.

I know your taste,
And I shall please your palate. [*Exit.*

GOODLACK.

Troth, 'tis a pretty soul!

SPENCER.

To thee I will unbosom all my thoughts:
Were her low birth but equal with her beauty,
Here would I fix my thoughts.

GOODLACK.

You are not mad, sir?
You say you love her.

SPENCER.

Never question that.

GOODLACK.

Then put her to't; win Opportunity,
She's the best bawd. If, as you say, she loves you,
She can deny you nothing.

SPENCER.

I have proved her
Unto the utmost test; examined her,
Even to a modest force; but all in vain:
She'll laugh, confer, keep company, discourse,
And something more, kiss; but beyond that compass
She no way can be drawn.

GOODLACK.

'Tis a virtue
But seldom found in taverns.

Re-enter BESS, with wine.

BESS.

'Tis of the best Graves wine, [\[11\]](#) sir.

SPENCER.

Gramercy, girl: come sit.

BESS.

Pray pardon, sir, I dare not.

SPENCER.

I'll ha' it so.

BESS.

My fellows love me not, and will complain
Of such a saucy boldness.

SPENCER.

Pox on your fellows!
I'll try whether their pottle-pots or heads
Be harder, if I do but hear them grumble.
Sit: now, Bess, drink to me.

BESS.

To your good voyage! [*Drinks.*

Re-enter 2nd Drawer.

2ND DRAWER.

Did you call, sir?

SPENCER.

Yes, sir, to have your absence. Captain, this health.

GOODLACK.

Let it come, sir.

2ND DRAWER.

Must you be set, and we wait, with a——!

SPENCER.

What say you, sir?

2ND DRAWER.

Anon, anon: I come there. [*Exit.*]

SPENCER.

What will you venture, Bess, to sea with me?

BESS.

What I love best, my heart: for I could wish
I had been born to equal you in fortune,
Or you so low, to have been ranked with me;
I could have then presumed boldly to say,
I love none but my Spencer.

SPENCER.

Bess, I thank thee.
Keep still that hundred pound till my return
From the Islands with my lord: if never, wench,
Take it; it is thine own.

BESS.

You bind me to you.

Re-enter 1st Drawer.

1ST DRAWER.

Bess, you must fill some wine into the Portcullis; the gentlemen there
will drink none but of your drawing.

SPENCER.

She shall not rise, sir. Go, let your master snick-up.[\[12\]](#)

1ST DRAWER.

And that should be cousin-german to the hick-up.

Re-enter 2nd Drawer.

2ND DRAWER.

Bess, you must needs come. The gentlemen fling pots, pottles, drawers,
and all down stairs. The whole house is in an uproar.

BESS.

Pray pardon, sir; I needs must be gone.

2ND DRAWER.

The gentlemen swear if she come not up to them, they will come down to her.

SPENCER.

If they come in peace,
Like civil gentlemen, they may be welcome:
If otherwise, let them usurp their pleasures.
We stand prepared for both.

Enter CARROL and the two Captains.

CARROL.

Save you, gallants! We are somewhat bold, to press
Into your company: it may be held scarce manners;
Therefore, 'tis fit that we should crave your pardon.

SPENCER.

Sir, you are welcome; so are your friends.

1ST CAPTAIN.

Some wine!

BESS.

Pray give me leave to fill it.

SPENCER.

You shall not stir. So, please you, we'll join company.—
Drawer, more stools.

CARROL.

I take't that's a she drawer. Are you of the house?

BESS.

I am, sir.

CARROL.

In what place?

BESS.

I draw.

CARROL.

Beer, do you not? You are some tapstress.

SPENCER.

Sir, the worst character you can bestow
Upon the maid is to draw wine.

CARROL.

She would draw none to us.
Perhaps she keeps a rundlet for your taste,
Which none but you must pierce.

2ND CAPTAIN.

I pray be civil.

SPENCER.

I know not, gentlemen, what your intents be,
Nor do I fear, or care. This is my room;
And if you bear you, as you seem in show,
Like gentlemen, sit and be sociable.

CARROL.

We will.—[to BESS.] Minx, by your leave. Remove, I say.

SPENCER.

She shall not stir.

CARROL.

How, sir?

SPENCER.

No, sir. Could you outface the devil,

We do not fear your roaring.[\[13\]](#)

CARROL.

Though you may be companion with a drudge,
It is not fit she should have place by us.—
About your business, housewife.

SPENCER.

She is worthy
The place as the best here, and she shall keep't.

CARROL.

You lie.

[They draw and justle: CARROL is slain.]

GOODLACK.

The gentleman's slain: away!

BESS.

O, Heaven! what have you done?

GOODLACK.

Undone thyself, and me too. Come away.

[Exeunt GOODLACK and SPENCER.]

BESS.

Oh, sad misfortune! I shall lose him ever.
What! are you men, or milksops? Stand you still,
Senseless as stones, and see your friend in danger
To expire his last?

1ST CAPTAIN.

Tush! all our help's in vain.

2ND CAPTAIN.

This is the fruit of whores;
This mischief came through thee.

BESS.

It grew first from your incivility.

1ST CAPTAIN.

Lend me a hand, to lift his body hence.
It was a fatal business.

[Exeunt the Captains, bearing the body.]

Re-enter the two Drawers.

1ST DRAWER.

One call my master, another fetch the constable. Here's a man killed in the room.

2ND DRAWER.

How! a man killed, say'st thou? Is all paid?

1ST DRAWER.

How fell they out, canst thou tell?

2ND DRAWER.

Sure, about this bold Bettrice.[\[14\]](#) 'Tis not so much for the death of the man, but how shall we come by our reckoning?

[Exeunt Drawers.]

BESS.

What shall become of me? Of all lost creatures,
The most infortunate! My innocence
Hath been the cause of blood, and I am now
Purpled with murder, though not within compass
Of the law's severe censure: but, which most
Adds unto my affliction, I by this
Have lost so worthy and approved a friend,
Whom to redeem from exile, I would give
All that's without and in me.

Enter FAWCETT.

FAWCETT.

Your name's Bess Bridges?

BESS.

An unfortunate maid,
Known by that name too well in Plymouth, here.
Your business, sir, with me?

FAWCETT.

Know you this ring?

BESS.

I do: it is my Spencer's.
I know, withal, you are his trusty friend,
To whom he would commit it. Speak: how fares he?
Is he in freedom, know ye?

FAWCETT.

He's in health
Of body, though in mind somewhat perplexed
For this late mischief happened.

BESS.

Is he fled,
And freed from danger?

FAWCETT.

Neither. By this token
He lovingly commends him to you, Bess,
And prays you, when 'tis dark, meet him o' th' Hoe,
Near to the new-made fort, where he'll attend you,
Before he flies, to take a kind farewell.
There's only Goodluck in his company:
He entreats you not to fail him.

BESS.

Tell him from me, I'll come, I'll run, I'll fly,
Stand death before me; were I sure to die.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE IV.—*The Hoe.*

Enter SPENCER and Captain GOODLACK.

GOODLACK.

You are too full of passion.
To have the guilt of murder burden me;
And next, my life in hazard to a death
So ignominious; last, to lose a love.

SPENCER.

Canst thou blame me,
So sweet, so fair, so amorous, and so chaste,
And all these at an instant! Art thou sure
Carrol is dead?

GOODLACK.

I can believe no less.
You hit him in the very speeding place.

SPENCER.

Oh! but the last of these sits near'st my heart.

GOODLACK.

Sir, be advised by me:
Try her, before you trust her. She, perchance,
May take the advantage of your hopeful fortunes;
But when she finds you subject to distress
And casualty, her flattering love may die,
Your hopes deceased.

SPENCER.

Thou counsell'st well.
I'll put her to the test and utmost trial,
Before I trust her further. Here she comes.

Enter FAWCETT, and BESS with a bag.

FAWCETT.

I have done my message, sir.

BESS.

Fear not, sweet Spencer; we are now alone,
And thou art sanctuarèd in these mine arms.

GOODLACK.

While these confer, we'll sentinel their safety.
This place I'll guard.

FAWCETT.

I this.

BESS.

Are you not hurt,
Or your skin rased with his offensive steel?
How is it with you?

SPENCER.

Bess, all my afflictions
Are that I must leave thee: thou know'st, withal,
My extreme necessity, and that the fear
Of a most scandalous death doth force me hence.
I am not near my country; and to stay
For new supply from thence might deeply engage me
To desperate hazard.

BESS.

Is it coin you want?
Here is the hundred pound you gave me late:
Use that, beside what I have stored and saved,
Which makes it fifty more. Were it ten thousand,
Nay, a whole million, Spencer, all were thine.

SPENCER.

No; what thou hast, keep still; 'tis all thine own.
Here be my keys: my trunks take to thy charge:
Such gold fit for transportage as I have,
I'll bear along: the rest are freely thine.
Money, apparel, and what else thou find'st,
Perhaps worth my bequest and thy receiving,
I make thee mistress of.

BESS.

Before, I doted;
But now you strive to have me ecstasied.
What would you have me do, in which to express
My zeal to you?

SPENCER.

I enjoin thee to keep
Ever my picture, which in my chamber hangs;
For when thou part'st with that, thou lovest me.

BESS.

My soul may from my body be divorced,
But never that from me.

SPENCER.

I have a house in Foy, a tavern called
The Windmill; that I freely give thee, too;
And thither, if I live, I'll send to thee.

BESS.

So soon as I have cast my reckonings up,
And made even with my master, I'll not fail
To visit Foy, in Cornwall. Is there else
Aught that you will enjoin me?

SPENCER.

Thou art fair:
Join to thy beauty virtue. Many suitors
I know will tempt thee: beauty's a shrewd bait,

But unto that if thou add'st chastity,
Thou shalt o'ercome all scandal. Time calls hence;
We now must part.

BESS.

Oh, that I had the power to make Time lame,
To stay the stars, or make the moon stand still,
That future day might never haste thy flight!
I could dwell here for ever in thine arms,
And wish it always night.

SPENCER.

We trifle hours. Farewell!

BESS.

First take this ring:
'Twas the first token of my constant love
That passed betwixt us. When I see this next,
And not my Spencer, I shall think thee dead;
For, till death part thy body from thy soul,
I know thou wilt not part with it.

SPENCER.

Swear for me, Bess; for thou mayst safely do't.
Once more, farewell: at Foy thou shalt hear from me.

BESS.

There's not a word that hath a parting sound
Which through mine ears shrills not immediate death.
I shall not live to lose thee.

FAWCETT.

Best be gone;
For hark, I hear some tread.

SPENCER.

A thousand farewells are in one contracted.
Captain, away!

[*Exeunt* SPENCER *and* GOODLACK.

BESS.

Oh! I shall die.

FAWCETT.

What mean you, Bess? will you betray your friend,
Or call my name in question? Sweet, look up.

BESS.

Ha, is my Spencer gone?

FAWCETT.

With speed towards Foy,
There to take ship for Fayal.

BESS.

Let me recollect myself,
And what he left in charge—virtue and chastity;
Next, with all sudden expedition
Prepare for Foy: all these will I conserve,
And keep them strictly, as I would my life.
Plymouth, farewell: in Cornwall I will prove
A second fortune, and for ever mourn,
Until I see my Spencer's safe return.

[*Exeunt.*

SCENE V.—*The same.*

Hautboys. A dumb show. [15] *Enter General, Captains and the Mayor of Plymouth. At the other side petitioners with papers; amongst these the Drawers. The General gives them bags of money. All go off, saving the two Drawers.*

1ST DRAWER.

'Tis well that we have gotten all the money due to my master. It is the commonest thing that can be, for these captains to score and to score; but when the scores are to be paid, *non est inventus*.

2ND DRAWER.

'Tis ordinary amongst gallants, now-a-days, who had rather swear forty oaths than only this one oath—"God, let me never be trusted!"

1ST DRAWER.

But if the captains would follow the noble mind of the general, before night there would not be one score owing in Plymouth.

2ND DRAWER.

Little knows Bess that my master hath got in these desperate debts. But she hath cast up her account, and is gone.

1ST DRAWER.

Whither, canst thou tell?

2ND DRAWER.

They say, to keep a tavern in Foy, and that Master Spencer hath given her a stock, to set up for herself. Well, howsoever, I am glad, though he killed the man, we have got our money.

[*Exeunt.*]

ACT THE SECOND.

SCENE I.—*Foy. The Windmill Tavern.*

Enter FAWCETT and ROUGHMAN.

FAWCETT.

In your time have you seen a sweeter creature?

ROUGHMAN.

Some week, or thereabouts.

FAWCETT.

And in that time she hath almost undone all the other taverns: the gallants make no rendezvous now but at the Windmill.

ROUGHMAN.

Spite of them, I'll have her. It shall cost me the setting on, but I'll have her.

FAWCETT.

Why, do you think she is so easily won?

ROUGHMAN.

Easily or not, I'll bid as fair and far as any man within twenty miles of my head, but I will put her to the squeak.

FAWCETT.

They say there are knights' sons already come as suitors to her.

ROUGHMAN.

'Tis like enough, some younger brothers, and so I intend to make them.

FAWCETT.

If these doings hold, she will grow rich in short time.

ROUGHMAN.

There shall be doings that shall make this Windmill my grand seat, my mansion, my palace, and my Constantinople.

Enter BESS BRIDGES and CLEM.

FAWCETT.

Here she comes. Observe how modestly she bears herself.

ROUGHMAN.

I must know of what burden this vessel is. I shall not bear with her till she bear with me; and till then I cannot report her for a woman of good carriage.

[ROUGHMAN and FAWCETT move aside.]

BESS.

Your old master, that dwelt here before my coming, hath turned over your years[\[16\]](#) to me.

CLEM.

Right, forsooth: before he was a vintner, he was a shoemaker, and left two or three turnovers more besides myself.

BESS.

How long hast thou to serve?

CLEM.

But eleven years, next grass, and then I am in hope of my freedom; for by that time I shall be at full age.

BESS.

How old art thou now?

CLEM.

Forsooth, newly come into my teens. I have scraped trenchers this two years, and the next vintage I hope to be bar-boy.

BESS.

What's thy name?

CLEM.

My name is Clem: my father was a baker; and, by the report of his neighbours, as honest a man as ever lived by bread.

BESS.

And where dwelt he?

CLEM.

Below here, in the next crooked street, at the sign of the Leg. He was nothing so tall as I; but a little wee man, and somewhat huck-backed.

BESS.

He was once constable?

CLEM.

He was, indeed; and in that one year of his reign, I have heard them say, he bolted and sifted out more business than others in that office in many years before him.

BESS.

How long is't since he died?

CLEM.

Marry, the last dear year; for when corn grew to be at a high rate,[\[17\]](#) my father never doughed after.

BESS.

I think I have heard of him.

CLEM.

Then I am sure you have heard he was an honest neighbour, and one that never loved to be meal-mouthed.

BESS.

Well, sirrah, prove an honest servant, and you shall find me your good mistress. What company is in the Mermaid?[\[18\]](#)

CLEM.

There be four sea-captains. I believe they be little better than pirates, they be so flush of their ruddocks.[\[19\]](#)

BESS.

No matter; we will take no note of them:
Here they vent many brave commodities,
By which some gain accrues. They're my good customers,
And still return me profit.

CLEM.

Wot you what, mistress, how the two sailors would have served me, that called for the pound and a half of cheese?

BESS.

How was it, Clem?

CLEM.

When I brought them a reckoning, they would have had me to have scored it up. They took me for a simple gull, indeed, that would have had me to have taken chalk for cheese.

BESS.

Well, go wait upon the captains: see them want no wine.

CLEM.

Nor reckoning neither, take my word, mistress.

ROUGHMAN.

She's now at leisure; I'll to her.— [*Coming forward.*
Lady, what gentlemen are those above?

BESS.

Sir, they are such as please to be my guests,
And they are kindly welcome.

ROUGHMAN.

Give me their names.

BESS.

You may go search the church-book where they were christened:
There you perhaps may learn them.

ROUGHMAN.

Minion, how!

FAWCETT.

Fie, fie! you are too rude with this fair creature,
That no way seeks to offend you.

BESS.

Pray, hands off!

ROUGHMAN.

I tell thee, maid, wife, or whate'er thou beest,
No man shall enter here but by my leave.
Come, let's be more familiar.

BESS.

'Las, good man!

ROUGHMAN.

Why, know'st thou whom thou slightest? I am Roughman,
The only approved gallant of these parts,
A man of whom the roarers stand in awe,
And must not be put off.

BESS.

I never yet heard man so praise himself,
But proved in the end a coward.

ROUGHMAN.

Coward, Bess!
You will offend me, raise in me that fury
Your beauty cannot calm. Go to; no more:
Your language is too harsh and peremptory;
Pray let me hear no more on't. I tell thee

That quiet day scarce passed me these seven years
I have not cracked a weapon in some fray,
And will you move my spleen?

FAWCETT.

What, threat a woman?

BESS.

Sir, if you thus persist to wrong my house,
Disturb my guests, and nightly domineer,
To put my friends from patience, I'll complain
And right myself before the magistrate.
Can we not live in compass of the law,
But must be swaggered out on't?

ROUGHMAN.

Go to, wench:
I wish thee well; think on't, there's good for thee
Stored in my breast; and when I come in place,
I must have no man to offend mine eye:
My love can brook no rivals. For this time
I am content your captains shall have peace,
But must not be used to it.

BESS.

Sir, if you come
Like other free and civil gentlemen,
You're welcome; otherwise my doors are barred you.

ROUGHMAN.

That's my good girl.
I have fortunes laid up for thee: what I have,
Command it as thine own. Go to; be wise.

BESS.

Well, I shall study for't.

ROUGHMAN.

Consider on't. Farewell.

[*Exeunt* ROUGHMAN *and* FAWCETT.]

BESS.

My mind suggests me that this prating fellow
Is some notorious coward. If he persist,
I have a trick to try what metal's in him. [*Re-enter* CLEM.
What news with you?

CLEM.

I am now going to carry the captains a reckoning.

BESS.

And what's the sum?

CLEM.

Let me see—eight shillings and sixpence.

BESS.

How can you make that good? Write them a
bill.

CLEM.

I'll watch them for that; 'tis no time of night to use our bills. The
gentlemen are no dwarfs; and with one word of my mouth I can tell them
what is to be-tall.[\[20\]](#)

BESS.

How comes it to so much?

CLEM.

Imprimis, six quarts of wine, at sevenpence the quart, seven sixpences.

BESS.

Why dost thou reckon it so?

CLEM.

Because, as they came in by hab nab, so I will bring them in a reckoning at six and at sevens.

BESS.

Well, wine, three shillings and sixpence.

CLEM.

And what wants that of ten groats?

BESS.

'Tis twopence over.

CLEM.

Then put sixpence more to it, and make it four shillings wine, though you bate it them in their meat.

BESS.

Why so, I prithee?

CLEM.

Because of the old proverb, "What they want in meat, let them take out in drink." Then, for twelve pennyworth of anchoves, eighteenpence.

BESS.

How can that be?

CLEM.

Marry, very well, mistress: twelvepence anchoves, and sixpence oil and vinegar. Nay, they shall have a saucy reckoning.

BESS.

And what for the other half-crown?

CLEM.

Bread, beer, salt, napkins, trenchers, one thing with another; so the *summa totalis* is eight shillings and sixpence.

BESS.

Well, take the reckoning from the bar.

CLEM.

What needs that, forsooth? The gentlemen seem to be high-flown already.
Send them in but another pottle of sack, and they will cast up the
reckoning of themselves. Yes, I'll about it. [*Exit.*

BESS.

Were I not with so many suitors pestered,
And might I enjoy my Spencer, what a sweet,
Contented life were this! for money flows,
And my gain's great. But to my Roughman next.
I have a trick to try what spirit's in him.
It shall be my next business; in this passion
For my dear Spencer, I propose me this:
'Mongst many sorrows, some mirth's not amiss. [*Exit.*

SCENE II.—*Fayal.*[\[21\]](#)

Enter SPENCER and Captain GOODLACK.

GOODLACK.

What were you thinking, sir?

SPENCER.

Troth, of the world: what any man should see in't to be in love with it.

GOODLACK.

The reason of your meditation?

SPENCER.

To imagine that in the same instant that one forfeits all his estate, another enters upon a rich possession. As one goes to the church to be married, another is hurried to the gallows to be hanged; the last having no feeling of the first man's joy, nor the first of the last man's misery. At the same time that one lies tortured upon the rack, another lies tumbling with his mistress over head and ears in down and feathers. This when I truly consider, I cannot but wonder why any fortune should make a man ecstasied.

GOODLACK.

You give yourself too much to melancholy.

SPENCER.

These are my maxims; and were they as faithfully practised by others as truly apprehended by me, we should have less oppression, and more charity.

Enter the two Captains.

1ST CAPTAIN.

Make good thy words.

2ND CAPTAIN.

I say, thou hast injured me.

1ST CAPTAIN.

Tell me wherein.

2ND CAPTAIN.

When we assaulted Fayal,
And I had, by the general's command,
The onset, and with danger of my person
Enforced the Spaniard to a swift retreat,
And beat them from their fort, thou, when thou saw'st
All fear and danger past, madest up with me,
To share that honour which was sole mine own,
And never ventured shot for't, or e'er came
Where bullet grazed.

SPENCER.

See, captain, a fray towards;
Let's, if we can, atone [\[22\]](#) this difference.

GOODLACK.

Content.

1ST CAPTAIN.

I'll prove it with my sword,
That though thou hadst the foremost place in field,
And I the second, yet my company
Was equal in the entry of the fort.
My sword was that day drawn as soon as thine,
And that poor honour which I won that day
Was but my merit.

2ND CAPTAIN.

Wrong me palpably,
And justify the same!

SPENCER.

You shall not fight.

1ST CAPTAIN.

Why, sir, who made you first a justicer,
And taught you that word “shall?” You are no general;
Or, if you be, pray show us your commission.

SPENCER.

Sir, I have no commission but my counsel,
And that I’ll show you freely.

2ND CAPTAIN.

’Tis some chaplain.

1ST CAPTAIN.

I do not like his text.

GOODLACK.

Let’s beat their weapons down.

1ST CAPTAIN.

I’ll aim at him that offers to divide us!

[They fight.]

2ND CAPTAIN.

Pox of these part-frays! see, I am wounded,
By beating down my weapon.

GOODLACK.

How fares my friend?

SPENCER.

You sought for blood, and, gentlemen, you have it.
Let mine appease you: I am hurt to death.

1ST CAPTAIN.

My rage converts to pity, that this gentleman
Shall suffer for his goodness.

GOODLACK.

Noble friend,
I will revenge thy death.

SPENCER.

He is no friend
That murmurs such a thought.—Oh, gentlemen,
I killed a man in Plymouth, and by you
Am slain in Fayal. Carrol fell by me,
And I fall by a Spencer. Heaven is just,
And will not suffer murder unrevenged.
Heaven pardon me, as I forgive you both!
Shift for yourselves: away!

2ND CAPTAIN.

We saw him die,
But grieve you should so perish.

SPENCER.

Note Heaven's justice,
And henceforth make that use on't—I shall faint.

1ST CAPTAIN.

Short farewells now must serve. If thou survivest,
Live to thine honour; but if thou expirest
Heaven take thy soul to mercy!

[Exeunt Captains.]

SPENCER.

I bleed much;
I must go seek a surgeon.

GOODLACK.

Sir, how cheer you?

SPENCER.

Like one that's bound upon a new adventure
To the other world; yet thus much, worthy friend,

Let me entreat you: since I understand
The fleet is bound for England, take your occasion
To ship yourself, and when you come to Foy,
Kindly commend me to my dearest Bess:
Thou shalt receive a will, in which I have
Possessed her of five hundred pounds a year.

GOODLACK.

A noble legacy.

SPENCER.

The rest I have bestowed amongst my friends,
Only reserving a bare hundred pounds,
To see me honestly and well interred.

GOODLACK.

I shall perform your trust as carefully
As to my father, breathed he.

SPENCER.

Mark me, captain;
Her legacy I give with this proviso:
If, at thy arrival where my Bess remains,
Thou find'st her well reported, free from scandal,
My will stands firm; but if thou hear'st her branded
For loose behaviour, or immodest life,
What she should have, I here bestow on thee;
It is thine own: but, as thou lovest thy soul,
Deal faithfully betwixt my Bess and me.

GOODLACK.

Else let me die a prodigy.

SPENCER.

This ring was hers; that, be she loose or chaste,
Being her own, restore her: she will know it;
And doubtless she deserves it. O my memory!
What had I quite forgot? She hath my picture.

GOODLACK.

And what of that?

SPENCER.

If she be ranked among the loose and lewd,
Take it away: I hold it much indecent
A whore should ha't in keeping; but if constant,
Let her enjoy it. This my will perform,
As thou art just and honest.

GOODLACK.

Sense else forsake me.

SPENCER.

Now lead me to my chamber. All's made even—
My peace with earth, and my atone with Heaven.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE III.—A *Field near Foy.*

Enter BESS BRIDGES, like a Page, with a sword; and CLEM.

BESS.

But that I know my mother to be chaste,
I'd swear some soldier got me.

CLEM.

It may be many a soldier's buff jerkin came out of your father's tan-vat.

BESS.

Methinks I have a manly spirit in me,
In this man's habit.

CLEM.

Now, am not I of many men's minds; for, if you should do me wrong, I
should not kill you, though I took you pissing against a wall.

BESS.

Methinks I could be valiant on the sudden,
And meet a man i' the field.
I could do all that I have heard discoursed
Of Mary Ambree,[\[23\]](#) or Westminster's Long Meg.

CLEM.

What Mary Ambree was I cannot tell; but unless you were taller, you will
come short of Long Meg.

BESS.

Of all thy fellows, thee I only trust,
And charge thee to be secret.

CLEM.

I am bound in my indentures to keep my master's secrets; and should I
find a man in bed with you, I would not tell.

BESS.

Begone, sir; but no words, as you esteem my favour.

CLEM.

But, mistress, I could wish you to look to your long seams; fights are dangerous. But am not I in a sweet taking, think you?

BESS.

I prithee, why?

CLEM.

Why, if you should swagger and kill anybody, I, being a vintner, should be called to the bar. [*Exit.*]

BESS.

Let none condemn me of immodesty,
Because I try the courage of a man,
Who on my soul's a coward, beats my servants,
Cuffs them, and, as they pass by him, kicks my maids;
Nay, domineers over me, making himself
Lord o'er my house and household. Yesternight
I heard him make appointment on some business
To pass alone this way. I'll venture fair,
But I will try what's in him.

Enter ROUGHMAN and FAWCETT.

FAWCETT.

Sir, I can now no farther; weighty business
Calls me away.

ROUGHMAN.

Why, at your pleasure, then.
Yet I could wish that ere I passed this field
That I could meet some Hector, so your eyes
Might witness what myself have oft repeated,
Namely, that I am valiant.

FAWCETT.

Sir, no doubt;
But now I am in haste. Farewell. [*Exit.*

ROUGHMAN.

How many times brave words bear out a man!
For if he can but make a noise, he's feared.
To talk of frays, although he ne'er had heart
To face a man in field, that's a brave fellow.
I have been valiant, I must needs confess,
In street and tavern, where there have been men
Ready to part the fray; but for the fields,
They are too cold to fight in.

BESS.

You are a villain, a coward; and you lie. [*Strikes him.*

ROUGHMAN.

You wrong me, I protest. Sweet, courteous gentleman,
I never did you wrong.

BESS.

Wilt tell me that?
Draw forth thy coward sword, and suddenly,
Or, as I am a man, I'll run thee through,
And leave thee dead i' the field.

ROUGHMAN.

Hold! as you are a gentleman.
I have ta'en an oath I will not fight to-day.

BESS.

Th'ast took a blow already, and the lie:
Will not both these enrage thee?

ROUGHMAN.

No; would you give the bastinado too,
I will not break mine oath.

BESS.

Oh! your name's Roughman:
No day doth pass you, but you hurt or kill!
Is this out of your calendar?

ROUGHMAN.

I! you are deceived.
I ne'er drew sword in anger, I protest,
Unless it were upon some poor, weak fellow,
That ne'er wore steel about him.

BESS.

Throw your sword.

ROUGHMAN.

Here, sweet young sir; [*Gives up his sword.*] but, as you are a gentleman,
Do not impair mine honour.

BESS.

Tie that shoe.

ROUGHMAN.

I shall, sir.

BESS.

Untruss that point.[\[24\]](#)

ROUGHMAN.

Any thing, this day, to save mine oath.

BESS.

Enough;—yet not enough. Lie down,
Till I stride o'er thee.

ROUGHMAN.

Sweet sir, any thing.

BESS.

Rise, thou hast leave. Now, Roughman, thou art blest:
This day thy life is saved; look to the rest.
Take back thy sword.

ROUGHMAN.

Oh! you are generous: honour me so much
As let me know to whom I owe my life.

BESS.

I am Bess Bridges' brother.

ROUGHMAN.

Still methought
That you were something like her.

BESS.

And I have heard
You domineer and revel in her house,
Control her servants, and abuse her guests,
Which if I ever shall hereafter hear,
Thou art but a dead man.

ROUGHMAN.

She never told me of a brother living;
But you have power to sway me.

BESS.

But for I see you are a gentleman,
I am content this once to let you pass;
But if I find you fall into relapse,
The second's far more dangerous.

ROUGHMAN.

I shall fear it.
Sir, will you take the wine?

BESS.

I am for London,

And for these two terms cannot make return;
But if you see my sister, you may say
I was in health.

ROUGHMAN.

Too well: the devil take you! [*Aside.*

BESS.

Pray, use her well, and at my coming back
I'll ask for your acquaintance. Now, farewell. [*Exit.*

ROUGHMAN.

None saw't: he's gone for London; I am unhurt;
Then who shall publish this disgrace abroad?
One man's no slander, should he speak his worst.
My tongue's as loud as his; but in this country
Both of more fame and credit. Should we contest,
I can outface the proudest. This is, then,
My comfort. Roughman, thou art still the same,
For a disgrace not seen is held no shame. [*Exit.*

SCENE IV.—*Fayal.*

Enter two Sailors.

1ST SAILOR.

Aboard, aboard! the wind stands fair for England;
The ships have all weighed anchor.

2ND SAILOR.

A stiff gale
Blows from the shore.

Enter Captain GOODLACK.

GOODLACK.

The sailors call aboard, and I am forced
To leave my friend now at the point of death,
And cannot close his eyes. Here is the will.
Now may I find yon tanner's daughter turned
Unchaste or wanton, I shall gain by it
Five hundred pounds a year. Here is good evidence.

1ST SAILOR.

Sir, will you take the long-boat and aboard?

Enter a third Sailor.

GOODLACK.

With all my heart.

3RD SAILOR.

What, are you ready, mates?

1ST SAILOR.

We stayed for you. Thou canst not tell who's dead?
The great bell rung out now.

3RD SAILOR.

They say 'twas for one Spencer, who this night
Died of a mortal wound.

GOODLACK.

My worthy friend:
Unhappy man, that cannot stay behind,
To do him his last rites!—Was his name Spencer?

3RD SAILOR.

Yes, sir; a gentleman of good account,
And well known in the navy.

GOODLACK.

This is the end of all mortality.
It will be news unpleasing to his Bess.
I cannot fare amiss, but long to see
Whether these lands belong to her or me.

Enter SPENCER and Surgeon.

SURGEON.

Nay, fear not, sir: now you have scaped this dressing,
My life for yours.

SPENCER.

I thank thee, honest friend.

SURGEON.

Sir, I can tell you news.

SPENCER.

What is't, I prithee?

SURGEON.

There is a gentleman, one of your name,
That died within this hour.

SPENCER.

My name! What was he? Of what sickness died he?

SURGEON.

No sickness, but a slight hurt in the body,
Which showed at first no danger, but, being searched,
He died at the third dressing.

SPENCER.

At my third search I am in hope of life.
The Heavens are merciful.

SURGEON.

Sir, doubt not your recovery.

SPENCER.

That hundred pound I had prepared to expend
Upon mine own expected funeral,
I for name-sake will now bestow on his.

SURGEON.

A noble resolution.

SPENCER.

What ships are bound for England? I would gladly
Venture to sea, though weak.

SURGEON.

All bound that way are under sail already.

SPENCER.

Here's no security;
For when the beaten Spaniards shall return,
They'll spoil whom they can find.

SURGEON.

We have a ship,
Of which I am surgeon, that belongs unto

A London merchant, now bound for Mamorah,
A town in Barbary; please you to use that,
You shall command free passage: ten months hence,
We hope to visit England.

SPENCER.

Friend, I thank thee.

SURGEON.

I'll bring you to the master, who I know
Will entertain you gladly.

SPENCER.

When I have seen the funeral rites performed
To the dead body of my countryman
And kinsman, I will take your courteous offer.
England, no doubt, will hear news of my death;
How Bess will take it is to me unknown.
On her behaviour I will build my fate,
There raise my love, or thence erect my hate.

[Exeunt.]

ACT THE THIRD.

SCENE I.—*Foy. A Street outside the Windmill Tavern.*

Enter ROUGHMAN and FAWCETT.

ROUGHMAN.

Oh! you're well met. Just as I prophesied,
So it fell out.

FAWCETT.

As how, I pray?

ROUGHMAN.

Had you but stayed the crossing of one field,
You had beheld a Hector, the boldest Trojan
That ever Roughman met with.

FAWCETT.

Pray, what was he?

ROUGHMAN.

You talk of Little Davy, Cutting Dick, [\[25\]](#)
And divers such; but tush! this hath no fellow.

FAWCETT.

Of what stature and years was he?

ROUGHMAN.

Indeed, I must confess he was no giant,
Nor above fifty; but he did bestir him—
Was here, and there, and everywhere, at once,
That I was ne'er so put to't since the midwife
First wrapped my head in linen. Let's to Bess:
I'll tell her the whole project.

FAWCETT.

Here's the house:

We'll enter, if you please.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—A Room in the Tavern.

Enter ROUGHMAN and FAWCETT.

ROUGHMAN.

Where be these drawers—rascals, I should say—
That will give no attendance?

Enter CLEM.

CLEM.

Anon, anon, sir: please you see a room? What, you here, again! Now we
shall have such roaring!

ROUGHMAN.

You, sirrah, call your mistress.

CLEM.

Yes, sir, I know it is my duty to call her mistress.

ROUGHMAN.

See an the slave will stir!

CLEM.

Yes, I do stir.

ROUGHMAN.

Shall we have humours, sauce-box? You have ears;
I'll teach you prick-song.[\[26\]](#)

CLEM.

But you have now a wrong sow by the ear. I will call her.

ROUGHMAN.

Do, sir; you had best.

CLEM.

If you were twenty Roughmans, if you lug me by the ears again, I'll draw.

ROUGHMAN.

Ha! what will you draw?

CLEM.

The best wine in the house for your worship; and I would call her, but I can assure you that she is either not stirring, or else not in case.

ROUGHMAN.

How not in case?

CLEM.

I think she hath not her smock on; for I think I saw it lie at her bed's head.

ROUGHMAN.

What! drawers grow capricious?[\[27\]](#)

CLEM.

Help! help!

Enter BESS BRIDGES.

BESS.

What uproar's this? Shall we be never rid
From these disturbances?

ROUGHMAN.

Why, how now, Bess?
Is this your housewifery? When you are mine,
I'll have you rise as early as the lark.
Look to the bar yourself; these lazy rascals
Will bring your state behindhand.

CLEM.

You lie, sir.

ROUGHMAN.

How! lie!

CLEM.

Yes, sir, at the Raven in the High Street. I was at your lodging this morning for a pottle-pot.

ROUGHMAN.

You will about your business: must you here
Stand gaping and idle? [*Strikes him.*]

BESS.

You wrong me, sir,
And tyrannize too much over my servants.
I will have no man touch them but myself.

CLEM.

If I do not put ratsbane into his wine, instead of sugar, say I am no true baker. [*Exit.*]

ROUGHMAN.

What! rise at noon?
A man may fight a tall fray in a morning,
And one of your best friends, too, be hacked and mangled,
And almost cut to pieces, and you fast,
Close in your bed, ne'er dream on't.

BESS.

Fought you this day?

ROUGHMAN.

And ne'er was better put to't in my days.

BESS.

I pray, how was't?

ROUGHMAN.

Thus. As I passed yon fields——

Enter Kitchenmaid.

MAID.

I pray, forsooth, what shall I reckon for the jowl of ling[28] in the Portcullis?

ROUGHMAN.

A pox upon your jowls, you kitchen-stuff!
Go, scour your skillets,[29] pots, and dripping-pans,
And interrupt not us. [*Kicks at her.*]

MAID.

The devil take your ox-heels, you foul cod's-head! must you be kicking?

ROUGHMAN.

Minion! dare you scold?

MAID.

Yes, sir; and lay my ladle over your coxcomb. [*Exit.*]

BESS.

I do not think that thou darest strike a man,
That swagger'st thus o'er women.

ROUGHMAN.

How now, Bess?

BESS.

Shall we be never quiet?

FAWCETT.

You are too rude.

ROUGHMAN.

Now I profess all patience.

BESS.

Then proceed.

ROUGHMAN.

Rising up early, minion, whilst you slept,
To cross yon field, I had but newly parted
With this my friend, but that I soon espied
A gallant fellow, and most strongly armed:
In the mid-field we met, and, both being resolute,
We justled for the wall.

BESS.

Why, did there stand a wall in the mid-field?

ROUGHMAN.

I meant, strove for the way.
Two such brave spirits meeting, straight both drew.

Re-enter CLEM.

CLEM.

The maid, forsooth, sent me to know whether you would have the
shoulder of mutton roasted or sod.[\[30\]](#)

ROUGHMAN.

A mischief on your shoulders! [*Strikes him.*]

CLEM.

That's the way to make me never prove good porter.

BESS.

You still heap wrongs on wrongs.

ROUGHMAN.

I was in fury,
To think upon the violence of that fight,
And could not stay my rage.

FAWCETT.

Once more proceed.

ROUGHMAN.

Oh! had you seen two tilting meteors jumble
In the mid-region, with like fear and fury
We too encountered. Not Briareus
Could with his hundred hands have struck more thick:
Blows came about my head,—I took them still;
Thrusts by my sides, 'twixt body and my arms,—
Yet still I put them by.

BESS.

When they were past, he put them by.—Go on.
But in this fury, what became of him?

ROUGHMAN.

I think I paid him home: he's soundly mauled.
I bosomed him at every second thrust.

BESS.

Scaped he with life?

ROUGHMAN.

Ay, that's my fear. If he recover this,
I'll never trust my sword more.

BESS.

Why fly you not, if he be in such danger?

ROUGHMAN.

Because a witch once told me
I ne'er should die for murder.

BESS.

I believe thee.
But tell me, pray, was not this gallant fellow
A pretty, fair, young youth, about my years?

ROUGHMAN.

Even thereabout.

CLEM.

He was not fifty, then.

BESS.

Much of my stature?

ROUGHMAN.

Much about your pitch.[\[31\]](#)

CLEM.

He was no giant, then.

BESS.

And wore a suit like this?

ROUGHMAN.

I half suspect.

BESS.

That gallant fellow,
So wounded and so mangled, was myself.
You base, white-livered slave! it was this shoe
That thou stooped to untie; untrussed those points;
And, like a beastly coward, lay along
Till I strid over thee. Speak; was't not so?

ROUGHMAN.

It cannot be denied.

BESS.

Hare-hearted fellow! milksop! Dost not blush?
Give me that rapier: I will make thee swear
Thou shalt redeem this scorn thou hast incurred,
Or in this woman shape I'll cudgel thee,
And beat thee through the streets. As I am Bess, I'll do't.

ROUGHMAN.

Hold, hold! I swear.

BESS.

Dare not to enter at my door till then.

ROUGHMAN.

Shame confounds me quite.

BESS.

That shame redeem, perhaps we'll do thee grace;
I love the valiant, but despise the base. [*Exit.*

CLEM.

Will you be kicked, sir?

ROUGHMAN.

She hath wakened me,
And kindled that dead fire of courage in me
Which all this while hath slept. To spare my flesh
And wound my fame, what is't? I will not rest,
Till by some valiant deed I have made good
All my disgraces past. I'll cross the street,
And strike the next brave fellow that I meet.

FAWCETT.

I am bound to see the end on't.

ROUGHMAN.

Are you, sir? [*Beats off* FAWCETT.

[*Exeunt.*

SCENE III.—A Street in Foy.

Enter the Mayor of Foy, an Alderman, and Servant.

MAYOR.

Believe me, sir, she bears herself so well,
No man can justly blame her; and I wonder,
Being a single woman as she is,
And living in a house of such resort,
She is no more distasted.

ALDERMAN.

The best gentlemen
The country yields become her daily guests.
Sure, sir, I think she's rich.

MAYOR.

Thus much I know: would I could buy her state,
Were't for a brace of thousands!

[A shot within.]

ALDERMAN.

'Twas said a ship is now put into harbour:
Know whence she is.

SERVANT.

I'll bring news from the quay. *[Exit.]*

MAYOR.

To tell you true, sir, I could wish a match
Betwixt her and mine own and only son;
And stretch my purse, too, upon that condition.

ALDERMAN.

Please you, I'll motion [\[32\]](#) it.

Re-enter Servant.

SERVANT.

One of the ships is new come from the Islands;
The greatest man of note's one Captain Goodlack.
It is but a small vessel.

Enter Captain GOODLACK and Sailors.

GOODLACK.

I'll meet you straight at the Windmill.
Not one word of my name.

1ST SAILOR.

We understand you.

MAYOR.

Sir, 'tis told us you came late from the Islands.

GOODLACK.

I did so.

MAYOR.

Pray, sir, the news from thence?

GOODLACK.

The best is, that the general is in health,
And Fayal won from the Spaniards; but the fleet,
By reason of so many dangerous tempests,
Extremely weather-beaten. You, sir, I take it,
Are mayor o' the town.

MAYOR.

I am the king's [\[33\]](#) lieutenant.

GOODLACK.

I have some letters of import from one,
A gentleman of very good account,

That died late in the Islands, to a maid
That keeps a tavern here.

MAYOR.

Her name Bess Bridges?

GOODLACK.

The same. I was desired to make inquiry
What fame she bears, and what report she's of.
Now, you, sir, being here chief magistrate,
Can best resolve me.

MAYOR.

To our understanding
She's without stain or blemish, well reputed;
And, by her modesty and fair demeanour,
Hath won the love of all.

GOODLACK.

The worse for me. [*Aside.*]

ALDERMAN.

I can assure you, many narrow eyes
Have looked on her and her condition;
But those that with most envy have endeavoured
To entrap her, have returned, won by her virtues.

GOODLACK.

So all that I inquire of make report.
I am glad to hear't. Sir, I have now some business,
And I of force must leave you.

MAYOR.

I entreat you
To sup with me to-night.

GOODLACK.

Sir, I may trouble you.— [*Exeunt Mayor and Alderman.*]

Five hundred pound a year out of my way.
Is there no flaw that I can tax her with,
To forfeit this revenue? Is she such a saint,
None can missay her? Why, then, I myself
Will undertake it. If in her demeanour
I can but find one blemish, stain, or spot,
It is five hundred pound a year well got.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE IV.—*The Windmill Tavern.*

Enter CLEM and Sailors on one side: on the other, ROUGHMAN, who draws and beats them off; then re-enter CLEM, and the Sailors, with BESS.

BESS.

But did he fight it bravely?

CLEM.

I assure you, mistress, most dissolutely: [\[34\]](#) he hath run this sailor three times through the body, and yet never touched his skin.

BESS.

How can that be?

CLEM.

Through the body of his doublet, I meant.

BESS.

How shame, base imputation, and disgrace,
Can make a coward valiant! Sirrah, you
Look to the bar.

CLEM.

I'll hold up my hand there presently. *[Exit.*

BESS.

I understand you came now from the Islands?

1ST SAILOR.

We did so.

BESS.

If you can tell me tidings of one gentleman,
I shall requite you largely.

1ST SAILOR.

Of what name?

BESS.

One Spencer.

1ST SAILOR.

We both saw and knew the man.

BESS.

Only for that, call for what wine you please.
Pray tell me where you left him.

2ND SAILOR.

In Fayal.

BESS.

Was he in health? How did he fare?

2ND SAILOR.

Why, well.

BESS.

For that good news, spend, revel, and carouse;
Your reckoning's paid beforehand.—I am ecstasied,
And my delight's unbounded.

1ST SAILOR.

Did you love him?

BESS.

Next to my hopes in Heaven.

1ST SAILOR.

Then change your mirth.

BESS.

Why, as I take it, you told me he was well;
And shall I not rejoice?

1ST SAILOR.

He's well, in Heaven; for, mistress, he is dead.

BESS.

Ha! dead! Was't so you said? Th' hast given me, friend,
But one wound yet: speak but that word again,
And kill me outright.

2ND SAILOR.

He lives not.

BESS.

And shall I?—Wilt thou not break, heart?
Are these my ribs wrought out of brass or steel,
Thou canst not craze[35] their bars?

1ST SAILOR.

Mistress, use patience,
Which conquers all despair.

BESS.

You advise well.
I did but jest with sorrow: you may see
I am now in gentle temper.

2ND SAILOR.

True; we see't.

BESS.

Pray take the best room in the house, and there
Call for what wine best tastes you: at my leisure,
I'll visit you myself.

1ST SAILOR.

I'll use your kindness.

[Exeunt Sailors.]

BESS.

That it should be my fate! Poor, poor sweetheart!
I do but think how thou becom'st thy grave,
In which would I lay by thee. What's my wealth,
To enjoy't without my Spencer? I will now
Study to die, that I may live with him.

Enter Captain GOODLACK.

GOODLACK.

[*Aside.*] The further I inquire, the more I hear
To my discomfort. If my discontinuance
And change at sea disguise me from her knowledge,
I shall have scope enough to prove her fully.
This sadness argues she hath heard some news
Of my friend's death.

BESS.

[*Aside.*] It cannot, sure, be true
That he is dead; Death could not be so envious,
To snatch him in his prime. I study to forget
That e'er was such a man.

GOODLACK.

[*Aside.*] If not impeach her,
My purpose is to seek to marry her.
If she deny me, I'll conceal the will,
Or, at the least, make her compound for half—
Save you, [*To BESS*] fair gentlewoman.

BESS.

You are welcome, sir.

GOODLACK.

I hear say there's a whore here, that draws wine.
I am sharp set, and newly come from sea,
And I would see the trash.

BESS.

Sure, you mistake, sir.
If you desire attendance, and some wine,
I can command you both.—Where be these boys?

GOODLACK.

Are you the mistress?

BESS.

I command the house.

GOODLACK.

Of what birth are you, pray?

BESS.

A tanner's daughter.

GOODLACK.

Where born?

BESS.

In Somersetshire.

GOODLACK.

A trade-fallen tanner's daughter go so brave![\[36\]](#)

Oh! you have tricks to compass these gay clothes.

BESS.

None, sir, but what are honest.

GOODLACK.

What's your name?

BESS.

Bess Bridges most men call me.

GOODLACK.

Y'are a whore.

BESS.

Sir, I will fetch you wine, to wash your mouth;

It is so foul, I fear't may fester, else:

There may be danger in't.

GOODLACK.

[*Aside.*] Not all this move her patience!

BESS.

Good, sir, at this time I am scarce myself,
By reason of a great and weighty loss
That troubles me.—[*Notices the ring given to him by SPENCER*]*—*But I
should know that ring.

GOODLACK.

How! this, you baggage? It was never made
To grace a strumpet's finger.

BESS.

Pardon, sir;
I both must and will leave you. [*Exit.*

GOODLACK.

Did not this well? This will stick in my stomach.
I could repent my wrongs done to this maid;
But I'll not leave her thus: if she still love him,
I'll break her heart-strings with some false report
Of his unkindness.

Re-enter CLEM.

CLEM.

You are welcome, gentleman. What wine will you drink? Claret, metheglin, or muscadine? Cider, or perry, to make you merry? Aragoosa, [\[37\]](#) or peter-see-me [\[38\]](#)? Canary, or charnico [\[39\]](#)? But, by your nose, sir, you should love a cup of malmsey: you shall have a cup of the best in Cornwall.

GOODLACK.

Here's a brave drawer, will quarrel with his wine.

CLEM.

But if you prefer the Frenchman before the Spaniard, you shall have either here of the deep red grape, or the pallid white. You are a pretty tall gentleman; you should love high country wine: none but clerks and sextons love Graves wine. Or, are you a married man, I'll furnish you

with bastard,[\[40\]](#) white or brown, according to the complexion of your bedfellow.

GOODLACK.

You rogue, how many years of your prenticeship have you spent in studying this set speech?

CLEM.

The first line of my part was “Anon, anon, sir;” and the first question I answered to, was loggerhead, or blockhead—I know not whether.

GOODLACK.

Speak: where’s your mistress?

CLEM.

Gone up to her chamber.

GOODLACK.

Set a pottle of sack in the fire, and carry it into the next room. [*Exit.*

CLEM.

Score a pottle of sack in the Crown, and see at the bar for some rotten eggs, to burn it: we must have one trick or other, to vent away our bad commodities. [*Exit.*

SCENE V.—A Bedroom in the Tavern.

Enter BESS, with SPENCER'S Picture.

BESS.

To die, and not vouchsafe some few commends
Before his death, was most unkindly done.
This picture is more courteous: 't will not shrink
For twenty thousand kisses; no, nor blush:
Then thou shalt be my husband; and I vow
Never to marry other.

Enter Captain GOODLACK.

GOODLACK.

Where's this harlot?

BESS.

You are immodest, sir, to press thus rudely
Into my private chamber.

GOODLACK.

Pox of modesty,
When punks[41] must have it mincing in their mouths!—
And have I found thee? thou shalt hence with me. [*Seizes the picture.*]

BESS.

Rob me not of the chiefest wealth I have.
Search all my trunks; take the best jewels there;
Deprive me not that treasure: I'll redeem it
With plate, and all the little coin I have,
So I may keep that still.

GOODLACK.

Think'st thou that bribes
Can make me leave my friend's will unperformed?

BESS.

What was that friend?

GOODLACK.

One Spencer, dead i' the Islands,
Whose very last words, uttered at his death,
Were these: "If ever thou shalt come to Foy,
Take thence my picture, and deface it quite;
For let it not be said, my portraiture
Shall grace a strumpet's chamber."

BESS.

'Twas not so:
You lie! you are a villain! 'twas not so.
'Tis more than sin thus to belie the dead.
He knew, if ever I would have transgressed,
'T had been with him: he durst have sworn me chaste,
And died in that belief.

GOODLACK.

Are you so brief?
Nay, I'll not trouble you. God be wi' you!

BESS.

Yet leave me still that picture, and I'll swear
You are a gentleman, and cannot lie.

GOODLACK.

I am inexorable.

BESS.

Are you a Christian?
Have you any name that ever good man gave you?
'Twas no saint you were called after. What's thy name?

GOODLACK.

My name is Captain Thomas Good——

BESS.

I can see no good in thee: rase that syllable
Out of thy name.

GOODLACK.

Goodlack's my name.

BESS.

I cry you mercy, sir: I now remember you;
You were my Spencer's friend; and I am sorry,
Because he loved you, I have been so harsh:
For whose sake I entreat, ere you take't hence,
I may but take my leave on't.

GOODLACK.

You'll return it?

BESS.

As I am chaste, I will.

GOODLACK.

For once I'll trust you. [*Returns the picture.*]

BESS.

O thou, the perfect semblance of my love,
And all that's left of him, take one sweet kiss,
As my last farewell! Thou resembllest him
For whose sweet safety I was every morning
Down on my knees, and with the lark's sweet tunes
I did begin my prayers; and when sad sleep
Had charmed all eyes, when none save the bright stars
Were up and waking, I remembered thee;
But all, all to no purpose.

GOODLACK.

[*Aside.*] Sure, most sure,
This cannot be dissembled.

BESS.

To thee I have been constant in thine absence;
And, when I looked upon this painted piece,
Remembered thy last rules and principles;
For thee I have given alms, visited prisons,
To gentlemen and passengers lent coin,
That, if they ever had ability,
They might repay't to Spencer; yet for this,
All this, and more, I cannot have so much
As this poor table.[\[42\]](#)

GOODLACK.

[*Aside.*] I should question truth,
If I should wrong this creature.

BESS.

I am resolved.—
See, sir, this picture I restore you back;
Which since it was his will you should take hence,
I will not wrong the dead.

GOODLACK.

God be wi' you!

BESS.

One word more.
Spencer, you say, was so unkind in death.

GOODLACK.

I tell you true.

BESS.

I do entreat you, even for goodness' sake,
Since you were one that he entirely loved,
If you some few days hence hear me expired,
You will, 'mongst other good men, and poor people
That haply may miss Bess, grace me so much
As follow me to the grave. This if you promise,

You shall not be the least of all my friends
Remembered in my will. Now, fare you well!

GOODLACK.

[*Aside.*] Had I had heart of flint or adamant,
It would relent at this.—[*Aloud.*] My Mistress Bess,
I have better tidings for you.

BESS.

You will restore
My picture? Will you?

GOODLACK.

Yes, and more than that:
This ring from my friend's finger, sent to you
With infinite commends.

BESS.

You change my blood.

GOODLACK.

These writings are the evidence of lands:
Five hundred pound a year's bequeathed to you,
Of which I here possess you: all is yours.

BESS.

This surplusage of love hath made my loss,
That was but great before, now infinite.—
It may be compassed; there's in this my purpose
No impossibility. [*Aside.*]

GOODLACK.

What study you?

BESS.

Four thousand pound, besides this legacy,
In jewels, gold, and silver, I can make,
And every man discharged. I am resolved

To be a pattern to all maids hereafter
Of constancy in love.

GOODLACK.

Sweet Mistress Bess, will you command my service?
If to succeed your Spencer in his love,
I would expose me wholly to your wishes.

BESS.

Alas! my love sleeps with him in his grave,
And cannot thence be wakened: yet for his sake
I will impart a secret to your trust,
Which, saving you, no mortal should partake.

GOODLACK.

Both for his love and yours, command my service.

BESS.

There's a prize
Brought into Falmouth road, a good tight vessel;
The bottom will but cost eight hundred pound;
You shall have money: buy it.

GOODLACK.

To what end?

BESS.

That you shall know hereafter. Furnish her
With all provision needful: spare no cost;
And join with you a ging[43] of lusty lads,
Such as will bravely man her. All the charge
I will commit to you; and when she's fitted,
Captain, she is thine own.

GOODLACK.

I sound it not.[44]

BESS.

Spare me the rest.—This voyage I intend,
Though some may blame, all lovers will commend.

[*Exeunt.*

ACT THE FOURTH.

SCENE I.—*On Board a Spanish Vessel.*

After an alarum, enter a Spanish Captain, with Sailors, bringing in an English Merchant, SPENCER, and the Surgeon, prisoners.

SPANISH CAPTAIN.

For Fayal's loss and spoil, by the English done,
We are in part revenged. There's not a vessel
That bears upon her top St. George's cross,
But for that act shall suffer.

MERCHANT.

Insult not, Spaniard,
Nor be too proud, that thou by odds of ships,
Provision, men, and powder, madest us yield.
Had you come one to one, or made assault
With reasonable advantage, we by this
Had made the carcase of your ship your graves,
Low sunk to the sea's bottom.

SPANISH CAPTAIN.

Englishman, thy ship shall yield us pillage.
These prisoners we will keep in strongest hold,
To pay no other ransom than their lives.

SPENCER.

Degenerate Spaniard, there's no nobless in thee,
To threaten men unarmed and miserable.
Thou mightst as well tread o'er a field of slaughter,
And kill them o'er that are already slain,
And brag thy manhood.

SPANISH CAPTAIN.

Sirrah, what are you?

SPENCER.

Thy equal, as I am a prisoner;
But once, to stay a better man than thou,
A gentleman in my country.

SPANISH CAPTAIN.

Wert thou not so, we have strappados, bolts,
And engines, [\[45\]](#) to the mainmast fastenèd,
Can make you gentle.

SPENCER.

Spaniard, do thy worst:
Thou canst not act more tortures than my courage
Is able to endure.

SPANISH CAPTAIN.

These Englishmen,
Nothing can daunt them. Even in misery,
They'll not regard their masters.

SPENCER.

Masters! Insulting, bragging Thrasos! [\[46\]](#)

SPANISH CAPTAIN.

His sauciness we'll punish 'bove the rest;
About their censures [\[47\]](#) we will next devise.
And now towards Spain, with our brave English prize.

[Flourish. Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—*The Windmill Tavern.*

Enter BESS, the Mayor of Foy, Alderman, and CLEM.

BESS.

A table and some stools!

CLEM.

I shall give you occasion to ease your tails, presently.

[Tables and stools set out.]

BESS.

Will't please you sit?

MAYOR.

With all our hearts, and thank you.

BESS.

Fetch me that parchment in my closet window.

CLEM.

The three sheepskins with the wrong side outward?

BESS.

That with the seal.

CLEM.

I hope it is my indenture, and now she means to give me my time. *[Exit.]*

ALDERMAN.

And now you are alone, fair Mistress Elizabeth,
I think it good to taste [\[48\]](#) you with a motion
That no way can displease you.

BESS.

Pray, speak on.

ALDERMAN.

'T hath pleased here Master Mayor so far to look
Into your fair demeanour, that he thinks you
A fit match for his son.

Re-enter CLEM, with the parchment.

CLEM.

Here's the parchment; but if it be the lease of your house, I can assure
you 'tis out.

BESS.

The years are not expired.

CLEM.

No; but it is out of your closet.

BESS.

About your business.

CLEM.

Here's even Susannah betwixt the two wicked elders. [*Exit.*

ALDERMAN.

What think you, Mistress Elizabeth?

BESS.

Sir, I thank you;
And how much I esteem this goodness from you,
The trust I shall commit unto your charge
Will truly witness. Marry, gentle sir!
'Las, I have sadder business now in hand
Than sprightly marriage; witness these my tears.
Pray read there.

MAYOR.

[*Reads.*] "The last will and testament of Elizabeth Bridges; to be
committed to the trust of the mayor and aldermen of Foy, and their

successors for ever.

To set up young beginners in their trade, a thousand pound.

To relieve such as have had loss by sea, five hundred pound.

To every maid that's married out of Foy, whose name's Elizabeth, ten pound.

To relieve maimed soldiers, by the year, ten pound.

To Captain Goodlack, if he shall perform the business he's employed in, five hundred pound.

The legacies for Spencer thus to stand:

To number all the poorest of his kin,

And to bestow on them—Item, to——”

BESS.

Enough! You see, sir, I am now too poor

To bring a dowry with me fit for your son.

MAYOR.

You want a precedent, you so abound

In charity and goodness.

BESS.

All my servants

I leave at your discretions to dispose;

Not one but I have left some legacy.

What shall become of me, or what I purpose;

Spare further to inquire.

MAYOR.

We'll take our leaves,

And prove to you faithful executors

In this bequest.

ALDERMAN.

Let never such despair,

As, dying rich, shall make the poor their heir.

[Exeunt Mayor and Alderman.]

BESS.

Why, what is all the wealth the world contains,
Without my Spencer?

Enter ROUGHMAN and FAWCETT.

ROUGHMAN.

Where's my sweet Bess?
Shall I become a welcome suitor, now
That I have changed my copy?[\[49\]](#)

BESS.

I joy to hear it.
I'll find employment for you.

Enter Captain GOODLACK, Sailors, and CLEM.

GOODLACK.

A gallant ship, and wondrous proudly trimmed;
Well caulked, well tackled, every way prepared.

BESS.

Here, then, our mourning for a season end.

ROUGHMAN.

Bess, shall I strike that captain? Say the word,
I'll have him by the ears.

BESS.

Not for the world.

GOODLACK.

What saith that fellow?

BESS.

He desires your love,
Good captain: let him ha' it.

GOODLACK.

Then change a hand.

BESS.

Resolve me all. I am bound upon a voyage:
Will you, in this adventure, take such part
As I myself shall do?

ROUGHMAN.

With my fair Bess,
To the world's end.

BESS.

Then, captain and lieutenant both join hands;
Such are your places now.

GOODLACK.

We two are friends.

BESS.

I next must swear you two, with all your ging,[\[50\]](#)
True to some articles you must observe,
Reserving to myself a prime command,
Whilst I enjoin nothing unreasonable.

GOODLACK.

All this is granted.

BESS.

Then, first you said your ship was trim and gay:
I'll have her pitched all o'er; no spot of white,
No colour to be seen; no sail but black;
No flag but sable.

GOODLACK.

'Twill be ominous,
And bode disastrous fortune.

BESS.

I will ha't so.

GOODLACK.

Why, then, she shall be pitched black as the devil.

BESS.

She shall be called the Negro. When you know
My conceit, [\[51\]](#) captain, you will thank me for't.

ROUGHMAN.

But whither are we bound?

BESS.

Pardon me that:
When we are out at sea, I'll tell you all.
For mine own wearing I have rich apparel,
For man or woman, as occasion serves.

CLEM.

But, mistress, if you be going to sea, what shall become of me a-land?

BESS.

I'll give thee thy full time.

CLEM.

And shall I take time, when time is, and let my mistress slip away? No; it shall be seen that my teeth are as strong to grind biscuit as the best sailor of them all, and my stomach as able to digest powdered beef and poor-john. [\[52\]](#) Shall I stay here to score a pudding in the Half-moon, and see my mistress at the mainyard, with her sails up and spread? No; it shall be seen that I, who have been brought up to draw wine, will see what water the ship draws, or I'll bewray the voyage.

BESS.

If thou hast so much courage, the captain shall accept thee.

CLEM.

If I have so much courage! When did you see a black beard with a white liver, or a little fellow without a tall stomach? I doubt not but to prove an honour to all the drawers in Cornwall.

GOODLACK.

What now remains?

FAWCETT.

To make myself associate
In this bold enterprise.

GOODLACK.

Most gladly, sir.
And now our number's full, what's to be done?

BESS.

First, at my charge, I'll feast the town of Foy;
Then set the cellars ope, that these my mates
May quaff unto the health of our boon voyage,
Our needful things being once conveyed aboard;
Then, casting up our caps, in sign of joy,
Our purpose is to bid farewell to Foy.

[Exeunt. Hautboys long.][\[53\]](#)

SCENE III.—*Morocco. The Court.*

Enter MULLISHEG, Bashaw ALCADÉ, and Bashaw JOFFER, with other Attendants.

MULLISHEG.

Out of these bloody and intestine broils
We have at length attained a fortunate peace,
And now at last established in the throne
Of our great ancestors, and reign as King
Of Fez and great Morocco.

ALCADÉ.

Mighty Mullisheg,
Pride of our age and glory of the Moors,
By whose victorious hand all Barbary
Is conquered, awed, and swayed, behold thy vassals
With loud applauses greet thy victory.

[Shout; flourish.]

MULLISHEG.

Upon the slaughtered bodies of our foes
We mount our high tribunal; and being sole,
Without competitor, we now have leisure
To stablish laws, first for our kingdom's safety,
The enriching of our public treasury,
And last our state and pleasure; then give order
That all such Christian merchants as have traffic
And freedom in our country, that conceal
The least part of our custom due to us,
Shall forfeit ship and goods.

JOFFER.

There are appointed
Unto that purpose careful officers.

MULLISHEG.

Those forfeitures must help to furnish up
The exhausted treasure that our wars consumed:
Part of such profits as accrue that way
We have already tasted.

ALCADE.

'Tis most fit
Those Christians that reap profit by our land
Should contribute unto so great a loss.

MULLISHEG.

Alcade, they shall.—But what's the style of king,
Without his pleasure? Find us concubines,
The fairest Christian damsels you can hire,
Or buy for gold; the loveliest of the Moors
We can command, and negroes everywhere;
Italians, French, and Dutch, choice Turkish girls,
Must fill our Alkedavy, the great palace
Where Mullisheg now deigns to keep his court.

JOFFER.

Who else are worthy to be libertines
But such as bear the sword?

MULLISHEG.

Joffer, thou pleasest us.
If kings on earth be termèd demigods,
Why should we not make here terrestrial Heaven?
We can, we will: our God shall be our pleasure;
For so our Meccan prophet warrants us.
And now the music of the drums surcease;
We'll learn to dance to the soft tunes of peace.

[Hautboys. Exeunt.]

SCENE IV.—*On Board an English Ship.*

Enter BESS as a Sea-captain, Captain GOODLACK, ROUGHMAN, and others.

BESS.

Good morrow, captain. Oh, this last sea-fight
Was gallantly performed! It did me good
To see the Spanish carvel[54] vail[55] her top
Unto my maiden flag. Where ride we now?

GOODLACK.

Among the Islands.

BESS.

What coast is this we now descry from far?

GOODLACK.

Yon fort's called Fayal.

BESS.

Is that the place where Spencer's body lies?

GOODLACK.

Yes; in yon church he's buried.

BESS.

Then know, to this place was my voyage bound,
To fetch the body of my Spencer thence;
In his own country to erect a tomb
And lasting monument, where, when I die,
In the same bed of earth my bones may lie.
Then, all that love me, arm and make for shore:
Yours be the spoil, he mine; I crave no more.

ROUGHMAN.

May that man die derided and accursed

That will not follow where a woman leads.

GOODLACK.

Roughman, you are too rash, and counsel ill.
Have not the Spaniards fortified the town?
In all our gins we are but sixty-five.

ROUGHMAN.

Come, I'll make one.

GOODLACK.

Attend me, good lieutenant;
And, sweet Bess, listen what I have devised.
With ten tall fellows I have manned our boat,
To see what straggling Spaniards they can take.
And see where Fawcett is returned with prisoners.

Enter FAWCETT, with two Spaniards.

FAWCETT.

These Spaniards we by break of day surprised,
As they were ready to take boat for fishing.

GOODLACK.

Spaniards, upon your lives, resolve us truly,
How strong's the town and fort?

1ST SPANIARD.

Since English Raleigh won and spoiled it first,
The town's re-edified, and fort new built,
And four field-pieces in the block-house lie,
To keep the harbour's mouth.

GOODLACK.

And what's one ship to these?

BESS.

Was there not, in the time of their abode,

A gentleman called Spencer buried there,
Within the church, whom some report was slain,
Or perished by a wound?

1ST SPANIARD.

Indeed, there was,
And o'er him raised a goodly monument;
But when the English navy were sailed thence,
And that the Spaniards did possess the town,
Because they held him for a heretic,
They straight removed his body from the church.

BESS.

And would the tyrants be so uncharitable
To wrong the dead! Where did they then bestow him?

1ST SPANIARD.

They buried him i' the fields.

BESS.

Oh, still more cruel!

1ST SPANIARD.

The man that ought [\[56\]](#) the field, doubtful his corn
Would never prosper whilst a heretic's body
Lay there, he made petition to the church
To ha' it digged up and burnt; and so it was.

BESS.

What's he, that loves me, would persuade me live,
Not rather leap o'er hatches into the sea?
Yet, ere I die, I hope to be revenged
Upon some Spaniards, for my Spencer's wrong.

ROUGHMAN.

Let's first begin with these.

BESS.

'Las, these poor slaves! Besides their pardoned lives,
One give them money.—And, Spaniards, where you come,
Pray for Bess Bridges, and speak well o' the English.

1ST & 2ND SPANIARDS.

We shall.

BESS.

Our mourning we will turn into revenge,
And since the church hath censured so my Spencer,
Bestow upon the church some few cast pieces.—
Command the gunner do't.

GOODLACK.

And, if he can,
To batter it to the earth.

[A gun is discharged.]

Enter CLEM, falling through haste.

CLEM.

A sail! a sail!

BESS.

From whence?

CLEM.

A pox upon yon gunner! Could he not give warning, before he had shot?

ROUGHMAN.

Why, I prithee?

CLEM.

Why? I was sent to the top-mast, to watch, and there I fell fast asleep.
Bounce! quoth the guns; down tumbles Clem; and, if by chance my feet
had not hung in the tackles, you must have sent to England for a bone-
setter, for my neck had been in a pitiful taking.

ROUGHMAN.

Thou told'st us of a sail.

Enter Sailor, above.

SAILOR.

Arm, gentlemen! a gallant ship of war
Makes with her full sails this way; who, it seems,
Hath took a bark of England.

BESS.

Which we'll rescue,
Or perish in the adventure. You have sworn
That, howsoe'er we conquer or miscarry,
Not to reveal my sex.

ALL.

We have.

BESS.

Then, for your country's honour, my revenge,
For your own fame, and hope of golden spoil,
Stand bravely to't.—The manage of the fight
We leave to you.

GOODLACK.

Then, now up with your fights,[\[57\]](#) and let your ensigns,
Blest with St. George's cross, play with the winds.—
Fair Bess, keep you your cabin.

BESS.

Captain, you wrong me: I will face the fight;
And where the bullets sing loud'st 'bout mine ears,
There shall you find me cheering up my men.

ROUGHMAN.

This wench would of a coward make a Hercules.

BESS.

Trumpets, a charge! and with your whistles shrill,
Sound, boatswains, an alarum to your mates.
With music cheer up their astonished souls,
The whilst the thundering ordnance bear the bass.

GOODLACK.

To fight against the Spaniards we desire.
Alarum, trumpets!

[Alarum.

ROUGHMAN.

Gunners, straight give fire!

[A shot is fired. Exeunt GOODLACK, BESS, &c.

*Re-enter Captain GOODLACK, wounded, BESS, ROUGHMAN, FAWCETT, and
CLEM.*

GOODLACK.

I am shot, and can no longer man the deck:
Yet let not my wound daunt your courage, mates.

BESS.

For every drop of blood that thou hast shed,
I'll have a Spaniard's life.—Advance your targets,
And now cry all, "Board! board! Amain for England!"

[Alarum. Exeunt GOODLACK, BESS, &c.

*Re-enter BESS, ROUGHMAN, FAWCETT, CLEM, &c., victorious. The
Spaniards prisoners.*

BESS.

How is it with the captain?

ROUGHMAN.

Nothing dangerous;

But, being shot i' the thigh, he keeps his cabin,
And cannot rise to greet your victory.

BESS.

He stood it bravely out, whilst he could stand.

CLEM.

But for these Spaniards: now, you Don Diegos,
You that made Paul's to stink. [\[58\]](#)

ROUGHMAN.

Before we further censure them, let's know
What English prisoners they have here aboard. *[Exit.*

1ST SPANIARD.

You may command them all. We that were now
Lords over them, fortune hath made your slaves.—
Release our prisoners.

BESS.

Had my captain died,
Not one proud Spaniard had escaped with life.
Your ship is forfeit to us, and your goods:
So live.—Give him his long boat: him and his
Set safe ashore; and pray for English Bess.

1ST SPANIARD.

I know not whom you mean; but be't your queen,
Famous Elizabeth, I shall report
She and her subjects both are merciful.

[Exeunt Spaniards.

Re-enter ROUGHMAN, with a Merchant, SPENCER and English Prisoners.

BESS.

Whence are you, sir, and whither were you bound?

MERCHANT.

I am a London merchant, bound for Barbary;
But by this Spanish man-of-war surprised,
Pillaged and captived.

BESS.

We much pity you.
What loss you have sustained, this Spanish prey
Shall make good to you, to the utmost farthing.

MERCHANT.

Our lives, and all our fortunes whatsoever,
Are wholly at your service.

BESS.

These gentlemen have been dejected long.
Let me peruse [\[59\]](#) them all, and give them money
To drink our health. And pray forget not, sirs,
To pray for——*[She sees SPENCER.]* Hold! support me, or I faint.

ROUGHMAN.

What sudden, unexpected ecstasy
Disturbs your conquest?

BESS.

Interrupt me not;
But give me way, for Heaven's sake!

SPENCER.

I have seen
A face, ere now, like that young gentleman,
But not remember where.

BESS.

But he was slain;
Lay buried in yon church; and thence removed,
Denied all Christian rites, and, like an infidel,
Confined unto the fields; and thence digged up,

His body, after death, had martyrdom.
All these assure me 'tis his shadow dogs me,
For some most just revenge, thus far to sea.—
Is it because the Spaniards scaped with life,
That were to thee so cruel after death,
Thou haunt'st me thus? Sweet ghost, thy rage forbear;
I will revenge thee on the next we seize.
I am amazed; this sight I'll not endure.
Sleep, sleep, fair ghost, for thy revenge is sure.

ROUGHMAN.

Fawcett, convey the owner to his cabin.

[Exit FAWCETT with BESS.]

SPENCER.

I pray, sir, what young gentleman is that?

ROUGHMAN.

He's both the owner of the ship and goods,
That for some reasons hath his name concealed.

SPENCER.

Methinks he looks like Bess; for in his eyes
Lives the first love that did my heart surprise.

ROUGHMAN.

Come, gentlemen, first make your losses good,
Out of this Spanish prize. Let's then divide
Both several ways, and Heavens be our guide.

MERCHANT.

We towards Mamorah.

ROUGHMAN.

We where the Fates do please,
Till we have tracked a wilderness of seas.

[Flourish. Exeunt.]

Enter Chorus.

CHORUS.

Our stage so lamely can express a sea,
That we are forced by Chorus to discourse
What should have been in action. Now, imagine
Her passion o'er, and Goodlack well recovered;
Who, had he not been wounded, and seen Spencer,
Had sure descried him. Much prize they have ta'en:
The French and Dutch she spares; only makes spoil
Of the rich Spaniard and the barbarous Turk.
And now her fame grows great in all these seas.
Suppose her rich, and forced, for want of water,
To put into Mamorah, in Barbary,
Where, wearied with the habit of a man,
She was discovered by the Moors aboard,
Which told it to the amorous King of Fez,
That ne'er before had English lady seen.
He sends for her on shore. How he receives her,
How she and Spencer meet, must next succeed.
Sit patient, then: when these are fully told,
Some may hap say, "Ay, there's a girl worth gold." *[Exit.]*

ACT THE FIFTH.

SCENE I.—*Morocco. The Court.*

Enter MULLISHEG, Bashaw ALCADÉ, Bashaw JOFFER, Attendants, &c.

MULLISHEG.

But was she of such presence?

ALCADÉ.

To describe her
Were to make eloquence dumb.

MULLISHEG.

Well habited?[\[60\]](#)

ALCADÉ.

I ne'er beheld a beauty more complete.

MULLISHEG.

Thou hast inflamed our spirits.
In England born?

ALCADÉ.

The captain so reported.

MULLISHEG.

How her ship?

ALCADÉ.

I never saw a braver vessel sail.
And she is called the Negro.

MULLISHEG.

Ominous,
Perhaps, to our good fate: she in a Negro

Hath sailed thus far, to bosom with a Moor.
But for the motion made to come ashore,
How did she relish that?

ALCADE.

I promised to the captain large reward,
To win him to it, and this day he hath promised
To bring me her free answer.

MULLISHEG.

When he comes,
Give him the entertainment of a prince. [*Enter a Moor.*
The news with thee?

MOOR.

The captain of the Negro craves admittance
Unto your highness' presence.

MULLISHEG.

A guard attend him, and our noblest bashaws
Conduct him safe where we will parley him.

Flourish. Enter Captain GOODLACK and ROUGHMAN.

GOODLACK.

Long live the high and mighty King of Fez!

MULLISHEG.

If thou bring'st her, then dost thou bring me life.
Say, will she come?

GOODLACK.

She will, my lord; but yet conditionally,
She may be free from violence.

MULLISHEG.

Now, by the mighty prophet we adore,
She shall live lady of her free desires:

'Tis love, not force, must quench our amorous fires.

ROUGHMAN.

We will conduct her to your presence straight.

[Exeunt ROUGHMAN and GOODLACK.]

MULLISHEG.

We will have banquets, revels, and what not,
To entertain this stranger.

*[Hautboys. Re-enter Captain GOODLACK and ROUGHMAN, with BESS
BRIDGES, veiled, FAWCETT, and Moors.]*

A goodly presence!—Why's that beauty veiled?

BESS.

Long live the King of Fez.

MULLISHEG.

I am amazed!
This is no mortal creature I behold,
But some bright angel, that is dropped from Heaven,
Sent by our prophet.—Captain, let me thus
Embrace thee in my arms.—Load him with gold,
For this great favour.

BESS.

Captain, touch it not.—
Know, King of Fez, my followers want no gold.
I only came to see thee for my pleasure,
And show thee, what these say thou never saw'st,
A woman born in England.

MULLISHEG.

That English earth may well be termed a Heaven,
That breeds such divine beauties. Make me sure
That thou art mortal by one friendly touch.

BESS.

Keep off: for, till thou swear'st to my demands,
I will have no commerce[61] with Mullisheg,
But leave thee as I came.

MULLISHEG.

Were't half my kingdom,
That, beauteous English virgin, thou shalt have.

BESS.

[*Hands GOODLACK a paper.*] Captain, read.

GOODLACK.

[*Reads.*] "First, liberty for her and hers to leave the land at her pleasure. Next, safe-conduct to and from her ship, at her own discretion. Thirdly, to be free from all violence, either by the king or any of his people. Fourthly, to allow her mariners fresh victuals aboard. Fifthly, to offer no further violence to her person than what he seeks by kindly usage and free entreaty."

MULLISHEG.

To these I vow and seal.

BESS.

These being assured,
Your courtship's free, and henceforth we secured.

MULLISHEG.

Say, gentlemen of England, what's your fashion
And garb of entertainment?

GOODLACK.

Our first greeting
Begins still on the lips.

MULLISHEG.

Fair creature, shall I be immortalized
With that high favour?

BESS.

'Tis no immodest thing
You ask, nor shame for Bess to kiss a king. [*Kisses him.*]

MULLISHEG.

This kiss hath all my vitals ecstasied.

ROUGHMAN.

Captain,
This king is mightily in love. Well, let her
Do as she list, I'll make use of his bounty.

GOODLACK.

We should be madmen else.

MULLISHEG.

Grace me so much as take your seat by me.

BESS.

I'll be so far commanded.

MULLISHEG.

Sweet, your age?

BESS.

Not fully yet seventeen.

MULLISHEG.

But how your birth? How came you to this wealth,
To have such gentlemen at your command,
And what your cause of travel?

BESS.

Mighty prince,
If you desire to see me beat my breast,
Pour forth a river of increasing tears,
Then you may urge me to that sad discourse.

MULLISHEG.

Not for Mamorah's wealth, nor all the gold
Coined in rich Barbary. Nay, sweet, arise,
And ask of me, be't half this kingdom's treasure,
And thou art lady on't.

BESS.

If I shall ask, 't must be, you will not give.
Our country breeds no beggars; for our hearts
Are of more noble temper.

MULLISHEG.

Sweet, your name?

BESS.

Elizabeth.

MULLISHEG.

There's virtue in that name.
The virgin queen, so famous through the world,
The mighty empress of the maiden isle,
Whose predecessors have o'errun great France,
Whose powerful hand doth still support the Dutch,
And keeps the potent king of Spain in awe,
Is not she titled so?

BESS.

She is.

MULLISHEG.

Hath she herself a face so fair as yours,
When she appears for wonder?

BESS.

Mighty Fez,
You cast a blush upon my maiden cheek,
To pattern me with her. Why, England's queen,
She is the only phoenix of her age,

The pride and glory of the Western Isles.
Had I a thousand tongues, they all would tire,
And fail me in her true description.

MULLISHEG.

Grant me this:
To-morrow we supply our judgment seat,
And sentence causes; sit with us in state,
And let your presence beautify our throne.

BESS.

In that I am your servant.

MULLISHEG.

And we thine.
Set on in state, attendants and full train.
But find to ask, we vow thou shalt obtain.

[Exeunt all except GOODLACK.]

Enter CLEM.

CLEM.

It is not now as when Andrea lived, or rather Andrew, our elder journeyman. What, drawers become courtiers! Now may I speak with the old ghost in Jeronimo—

When this eternal substance of my soul
Did live imprisoned in this wanton flesh,
I was a courtier in the court of Fez.[\[62\]](#)

GOODLACK.

Oh, well done, Clem! It is your mistress' pleasure,
None come ashore that's not well habited.

CLEM.

Nay; for mine own part, I hold myself as good a Christian in these clothes, as the proudest infidel of them all.

Re-enter ALCADE and JOFFER.

ALCADE.

Sir, by your leave, you're of the English train?

CLEM.

I am so, thou great monarch of the Mauritanians.

JOFFER.

Then, 'tis the king's command we give you all attendance.

CLEM.

Great Signior of the Saracens, I thank thee.

ALCADE.

Will you walk in to banquet?

CLEM.

I will make bold to march in towards your banquet, and there comfit myself, and cast all caraways down my throat, the best way I have to conserve myself in health; and for your country's sake, which is called Barbary, I will love all barbers and barberries the better.

And for you Moors, thus much I mean to say,
I'll see if more I eat, the more I may.

Enter two Merchants.

1ST MERCHANT.

I pray, sir, are you of the English train?

CLEM.

Why, what art thou, my friend?

1ST MERCHANT.

Sir, a French merchant, run into relapse,
And forfeit of the law. Here's for you, sir,
Forty good Barbary pieces, to deliver
Your lady this petition, who, I hear,

Can all things with the king.

CLEM.

Your gold doth bind me to you.—You may see what it is to be a sudden courtier: I no sooner put my nose into the court, but my hand itches for a bribe already.—What's your business, my friend?

2ND MERCHANT.

Some of my men, for a little outrage done,
Are sentenced to the galleys.

CLEM.

To the gallows?

2ND MERCHANT.

No; to the galleys. Now, could your lady purchase
Their pardon from the king, here's twenty angels.[\[63\]](#)

CLEM.

What are you, sir?

2ND MERCHANT.

A Florentine merchant.

CLEM.

Then you are, as they say, a Christian?

2ND MERCHANT.

Heaven forbid, else!

CLEM.

I should not have the faith to take your gold, else.
Attend on me: I'll speak in your behalf.—
Where be my bashaws? Usher us in state:
And when we sit to banquet, see you wait.

[Flourish. Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—*The same.*

Enter SPENCER.

SPENCER.

This day the king ascends his royal throne.
The honest merchant, in whose ship I came,
Hath, by a cunning quiddit[64] in the law,
Both ship and goods made forfeit to the king,
To whom I will petition. But no more;
He's now upon his entrance.

[Hautboys.

*Enter MULLISHEG, BESS, Captain GOODLACK, ROUGHMAN, ALCADE,
JOFFER, with all the other train.*

MULLISHEG.

Here seat thee, maid of England, like a queen—
The style we'll give thee, wilt thou deign us love.

BESS.

Bless me, you holy angels!

MULLISHEG.

What is't offends you, sweet?

SPENCER.

I am amazed, and know not what to think on't.

BESS.

Captain, dost not see? Is not that Spencer's ghost?

GOODLACK.

I see, and, like you, I am ecstasied.

SPENCER.

If mine eyes mistake not,
That should be Captain Goodlack, and that Bess.
But oh! I cannot be so happy.

GOODLACK.

'Tis he, and I'll salute him.

BESS.

Captain, stay.
You shall be swayed by me.

SPENCER.

Him I well know; but how should she come hither?

MULLISHEG.

What is't that troubles you?

BESS.

Most mighty king,
Spare me no longer time but to bestow
My captain on a message.

MULLISHEG.

Thou shalt command my silence, and his ear.

BESS.

[To GOODLACK.] Go wind about, and when you see least eyes
Are fixed on you, single him out, and see
If we mistake not. If he be the man,
Give me some private note.

GOODLACK.

This. [*Making a sign.*]

BESS.

Enough.—What said your highness?

MULLISHEG.

Hark what I proffer thee. Continue here,
And grant me full fruition of thy love.—

BESS.

Good.

MULLISHEG.

Thou shalt have all my peers to honour thee,
Next our great prophet.

BESS.

Well.

MULLISHEG.

And when thou'rt weary of our sun-burnt clime,
Thy Negro shall be ballast home with gold.

BESS.

I am eternized ever!
Now, all you sad disasters, dare your worst;
I neither care nor fear: my Spencer lives!

MULLISHEG.

You mind me not, sweet virgin.

BESS.

You talk of love:
My lord, I'll tell you more of that hereafter;
But now to your state-business.—Bid him do thus
No more, and not to be seen till then.

GOODLACK.

Enough.—Come, sir, you must along with me.

[Exeunt GOODLACK and SPENCER.]

BESS.

Now, stood a thousand deaths before my face,

I would not change my cheer, since Spencer's safe.

Enter CLEM with the French and Italian Merchants; and a Preacher.

CLEM.

By your leave, my masters; room for generosity.[\[65\]](#)

1ST MERCHANT.

Pray, sir, remember me.

2ND MERCHANT.

Good sir, my suit.

CLEM.

I am perfect in both your parts, without prompting. Mistress, here are two Christen friends of mine have forfeited ships and men to the black-amorian king: now, one sweet word from your lips might get their release. I have had a feeling of the business already.

MULLISHEG.

For dealing in commodities forbid,
You're fined a thousand ducats.

BESS.

Cast off the burden of your heavy doom:
A follower of my train petitions for him.

MULLISHEG.

One of thy train, sweet Bess?

CLEM.

And no worse man than myself, sir.

MULLISHEG.

Well, sirrah, for your lady's sake
His ship and goods shall be restored again.

1ST MERCHANT.

Long live the King of Fez!

CLEM.

Mayst thou never want sweet water to wash thy black face in, most mighty monarch of Morocco.—Mistress, another friend; ay, and paid beforehand.

MULLISHEG.

Sirrah, your men, for outrage and contempt,
Are doomed unto the gallies.

BESS.

A censure too severe for Christians.
Great king, I'll pay their ransom.

MULLISHEG.

Thou, my Bess!
Thy word shall be their ransom: they're discharged.
What grave old man is that?

JOFFER.

A Christian preacher; one that would convert
Your Moors, and turn them to a new belief.

MULLISHEG.

Then he shall die, as we are king of Fez.

BESS.

For these I only spake; for him I kneel,
If I have any grace with mighty Fez.

MULLISHEG.

We can deny thee nothing, beauteous maid.
A kiss shall be his pardon.

BESS.

Thus I pay't.

CLEM.

Must your black face be smouching my mistress' white lips with a moorian! [\[66\]](#) I would you had kissed her a—

ALCADE.

Hah! how is that, sir?

CLEM.

I know what I say, sir; I would he had kissed her a—

ALCADE.

A—what?

CLEM.

A thousand times, to have done him a pleasure!

Re-enter SPENCER and Captain GOODLACK.

MULLISHEG.

That kiss was worth the ransom of a king.—
What's he, of that brave presence?

BESS.

A gentleman of England, and my friend.
Do him some grace, for my sake.

MULLISHEG.

For thy sake what would not I perform?
He shall have grace and honour.—Joffer, go
And see him gelded to attend on us:
He shall be our chief eunuch.

BESS.

Not for ten worlds! Behold, great king, I stand
Betwixt him and all danger.—Have I found thee?—
Seize what I have; take both my ship and goods;
Leave nought that's mine unrifled: spare me him.—
And have I found my Spencer?

CLEM.

Please your majesty, I see all men are not capable of honour: what he refuseth, may it please you to bestow on me.

MULLISHEG.

With all my heart. Go, bear him hence, Alcade,
Into our Alkedavy: honour him,
And let him taste the razor.

CLEM.

There's honour for me!

ALCADE.

Come, follow.

CLEM.

No, sir; I'll go before you, for mine honour.

[Exeunt CLEM and ALCADE.]

SPENCER.

Oh! show yourself, renowned king, the same
Fame blazons you. Bestow this maid on me:
'Tis such a gift as kingdoms cannot buy.
She is a precedent of all true love,
And shall be registered to after-times,
That ne'er shall pattern her.

GOODLACK.

Heard you the story of their constant love,
'Twould move in you compassion.

ROUGHMAN.

Let not intemperate love sway you 'bove pity.
That foreign nation, that ne'er heard your name,
May chronicle your virtues.

MULLISHEG.

You have wakened in me an heroic spirit:
Lust shall not conquer virtue.—Till this hour,
We graced thee for thy beauty, English woman;
But now we wonder at thy constancy.

BESS.

Oh! were you of our faith, I'd swear great Mullisheg
To be a god on earth.—And lives my Spencer?
In troth I thought thee dead.

SPENCER.

In hope of thee,
I lived to gain both life and liberty.

Re-enter CLEM, running.

CLEM.

No more of your honour, if you love me! Is this your Moorish
preferment, to rob a man of his best jewels?

MULLISHEG.

Hast thou seen our Alkedavy?

CLEM.

Davy do you call him? he may be called shavy; I am sure he hath tickled
my current commodity. No more of your cutting honour, if you love me.

MULLISHEG.

[To SPENCER.] All your strange fortunes we will hear discoursed,
And after that your fair espousals grace,
If you can find a man of your belief
To do that grateful office.

SPENCER.

None more fit
Than this religious and brave gentleman,
Late rescued from death's sentence.

PREACHER.

None more proud
To do you that poor service.

MULLISHEG.

Noble Englishman,
I cannot fasten bounty to my will
Worthy thy merit: move some suit to us.

SPENCER.

To make you more renowned, great king, and us
The more indebted, there's an Englishman
Hath forfeited his ship for goods uncustomed.—

MULLISHEG.

Thy suit is granted ere it be half begged:
Dispose them at thy pleasure.

SPENCER.

Mighty king,
We are your highness' servants.

MULLISHEG.

Come, beauteous maid; we'll see thee crowned a bride.
At all our pompous banquets these shall wait.
Thy followers and thy servants press with gold;
And not the mean'st that to thy train belongs,
But shall approve our bounty. Lead in state,
And, wheresoe'er thy fame shall be enrolled,
The world report thou art a Girl worth Gold.

[Exeunt.]

THE ENGLISH TRAVELLER.

The English Traveller was first printed in 1633, and from the preface it would seem that the publication of the play was an accident; the date of its production (at the Cockpit in Drury Lane) we do not know. The bye-plot of the prodigal Lionel and his servant is borrowed from Plautus' *Mostellaria*, which a century or more later was laid under contribution by Fielding in his *Intriguing Chambermaid*. Heywood may have known Plautus' comedy in the original or in one of the Italian versions. The character of Young Geraldine deserves study: "he is," says Professor Ward, "one of the truest gentlemen of Elizabethan comedy." Mr. Saintsbury (*Elizabethan Literature*, p. 284) ranks *The English Traveller* with *A Woman Killed with Kindness* as Heywood's best plays.

In the old editions the scenes are only partially indicated.

THE EPISTLE DEDICATORY.

To the Right Worshipful
SIR HENRY APPLETON, KNIGHT BARONET, ETC.

Noble Sir,

FOR many reasons I am induced to present this Poem to your favourable acceptance; and not the least of them that alternate love and those frequent courtesies which interchangeably passed betwixt yourself and that good old gentleman, mine uncle (Master Edmund Heywood), whom you pleased to grace by the title of father. I must confess I had altogether slept (my weakliness and bashfulness discouraging me) had they not been wakened and animated by that worthy gentleman your friend and my countryman, Sir William Elvish, whom (who for his unmerited love many ways extended towards me,) I much honour; neither, sir, need you to think it any undervaluing of your worth to undertake the patronage of a poem in this nature, since the like hath been done by Roman Lælius, Scipio, Mæcenas, and many other mighty princes and captains; nay, even by Augustus Cæsar himself, concerning whom Ovid is thus read (*De Tristi*, lib. 2):

Inspice ludorum sumptus, Auguste, tuorum:
Empta tibi magno talia multa leges.
Hæc tu spectasti, spectandaque sæpe dedisti.
Majestas adeo comis ubique tua est.

So highly were they respected in the most flourishing estate of the Roman Empire; and if they have been vilified of late by any separistical humorist (as in the now questioned *Histrion-Mastix*),[\[1\]](#) I hope by the next term (Minerva assistente) to give such satisfaction to the world, by vindicating many particulars in that work maliciously exploded and condemned, as that no gentleman of quality and judgment but shall therein receive a reasonable satisfaction. I am loth by tediousness to grow troublesome, therefore conclude with a grateful remembrance of my service, intermixed with myriads of zealous wishes for your health of body

and peace of mind, with superabundance of earth's blessings and Heaven's
graces, ever remaining,

Yours most observant,
THOMAS HEYWOOD.

TO THE READER.

IF, Reader, thou hast of this play been an auditor, there is less apology to be used by entreating thy patience. This tragi-comedy (being one reserved amongst two hundred and twenty in which I have had either an entire hand, or at the least a main finger) coming accidentally to the press, and I having intelligence thereof, thought it not fit that it should pass as *filius populi*, a bastard without a father to acknowledge it. True it is, that my plays are not exposed unto the world in volumes, to bear the title of works, (as others); one reason is, that many of them by shifting and change of companies have been negligently lost; others of them are still retained in the hands of some actors, who think it against their peculiar profit to have them come in print; and a third, that it never was any great ambition in me, to be in this kind voluminously read. All that I have further to say at this time is only this: [censure\[2\]](#) I entreat as favourably as it is exposed to thy view freely. Ever

Studious of thy pleasure and profit,

THOMAS HEYWOOD.

PROLOGUE.

A STRANGE play you are like to have, for know,
We use no drum, nor trumpet, nor dumb show;
No combat, marriage, not so much to-day
As song, dance, masque, to bombast out a play;
Yet these all good, and still in frequent use
With our best poets; nor is this excuse
Made by our author, as if want of skill
Caused this defect; it's rather his self will.
Will you the reason know? There have so many
Been in that kind, that he desires not any
At this time in his scene, no help, no strain,
Or flash that's borrowed from another's brain;
Nor speaks he this that he would have you fear it,
He only tries if once bare lines will bear it:
Yet may't afford, so please you silent sit,
Some mirth, some matter, and perhaps some wit.

DRAMATIS PERSONÆ.

Two young Gentlemen:

GERALDINE,

DELAVIL,

Old WINCOTT.

Young LIONEL, a riotous Citizen.

Old GERALDINE, Father of Young GERALDINE.

Old LIONEL, a Merchant, Father of Young LIONEL.

REIGNALD, a parasitical Serving-man.

ROBIN, an old country Serving-man.

ROGER the Clown, Servant to Old WINCOTT.

RIOTER, a Spendthrift.

Two Gallants, his Companions.

Master RICOTT, a Merchant.

A Gentleman, Companion to DELAVIL.

A Usurer and his Man.

The Owner of the House, supposed to be possessed.

A Tavern Drawer.

Servants.

WINCOTT'S Wife, a young Gentlewoman.

PRUDENTILLA, her Sister.

BLANDA, a Whore.

SCAPHA, a Bawd.

Two Wenches, Companions to BLANDA.

BESS, Chambermaid to Mistress WINCOTT.

SCENE—LONDON and BARNET.

**THE
ENGLISH TRAVELLER.**

ACT THE FIRST.

SCENE I.—A Room in Old WINCOTT's House.

Enter Young GERALDINE and DELAVIL.

DELAVIL.

Oh, friend, that I to mine own notion
Had joined but your experience! I have
The theoric, but you the practic.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I

Perhaps have seen what you have only read of.

DELAVIL.

There's your happiness.
A scholar in his study knows the stars,
Their motion and their influence, which are fixed
And which are wandering, can decipher seas,
And give each several land his proper bounds;
But set him to the compass, he's to seek,
When a plain pilot can direct his course
From hence unto both the Indies; can bring back
His ship and charge, with profits quintuple.
I have read Jerusalem, and studied Rome,
Can tell in what degree each city stands,
Describe the distance of this place from that—
All this the scale in every map can teach;
Nay, for a need could punctually recite

The monuments in either; but what I
Have by relation only, knowledge by travel,
Which still makes up a complete gentleman,
Proves eminent in you.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I must confess
I have seen Jerusalem and Rome, have brought
Mark from the one, from the other testimony,
Known Spain, and France, and from their airs have sucked
A breath of every language: but no more
Of this discourse, since we draw near the place
Of them we go to visit.

Enter Clown.

CLOWN.

Noble Master Geraldine, worshipful Master Delavil!

DELAVIL.

I see thou still rememberest us.

CLOWN.

Remember you! I have had so many memorandums from the
multiplicities of your bounties, that not to remember you were to forgot
myself; you are both most ingeniously and nobly welcome.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

And why ingeniously and nobly?

CLOWN.

Because had I given your welcomes other attributes than I have done, the
one being a soldier, and the other seeming a scholar, I should have lied in
the first, and showed myself a kind of blockhead in the last.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I see your wit is nimble as your tongue;
But how doth all at home?

CLOWN.

Small doings at home, sir, in regard that the age of my master corresponds not with the youth of my mistress, and you know cold January and lusty May seldom meet in conjunction.

DELAVIL.

I do not think but this fellow in time may for his wit and understanding make almanacks.

CLOWN.

Not so, sir, you being more judicious than I, I'll give you the pre-eminence in that, because I see by proof you have such judgment in times and seasons.

DELAVIL.

And why in times and seasons?

CLOWN.

Because you have so seasonably made choice to come so just at dinner-time. You are welcome, gentlemen; I'll go tell my master of your coming.
[Exit.]

DELAVIL.

A pleasant knave.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

This fellow I perceive
Is well acquainted with his master's mind.
Oh 'tis a good old man.

DELAVIL.

And she a lady
For beauty and for virtue unparalleled,
Nor can you name that thing to grace a woman
She has not in a full perfection.
Though in their years might seem disparity,
And therefore at the first a match unfit,
Imagine but his age and government,

Withal her modesty and chaste respect;
Betwixt them there's so sweet a sympathy
As crowns a noble marriage.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

'Tis acknowledged;
But to the worthy gentleman himself
I am so bound in many courtesies,
That not the least, by all the expression
My labour or my industry can show,
I will know how to cancel.

DELAVIL.

Oh, you are modest.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

He studies to engross me to himself,
And is so wedded to my company,
He makes me stranger to my father's house,
Although so near a neighbour.

DELAVIL.

This approves you
To be most nobly propertied, that from one
So exquisite in judgment, can attract
So affectionate an eye.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Your character
I must bestow on his unmerited love,
As one that know I have it, and yet ignorant
Which way I should deserve it: here both come.

Enter Old WINCOTT, his Wife, and PRUDENTILLA.

WINCOTT.

Gentlemen, welcome; but what need I use
A word so common, unto such to whom

My house was never private? I expect
You should not look for such a needless phrase,
Especially you, Master Geraldine;
Your father is my neighbour, and I know you
Even from the cradle; then I loved your infancy,
And since your riper growth bettered by travel:
My wife and you in youth were play-fellows,
And must not now be strangers; as I take it,
Not above two years different in your age.

WIFE.

So much he hath outstripped me.

WINCOTT.

I would have you
Think this your home, free as your father's house,
And to command it, as the master on't;
Call boldly here, and entertain your friends,
As in your own possessions: when I see't,
I'll say you love me truly, not till then;
Oh, what a happiness your father hath,
Far above me!—one to inherit after him,
Where I (Heaven knows) am childless.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

That defect
Heaven hath supplied in this your virtuous wife,
Both fair, and full of all accomplishments;
My father is a widower, and herein
Your happiness transcends him.

WIFE.

Oh, Master Geraldine,
Flattery in men's an adjunct of their sex,
This country breeds it, and for that, so far
You needed not to have travelled.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Truth's a word
That should in every language relish well,
Nor have I that exceeded.

WIFE.

Sir, my husband
Hath took much pleasure in your strange discourse
About Jerusalem and the Holy Land:
How the new city differs from the old,
What ruins of the Temple yet remain,
And whether Sion, and those hills about,
With the adjacent towns and villages,
Keep that proportioned distance as we read;
And then in Rome, of that great pyramis
Reared in the front, on four lions mounted;
How many of those idol temples stand,
First dedicated to their heathen gods,
Which ruined, which to better use repaired;
Of their Pantheon, and their Capitol,—
What structures are demolished, what remain.

WINCOTT.

And what more pleasure to an old man's ear,
That never drew save his own country's air,
Than hear such things related? I do exceed him
In years, I must confess, yet he much older
Than I in his experience.

PRUDENTILLA.

Master Geraldine,
May I be bold to ask you but one question,
The which I'd be resolved in?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Anything
That lies within my knowledge.

WINCOTT.

Put him to't.
Do, sister, you shall find him, make no doubt,
Most pregnant in his answer.

PRUDENTILLA.

In your travels
Through France, through Savoy, and through Italy,
Spain, and the Empire, Greece and Palestine,
Which breeds the choicest beauties?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

In troth, lady,
I never cast on any in those parts
A curious eye of censure,[\[3\]](#) since my travel
Was only aimed at language, and to know;
These passed me but as common objects did—
Seen, but not much regarded.

PRUDENTILLA.

Oh, you strive
To express a most unheard-of modesty,
And seldom found in any traveller,
Especially of our country, thereby seeking
To make yourself peculiar.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I should be loth
Profess in outward show to be one man,
And prove myself another.

PRUDENTILLA.

One thing more:
Were you to marry, you that know these climes,
Their states and their conditions, out of which
Of all these countries would you choose your wife?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I'll answer you in brief: as I observe,

Each several clime, for object, fare, or use,
Affords within itself for all of these
What is most pleasing to the man there born:
Spain, that yields scant of food, affords the nation
A parsimonious stomach, where[4] our appetites
Are not content but with the large excess
Of a full table; where the pleasing'st fruits
Are found most frequent, there they best content;
Where plenty flows, it asks abundant feasts;
For so hath provident Nature dealt with all.
So in the choice of women: the Greek wantons,
Compelled beneath the Turkish slavery,
Vassal themselves to all men, and such best
Please the voluptuous that delight in change;
The French is of one humour, Spain another,
The hot Italian has a strain from both,
All pleased with their own nations—even the Moor,
He thinks the blackest the most beautiful;
And, lady, since you so far tax my choice,
I'll thus resolve you: being an Englishman,
'Mongst all these nations I have seen or tried,
To please me best, here would I choose my bride.

PRUDENTILLA.

And happy were that lady, in my thoughts,
Whom you would deign that grace to.

WIFE.

How now, sister!
This is a fashion that's but late come up.
For maids to court their husbands.

WINCOTT.

I would, wife,
It were no worse, upon condition
They had my helping hand and purse to boot,
With both in ample measure. Oh, this gentleman

I love, nay almost dote on.

WIFE.

You've my leave
To give it full expression.

WINCOTT.

In these arms, then.
Oh, had my youth been blest with such a son,
To have made my estate to my name hereditary,
I should have gone contented to my grave,
As to my bed; to death, as to my sleep;
But Heaven hath will in all things. Once more welcome;
And you, sir, for your friend's sake.

DELAVIL.

Would I had in me
That which he hath, to have claimed it for mine own;
However, I much thank you.

Enter Clown.

WINCOTT.

Now, sir, the news with you?

CLOWN.

Dancing news, sir; for the meat stands piping hot upon the dresser, the kitchen's in a heat, and the cook hath so bestirred himself that he's in a sweat. The jack[5] plays music, and the spits turn round to't.

WINCOTT.

This fellow's my best clock,
He still strikes true to dinner.

CLOWN.

And to supper too, sir: I know not how the day goes with you, but my stomach hath struck twelve, I can assure you that.

WINCOTT.

You take us unprovided, gentlemen;
Yet something you shall find, and we would rather
Give you the entertain of household guests
Than compliment of strangers. I pray enter.

[Exeunt all but Clown.]

CLOWN.

I'll stand to't, that in good hospitality there can be nothing found that's ill: he that's a good house-keeper keeps a good table, a good table is never without good stools, good stools seldom without good guests, good guests never without good cheer, good cheer cannot be without good stomachs, good stomachs without good digestion, good digestion keeps men in good health; and therefore, all good people that bear good minds, as you love goodness, be sure to keep good meat and drink in your houses, and so you shall be called good men, and nothing can come on't but good, I warrant you. *[Exit.]*

SCENE II.—A Room in Old LIONEL'S House.

Enter REIGNALD and ROBIN, two Serving-men.

REIGNALD.

Away, you Corydon!

ROBIN.

Shall I be beat out of my master's house thus?

REIGNALD.

Thy master! we are lords amongst ourselves,
And here we live and reign. Two years already
Are past of our great empire, and we now
Write *anno tertio*.

ROBIN.

But the old man lives
That shortly will depose you.

REIGNALD.

I' the meantime,
I, as the mighty lord and seneschal
Of this great house and castle, banish thee
The very smell o' the kitchen; be it death
To appear before the dresser.

ROBIN.

And why so?

REIGNALD.

Because thou stink'st of garlick. Is that breath
Agreeing with our palace, where each room
Smells with musk, civet, and rich ambergris,
Aloes, cassia, aromatic gums,
Perfumes, and powders? One whose very garments

Scent of the fowls and stables! Oh, fie, fie!
What a base nasty rogue 'tis!

ROBIN.

Yet your fellow.

REIGNALD.

Then let us put a cart-horse in rich trappings,
And bring him to the tilt-yard.

ROBIN.

Prank it, do;
Waste, riot, and consume, misspend your hours
In drunken surfeits, lose your days in sleep,
And burn the nights in revels, drink and drab,
Keep Christmas all year long, and blot lean Lent
Out of the calendar; all that mass of wealth
Got by my master's sweat and thrifty care,
Havoc in prodigal uses; make all fly,
Pour't down your oily throats, or send it smoking
Out at the tops of chimneys. At his departure,
Was it the old man's charge to have his windows
Glisten all night with stars? his modest house
Turned to a common stew? his beds to pallets
Of lusts and prostitutions? his buttery hatch[6]
Now made more common than a tavern's bar?
His stools, that welcomed none but civil guests,
Now only free for pandars, whores and bawds,
Strumpets, and such?

REIGNALD.

I suffer thee too long.
What is to me thy country; or to thee
The pleasure of our city? thou hast cows,
Cattle, and beeves to feed, oves and boves;
These that I keep, and in this pasture graze,
Are dainty damosellas, bonny girls.
If thou be'st born to hedge, ditch, thresh, and plough,

And I to revel, banquet and carouse;
Thou, peasant, to the spade and pickaxe, I
The battoon and stiletto, think it only
Thy ill, my good; our several lots are cast,
And both must be contented.

ROBIN.

But when both
Our services are questioned—

REIGNALD.

Look thou to one,
My answer is provided.

Enter Young LIONEL.

ROBIN.

Farewell, musk-cat! [*Exit.*

REIGNALD.

Adieu, good cheese and onions; stuff thy guts
With speck and barley-pudding for digestion;
Drink whig[Z] and sour milk, whilst I rinse my throat
With Bordeaux and canary.

YOUNG LIONEL.

What was he?

REIGNALD.

A spy, sir;
One of their hinds o' the country, that came prying
To see what dainty fare our kitchen yields,
What guests we harbour, and what rule we keep,
And threats to tell the old man when he comes;
I think I sent him packing.

YOUNG LIONEL.

It was well done.

REIGNALD.

A whoreson-jackanapes, a base baboon,
To insinuate in our secrets.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Let such keep
The country, where their charge is.

REIGNALD.

So I said, sir.

YOUNG LIONEL.

And visit us when we command them thence,
Not search into our counsels.

REIGNALD.

'Twere not fit.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Who in my father's absence should command,
Save I his only son?

REIGNALD.

It is but justice.

YOUNG LIONEL.

For am not I now lord?

REIGNALD.

Dominus-fac-totum.

And am not I your steward?

YOUNG LIONEL.

Well remembered.

This night I have a purpose to be merry,
Jovial and frolic. How doth our cash hold out?

REIGNALD.

The bag's still heavy.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Then my heart's still light.

REIGNALD.

I can assure you, yet 'tis pretty deep
Though scarce a mile to the bottom.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Let me have
To supper, let me see, a duck—

REIGNALD.

Sweet rogue!

YOUNG LIONEL.

A capon—

REIGNALD.

Geld the rascal!

YOUNG LIONEL.

Then a turkey—

REIGNALD.

Now spit him, for an infidel!

YOUNG LIONEL.

Green plover, snipe,
Partridge, lark, cock, and pheasant.

REIGNALD.

Ne'er a widgeon?

YOUNG LIONEL.

Yes; wait thyself at table.

REIGNALD.

Where I hope
Yourself will not be absent.

YOUNG LIONEL.
Nor my friends.

REIGNALD.
We'll have them then in plenty.

YOUNG LIONEL.
Caviare, sturgeon, anchoves, pickle-oysters; yes,
And a potato pie; besides all these,
What thou think'st rare and costly.

REIGNALD.
Sir, I know
What's to be done; the stock that must be spent
Is in my hands, and what I have to do
I will do suddenly.

YOUNG LIONEL.
No butcher's meat;
Of that beware in any case.

REIGNALD.
I still remember
Your father was no grazier; if he were,
This were a way to eat up all his fields,
Hedges and all.

YOUNG LIONEL.
You will begone, sir?

REIGNALD.
Yes, and you are i' the way going. [*Exit.*

YOUNG LIONEL.
To what may young men best compare themselves?

Better to what, than to a house new built,
The fabric strong, the chambers well contrived,
Polished within, without well beautified;
When all that gaze upon the edifice
Do not alone commend the workman's craft,
But either make it their fair precedent
By which to build another, or at least
Wish there to inhabit? Being set to sale,
In comes a slothful tenant, with a family
As lazy and debauched; rough tempests rise,
Untile the roof, which by their idleness
Left unrepaired, the stormy showers beat in,
Rot the main posts and rafters, spoil the rooms,
Deface the ceilings, and in little space
Bring it to utter ruin, yet the fault
Not in the architector that first reared it,
But him that should repair it. So it fares
With us young men; we are those houses made;
Our parents raise these structures, the foundation
Laid in our infancy; and as we grow
In years, they strive to build us by degrees,
Story on story higher; up at height,
They cover us with counsel, to defend us
From storms without; they polish us within
With learnings, knowledge, arts and disciplines;
All that is naught and vicious they sweep from us,
Like dust and cobwebs, and our rooms concealed,
Hang with the costliest hangings, 'bout the walls
Emblems and beauteous symbols pictured round:
But when that lazy tenant, Love, steps in,
And in his train brings sloth and negligence,
Lust, disobedience, and profuse excess,
The thrift with which our fathers tiled our roofs
Submits to every storm and winter's blast,
And, yielding place to every riotous sin,
Gives way without to ruin what's within:
Such is the state I stand in.

Enter BLANDA and SCAPHA; Young LIONEL retires.

BLANDA.

And how doth this tire become me?

SCAPHA.

Rather ask, how your sweet carriage and court behaviour doth best grace you, for lovers regard not so much the outward habit as that which the garment covers.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Oh, here's that hail, shower, tempest, storm, and gust
That shattered hath this building; let in lust,
Intemperance, appetite to vice; withal,
Neglect of every goodness: thus I see
How I am sinking in mine own disease,
Yet can I not abide it. [*Aside.*]

BLANDA.

And how this gown? I prithee view me well,
And speak with thy best judgment.

SCAPHA.

What do you talk of gowns and ornaments,
That have a beauty precious in itself,
And becomes anything?

YOUNG LIONEL.

Let me not live, but she speaks nought but truth,
And I'll for that reward her. [*Aside.*]

BLANDA.

All's one to me, become they me or not,
Or be I fair or foul in others' eyes,
So I appear so to my Lionel;
He is the glass in whom I judge my face,
By whom in order I will dress these curls,
And place these jewels, only to please him.

Why dost smile?

SCAPHA.

To hear a woman that thinks herself so wise speak so foolishly; that knows well, and does ill.

BLANDA.

Teach me wherein I err.

SCAPHA.

I'll tell thee, daughter: in that thou knowest thyself to be beloved of so many, and settlest thy affection only upon one. Doth the mill grind only when the wind sits in one corner, or ships only sail when it's in this or that quarter? Is he a cunning fencer that lies but at one guard, or he a skilful musician that plays but on one string? Is there but one way to the wood, and but one bucket that belongs to the well? To affect one, and despise all other, becomes the precise matron, not the prostitute; the loyal wife, not the loose wanton. Such have I been as you are now, and should learn to sail with all winds, defend all blows, make music with all strings, know all the ways to the wood, and, like a good travelling hackney, learn to drink of all waters.

YOUNG LIONEL.

May I miscarry in my Blanda's love,
If I that old damnation do not send
To hell before her time! [*Aside.*]

BLANDA.

I would not have you, mother, teach me aught
That tends to injure him.

SCAPHA.

Well, look to't when 'tis too late, and then repent at leisure, as I have done. Thou seest, here's nothing but prodigality and pride, wantoning and wasting, rioting and revelling, spoiling and spending, gluttony and gormandising—all goes to havoc. And can this hold out? When he hath nothing left to help himself, how can he harbour thee? Look at length to

drink from a dry bottle, and feed from an empty knapsack; look to't,
'twill come to that.

YOUNG LIONEL.

My parsimony shall begin in thee,
And instantly; for from this hour, I vow
That thou no more shalt drink upon my cost,
Nor taste the smallest fragment from my board;
I'll see thee starve i' the street first. [*Aside.*]

SCAPHA.

Live to one man! a jest; thou mayst as well tie thyself to one gown; and
what fool but will change with the fashion? Yes, do, confine thyself to
one garment, and use no variety, and see how soon it will rot, and turn to
rags.

YOUNG LIONEL. [*Coming forward.*]

Those rags be thy reward!—Oh, my sweet Blanda,
Only for thee I wish my father dead,
And ne'er to rouse us from our sweet delight;
But for this hag, this beldam, she whose back
Hath made her items in my mercer's books;
Whose ravenous guts I have stuffed with delicates,
Nay even to surfeit; and whose frozen blood
I have warmed with aquavitæ—be this day
My last of bounty to a wretch ingrate;
But unto thee a new indenture[8] sealed
Of an affection fixed and permanent.
I'll love thee still, be't but to give the lie
To this old cankered worm.

BLANDA.

Nay, be not angry.

YOUNG LIONEL.

With thee my soul shall ever be at peace;
But with this love-seducer, still at war.

SCAPHA.

Hear me but speak.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Ope but thy lips again, it makes a way
To have thy tongue plucked out.

Enter RIOTER and two Gallants.

RIOTER.

What, all in tempest!

YOUNG LIONEL.

Yes, and the storm raised by that witch's spells;
Oh, 'tis a damned enchantress!

RIOTER.

What's the business?

BLANDA.

Only some few words, slipped her unawares:
For my sake make her peace.

RIOTER.

You charge me deeply.
Come, friend, will you be moved at women's words,
A man of your known judgment?

YOUNG LIONEL.

Had you but heard
The damned erroneous doctrine that she taught,
You would have judged her to the stake.

BLANDA.

But, sweetheart,
She now recants those errors; once more number her
Amongst your household servants.

RIOTER.

Shall she beg,
And be denied aught from you?

BLANDA.

Come, this kiss
Shall end all former quarrels.

RIOTER.

'Tis not possible
Those lips should move in vain, that two ways plead,—
Both in their speech and silence.

YOUNG LIONEL.

You have prevailed,
But upon this condition, no way else:
I'll censure her, as she hath sentenced thee,
But with some small inversion.

RIOTER.

Speak, how's that?

BLANDA.

Not too severe, I prithee; see, poor wretch,
She at the bar stands quaking.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Now, hold up—

RIOTER.

How, man, how?

YOUNG LIONEL.

Her hand, I mean.—And now I'll sentence thee,
According to thy counsel given to her:
Sail by one wind; thou shalt to one tune sing,
Lie at one guard, and play but on one string;
Henceforth I will confine thee to one garment,

And that shall be a cast one, like thyself,
Just past all wearing, as thou past all use,
And not to be renewed, till't be as ragged
As thou art rotten.

BLANDA.

Nay, sweet—

YOUNG LIONEL.

That for her habit.

SCAPHA.

A cold suit I have on't.

YOUNG LIONEL.

To prevent surfeit,
Thy diet shall be to one dish confined,
And that too rifled, with as unclean hands
As e'er were laid on thee.

SCAPHA.

What he scants me in victuals, would he but allow me in drink!

YOUNG LIONEL.

That shall be the refuse of the flagons, jacks,
And snuffs, such as the nastiest breaths shall leave;
Of wine, and of strong-water, never hope
Henceforth to smell.

SCAPHA.

Oh me! I faint already.

YOUNG LIONEL.

If I sink in my state, of all the rest
Be thou excused; what thou proposed to her,
Beldam, is now against thyself decreed:
Drink from dry springs, from empty knapsacks feed.

SCAPHA.

No burnt wine, [\[9\]](#) nor hot-waters! [*She swoons.*

YOUNG LIONEL.

Take her hence.

BLANDA.

Indeed you are too cruel.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Yes, to her,
Only of purpose to be kind to thee;
Are any of my guests come?

RIOTER.

Fear not, sir,
You will have a full table.

YOUNG LIONEL.

What, and music?

RIOTER.

Best consort [\[10\]](#) in the city, for six parts.

YOUNG LIONEL.

We shall have songs then?

RIOTER.

By the ear. [*Whispers.*

YOUNG LIONEL.

And wenches?

RIOTER.

Yes, by the eye.

BLANDA.

Ha! what was that you said?

RIOTER.

We shall have such to bear you company
As will no doubt content you.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Ever thine:
In youth there is a fate that sways us still,
To know what's good, and yet pursue what's ill.

[Exeunt.

ACT THE SECOND.

SCENE I.—*A Room in Old WINCOTT's House.*

Enter Old WINCOTT and his Wife.

WINCOTT.

And what's this Delavil?

WIFE.

My apprehension
Can give him no more true expression,
Than that he first appears a gentleman,
And well conditioned.

WINCOTT.

That for outward show;
But what in him have you observèd else,
To make him better known?

WIFE.

I have not eyes
To search into the inward thoughts of men,
Nor ever was I studied in that art
To judge of men's affection by the face;
But that which makes me best opinioned of him
Is that he's the companion and the friend
Beloved of him whom you so much commend—
The noble Master Geraldine.

WINCOTT.

Thou hast spoke
That which not only crowns his true desert,
But now instates him in my better thoughts,
Making his worth unquestioned.

WIFE.

He pretends
Love to my sister Pru. I have observed him
Single her out to private conference.

WINCOTT.

But I could rather, for her own sake, wish
Young Geraldine would fix his thoughts that way,
And she towards him; in such affinity,
Trust me, I would not use a sparing hand.

WIFE.

But Love in these kinds should not be compelled,
Forced, nor persuaded; when it freely springs,
And of itself takes voluntary root,
It grows, it spreads, it ripens, and brings forth
Such an usurious crop of timely fruit
As crowns a plenteous autumn.

WINCOTT.

Such a harvest
I should not be the ungladdest man to see, [*Enter Clown.*
Of all thy sister's friends.—Now, whence come you?

CLOWN.

Who, I, sir? from a lodging of largess, a house of hospitality, and a palace of plenty; where there's feeding like horses and drinking like fishes; where for pints, we're served in pottles; and instead of pottle-pots, in pails; instead of silver tankards, we drink out of water-tankards; claret runs as freely as the cocks, and canary like the conduits of a coronation day; where there's nothing but feeding and frolicking, carving in kissing, drinking and dancing, music and madding, fiddling and feasting.

WINCOTT.

And where, I pray thee, are all these revels kept?

CLOWN.

They may be rather called reaks[11] than revels; as I came along by the door I was called up amongst them—he-gallants and she-gallants. I no sooner looked out, but saw them out with their knives, slashing of shoulders, mangling of legs, and lanching[12] of loins, till there was scarce a whole limb left amongst them.

WINCOTT.

A fearful massacre!

CLOWN.

One was hacking to cut off a neck; this was mangling a breast; his knife slipped from the shoulder, and only cut off a wing; one was picking the brains out of a head, another was knuckle-deep in a belly; one was groping for a liver, another searching for the kidneys. I saw one pluck the soul[13] from the body—goose that she was to suffer't!; another pricked into the breast with his own bill—woodcock to endure it!

WIFE.

How fell they out at first?

CLOWN.

I know not that, but it seems one had a stomach, and another had a stomach; but there was such biting and tearing with their teeths, that I am sure I saw some of their poor carcasses pay for't.

WINCOTT.

Did they not send for surgeons?

CLOWN.

Alas, no! surgeons' help was too late; there was no stitching up of those wounds, where limb was plucked from limb; nor any salve for those scars, which all the plaster of Paris cannot cure.

WINCOTT.

Where grew the quarrel first?

CLOWN.

It seems it was first broached in the kitchen, certain creatures being brought in thither by some of the house. The cook, being a choleric fellow, did so towse them and toss them, so pluck them and pull them, till he left them as naked as my nail; pinioned some of them like felons; cut the spurs from others off their heels; then down went his spits, some of them he ran in at the throat, and out at the backside: about went his basting-ladle, where he did so besauce them that many a shrewd[14] turn they had amongst them.

WIFE.

But, in all this, how did the women scape?

CLOWN.

They fared best, and did the least hurt that I saw, but for quietness-sake were forced to swallow what is not yet digested; yet every one had their share, and she that had least, I am sure, by this time hath her bellyful.

WINCOTT.

And where was all this havoc kept?

CLOWN.

Marry, sir, at your next neighbour's, Young Master Lionel, where there is nothing but drinking out of dry-vats, and healing in half-tubs; his guests are fed by the belly, and beggars served at his gate in baskets. He's the adamant of this age, the daffodil of these days, the prince of prodigality, and the very Cæsar of all young citizens.

WINCOTT.

Belike, then, 'twas a massacre of meat,
Not as I apprehended?

CLOWN.

Your gravity hath guessed aright: the chiefest that fell in this battle were wild fowl and tame fowl; pheasants were wounded instead of alfarez,[15] and capons for captains; anchoves stood for ancients, and caviare for corporals; dishes were assaulted instead of ditches, and rabbits were cut to pieces upon the rebellings;[16] some lost their legs, whilst other of

their wings were forced to fly; the pioner undermined nothing but pie crust, and—

WINCOTT.

Enough, enough! your wit hath played too long
Upon our patience.—Wife, it grieves me much
Both for the young and old man: the one graces
His head with care, endures the parching heat
And biting cold, the terrors of the lands,
And fears at sea, in travel, only to gain
Some competent estate to leave his son;
Whiles all that merchandise, through gulfs, cross-tides,
Pirates, and storms, he brings so far, the other
Here shipwrecks in the harbour.

WIFE.

'Tis the care
Of fathers; and the weakness incident
To youth, that wants experience.

Enter Young GERALDINE, DELAVIL, and PRUDENTILLA, laughing.

CLOWN.

I was at the beginning of the battle; but here comes some, that it seems
were at the rifling of the dead carcasses; for by their mirth they have had
part of the spoil.

WINCOTT.

You are pleasant, gentlemen; what, I entreat,
Might be the subject of your pleasant sport?
It promiseth some pleasure.

PRUDENTILLA.

If their recreation
Be, as I make no question, on truth grounded,
'Twill beget sudden laughter.

WIFE.

What's the project?

DELAVIL.

Who shall relate it?

WINCOTT.

Master Geraldine,
If there be anything can please my ear
With pleasant sounds, your tongue must be the instrument
On which the string must strike.

DELAVIL.

Be it his, then.

PRUDENTILLA.

Nay, hear it, 'tis a good one.

WIFE.

We entreat you,
Possess [\[17\]](#) us o' the novel. [\[18\]](#)

WINCOTT.

Speak, good sir.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I shall, then, with a kind of barbarism,
Shadow a jest that asks a smoother tongue,
For in my poor discourse, I do protest,
It will but lose its lustre.

WIFE.

You are modest.

WINCOTT.

However, speak, I pray; for my sake do't.

CLOWN.

This is like a hasty pudding, longer in eating than it was in making.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Then thus it was: this gentleman and I
Passed but just now by your next neighbour's house,
Where, as they say, dwells one young Lionel.

CLOWN.

Where I was to-night at supper.

WINCOTT.

An unthrift youth, his father now at sea.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Why, that's the very subject upon which
It seems this jest is grounded; there this night
Was a great feast.

CLOWN.

Why, so I told you, sir.

WINCOTT.

Be thou still dumb; 'tis he that I would hear.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

In the height of their carousing, all their brains
Warmed with the heat of wine, discourse was offered
Of ships, and storms at sea; [\[19\]](#) when suddenly,
Out of his giddy wildness, one conceives
The room wherein they quaffed to be a pinnacle,
Moving and floating; and the confused noise
To be the murmuring winds, gusts, mariners;
That their unsteadfast footing did proceed
From rocking of the vessel: this conceived,
Each one begins to apprehend the danger,
And to look out for safety. "Fly," saith one,
"Up to the main-top, and discover;" he
Climbs by the bed-post to the tester, there
Reports a turbulent sea and tempest towards,
And wills them, if they'll save their ship and lives,

To cast their lading overboard; at this
All fall to work, and hoist into the street,
As to the sea, what next come to their hand—
Stools, tables, trestles, trenchers, bedsteads, cups,
Pots, plate, and glasses; here a fellow whistles,
They take him for the boatswain; one lies struggling
Upon the floor, as if he swum for life;
A third takes the bass-viol for the cockboat,
Sits in the belly on't, labours and rows,
His oar the stick with which the fiddler played;
A fourth bestrides his fellows, thinking to scape
As did Arion on the dolphin's back,
Still fumbling on a gittern.

CLOWN.

Excellent sport!

WINCOTT.

But what was the conclusion?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

The rude multitude,
Watching without, and gaping for the spoil
Cast from the windows, went by the ears about it;
The constable is called to atone[20] the broil,
Which done, and hearing such a noise within
Of imminent shipwreck, enters the house, and finds them
In this confusion. They adore his staff,
And think it Neptune's trident, and that he
Comes with his Tritons (so they called his watch)
To calm the tempest, and appease the waves;
And at this point we left them.

CLOWN.

Come what will, I'll steal out of doors, and see the end of it, that's
certain. [*Exit.*]

WINCOTT.

Thanks, Master Geraldine, for this discourse;
In troth it hath much pleased me; but the night
Begins to grow fast on us: for your parts
You are all young, and you may sit up late;
My eyes begin to summon me to sleep,
And nothing's more offensive unto age
Than to watch long and late. [*Exit.*]

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Now good rest with you!

DELAVIL.

What says fair Prudentilla? Maids and widows,
And we young bachelors, such as indeed
Are forced to lie in solitary beds,
And sleep without disturbance—we, methinks,
Should desire later hours than married wives,
That in their amorous arms hug their delights!
To often wakings subject, their more haste
May better be excused.

PRUDENTILLA.

How can you,
That are, as you confess, a single man,
Enter so far into these mystical secrets
Of marriage, which as yet you never proved?

DELAVIL.

There's, lady, an instinct innate in man,
Which prompts us to the apprehensions
Of the uses we were born to; such we are
Aptest to learn, ambitious most to know,
Of which our chief is marriage.

PRUDENTILLA.

What you men
Most meditate, we women seldom dream of.

DELAVAL.

When dream maids most?

PRUDENTILLA.

When, think you?

DELAVAL.

When you lie upon your backs.
Come, come; your ear.

[Exeunt DELAVAL and PRUDENTILLA.]

YOUNG GERALDINE.

We now are left alone.

WIFE.

Why, say we be, who should be jealous of us?
This is not first of many hundred nights
That we two have been private: from the first
Of our acquaintance, when our tongues but clipped
Our mother's-tongue, and could not speak it plain,
We knew each other; as in stature, so
Increased our sweet society; since your travel,
And my late marriage, through my husband's love,
Midnight hath been as mid-day, and my bed-chamber
As free to you as your own father's house,
And you as welcome to't.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I must confess
It is in you your noble courtesy,
In him a more than common confidence,
And in this age can scarce find precedent.

WIFE.

Most true; it is withal an argument
That both our virtues are so deep impressed
In his good thoughts, he knows we cannot err.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

A villain were he to deceive such trust,
Or, were there one, a much worse character.

WIFE.

And she no less, whom either beauty, youth,
Time, place, or opportunity could tempt
To injure such a husband.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

You deserve,
Even for his sake, to be for ever young;
And he, for yours, to have his youth renewed,
So mutual is your true conjugal love;
Yet, had the Fates so pleased—

WIFE.

I know your meaning.
It was once voiced that we two should have matched;
The world so thought, and many tongues so spake;
But Heaven hath now disposed us otherways;
And being as it is, (a thing in me
Which, I protest, was never wished nor sought),
Now done, I not repent it.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

In those times,
Of all the treasures of my hopes and love,
You were the exchequer, they were stored in you;
And, had not my unfortunate travel crossed them,
They had been here reserved still.

WIFE.

Troth, they had;
I should have been your trusty treasurer.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

However, let us love still, I entreat:

That, neighbourhood and breeding will allow;
So much the laws divine and human both
'Twixt brother and a sister will approve;
Heaven then forbid that they should limit us
Wish well to one another!

WIFE.

If they should not,
We might proclaim they were not charitable,
Which were a deadly sin but to conceive.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Will you resolve me one thing?

WIFE.

As to one
That in my bosom hath a second place,
Next my dear husband.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

That's the thing I crave,
And only that—to have a place next him.

WIFE.

Presume on that already; but perhaps
You mean to stretch it further.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Only thus far:
Your husband's old, to whom my soul doth wish
A Nestor's age, so much he merits from me;
Yet if (as proof and Nature daily teach
Men cannot always live, especially
Such as are old and crazed) he be called hence,
Fairly, in full maturity of time,
And we two be reserved to after-life,
Will you confer your widowhood on me?

WIFE.

You ask the thing I was about to beg;
Your tongue hath spake mine own thoughts.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Vow to that.

WIFE.

As I hope mercy.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

'Tis enough; that word
Alone instates me happy. Now, so please you,
We will divide, you to your private chamber,

I to find out my friend.

WIFE.

Nay, Master Geraldine,
One ceremony rests yet unperformed:
My vow is past, your oath must next proceed;
And as you covet to be sure of me,
Of you I would be certain.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Make ye doubt?

WIFE.

No doubt; but Love's still jealous, and in that
To be excused; you then shall swear by Heaven,
And as in all your future acts you hope
To thrive and prosper; as the day may yield
Comfort, or the night rest; as you would keep
Entire the honour of your father's house,
And free your name from scandal and reproach;
By all the goodness that you hope to enjoy,
Or ill to shun—

YOUNG GERALDINE.

You charge me deeply, lady.

WIFE.

Till that day come, you shall reserve yourself
A single man; converse nor company
With any woman, contract nor combine
With maid or widow; which expected hour,
As I do wish not haste, so when it happens
It shall not come unwelcome. You hear all;
Vow this.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

By all that you have said, I swear,
And by this kiss confirm.

WIFE.

You're now my brother;
But then, my second husband.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—*Before Old LIONEL's House.*

Enter, from the House, Young LIONEL, RIOTER, BLANDA, SCAPHA, two Gallants, and two Wenchs, as newly waked from sleep.

YOUNG LIONEL.

We had a stormy night on't.

BLANDA.

The wine still works,
And, with the little rest they have took to-night,
They are scarce come to themselves.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Now 'tis a calm,
Thanks to those gentle sea-gods, that have brought us
To this safe harbour: can you tell their names?

SCAPHA.

He with the painted staff I heard you call Neptune.

YOUNG LIONEL.

The dreadful god of seas,
Upon whose back ne'er stuck March fleas.

1ST GALLANT.

One with the bill^[21] keeps Neptune's porpoises,
So Ovid says in's Metamorphoses.

2ND GALLANT.

A third the learned poets write on,
And, as they say, his name is Triton.

YOUNG LIONEL.

These are the marine gods, to whom my father
In his long voyage prays to; cannot they,
That brought us to our haven, bury him

In their abyss? For if he safe arrive,
I, with these sailors, sirens, and what not,
Am sure here to be shipwrecked.

1ST WENCH.

[*To RIOTER*]. Stand up stiff.

RIOTER.

But that the ship so totters—I shall fall.

1ST WENCH.

If thou fall, I'll fall with thee.

RIOTER.

Now I sink,
And, as I dive and drown, thus by degrees
I'll pluck thee to the bottom.

[*They fall.*]

Enter REIGNALD.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Amain for England! See, see,
The Spaniard now strikes sail.

REIGNALD.

So must you all.

1ST GALLANT.

Whence is your ship—from the Bermoothes?[\[22\]](#)

REIGNALD.

Worse, I think from Hell:
We are all lost, split, shipwrecked, and undone.
This place is a mere quicksands.

2ND GALLANT.

So we feared.

REIGNALD.

Where's my young master?

YOUNG LIONEL.

Here, man; speak, the news?

REIGNALD.

The news is, I, and you—

YOUNG LIONEL.

What?

REIGNALD.

She, and all these—

BLANDA.

I!

REIGNALD.

We, and all ours, are in one turbulent sea
Of fear, despair, disaster, and mischance
Swallowed. Your father, sir—

YOUNG LIONEL.

Why, what of him?

REIGNALD.

He is—
Oh I want breath.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Where?

REIGNALD.

Landed, and at hand.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Upon what coast? Who saw him?

REIGNALD.

I—these eyes.

YOUNG LIONEL.

O Heaven! what shall I do then?

REIGNALD.

Ask ye me
What shall become of you, that have not yet
Had time of study to dispose myself?
I say again, I was upon the quay,
I saw him land, and this way bend his course.
What drunkard's this, that can outsleep a storm
Which threatens all our ruins? Wake him.

BLANDA.

Ho, Rioter, awake!

RIOTER.

Yes, I am 'wake;
How dry hath this salt-water made me! Boy,
Give me the other glass.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Arise, I say:
My father's come from sea.

RIOTER.

If he be come,
Bid him be gone again.

REIGNALD.

Can you trifle
At such a time, when your inventions, brains,
Wits, plots, devices, stratagems, and all
Should be at one in action? Each of you
That love your safeties, lend your helping hands,
Women and all, to take this drunkard hence,

And to bestow him elsewhere.

BLANDA.

Lift, for Heaven's sake.

[They carry RIOTER in.]

REIGNALD.

But what am I the nearer, were all these
Conveyed to sundry places and unseen?
The stain of our disorders still remains,
Of which the house will witness, and the old man
Must find it when he enters; and for these

[Re-enter Young LIONEL and others.]

I am here left to answer.—What, is he gone?

YOUNG LIONEL.

But whither? But into the selfsame house
That harbours him; my father's, where we all
Attend from him surprisal.

REIGNALD.

I will make
That prison of your fears your sanctuary;
Go, get you in together.

YOUNG LIONEL.

To this house?

REIGNALD.

Your father's, with your sweetheart, these and all;
Nay, no more words, but do it.

BLANDA.

That were to
Betray us to his fury.

REIGNALD.

I have't here
To bail you hence at pleasure; and in the interim
I'll make this supposed gaol, to you as safe
From the injured old man's just-incensèd spleen,
As were you now together i' the Low-Countries,
Virginia, or i' the Indies.

BLANDA.

Present fear
Bids us to yield unto the faint belief
Of the least hopèd safety.

REIGNALD.

Will you in?

ALL.

By thee we will be counselled.

REIGNALD.

Shut them fast.

YOUNG LIONEL.

And thou and I to leave them?

REIGNALD.

No such thing;
For you shall bear your sweetheart company,
And help to cheer the rest.

YOUNG LIONEL.

And so thou meanest to escape alone?

REIGNALD.

Rather without,
I'll stand a champion for you all within.
Will you be swayed? One thing in any case
I must advise: the gates bolted and locked,
See that 'mongst you no living voice be heard;

No, not so much as but a dog to howl,
Or cat to mew—all silence, that I charge;
As if this were a mere forsaken house,
And none did there inhabit.

YOUNG LIONEL.
Nothing else?

REIGNALD.
And, though the old man thunder at the gates
As if he meant to ruin what he had reared,
None on their lives to answer.

YOUNG LIONEL.
'Tis my charge:
Remains there nothing else?

REIGNALD.
Only the key;
For I must play the gaoler for your durance,[\[23\]](#)
To be the Mercury in your release.

YOUNG LIONEL.
Me, and my hope, I in this key deliver
To thy safe trust.

REIGNALD.
When you are fast you are safe,
And with this turn 'tis done.
[Exeunt all except REIGNALD who locks the door.]
What fools are these,
To trust their ruined fortunes to his hands
That hath betrayed his own, and make themselves
Prisoner to one deserves to lie for all,
As being cause of all! And yet something prompts me—
I'll stand it at all dangers; and, to recompense
The many wrongs unto the young man done,
Now, if I can doubly delude the old—

My brain, about it, then. All's hushed within;
The noise that shall be, I must make without,
And he that, part for gain and part for wit,
So far hath travelled, strive to fool at home:
Which to effect, art must with knavery join,
And smooth dissembling meet with impudence.
I'll do my best, and howsoe'er it prove,
My praise or shame, 'tis but a servant's love. [*Retires.*]

Enter Old LIONEL, with Watermen, and two Servants with burdens and caskets.

OLD LIONEL.

Discharge these honest sailors that have brought
Our chests ashore, and pray them have a care
Those merchandise be safe we left aboard.
As Heaven hath blessed us with a fortunate voyage,
In which we bring home riches with our healths,
So let not us prove niggards in our store;
See them paid well, and to their full content.

1ST SERVANT.

I shall, sir.

OLD LIONEL.

Then return: these special things,
And of most value, we'll not trust aboard;
Methinks they are not safe till they see home,
And there repose, where we will rest ourselves,
And bid farewell to travel; for I vow
After this hour no more to trust the seas,
Nor throw me to such danger.

REIGNALD.

I could wish
You had took your leave o' the land too. [*Aside.*]

OLD LIONEL.

And now it much rejoiceth me to think
What a most sudden welcome I shall bring
Both to my friends and private family.

REIGNALD.

Oh, but how much more welcome had he been
That had brought certain tidings of thy death! [*Aside.*

OLD LIONEL.

But soft, what's this? my own gates shut upon me,
And bar their master entrance! Who's within there?
How, no man speak! are all asleep or dead,
That no soul stirs to open? [*Knocks loudly.*

REIGNALD.

What madman's that who, weary of his life,
Dares once lay hand on these accursèd gates?

OLD LIONEL.

Who's that? my servant Reignald!

REIGNALD.

My old master!
Most glad I am to see you; are you well, sir?

OLD LIONEL.

Thou seest I am.

REIGNALD.

But are you sure you are?
Feel you no change about you? Pray you stand off.

OLD LIONEL.

What strange and unexpected greeting's this,
That thus a man may knock at his own gates,
Beat with his hands and feet, and call thus loud,
And no man give him entrance?

REIGNALD.

Said you, sir—
Did your hand touch that hammer?

OLD LIONEL.

Why, whose else?

REIGNALD.

But are you sure you touched it?

OLD LIONEL.

How else, I prithee,
Could I have made this noise?

REIGNALD.

You touched it then?

OLD LIONEL.

I tell thee yet I did.

REIGNALD.

Oh, for the love I bear you—
O me most miserable! you, for your own sake,
Of all alive most wretched!—did you touch it?

OLD LIONEL.

Why, say I did?

REIGNALD.

You have then a sin committed,
No sacrifice can expiate, to the dead;
But yet I hope you did not.

OLD LIONEL.

'Tis past hope;
The deed is done, and I repent it not.

REIGNALD.

You and all yours will do't. In this one rashness,
You have undone us all: pray be not desperate,
But first thank Heaven that you have escaped thus well.
Come from the gate—yet further, further yet—
And tempt your fate no more; command your servants
Give off and come no nearer; they are ignorant,
And do not know the danger, therefore pity
That they should perish in't. 'Tis full seven months
Since any of your house durst once set foot
Over that threshold.

OLD LIONEL.

Prithee speak the cause?

REIGNALD.

First look about; beware that no man hear;
Command these to remove.

OLD LIONEL.

Begone.—[*Exeunt Servants and Watermen*].—Now speak.

REIGNALD.

Oh, sir, this house is grown prodigious,[\[24\]](#)
Fatal, disastrous unto you and yours.

OLD LIONEL.

What fatal? what disastrous?

REIGNALD.

Some host, that hath been owner of this house,
In it his guest hath slain; and we suspect
'Twas he of whom you bought it.

OLD LIONEL.

How came this
Discovered to you first?

REIGNALD.

I'll tell you, sir;
But further from the gate. Your son one night
Supped late abroad, I within—oh, that night
I never shall forget! Being safe got home,
I saw him in his chamber laid to rest;
And after went to mine, and, being drowsy,
Forgot by chance to put the candle out:
Being dead asleep, your son, affrighted, calls
So loud that I soon wakened, brought in light,
And found him almost drowned in fearful sweat;
Amazed to see't, I did demand the cause,
Who told me that this murdered ghost appeared,
His body gashed, and all o'er-stuck with wounds,
And spake to him as follows.

OLD LIONEL.

Oh, proceed;
'Tis that I long to hear.

REIGNALD.

"I am," quoth he,
"A transmarine by birth, who came well stored
With gold and jewels to this fatal house,
Where, seeking safety, I encountered death:
The covetous merchant, landlord of this rent,
To whom I gave my life and wealth in charge,
Freely to enjoy the one, robbed me of both:
Here was my body buried, here my ghost
Must ever walk, till that have Christian right;
Till when, my habitation must be here.
Then fly, young man; remove thy family,
And seek some safer dwelling; for my death
This mansion is accursed; 'tis my possession,
Bought at the dear rate of my life and blood:
None enter here, that aims at his own good."
And with this charge he vanished.

OLD LIONEL.

O my fear!

Whither wilt thou transport me?

REIGNALD.

I entreat

Keep further from the gate, and fly.

OLD LIONEL.

Fly whither?

Why dost not thou fly too?

REIGNALD.

What need I fear?

The ghost and I am friends.

OLD LIONEL.

But Reignald——

REIGNALD. [*Turning round.*]

Tush!

I nothing have deserved, nor aught transgressed:

I came not near the gate.

OLD LIONEL.

To whom was that thou spakest?

REIGNALD.

Was't you, sir, named me?

Now as I live, I thought the dead man called,

To inquire for him that thundered at the gate

Which he so dearly paid for. Are you mad,

To stand a foreseen danger?

OLD LIONEL.

What shall I do?

REIGNALD.

Cover your head and fly, lest, looking back,
You spy your own confusion.

OLD LIONEL.

Why dost thou not fly too?

REIGNALD.

I tell you, sir,
The ghost and I am friends.

OLD LIONEL.

Why didst thou quake then?

REIGNALD.

In fear lest some mischance may fall on you,
That have the dead offended; for my part,
The ghost and I am friends. Why fly you not,
Since here you are not safe?

OLD LIONEL.

Some blest powers guard me!

REIGNALD.

Nay, sir,
I'll not forsake you.—[*Exit* OLD LIONEL.]—I have got the start;
But ere the goal, 'twill ask both brain and art. [*Exit.*

ACT THE THIRD.

SCENE I.—*The Dining Hall in Old GERALDINE'S House.*

*Enter Old GERALDINE, Young GERALDINE, WINCOTT and his Wife,
DELAVIL, and PRUDENTILLA.*

WINCOTT.

We are bound to you, kind Master Geraldine,
For this great entertainment; troth, your cost
Hath much exceeded common neighbourhood;
You have feasted us like princes.

OLD GERALDINE.

This, and more
Many degrees, can never countervail [\[25\]](#)
The oft and frequent welcomes given my son:
You have took him from me quite, and have, I think,
Adopted him into your family,
He stays with me so seldom.

WINCOTT.

And in this,
By trusting him to me, of whom yourself
May have both use and pleasure, you're as kind
As moneyed men, that might make benefit
Of what they are possessed, yet to their friends
In need will lend it gratis.

WIFE.

And, like such
As are indebted more than they can pay,
We more and more confess ourselves engaged
To you for your forbearance.

PRUDENTILLA.

Yet you see,
Like debtors, such as would not break their day,[\[26\]](#)
The treasure late received we tender back,
The which, the longer you can spare, you still
The more shall bind us to you.

OLD GERALDINE.

Most kind ladies,
Worthy you are to borrow, that return
The principal with such large use[\[27\]](#) of thanks.

DELAVIL.

[*Aside.*] What strange felicity these rich men take
To talk of borrowing, lending, and of use!
The usurer's language right.

WINCOTT.

You've, Master Geraldine,
Fair walks and gardens; I have praised them
Both to my wife and sister.

OLD GERALDINE.

You would see them?
There is no pleasure that the house can yield
That can be debarred from you.—Prithee, son,
Be thou the usher to those mounts and prospects
May one day call thee master.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Sir, I shall.—
Please you to walk?

PRUDENTILLA.

What, Master Delavil,
Will you not bear us company?

DELAVIL.

'Tis not fit
That we should leave our noble host alone.
Be you my friend's charge, and this old man mine.

PRUDENTILLA.

Well, be't then at your pleasure.

[Exeunt all but DELAVIL and Old GERALDINE.]

DELAVIL.

You to your prospects, but there's project here
That's of another nature.—Worthy sir,
I cannot but approve your happiness
To be the father of so brave a son,
So every way accomplished and made up,
In which my voice is least; for I, alas!
Bear but a mean part in the common choir,
When with much louder accents of his praise
So all the world reports him.

OLD GERALDINE.

Thank my stars,
They have lent me one who, as he always was
And is my present joy, if their aspect
Be no ways to our goods malevolent,
May be my future comfort.

DELAVIL.

Yet must I hold him happy above others,
As one that solely to himself enjoys
What many others aim at, but in vain.

OLD GERALDINE.

How mean you that?

DELAVIL.

So beautiful a mistress.

OLD GERALDINE.

A mistress, said you?

DELAVIL.

Yes, sir, or a friend,
Whether you please to style her.

OLD GERALDINE.

Mistress! friend!
Pray be more open-languaged.

DELAVIL.

And indeed
Who can blame him to absent himself from home,
And make his father's house but as a grange[28]
For a beauty so attractive? or blame her,
Hugging so weak an old man in her arms,
To make a new choice of an equal youth,
Being in him so perfect? Yet, in troth,
I think they both are honest.

OLD GERALDINE.

You have, sir,
Possessed me with such strange fancies—

DELAVIL.

For my part,
How can I love the person of your son,
And not his reputation? His repair
So often to the house is voiced by all,
And frequent in the mouths of the whole country:
Some, equally addicted, praise his happiness,[29]
But others, more censorious and austere,
Blame and reprove a course so dissolute;
Each one in general pity the good man,
As one unfriendly dealt with, yet in my conscience
I think them truly honest.

OLD GERALDINE.

'Tis suspicious.

DELAVIL.

True, sir, at best; but what when scandalous tongues
Will make the worst, and what's good in itself,
Sully and stain by fabulous misreport?
For let men live as chary as they can,
Their lives are often questioned; then no wonder
If such as give occasion of suspicion
Be subject to this scandal. What I speak
Is as a noble friend unto your son;
And therefore, as I glory in his fame,
I suffer in his wrong; for, as I live,
I think they both are honest.

OLD GERALDINE.

Howsoever,
I wish them so.

DELAVIL.

Some course might be devised
To stop this clamour ere it grow too rank,
Lest that which yet but inconvenience seems
May turn to greater mischief: this I speak
In zeal to both,—in sovereign care of him
As of a friend, and tender of her honour
As one to whom I hope to be allied
By marriage with her sister.

OLD GERALDINE.

I much thank you,
For you have clearly given me light of that
Till now I never dreamt on.

DELAVIL.

'Tis my love,
And therefore I entreat you make not me

To be the first reporter.

OLD GERALDINE.

You have done
The office of a noble gentleman,
And shall not be so injured.

*Re-enter WINCOTT and his Wife, Young GERALDINE, and PRUDENTILLA;
the ladies wearing flowers.*

WINCOTT.

See, Master Geraldine,
How bold we are; especially these ladies
Play little better than the thieves with you,
For they have robbed your garden.

WIFE.

You might, sir,
Better have termed it sauciness than theft;
You see we blush not what we took in private
To wear in public view.

PRUDENTILLA.

Besides, these cannot
Be missed out of so many; in full fields
The gleanings are allowed.

OLD GERALDINE.

These and the rest
Are, ladies, at your service.

WINCOTT.

Now to horse:
But one thing, ere we part, I must entreat,
In which my wife will be joint suitor with me,
My sister too.

OLD GERALDINE.

In what, I pray?

WINCOTT.

That he
Which brought us hither may but bring us home;
Your much-respected son.

OLD GERALDINE.

How men are born
To woo their own disasters! [*Aside.*

WIFE.

But to see us
From whence he brought us, sir, that's all.

OLD GERALDINE.

This second motion[\[30\]](#) makes it palpable.
To note a woman's cunning! Make her husband
Bawd to her own lascivious appetite,
And to solicit his own shame! [*Aside.*

PRUDENTILLA.

Nay, sir;
When all of us join in so small a suit,
It were some injury to be denied.

OLD GERALDINE.

And work her sister too! What will not woman
To accomplish her own ends? But this disease
I'll seek to physic ere it grow too far.— [*Aside.*
I am most sorry to be urged, sweet friends,
In what at this time I can no ways grant;
Most, that these ladies should be aught denied,
To whom I owe all service; but occasions
Of weighty and important consequence,
Such as concern the best of my estate,
Call him aside. Excuse us both this once;
Presume this business is no sooner over,

But he's at his own freedom.

WINCOTT.

'Twere no manners
In us to urge it further.—We will leave you,
With promise, sir, that he shall in my will
Not be the last remembered.

OLD GERALDINE.

We are bound to you.—
See them to horse, and instantly return;
We have employments for you.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Sir, I shall.

DELAVIL.

Remember your last promise.

[*Exeunt DELAVIL, WINCOTT and his Wife, PRUDENTILLA, and Young GERALDINE.*]

OLD GERALDINE.

Not to do't
I should forget myself.—If I find him false
To such a friend, be sure he forfeits me;
In which to be more punctually resolved,
I have a project how to sift his soul,
How 'tis inclined,—whether to yonder place,
[*Re-enter Young GERALDINE.*]
The clear bright palace, or black dungeon. See,
They are onward on the way, and he returned.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I now attend your pleasure.

OLD GERALDINE.

You are grown perfect man, and now you float,

Like to a well-built vessel, 'tween two currents,
Virtue and vice: take this, you steer to harbour;
Take that, to imminent shipwreck.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Pray, your meaning?

OLD GERALDINE.

What fathers' cares are, you shall never know,
Till you yourself have children. Now my study
Is how to make you such, that you in them
May have a feeling of my love to you.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Pray, sir, expound yourself; for I protest,
Of all the languages I yet have learned,
This is to me most foreign.

OLD GERALDINE.

Then I shall;
I have lived to see you in your prime of youth
And height of fortune, so you will but take
Occasion by the forehead; to be brief,
And cut off all superfluous circumstance,
All the ambition that I aim at now
Is but to see you married.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Married, sir!

OLD GERALDINE.

And, to that purpose, I have found out one
Whose youth and beauty may not only please
A curious eye, but her immediate means
Able to strengthen a state competent,
Or raise a ruined fortune.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Of all which
I have, believe me, neither need nor use;
My competence best pleasing as it is,
And this my singularity[31] of life
Most to my mind contenting.

OLD GERALDINE.

I suspect,
But yet must prove him further.— [*Aside.*
Say to my care I add a father's charge,
And couple with my counsel my command—
To that how can you answer?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

That I hope
My duty and obedience, still unblamed,
Did never merit such austerity,
And from a father never yet displeased.

OLD GERALDINE.

Nay, then, to come more near unto the point:
Either you must resolve for present marriage,
Or forfeit all your interest in my love.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Unsay that language, I entreat you, sir,
And do not so oppress me; or, if needs
Your heavy imposition stand in force,
Resolve me by your counsel. With more safety
May I infringe a sacred vow to Heaven,
Or to oppose me to your strict command?—
Since one of these I must.

OLD GERALDINE.

Now, Delavil,
I find thy words too true. [*Aside.*

YOUNG GERALDINE.

For marry, sir,
I neither may nor can.

OLD GERALDINE.

Yet whore you may,
And that's no breach of any vow to Heaven;
Pollute the nuptial bed with mechal[32] sin;
Asperse the honour of a noble friend;
Forfeit thy reputation here below,
And the interest that thy soul might claim above
In yon blest city! These you may, and can,
With untouched conscience. Oh that I should live
To see the hopes that I have stored so long
Thus in a moment ruined, and the staff
On which my old decrepit age should lean
Before my face thus broken; on which trusting,
I thus abortively, before my time,
Fall headlong to my grave. [*Falls on the ground.*]

YOUNG GERALDINE.

It yet stands strong,
Both to support you unto future life
And fairer comfort.

OLD GERALDINE.

Never, never, son;
For till thou canst acquit thyself of scandal,
And me of my suspicion, here, even here,
Where I have measured out my length of earth,
I shall expire my last.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Both these I can:
Then rise, sir, I entreat you; and that innocency,
Which poisoned by the breath of calumny
Cast you thus low, shall, these few stains wiped off,
With better thoughts erect you.

OLD GERALDINE.

Well, say on. [*Rises.*]

YOUNG GERALDINE.

There's but one fire from which this smoke may grow,
Namely, the unmatched yoke of youth and age,
In which, if ever I occasion was
Of the smallest breach, the greatest implacable mischief
Adultery can threaten fall on me!
Of you may I be disavowed a son,
And unto Heaven a servant! For that lady,
As she is beauty's mirror, so I hold her
For chastity's example: from her tongue
Never came language that arrived my ear
That even censorious Cato, lived he now,
Could misinterpret; never from her lips
Came unchaste kiss, or from her constant eye
Look savouring of the least immodesty:
Further—

OLD GERALDINE.

Enough! One only thing remains,
Which, on thy part performed, assures firm credit
To these thy protestations.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Name it then.

OLD GERALDINE.

Take hence the occasion of this common fame,
Which hath already spread itself so far
To her dishonour and thy prejudice:
From this day forward to forbear the house;
This do upon my blessing.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

As I hope it,
I will not fail your charge.

OLD GERALDINE.

I am satisfied.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—*Before Old LIONEL's House.*

Enter at one side Usurer and his Man; at the other, Old LIONEL and his Servant; behind, REIGNALD.

REIGNALD.

[*Aside.*] To which hand shall I turn me? Here's my master
Hath been to inquire of him that sold the house,
Touching the murder; here's an usuring rascal,
Of whom we have borrowed money to supply
Our prodigal expenses, broke our day,
And owe him still the principal and use.
Were I to meet them single, I have brain
To oppose both, and to come off unscarred;
But if they do assault me, and at once,
Not Hercules himself could stand that odds:
Therefore I must encounter them by turns,
And to my master first.—Oh, sir, well met.

OLD LIONEL.

What, Reignald! I but now met with the man
Of whom I bought yon house.

REIGNALD.

What, did you, sir?
But did you speak of aught concerning that
Which I last told you?

OLD LIONEL.

Yes, I told him all.

REIGNALD.

Then am I cast! [*Aside.*]—But I pray tell me, sir,
Did he confess the murder?

OLD LIONEL.

No such thing;
Most stiffly he denies it.

REIGNALD.

Impudent wretch!
Then serve him with a warrant; let the officer
Bring him before a justice, you shall hear
What I can say against him! 'Sfoot! deny't!
But I pray, sir, excuse me; yonder's one
With whom I have some business; stay you here,
And but determine what's best course to take,
And note how I will follow't.

OLD LIONEL.

Be brief, then.

REIGNALD.

Now, if I can as well put off my use-man,
This day I shall be master of the field. [*Aside.*]

USURER.

That should be Lionel's man.

MAN.

The same, I know him.

USURER.

After so many frivolous delays,
There's now some hope. He that was wont to shun us,
And to absent himself, accosts us freely,
And with a pleasant countenance.—Well met, Reignald,
What, is this money ready?

REIGNALD.

Never could you
Have come in better time.

USURER.

Where is your master,
Young Lionel? it something troubles me
That he should break his day.

REIGNALD.

A word in private.

USURER.

Tush, private me no privates; [\[33\]](#) in a word,
Speak, are my moneys ready?

REIGNALD.

Not so loud.

USURER.

I will be louder yet. Give me my moneys;
Come, tender me my moneys.

REIGNALD.

We know you have a throat wide as your conscience;
You need not use it now. Come, get you home.

USURER.

Home!

REIGNALD.

Yes, home, I say; return by three o'clock,
And I will see all cancelled.

USURER.

'Tis now past two, and I can stay till three;
I'll make that now my business; otherways,
With these loud clamours I will haunt thee still:
Give me my use, give me my principal.

REIGNALD.

This burr will still cleave to me; what, no means
To shake him off! I ne'er was caught till now.—*[Aside.*

Come, come, you're troublesome.

USURER.

Prevent that trouble,
And, without trifling, pay me down my cash;
I will be fooled no longer.

REIGNALD.

So, so, so.

USURER.

I have been still put off, from time to time,
And day to day; these are but cheating tricks,
And this is the last minute I'll forbear
Thee, or thy master: once again, I say,
Give me my use, give me my principal.

REIGNALD.

Pox o' this use, that hath undone so many,
And now will confound me! [*Aside.*]

OLD LIONEL.

Hast thou heard this?

SERVANT.

Yes, sir, and to my grief.

OLD LIONEL.

Come hither, Reignald.

REIGNALD.

Here, sir. [*Aside.*] Nay, now I am gone.

OLD LIONEL.

What use is this,
What principal he talks of, in which language
He names my son, and thus upbraideth thee?
What is't you owe this man?

REIGNALD.

A trifle, sir:
Pray stop his mouth, and pay't him.

OLD LIONEL.

I pay!—what?

REIGNALD.

If I say pay't him, pay't him.

OLD LIONEL.

What's the sum?

REIGNALD.

A toy, the main about five hundred pounds;
And the use fifty.

OLD LIONEL.

Call you that a toy?
To what use was it borrowed? At my departure
I left my son sufficient in his charge,
With surplus, to defray a large expense,
Without this need of borrowing.

REIGNALD.

'Tis confessed;
Yet stop his clamorous mouth, and only say
That you will pay't to-morrow.

OLD LIONEL.

I pass my word!

REIGNALD.

Sir, if I bid you, do't; nay, no more words,
But say you'll pay't to-morrow.

OLD LIONEL.

Jest indeed!

But tell me how these moneys were bestowed?

REIGNALD.

Safe, sir, I warrant you.

OLD LIONEL.

The sum still safe?

Why do you not then tender it yourselves?

REIGNALD.

Your ear, sir. With this sum, joined to the rest,
Your son hath purchased land and houses.

OLD LIONEL.

Land, dost thou say?

REIGNALD.

A goodly house, and gardens.

OLD LIONEL.

Now joy on him,
That whilst his father merchandised abroad,
Had care to add to his estate at home!
But, Reignald, wherefore houses?

REIGNALD.

Now, Lord, sir,
How dull you are! This house possessed with spirits,
And there no longer stay, would you have had
Him, us, and all your other family,
To live and lie i' the streets? It had not, sir,
Been for your reputation.

OLD LIONEL.

Blessing on him,
That he is grown so thrifty!

USURER.

'Tis struck three;
My money's not yet tendered.

REIGNALD.

Pox upon him!
See him discharged, I pray, sir.

OLD LIONEL.

Call upon me
To-morrow, friend, as early as thou wilt;
I'll see thy debt defrayed.

USURER.

It is enough, I have a true man's word.

[Exeunt Usurer and Man.]

OLD LIONEL.

Now tell me, Reignald,
For thou hast made me proud of my son's thrift,
Where, in what country, doth this fair house stand?

REIGNALD.

[Aside.] Never in all my time so much to seek;
I know not what to answer.

OLD LIONEL.

Wherefore studieth thou?
Use men to purchase lands at a dear rate,
And know not where they lie?

REIGNALD.

'Tis not for that;
I only had forgot his name that sold them.
'Twas, let me see—see—

OLD LIONEL.

Call thyself to mind.

REIGNALD.

Non-plussed or never now; where are thou, brain?—
O sir, where was my memory? 'Tis this house
That next adjoins to yours.

OLD LIONEL.

My neighbour Ricott's?

REIGNALD.

The same, the same, sir; we had pennyworths in't;
And I can tell you, have been offered well
Since, to forsake our bargain.

OLD LIONEL.

As I live,
I much commend your choice.

REIGNALD.

Nay, 'tis well seated,
Rough-cast without, but bravely lined within;
You have met with few such bargains.

OLD LIONEL.

Prithee knock,
And call the master or the servant on't,
To let me take free view on't.

REIGNALD.

[*Aside.*] Puzzle again on puzzle!—One word, sir:
The house is full of women; no man knows
How on the instant they may be employed;
The rooms may lie unhandsome, and maids stand
Much on their cleanliness and huswifery;
To take them unprovided were disgrace;
'Twere fit they had some warning. Now, do you
Fetch but a warrant from the justice, sir;—
You understand me?

OLD LIONEL.

Yes, I do.

REIGNALD.

To attach [\[34\]](#)

Him of suspected murder; I'll see't served,
Did he deny't; and in the interim, I
Will give them notice you are now arrived,
And long to see your purchase.

OLD LIONEL.

Counselled well;
And meet some half-hour hence.

REIGNALD.

This plunge well passed,
All things fall even, to crown my brain at last.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE III.—*Barnet. A Street.*

Enter DELAVIL and a Gentleman.

GENTLEMAN.

Where shall we dine to-day?

DELAVIL.

At the ordinary.

I see, sir, you are but a stranger here.

This Barnet is a place of great resort,

And commonly, upon the market days,

Here all the country gentlemen appoint

A friendly meeting; some about affairs

Of consequence and profit—bargain, sale,

And to confer with chapmen; some for pleasure,

To match their horses, wager on their dogs,

Or try their hawks; some to no other end

But only meet good company, discourse,

Dine, drink, and spend their money.

GENTLEMAN.

That's the market

We have to make this day.

DELAVIL.

'Tis a commodity

That will be easily vented.—What, my worthy friend!

[*Enter Old GERALDINE and Young GERALDINE.*]

You are happily encountered. Oh, you're grown strange

To one that much respects you. Troth, the house

Hath all this time seemed naked without you;

The good old man doth never sit to meat,

But next his giving thanks he speaks of you;

There's scarce a bit that he at table tastes,

That can digest without a Geraldine,

You are in his mouth so frequent. He and she
Both wondering what distaste from one, or either,
So suddenly should alienate a guest
To them so dearly welcome.

OLD GERALDINE.

Master Delavil,
Thus much let me for him apologise:
Divers designs have thronged upon us late
My weakness was not able to support
Without his help; he hath been much abroad,
At London, or elsewhere; besides, 'tis term,
And lawyers must be followed; seldom at home,
And scarcely then at leisure.

DELAVAL.

I am satisfied,
And I would they were so too; but I hope, sir,
In this restraint you have not used my name.

OLD GERALDINE.

Not as I live.

DELAVAL.

You're noble.—Who had thought
To have met with such good company? You are, it seems,
But new alighted. Father and son, ere part,
I vow we'll drink a cup of sack together;
Physicians say it doth prepare the appetite
And stomach against dinner.

OLD GERALDINE.

We old men
Are apt to take these courtesies.

DELAVAL.

What say you, friend?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I'll but inquire for one at the next inn,
And instantly return.

DELAVIL.

It is enough.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE IV.—*Inside a Tavern.*

Enter BESS and Young GERALDINE, meeting.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Bess! How dost thou, girl?

BESS.

Faith, we may do how we list for you, you are grown
So great a stranger: we are more beholding
To Master Delavil; he's a constant guest:
And howsoe'er to some, that shall be nameless,
His presence may be graceful, yet to others—
I could say somewhat.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

He's a noble fellow,
And my choice friend.

BESS.

Come, come, he is what he is;
And that the end will prove.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

And how's all at home?
Nay, we'll not part without a glass of wine,
And meet so seldom.—Boy!

Enter Drawer.

DRAWER.

Anon, anon, sir.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

A pint of claret, quickly. [*Exit Drawer.*] Nay, sit down:
The news, the news, I pray thee; I am sure,
I have been much inquired of thy old master,

And thy young mistress too.

BESS.

Ever your name
Is in my master's mouth, and sometimes too
In hers, when she hath nothing else to think of.
Well, well, I could say somewhat.

Re-enter Drawer.

DRAWER.

Here's your wine, sir.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Fill, boy. Here, Bess, this glass to both their healths. [*Exit Drawer.*]
Why dost thou weep, my wench?

BESS.

Nay, nothing, sir.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Come, I must know.

BESS.

In troth, I love you, sir,
And ever wished you well; you are a gentleman
Whom always I respected; know the passages
And private whisperings of the secret love
Betwixt you and my mistress—I dare swear,
On your part well intended, but—

YOUNG GERALDINE.

But what?

BESS.

You bear the name of landlord, but another
Enjoys the rent; you dote upon the shadow,
But another he bears away the substance.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Be more plain.

BESS.

You hope to enjoy a virtuous widowhood;
But Delavil, whom you esteem your friend,
He keeps the wife in common.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

You're to blame,
And, Bess, you make me angry: he's my friend,
And she my second self; in all their meetings
I never saw so much as cast of eye
Once entertained betwixt them.

BESS.

That's their cunning.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

For her, I have been with her at all hours,
Both late and early; in her bed-chamber,
And often singly ushered her abroad:
Now, would she have been any man's alive,
She had been mine. You wrong a worthy friend
And a chaste mistress; you're not a good girl.
Drink that, speak better of her; I could chide you,
But I'll forbear. What you have rashly spoke,
Shall ever here be buried.

BESS.

I am sorry
My freeness should offend you, but yet know
I am her chamber-maid.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Play now the market-maid,
And prithee 'bout thy business.

BESS.

Well, I shall.—

That man should be so foolèd! [*Exit.*]

YOUNG GERALDINE.

She a prostitute!

Nay, and to him, my troth-plight, and my friend

As possible it is that Heaven and earth

Should be in love together, meet and kiss,

And so cut off all distance. What strange frenzy

Came in this wench's brain, so to surmise?

Were she so base, his nobleness is such

He would not entertain it for my sake;

Or he so bent, his hot and lust-burnt appetite

Would be so quenched at the mere contemplation

Of her most pious and religious life.

The girl was much to blame; perhaps her mistress

Hath stirred her anger by some word or blow,

Which she would thus revenge—not apprehending

At what a high price honour's to be rated;

Or else some one that envies her rare virtue

Might hire her thus to brand it; or, who knows

But the young wench may fix a thought on me,

And to divert me from her mistress' love,

May raise this false aspersion? Howsoever,

My thoughts on these two columns fixèd are,

She's good as fresh, and purely chaste as fair.

Enter Clown with a letter.

CLOWN.

Oh, sir, you are the needle, and if the whole county of Middlesex had been turned to a mere bottle^[35] of hay, I had been enjoined to have found you out, or never more returned back to my old master: there's a letter, sir.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I know the hand that superscribed it well;

Stay but till I peruse it, and from me
Thou shalt return an answer. [*Reads letter.*]

CLOWN.

I shall, sir. This is market-day, and here acquaintance commonly meet; and whom have I encountered? my gossip Pint-pot, and brim-full; nay, I mean to drink with you before I part. And how doth all your worshipful kindred? your sister Quart, your pater Pottle (who was ever a gentleman's fellow), and your old grandsire Gallon; they cannot choose but be all in health, since so many healths have been drunk out of them: I could wish them all here, and in no worse state than I see you are in at this present. Howsoever, gossip, since I have met you hand to hand, I'll make bold to drink to you—nay, either you must pledge me, or get one to do't for you, Do you open your mouth towards me? well, I know what you would say: "Here, Roger, to your master and mistress, and all our good friends at home. Gramercy, gossip, if I should not pledge thee, I were worthy to be turned out to grass, and stand no more at livery." And now, in requital of this courtesy, I'll begin one health to you and all your society in the cellar—to Peter Pipe, Harry Hogshead, Bartholomew Butt, and little Master Randal Rundlet, to Timothy Taster, and all your other great and small friends.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

He writes me here
That at my discontinuance he's much grieved;
Desiring me, as I have ever tendered
Or him or his, to give him satisfaction
Touching my discontent; and that in person,
By any private meeting.

CLOWN.

Ay, sir, 'tis very true; the letter speaks no more than he wished me to tell you by word of mouth.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Thou art then of his counsel?

CLOWN.

His Privy, [\[36\]](#) an't please you.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Though ne'er so strict hath been my father's charge,
A little I'll dispense with't, for his love.
Commend me to thy master, tell him from me,
On Monday night (then will my leisure serve)
I will by Heaven's assistance visit him.

CLOWN.

On Monday, sir? that's, as I remember, just the day before Tuesday.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

But 'twill be midnight first, at which late hour
Please him to let the garden door stand ope;
At that I'll enter, but conditionally
That neither wife, friend, servant, no third soul
Save him, and thee to whom he trusts this message,
Know of my coming in, or passing out;
When, tell him, I will fully satisfy him
Concerning my forced absence.

CLOWN.

I am something oblivious; your message would be the trulier delivered if
it were set down in black and white.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I'll call for pen and ink,
And instantly despatch it.

[Exeunt.]

ACT THE FOURTH.

SCENE I.—*Outside RICOTT's House.*

Enter REIGNALD.

REIGNALD.

Now, impudence, but steel my face this once,
Although I ne'er blush after! Here's the house.
Ho! who's within? What, no man to defend
These innocent gates from knocking?

Enter Master RICOTT.

RICOTT.

Who's without there?

REIGNALD.

One, sir, that ever wished your worship's health;
And those few hours I can find time to pray in,
I still remember it.

RICOTT.

Gramercy, Reignald,
I love all those that wish it: you are the men
Lead merry lives, feast, revel, and carouse;
You feel no tedious hours; Time plays with you—
This is your golden age.

REIGNALD.

It was; but now, sir,
That gold is turned to worse than alchemy;
It will not stand the test. Those days are past,
And now our nights come on.

RICOTT.

Tell me, Reignald, is he returned from sea?

REIGNALD.

Yes, to our grief already, but we fear
Hereafter it may prove to all our costs.

RICOTT.

Suspects thy master anything?

REIGNALD.

Not yet, sir.
Now my request is, that your worship being
So near a neighbour, therefore most disturbed,
Would not be first to peach us.

RICOTT.

Take my word;
With other neighbours make what peace you can,
I'll not be your accuser.

REIGNALD.

Worshipful sir;
I shall be still your beadsman. Now the business
That I was sent about: the old man my master
Claiming some interest in acquaintance past,
Desires (might it be no way troublesome)
To take free view of all your house within.

RICOTT.

View of my house! Why, 'tis not set to sale,
Nor bill upon the door. Look well upon't;
View of my house!

REIGNALD.

Nay, be not angry, sir;
He no way doth disable [\[37\]](#) your estate;
As far to buy, as you are loath to sell.

Some alterations in his own he'd make,
And hearing yours by workmen much commended,
He would make that his precedent.

RICOTT.

What fancies
Should at this age possess him, knowing the cost,
That he should dream of building!

REIGNALD.

'Tis supposed,
He hath late found a wife out for his son;
Now, sir, to have him near him, and that nearness
Too without trouble, though beneath one roof,
Yet parted in two families, he would build,
And make what's picked[38] a perfect quadrangle,
Proportioned just with yours, were you so pleased
To make it his example.

RICOTT.

Willingly.
I will but order some few things within,
And then attend his coming. [*Exit.*

REIGNALD.

Most kind coxcomb!
Great Alexander and Agathocles,
Cæsar, and others, have been famed, they say,
And magnified for high facinorous deeds;
Why claim not I an equal place with them—
Or rather a precedent? These commanded
Their subjects, and their servants; I my master,
And every way his equals, where I please,
Lead by the nose along: they placed their burdens
On horses, mules, and camels; I, old men
Of strength and wit, load with my knavery,
Till both their backs and brains ache; yet, poor animals,
[*Enter* Old LIONEL.]

They ne'er complain of weight.—Oh, are you come, sir?

OLD LIONEL.

I made what haste I could.

REIGNALD.

And brought the warrant?

OLD LIONEL.

See here, I have't.

REIGNALD.

'Tis well done; but speak, runs it
Both without bail and mainprize[\[39\]](#)?

OLD LIONEL.

Nay, it carries
Both form and power.

REIGNALD.

Then I shall warrant him.
I have been yonder, sir.

OLD LIONEL.

And what says he?

REIGNALD.

Like one that offers you
Free ingress, view, and regress, at your pleasure,
As to his worthy landlord.

OLD LIONEL.

Was that all?

REIGNALD.

He spake to me, that I would speak to you,
To speak unto your son; and then again,
To speak to him, that he would speak to you,

You would release his bargain.

OLD LIONEL.

By no means:
Men must advise before they part with land,
Not after to repent it: 'tis most just
That such as hazard and disburse their stocks,
Should take all gains and profits that accrue,
As well in sale of houses as in barter,
And traffic of all other merchandise.

Re-enter RICOTT; he walks before the gate.

REIGNALD.

See, in acknowledgment of a tenant's duty,
He attends you at the gate; salute him, sir.

OLD LIONEL.

My worthy friend!

RICOTT.

Now, as I live, all my best thoughts and wishes
Impart with yours, in your so safe return;
Your servant tells me you have great desire
To take surview of this my house within.

OLD LIONEL.

Be't, sir, no trouble to you.

RICOTT.

None; enter boldly,
With as much freedom as it were your own.

OLD LIONEL.

As it were mine! Why, Reignald, is it not?

REIGNALD.

Lord, sir, that in extremity of grief

You'll add unto vexation! See you not
How sad he's on the sudden?

OLD LIONEL.

I observe it.

REIGNALD.

To part with that which he hath kept so long,
Especially his inheritance: now, as you love
Goodness and honesty, torment him not
With the least word of purchase.

OLD LIONEL.

Counselled well;
Thou teachest me humanity.

RICOTT.

Will you enter?
Or shall I call a servant, to conduct you
Through every room and chamber?

OLD LIONEL.

By no means;
I fear we are too much troublesome of ourselves.

REIGNALD.

See what a goodly gate!

OLD LIONEL.

It likes me well.

REIGNALD.

What brave carved posts! who knows but here,
In time, sir, you may keep your shrievalty;[\[40\]](#)
And I be one o' the serjeants!

OLD LIONEL.

They are well carved.

RICOTT.

And cost me a good price, sir: take your pleasure;
I have business in the town. [*Exit.*]

REIGNALD.

Poor man, I pity him;
H'ath not the heart to stay and see you come,
As 'twere, to take possession. Look that way, sir,
What goodly fair bay windows.

OLD LIONEL.

Wondrous stately.

REIGNALD.

And what a gallery, how costly ceiled;
What painting round about.

OLD LIONEL.

Every fresh object
To good adds betterness.

REIGNALD.

Terraced above,
And how below supported. Do they please you?

OLD LIONEL.

All things beyond opinion. Trust me, Reignald,
I'll not forego the bargain, for more gain
Than half the price it cost me.

REIGNALD.

If you would,
I should not suffer you; was not the money
Due to the usurer, took upon good ground,
That proved well built upon? We were no fools
That knew not what we did.

OLD LIONEL.

It shall be satisfied.

REIGNALD.

Please you to trust me with't, I'll see't discharged.

OLD LIONEL.

He hath my promise, and I'll do't myself.
Never could son have better pleased a father
Than in this purchase! Hie thee instantly
Unto my house i' the country, give him notice
Of my arrive, and bid him with all speed
Post hither.

REIGNALD.

Ere I see the warrant served?

OLD LIONEL.

It shall be thy first business; for my soul
Is not at peace, till face to face I approve
His husbandry, and much commend his thrift;
Nay, without pause, begone.

REIGNALD.

But a short journey;
For he's not far that I am sent to seek:
I have got the start; the best part of the race
Is run already; what remains is small,
And, tire now, I should but forfeit all.

OLD LIONEL.

Make haste, I do entreat thee.

[*Exeunt.*

SCENE II.—*The Garden of Old Wincott's House.*

Enter the Clown.

CLOWN.

This is the garden gate; and here am I set to stand sentinel, and to attend the coming of young master Geraldine. Master Delavil's gone to his chamber, my mistress to hers. 'Tis now about midnight; a banquet prepared, bottles of wine in readiness, all the whole household at their rest, and no creature by this honestly stirring, saving I and my old master; he in a bye-chamber, prepared of purpose for their private meeting, and I here to play the watchman against my will! [*Enter Young Geraldine.*] Chavelah?[\[41\]](#) Stand! Who goes there?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

A friend.

CLOWN.

The word?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Honest Roger.

CLOWN.

That's the word indeed; you have leave to pass freely without calling my corporal.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

How go the affairs within?

CLOWN.

According to promise: the business is composed, and the servants disposed; my young mistress reposed; my old master, according as you proposed, attends you, if you be exposed, to give him meeting; nothing in the way being interposed, to transpose you to the least danger: and this I dare be deposed, if you will not take my word, as I am honest Roger.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Thy word shall be my warrant, but secured
Most in thy master's promise, on which building,
By this known way I enter.

CLOWN.

Nay, by your leave, I that was late but a plain sentinel will now be your
captain conductor: follow me.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE III.—A Room in Old WINCOTT's House.

Table and stools set out, lights, a banquet, [42](#) wine. Enter Old WINCOTT.

WINCOTT.

I wonder whence this strangeness should proceed,
Or wherein I, or any of my house,
Should be the occasion of the least distaste:
Now, as I wish him well, it troubles me;
But now the time grows on from his own mouth
To be resolved, and I hope satisfied.

[Enter Clown and Young GERALDINE.]

Sir, as I live, of all my friends, to me
Most wishedly you are welcome: take that chair,
I this: nay, I entreat, no compliment.—
Attend; fill wine.

CLOWN.

Till the mouths of the bottles yawn directly upon the floor, and the
bottoms turn their tails up to the ceiling; whilst there's any blood in their
bellies I'll not leave them.

WINCOTT.

I first salute you thus.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

It could not come
From one whom I more honour; sir, I thank you.

CLOWN.

Nay, since my master begun it, I'll see't go round to all three.

WINCOTT.

Now give us leave.

CLOWN.

Talk you by yourselves, whilst I find something to say to this:[\[43\]](#) I have a tale to tell him shall make his stony heart relent. [*Exit.*]

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Now, first, sir, your attention I entreat:
Next, your belief that what I speak is just,
Maugre all contradiction.

WINCOTT.

Both are granted.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Then I proceed; with due acknowledgment
Of all your more than many courtesies:
You've been my second father, and your wife
My noble and chaste mistress; all your servants
At my command; and this your bounteous table
As free and common as my father's house:
Neither 'gainst any, or the least of these,
Can I commence just quarrel.

WINCOTT.

What might then be
The cause of this constraint, in thus absenting
Yourself from such as love you?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Out of many,
I will propose some few: the care I have
Of your as yet unblemished renown,
The untouched honour of your virtuous wife,
And (which I value least, yet dearly too)
My own fair reputation.

WINCOTT.

How can these
In any way be questioned?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Oh, dear sir,
Bad tongues have been too busy with us all;
Of which I never yet had time to think,
But with sad thoughts and griefs unspeakable.
It hath been whispered by some wicked ones,
But loudly thundered in my father's ears,
By some that have maligned our happiness,
(Heaven, if it can brook slander, pardon them!)
That this my customary coming hither
Hath been to base and sordid purposes:
To wrong your bed, injure her chastity,
And be mine own undoer, which, how false!

WINCOTT.

As Heaven is true, I know't.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Now, this calumny
Arriving first unto my father's ears,
His easy nature was induced to think
That these things might perhaps be possible:
I answered him as I would do to Heaven,
And cleared myself in his suspicious thoughts
As truly as the high all-knowing Judge
Shall of these stains acquit me, which are merely
Aspersions and untruths. The good old man,
Possessed with my sincerity, and yet careful
Of your renown, her honour, and my fame,
To stop the worst that scandal could inflict,
And to prevent false rumours, charges me,
The cause removed, to take away the effect;
Which only could be to forbear your house—
And this upon his blessing. You hear all.

WINCOTT.

And I of all acquit you: this your absence,

With which my love most cavilled, orators[\[44\]](#)
In your behalf. Had such things passed betwixt you,
Not threats nor chidings could have driven you hence.
It pleads in your behalf, and speaks in hers,
And arms me with a double confidence,
Both of your friendship and her loyalty:
I am happy in you both, and only doubtful
Which of you two doth most impart my love.
You shall not hence to-night.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Pray, pardon, sir.

WINCOTT.

You are in your lodging.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

But my father's charge?

WINCOTT.

My conjuration shall dispense with that.

You may be up as early as you please,

But hence to-night you shall not.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

You are powerful.

WINCOTT.

This night, of purpose, I have parted beds,

Feigning myself not well, to give you meeting;

Nor can be aught suspected by my wife,

I have kept all so private: now 'tis late,

I'll steal up to my rest. But, howsoever,

Let's not be strange in our writing; that way daily

We may confer without the least suspect,

In spite of all such base calumnious tongues.

So now good-night, sweet friend. [*Exit.*]

YOUNG GERALDINE.

May He that made you
So just and good still guard you!—Not to bed;
So I perhaps might oversleep myself,
And then my tardy waking might betray me
To the more early household; thus as I am,
I'll rest me on this pallet.—But in vain:
I find no sleep can fasten on mine eyes,
There are in this disturbèd brain of mine
So many mutinous fancies. This to me
Will be a tedious night; how shall I spend it?
No book that I can spy? no company?
A little let me recollect myself.
Oh, what more wishèd company can I find,
Suiting the apt occasion, time, and place,
Than the sweet contemplation of her beauty;
And the fruition too, time may produce,
Of what is yet lent out? 'Tis a sweet lady,
And every way accomplished: hath mere accident
Brought me thus near, and I not visit her?
Should it arrive her ear, perhaps might breed
Our lasting separation; for, 'twixt lovers,
No quarrels to unkindness.[45] Sweet opportunity
Offers prevention, and invites me to't:
The house is known to me, the stairs and rooms;
The way into her chamber frequently
Trodden by me at midnight, and all hours:
How joyful to her would a meeting be,
So strange and unexpected—shadowed too
Beneath the veil of night! I am resolved
To give her visitation in that place
Where we have passed deep vows—her bed-chamber:
My fiery love this darkness makes seem bright,
And this the path that leads to my delight,
[Goes in at one door, and comes out at another.][46]
And this the gate unto't.—I'll listen first,
Before too rudely I disturb her rest

And gentle breathing. Ha! she's sure awake,
For in the bed two whisper, and their voices
Appear to me unequal;—one a woman's—
And hers! The other should be no maid's tongue,
It bears too big a tone. And hark, they laugh—
Damnation! But list further; t'other sounds
Like—'tis the same false perjured Delavil, traitor
To friend and goodness. Unchaste, impious woman,
False to all faith and true conjugal love;
There's met a serpent and a crocodile,
A Sinon and a Circe. Oh, to what
May I compare you?—Out, my sword!
I'll act a noble execution
On two unmatched for sordid villainy—
I left it in my chamber, and thank Heaven
That I did so! it hath prevented me
From playing a base hangman. Sin securely,
Whilst I, although for many yet less faults,
Strive hourly to repent me! I once loved her,
And was to him entire. Although I pardon,
Heaven will find time to punish: I'll not stretch
My just revenge so far as once by blabbing
To make your brazen impudence to blush—
Damn on—revenge too great; and, to suppress
Your souls yet lower, without hope to rise,
Heap Ossa upon Pelion. You have made me
To hate my very country, because here bred
Near two such monsters. First I'll leave this house,
And then my father's; next I'll take my leave,
Both of this clime and nation, travel till
Age snow upon this head. My passions now
Are unexpressible; I'll end them thus:
Ill man, bad woman, your unheard-of treachery
This unjust censure on a just man give,—
To seek out place where no two such can live. [*Exit.*

SCENE IV.—*Another Room in the House.*

Enter DELAVIL in a nightgown, and Wife in night attire.

DELAVIL.

A happy morning now betide you, lady,
To equal the content of a sweet night.

WIFE.

It hath been to my wish, and your desire;
And this your coming by pretended love
Unto my sister Prue cuts off suspicion
Of any such converse 'twixt you and me.

DELAVIL.

It hath been wisely carried.

WIFE.

One thing troubles me.

DELAVIL.

What's that, my dearest?

WIFE.

Why your friend Geraldine
Should on the sudden thus absent himself:
Has he had, think you, no intelligence
Of these our private meetings?

DELAVIL.

No, on my soul,
For therein hath my brain exceeded yours:
I, studying to engross you to myself,
Of his continued absence have been cause;
Yet he of your affection no way jealous,
Or of my friendship. How the plot was cast,

You at our better leisure shall partake:
The air grows cold, have care unto your health;
Suspicious eyes are o'er us, that yet sleep,
But with the dawn will open. Sweet, retire you
To your warm sheets; I now to fill my own,
That have this night been empty.

WIFE.

You advise well:
Oh, might this kiss dwell ever on thy lips
In my remembrance!

DELAVIL.

Doubt it not, I pray,
Whilst day frights night, and night pursues the day.
Good-morrow.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE V.—A Room in Old LIONEL's House.

*Enter REIGNALD with a key in his hand, Young LIONEL, BLANDA,
SCAPHA, RIOTER, and two Gallants.*

REIGNALD.

Now is the gaol delivery; through this back gate
Shift for yourselves; I here unprison all.

YOUNG LIONEL.

But tell me, how shall we dispose ourselves?
We are as far to seek now as at the first;
What is it to reprieve us for few hours,
And now to suffer? better had it been
At first to have stood the trial, so by this
We might have passed our penance.

BLANDA.

Sweet Reignald!

YOUNG LIONEL.

Honest rogue!

RIOTER.

If now thou fail'st us, then we are lost for ever.

REIGNALD.

This same sweet Reignald, and this honest rogue,
Hath been the burgess under whose protection
You all this while have lived, free from arrests:
But now the sessions of my power's broke up,
And you exposed to actions, warrants, writs;
For all the hellish rabble are broke loose,
Of serjeants, sheriffs, and bailiffs.

ALL.

Guard us, Heaven!

REIGNALD.

I tell you as it is; nay, I myself
That have been your protector, now as subject
To every varlet's pestle, for you know
How I am engaged with you——At whose suit, sir?

ALL.

Why didst thou start? [*They all start.*]

REIGNALD.

I was afraid some catchpole stood behind me,
To clap me on the shoulder.

RIOTER.

No such thing;
Yet I protest thy fear did fright us all.

REIGNALD.

I knew your guilty consciences.

YOUNG LIONEL.

No brain left?

BLANDA.

No crotchet for my sake?

REIGNALD.

One kiss then, sweet;
Thus shall my crotchets and your kisses meet.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Nay, tell us what to trust to.

REIGNALD.

Lodge yourselves
In the next tavern; there's the cash that's left

Go, health it freely for my good success;
Nay, drown it all, let not a tester^[47] scape
To be consumed in rot-gut:^[48] I have begun,
And I will stand the period.

YOUNG LIONEL.
Bravely spoke.

REIGNALD.
Or perish in the conflict.

RIOTER.
Worthy Reignald—

REIGNALD.
Will, if he now come off well, fox you all;^[49]
Go, call for wine; for singly of myself
I will oppose all danger; but I charge you,
When I shall faint or find myself distressed,
If I, like brave Orlando,^[50] wind my horn,
Make haste unto my rescue.

YOUNG LIONEL.
And die in't.

REIGNALD.
Well hast thou spoke, my noble Charlemain
With these thy peers about thee.

YOUNG LIONEL.
May good speed
Attend thee still!

REIGNALD.
The end still crowns the deed.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE VI.—*Outside Old LIONEL's House.*

Enter Old LIONEL, and the former Owner of the House.

OWNER.

Sir, sir, your threats nor warrants can fright me;
My honesty and innocency's known
Always to have been unblemished; would you could
As well approve your own integrity
As I shall doubtless acquit myself
Of this surmisèd murder.

OLD LIONEL.

Rather surrender
The price I paid, and take into thy hands
This haunted mansion, or I'll prosecute
My wrong, even to the utmost of the law,
Which is no less than death.

OWNER.

I'll answer all,
Old Lionel, both to thy shame and scorn;
This [*Snapping his fingers*] for thy menaces!

Enter Clown.

CLOWN.

This is the house, but where's the noise that was wont to be in't? I am sent hither to deliver a note to two young gentlemen that here keep revel-rout; I remember it, since the last massacre of meat that was made in't; but it seems that the great storm that was raised then is chased now. I have other notes to deliver, one to Master Ricott—and—I shall think on them all in order. My old master makes a great feast for the parting of young Master Geraldine, who is presently upon his departure for travel, and, the better to grace it, hath invited many of his neighbours and friends, where will be old Master Geraldine, his son, and I cannot tell

how many. But this is strange; the gates shut up at this time o' day! belike they are all drunk and laid to sleep; if they be, I'll wake them, with a murrain! [*Knocks.*]

OLD LIONEL.

What desperate fellow's this, that, ignorant
Of his own danger, thunders at these gates?

CLOWN.

Ho, Reignald! riotous Reignald, revelling Reignald!

OLD LIONEL.

What madness doth possess thee, honest friend,
To touch that hammer's handle?

CLOWN.

What madness doth possess thee, honest friend,
To ask me such a question?

OLD LIONEL.

[*To Owner.*] Nay, stir not you.

OWNER.

Not I. The game begins.

OLD LIONEL.

How dost thou? art thou well?

CLOWN.

Yes, very well, I thank you; how do you, sir?

OLD LIONEL.

No alteration: what change about thee?

CLOWN.

Not so much change about me at this time as to change you a shilling into two testers.

OLD LIONEL.

Yet I advise thee, fellow, for thy good,
Stand further from the gate.

CLOWN.

And I advise thee, friend, for thine own good, stand not betwixt me and the gate, but give me leave to deliver my errand. Ho! Reignald, you mad rascal!

OLD LIONEL.

In vain thou thunder'st at these silent doors,
Where no man dwells to answer, saving ghosts,
Furies, and sprites.

CLOWN.

Ghosts! indeed there has been much walking in and about the house after midnight.

OLD LIONEL.

Strange noise oft heard?

CLOWN.

Yes, terrible noise, that none of the neighbours could take any rest for it. I have heard it myself.

OLD LIONEL.

You hear this? Here's more witness.

OWNER.

Very well, sir.

OLD LIONEL.

Which you shall dearly answer.—Whooping?

CLOWN.

And hollooming.

OLD LIONEL.

And shouting?

CLOWN.

And crying out, till the whole house rung again.

OLD LIONEL.

Which thou hast heard?

CLOWN.

Oftener than I have toes and fingers.

OLD LIONEL.

Thou wilt be deposed of this?

CLOWN.

I'll be sworn to't, and that's as good.

OLD LIONEL.

Very good still;—yet you are innocent.

Shall I entreat thee, friend, to avouch as much

Hereby to the next justice?

CLOWN.

I'll take my soldier's oath on't.

OLD LIONEL.

A soldier's oath—what's that?

CLOWN.

My corporal oath; and you know, sir, a corporal is an office belonging to a soldier.

OLD LIONEL.

Yet you are clear? Murder will come to light.

OWNER.

So will your gullery[\[51\]](#) too.

Enter ROBIN.

ROBIN.

They say my old master's come home; I'll see if he will turn me out of doors, as the young man has done. I have laid rods in piss for somebody; scape Reignald as he can; and with more freedom than I durst late, I boldly now dare knock. [*Knocks.*]

OLD LIONEL.

More madmen yet! I think since my last voyage
Half of the world's turned frantic. What dost mean?
Or long'st thou to be blasted?

ROBIN.

Oh, sir, you are welcome home; 'twas time to come,
Ere all was gone to havoc.

OLD LIONEL.

My old servant!
Before I shall demand of further business,
Resolve me why thou thunder'st at these doors,
Where thou know'st none inhabits?

ROBIN.

Are they gone, sir?
'Twas well they have left the house behind;
For all the furniture, to a bare bench,
I am sure is spent and wasted.

OLD LIONEL.

Where's my son,
That Reignald, posting for him with such speed,
Brings him not from the country?

ROBIN.

Country, sir!
'Tis a thing they know not: here they feast,
Dice, drink, and drab; the company they keep,
Cheaters and roaring-lads, and these attended
By bawds and queans; your son hath got a strumpet
On whom he spends all that your sparing left;

And here they keep court, to whose damned abuses
Reignald gives all encouragement.

OLD LIONEL.

But stay, stay:
No living soul hath for these six months' space
Here entered, but the house stood desolate.

ROBIN.

Last week I am sure, so late, and the other day,
Such revels were here kept.

OLD LIONEL.

And by my son?

ROBIN.

Yes, and his servant Reignald.

OLD LIONEL.

And this house
At all not haunted?

ROBIN.

Save, sir, with such sprites.

OWNER.

This murder will come out.

Enter RICOTT.

OLD LIONEL.

But see, in happy time here comes my neighbour
Of whom he bought this mansion; he, I am sure,
More amply can resolve me.—I pray, sir,
What sums of moneys have you late received
Of my young son?

RICOTT.

Of him? None, I assure you.

OLD LIONEL.

What of my servant Reignald?

RICOTT.

But devise
What to call less than nothing, and that sum
I will confess received.

OLD LIONEL.

Pray, sir, be serious;
I do confess myself indebted to you
A hundred pound.

RICOTT.

You may do well to pay't then, for here's witness
Sufficient of your words.

OLD LIONEL.

I speak no more
Than what I purpose; just so much I owe you,
And ere I sleep will tender.

RICOTT.

I shall be
As ready to receive it, and as willing
As you can be to pay it.

OLD LIONEL.

But provided
You will confess seven hundred pounds received
Beforehand of my son.

RICOTT.

But, by your favour,
Why should I yield seven hundred pounds received
Of them I never dealt with? Why? For what?

What reason? What condition? Where or when
Should such a sum be paid me?

OLD LIONEL.

Why? for this bargain. And for what? this house.
Reason? because you sold it. The conditions?
Such as were agreed between you. Where and when?
That only hath escaped me.

RICOTT.

Madness all.

OLD LIONEL.

Was I not brought to take free view thereof,
As of mine own possession?

RICOTT.

I confess
Your servant told me you had found out a wife
Fit for your son, and that you meant to build;
Desired to take a friendly view of mine,
To make it your example: but for selling,
I tell you, sir, my wants be not so great
To change my house to coin.

OLD LIONEL.

Spare, sir, your anger,
And turn it into pity. Neighbours and friends,
I am quite lost; was never man so fooled,
And by a wicked servant! Shame and blushing
Will not permit to tell the manner how,
Lest I be made ridiculous to all:
My fears are, to inherit what's yet left,
He hath made my son away.

ROBIN.

That's my fear too.

OLD LIONEL.

Friends, as you would commiserate a man
Deprived at once both of his wealth and son,
And in his age, by one I ever tendered
More like a son than servant, by imagining
My case were yours, have feeling of my griefs
And help to apprehend him: furnish me
With cords and fetters; I will lay him safe
In prison within prison.

RICOTT.

We'll assist you.

ROBIN.

And I.

CLOWN.

And all.—But not to do the least hurt to my old friend Reignald. [*Aside.*

OLD LIONEL.

His legs will be as nimble as his brain,
And 'twill be difficult to seize the slave,
Yet your endeavours, pray. Peace! here he comes.

Enter REIGNALD with a horn in his pocket; the rest withdraw,[\[52\]](#)
excepting Old LIONEL.

REIGNALD.

My heart misgives, for 'tis not possible
But that in all these windings and indents[\[53\]](#)
I shall be found at last: I'll take that course
That men both troubled and affrighted do,—
Heap doubt on doubt, and, as combustions rise,
Try if from many I can make my peace,
And work mine own atonement.

OLD LIONEL.

[*Aside.*] Stand you close,

Be not yet seen, but at your best advantage
Hand him, and bind him fast; whilst I dissemble
As if I yet knew nothing.

REIGNALD.

I suspect
And find there's trouble in my master's looks;
Therefore I must not trust myself too far
Within his fingers.

OLD LIONEL.

Reignald!

REIGNALD.

Worshipful sir.

OLD LIONEL.

What says my son i' the country?

REIGNALD.

That to-morrow,
Early i' the morning, he'll attend your pleasure,
And do as all such duteous children ought—
Demand your blessing, sir.

OLD LIONEL.

Well, 'tis well.

REIGNALD.

I do not like his countenance. [*Aside.*

OLD LIONEL.

But, Reignald, I suspect the honesty
And the good meaning of my neighbour here,
Old Master Ricott. Meeting him but now,
And having some discourse about the house,
He makes all strange, and tells me in plain terms
He knows of no such matter.

REIGNALD.

Tell me that, sir!

OLD LIONEL.

I tell thee as it is: nor that such moneys,
Took up at use, were ever tendered him
On any such conditions.

REIGNALD.

I cannot blame
Your worship to be pleasant, knowing at what
An under-rate we bought it; but you ever
Were a most merry gentleman.

OLD LIONEL.

Impudent slave! [*Aside.*
But, Reignald, he not only doth deny it,
But offers to depose himself and servants
No such thing ever was.

REIGNALD.

Now, Heaven to see
To what this world is grown to! I will make him—

OLD LIONEL.

Nay more, this man will not confess the murder.

REIGNALD.

Which both shall dearly answer; you have warrant
For him already; but for the other, sir,
If he deny it, he had better—

OLD LIONEL.

Appear, gentlemen; [*Softly.*
'Tis a fit time to take him.

REIGNALD.

[*Aside.*] I discover

The ambush that's laid for me.

OLD LIONEL.

Come nearer, Reignald.

REIGNALD.

First, sir,
Resolve me one thing: amongst other merchandize
Bought in your absence by your son and me,
We engrossed a great commodity of combs,
And how many sorts, think you?

OLD LIONEL.

You might buy
Some of the bones of fishes, some of beasts,
Box-combs, and ivory-combs.

REIGNALD.

But, besides these, we have for horses, sir,
Mane-combs and curry-combs; now, sir, for men
We have head-combs, beard-combs, ay, and cox-combs too;
Take view of them at your pleasure, whilst for my part
I thus bestow myself.

[Whilst he climbs to the balcony, they come forward with cords and shackles.]

CLOWN.

Well said, Reignald; nobly put off, Reignald; look to thyself, Reignald.

OLD LIONEL.

Why dost thou climb thus?

REIGNALD.

Only to practise the nimbleness of my arms and legs, ere they prove your
cords and fetters.

OLD LIONEL.

Why to that place?

REIGNALD.

Why! because, sir, 'tis your own house. It hath been
My harbour long, and now it must be my sanctuary;
Dispute now, and I'll answer.

OWNER.

Villain, what devilish meaning hadst thou in't,
To challenge me of murder?

REIGNALD.

Oh, sir, the man you killed is alive at this present to justify it:
"I am," quoth he, "a trans-marine by birth"—

RICOTT.

Why challenge me
Receipt of moneys, and to give abroad
That I had sold my house?

REIGNALD.

Why! because, sir,
Could I have purchased houses at that rate,
I had meant to have bought all London.

CLOWN.

Yes, and Middlesex too; and I would have been thy half, Reignald.

OLD LIONEL.

Yours are great,
My wrongs insufferable. As first, to fright me
From mine own dwelling, till they had consumed
The whole remainder of the little left;
Besides, out of my late stock got at sea,
Discharge the clamorous usurer; make me accuse
This man of murder; be at charge of warrants;
And challenging this my worthy neighbour of
Forswearing sums he never yet received;

Fool me, to think my son, that had spent all,
Had by his thrift bought land; ay, and him too,
To open all the secrets of his house
To me, a stranger! O thou insolent villain,
What to all these canst answer?

REIGNALD.

Guilty, guilty.

OLD LIONEL.

But to my son's death, what, thou slave?

REIGNALD.

Not guilty.

OLD LIONEL.

Produce him then; i' the meantime, and—
Honest friends, get ladders.

REIGNALD.

Yes, and come down in your own ropes.

OWNER.

I'll fetch a piece, [\[54\]](#) and shoot him.

REIGNALD.

So the warrant in my master's pocket will serve for my murder; and ever
after shall my ghost haunt this house.

CLOWN.

And I will say, like Reignald, "this ghost and I am friends."

OLD LIONEL.

Bring faggots; I'll set fire upon the house
Rather than this endure.

REIGNALD.

To burn houses is felony, and I'll not out till I be fired out; but, since I am besieged thus, I'll summon supplies unto my rescue. [*He winds the horn.*]

Enter Young LIONEL, RIOTER, two Gallants, BLANDA, SCAPHA, and others.

YOUNG LIONEL.

Before you chide, first hear me; next your blessing,
That on my knees I beg. I have but done
Like misspent youth, which, after wit dear-bought,
Turns his eyes inward, sorry and ashamed.
These things in which I have offended most,
Had I not proved, I should have thought them still
Essential things, delights perdurable;
Which now I find mere shadows, toys and dreams,
Now hated more than erst I doted on.
Best natures are soon'st wrought on; such was mine;
As I the offences, so the offenders throw
Here at your feet, to punish as you please;
You have but paid so much as I have wasted,
To purchase to yourself a thrifty son,
Which I from henceforth vow.

OLD LIONEL.

See what fathers are,
That can three years' offences, foul ones too,
Thus in a minute pardon; and thy faults
Upon myself chastise, in these my tears.
Ere this submission, I had cast thee off;
Rise in my new adoption. But for these—

CLOWN.

The one you have nothing to do withal; here's his ticket for his discharge:
another for you, sir, to summon you to my master's feast,—for you, and
you,—where I charge you all to appear, upon his displeasure and your
own apperils.

YOUNG LIONEL.

This is my friend, the other one I loved;
Only because they have been dear to him
That now will strive to be more dear to you,
Vouchsafe their pardon.

OLD LIONEL.

All dear to me indeed,
For I have paid for't soundly, yet for thy sake
I am atoned with all; only that wanton,
Her and her company, abandon quite;
So doing, we are friends.

YOUNG LIONEL.

A just condition, and willingly subscribed to.

OLD LIONEL.

But for that villain; I am now devising
What shame, what punishment remarkable
To inflict on him.

REIGNALD.

Why, master! have I laboured,
Plotted, contrived, and all this while for you,
And will you leave me to the whip and stocks;
Not mediate my peace?

OLD LIONEL.

Sirrah, come down.

REIGNALD.

Not till my pardon's sealed; I'll rather stand here
Like a statue, in the fore-front of your house,
For ever, like the picture of Dame Fortune
Before the Fortune play-house.[\[55\]](#)

YOUNG LIONEL.

If I have here
But any friend amongst you, join with me

In this petition.

CLOWN.

Good sir, for my sake! I resolved you truly concerning whooping, the noise, the walking, and the sprites, and for a need can show you a ticket for him too.

OWNER.

I impute my wrongs rather to knavish cunning
Than least pretended malice.

RICOTT.

What he did
Was but for his young master; I allow it
Rather as sports of wit than injuries;
No other, pray, esteem them.

OLD LIONEL.

Even as freely
As you forget my quarrels made with you,
Raised from the errors first begot by him,
I here remit all free. I now am calm,
But had I seized upon him in my spleen—

REIGNALD.

I knew that, therefore this was my invention,
For policy's the art still of prevention.

CLOWN.

Come down, then, Reignald,—first on your hands and feet, and then on your knees to your master.—Now, gentlemen, what do you say to your inviting to my master's feast?

RICOTT.

We will attend him.

OLD LIONEL.

Nor do I love to break good company,

For Master Wincott is my worthy friend
And old acquaintance—[REIGNALD *descends*.] Oh, thou crafty wag-string!
And couldst thou thus delude me? But we are friends.—
Nor, gentlemen, let not what's hereto past,
In your least thoughts disable my estate:
This my last voyage hath made all things good,
With surplus too; be that your comfort, son.
Well, Reignald——But no more.

REIGNALD.

I was the fox,
But I from henceforth will no more the cox—
Comb put upon your pate.

OLD LIONEL.

Let's walk, gentlemen.

[*Exeunt*.]

ACT THE FIFTH.

SCENE I.—*Outside Old WINCOTT's House.*

Enter Old GERALDINE and Young GERALDINE.

OLD GERALDINE.

Son, let me tell you, you are ill advised,
And doubly to be blamed, by undertaking
Unnecessary travel, grounding no reason
For such a rash and giddy enterprise.
What profit aim you at, you have not reaped?
What novelty affords the Christian world,
Of which your view hath not participated
In a full measure? Can you either better
Your language or experience? Your self-will
Hath only purpose to deprive a father
Of a loved son, and many noble friends
Of your much-wished acquaintance.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Oh, dear sir,
Do not, I do entreat you, now repent you
Of your free grant, which with such care and study
I have so long, so often laboured for.

OLD GERALDINE.

Say that may be dispensed with, show me reason
Why you desire to steal out of your country,
Like some malefactor that had forfeited
His life and freedom. Here's a worthy gentleman
Hath for your sake invited many guests,
To his great charge, only to take of you
A parting leave: you send him word you cannot—
After, you may not come. Had not my urgency,

Almost compulsion, driven you to his house,
The unkindness might have forfeited your love,
And razed you from his will; in which he hath given you
A fair and large estate; yet you of all this strangeness
Show no sufficient ground.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Then understand
The ground thereof took his first birth from you;
'Twas you first charged me to forbear the house,
And that upon your blessing. Let it not then
Offend you, sir, if I so great a charge
Have strived to keep so strictly.

OLD GERALDINE.

Me perhaps
You may appease, and with small difficulty,
Because a father; but how satisfy
Their dear and, on your part, unmerited love?
But this your last obedience may salve all.
We now grow near the house.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Whose doors, to me,
Appear as horrid as the gates of Hell.
Where shall I borrow patience, or from whence,
To give a meeting to this viperous brood
Of friend and mistress?

[They enter the house.]

SCENE II.—A Room in Old WINCOTT's House.

*Enter WINCOTT, his Wife, the two LIONELS, Owner, DELAVIL,
PRUDENTILLA, REIGNALD, and RIOTER.*

WINCOTT.

You've entertained me with a strange discourse
Of your man's knavish wit; but I rejoice
That in your safe return all ends so well.
Most welcome you, and you, and indeed all;
To whom I am bound, that at so short a warning,
Thus friendly, you will deign to visit me.

OLD LIONEL.

It seems my absence hath begot some sport;
Thank my kind servant here.

REIGNALD.

Not so much worth, sir.

OLD LIONEL.

But, though their riots tripped at my estate,
They have not quite o'erthrown it.

Enter Old and Young GERALDINE.

WINCOTT.

But see, gentlemen,
These whom we most expected come at length.
This I proclaim the master of the feast,
In which, to express the bounty of my love,
I'll show myself no niggard.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Your choice favours
I still taste in abundance.

WIFE.

Methinks it would not misbecome me, sir,
To chide your absence, that have made yourself
To us so long a stranger.

[Young GERALDINE *turns sadly away*.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Pardon me, sir,
That have not yet, since your return from sea,
Voted[56] the least fit opportunity
To entertain you with a kind salute.

OLD LIONEL.

Most kindly, sir, I thank you.

DELAVIL.

Methinks, friend,
You should expect green rushes[57] to be strowed
After such discontinuance.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Mistress Prue,
I have not seen you long, but greet you thus:
May you be lady of a better husband
Than I expect a wife!

WINCOTT.

I like that greeting.
Nay, enter, gentlemen; dinner perhaps
Is not yet ready, but the time we stay,
We'll find some fresh discourse to spend away.

[*Exeunt all but DELAVIL.*

DELAVIL.

Not speak to me, nor once vouchsafe an answer,
But slight me with a poor and base neglect!

No, nor so much as cast an eye on her,
Or least regard, though in a seeming show
She courted a reply! 'Twixt him and her,
Nay, him and me, this was not wont to be;
If she have brain to apprehend as much
As I have done, she'll quickly find it out.—

[*Re-enter Young GERALDINE and Wife.*]

Now, as I live, as our affections meet,
So our conceits, and she hath singled him
To some such purpose. I'll retire myself,
Not interrupt their conference. [*Exit.*]

WIFE.

You are sad, sir.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I know no cause.

WIFE.

Then can I show you some.
Who could be otherways, to leave a father
So careful, and each way so provident?
To leave so many and such worthy friends?
To abandon your own country? These are some;
Nor do I think you can be much the merrier
For my sake.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Now your tongue speaks oracles;
For all the rest are nothing: 'tis for you—
Only for you I cannot.

WIFE.

So I thought;
Why, then, have you been all this while so strange?
Why will you travel, suing a divorce
Betwixt us of a love inseparable;
For here shall I be left as desolate

Unto a frozen, almost widowed bed,
Warmed only in that future stored in you;
For who can in your absence comfort me?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

[*Aside.*] Shall my oppressed sufferance yet break forth
Into impatience, or endure her more?

WIFE.

But since by no persuasion, no entreats,
Your settled obstinacy can be swayed,
Though you seem desperate of your own dear life,
Have care of mine, for it exists in you.
Oh, sir, should you miscarry I were lost,
Lost and forsaken! Then, by our past vows,
And by this hand once given me, by these tears
Which are but springs begetting greater floods,
I do beseech thee, my dear Geraldine,
Look to thy safety, and preserve thy health;
Have care into what company you fall;
Travel not late, and cross no dangerous seas;
For till Heavens bless me in thy safe return,
How will this poor heart suffer!

YOUNG GERALDINE.

[*Aside.*] I had thought
Long since the sirens had been all destroyed;
But one of them I find survives in her:
She almost makes me question what I know,
A heretic unto my own belief:—
O thou mankind's seducer!

WIFE.

What, no answer!

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Yes, thou hast spoke to me in showers; I will
Reply in thunder: thou adulteress,

That hast more poison in thee than the serpent
Who was the first that did corrupt thy sex,
The devil!

WIFE.

To whom speaks the man?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

To thee,
Falsest of all that ever man termed fair.
Hath impudence so steeled thy smooth soft skin,
It cannot blush? Or sin so obdured thy heart,
It doth not quake and tremble? Search thy conscience;
There thou shalt find a thousand clamorous tongues
To speak as loud as mine doth.

WIFE.

Save from yours,
I hear no noise at all.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

I'll play the doctor
To open thy deaf ears. Monday the ninth
Of the last month—canst thou remember that,
That night more black in thy abhorrèd sin
Than in the gloomy darkness?—that the time.

WIFE.

Monday!

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Wouldst thou the place know?—thy polluted chamber,
So often witness of my sinless vows.
Wouldst thou the person?—one not worthy name,
Yet, to torment thy guilty soul the more,
I'll tell him thee—that monster Delavil.
Wouldst thou your bawd know?—midnight, that the hour.
The very words thou spake?—“Now what would Geraldine
Say, if he saw us here?”—to which was answered,
“Tush, he's a coxcomb, fit to be so fooled!”
No blush! What, no faint fever on thee yet!
How hath thy black sins changed thee! Thou Medusa!
Those hairs that late appeared like golden wires
Now crawl with snakes and adders. Thou art ugly.

WIFE.

And yet my glass, till now, ne'er told me so.
Who gave you this intelligence?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Only He
That, pitying such an innocency as mine
Should by two such delinquents be betrayed,—
He brought me to that place by miracle,
And made me an ear-witness of all this.

WIFE.

I am undone!

YOUNG GERALDINE.

But think what thou hast lost
To forfeit me! I, notwithstanding these,
(So fixèd was my love and unalterable,)
I kept this from thy husband, nay, all ears,
With thy transgressions smothering mine own wrongs,
In hope of thy repentance.

WIFE.

Which begins
Thus low upon my knees—

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Tush! bow to Heaven,
Which thou hast most offended; I, alas!
Save in such scarce unheard-of treachery,
Most sinful, like thyself. Wherein, oh, wherein
Hath my unspotted and unbounded love
Deserved the least of these? Sworn to be made a stale
For term of life, and all this for my goodness!
Die, and die soon; acquit me of my oath,
But prithee die repentant. Farewell ever:
'Tis thou, and only thou, hast banished me
Both from my friends and country.

WIFE.

Oh, I am lost! [*Sinks down.*]

Re-enter DELAVIL, meeting Young GERALDINE going out.

DELAVIL.

Why, how now, what's the business?

YOUNG GERALDINE.

Go, take her up, whom thou hast oft thrown down.
Villain! [*Exit.*]

DELAVIL.

That was no language from a friend,
It had too harsh an accent. But how's this?
My mistress thus low cast upon the earth,
Grovvelling and breathless! Mistress, lady, sweet—

WIFE.

Oh, tell me if thy name be Geraldine:
Thy very looks will kill me!

DELAVIL.

View me well;
I am no such man; see, I am Delavil.

WIFE.

Thou'rt then a devil, that presents before me
My horrid sins, persuades me to despair,
When he, like a good angel sent from Heaven,
Besought me of repentance. Swell, sick heart,
Even till thou burst the ribs that bound thee in!
So, there's one string cracked. Flow, and flow high,
Even till thy blood distil out of mine eyes,
To witness my great sorrow.

DELAVIL.

Faint again!
Some help within there! No attendant near?
Thus to expire! In this I am more wretched
Than all the sweet fruition of her love
Before could make me happy.

*Re-enter WINCOTT, Old GERALDINE, Young GERALDINE, the two LIONELS,
RICOTT, Owner, PRUDENTILLA, and REIGNALD; also enter Clown.*

WINCOTT.

What was he
Clamoured so loud, to mingle with our mirth
This terror and affright?

DELAVIL.

See, sir, your wife
In these my arms expiring.

WINCOTT.

How!

PRUDENTILLA.

My sister!

WINCOTT.

Support her, and by all means possible
Provide for her dear safety.

OLD GERALDINE.

See, she recovers.

WINCOTT.

Woman, look up.

WIFE.

Oh, sir, your pardon!
Convey me to my chamber; I am sick,
Sick even to death. Away, thou sycophant,
Out of my sight! I have, besides thyself,
Too many sins about me.

CLOWN.

My sweet mistress!

[*PRUDENTILLA and Clown lead Wife off.*]

DELAVIL.

The storm is coming; I must provide for harbour. [*Exit.*]

OLD LIONEL.

What strange and sudden alteration's this!
How quickly is this clear day overcast!
But such and so uncertain are all things
That dwell beneath the moon.

YOUNG LIONEL.

A woman's qualm,
Frailties that are inherent to her sex—
Soon sick, and soon recovered.

WINCOTT.

If she misfare,

I am a man more wretched in her loss
Than had I forfeited life and estate;
She was so good a creature.

OLD GERALDINE.

I the like
Suffered, when I my wife brought to her grave;
So you, when you were first a widower:
Come, arm yourself with patience.

RICOTT.

These are casualties
That are not new, but common.

REIGNALD.

Burying of wives!—
As stale as shifting shirts, or for some servants
To flout and gull their masters.

OWNER.

Best to send
And see how her fit holds her.

Re-enter PRUDENTILLA and Clown.

PRUDENTILLA.

Sir, my sister
In these few lines commends her last to you,
For she is now no more. What's therein writ,
Save Heaven and you, none knows: this she desired
You would take view of, and with these words expired.

WINCOTT.

Dead!

YOUNG GERALDINE.

She hath made me then a free release
Of all the debts I owed her.

WINCOTT.

[*Aside, reading.*] “My fear[58] is beyond pardon. Delavil
Hath played the villain; but for Geraldine,
He hath been each way noble; love him still.
My peace already I have made with Heaven;
Oh, be not you at war with me! my honour
Is in your hands to punish, or preserve;
I am now confessed, and only Geraldine
Hath wrought on me this unexpected good.
The ink I write with, I wish had been my blood,
To witness my repentance.”—Delavil!
Where’s he? go seek him out.

CLOWN.

I shall, I shall, sir. [*Exit.*]

WINCOTT.

The wills of dead folk should be still obeyed:
However false to me, I’ll not reveal’t;
Where Heaven forgives, I pardon.—Gentlemen,
I know you all commiserate my loss;
I little thought this feast should have been turned
Into a funeral.—[*Re-enter Clown.*] What’s the news of him?

CLOWN.

He went presently[59] to the stable, put the saddle upon his horse, put his
foot into the stirrup, clapped his spurs into his sides, and away he’s
galloped, as if he were to ride a race for a wager.

WINCOTT.

All our ill lucks go with him! Farewell he!
But all my best of wishes wait on you, [*To Young GERALDINE.*]
As my chief friend! This meeting, that was made
Only to take of you a parting leave,
Shall now be made a marriage of our love,
Which none save only death shall separate.

YOUNG GERALDINE.

It calls me from all travel, and from henceforth
With my country I am friends.

WINCOTT.

The lands that I have left,
You lend me for the short space of my life;
As soon as Heaven calls me, they call you lord.—
First feast, and after mourn; we'll, like some gallants
That bury thrifty fathers, think't no sin
To wear blacks without, but other thoughts within.

[Exeunt.]

THE WISE-WOMAN OF HOGSDON.

The Wise-Woman of Hogsdon was printed in 1638. Of its history nothing is known; that it was popular is implied by the statement on the title-page —“As it hath been sundry times acted with great applause.” The technical cleverness of the last Act is noticeable. In the original editions the play is divided into acts but not into scenes. These are now indicated for the first time.

Hogsdon, *i.e.* Hoxton, in the parish of St. Leonard’s, Shoreditch, was described by Stow, in 1598, as “a large street with houses on both sides.” It was in the adjacent fields that the duel was fought between Ben Jonson and Gabriel Spenser, a player belonging to Henslowe’s company, which resulted in the death of the latter and put Jonson in peril of his life.

DRAMATIS PERSONÆ.

Young CHARTLEY, a wild-headed Gentleman.

BOYSTER, a blunt Fellow.

SENCER, a conceited Gentleman.

HARINGFIELD, a civil Gentleman.

LUCE's Father, a Goldsmith.

JOSEPH, his Apprentice.

Old Master CHARTLEY.

Sir HARRY, a Knight, who is no Scholar.

Sir BONIFACE, an ignorant Schoolmaster.

Young CHARTLEY's Man.

Old CHARTLEY's Men.

TABER, Sir HARRY's Man.

A Countryman, Client to the Wise-Woman.

A Serving-man.

LUCE, a Goldsmith's Daughter.

The second LUCE.

GRATIANA, Sir HARRY's Daughter.

The Wise-Woman of Hogsdon.

A Kitchen-maid.

Two Citizens' Wives.

SCENE—LONDON and HOGSDON.

THE WISE-WOMAN OF HOGSDON.

ACT THE FIRST.

SCENE I.—*A Room in a Tavern.*

*Enter, as newly come from play, Young CHARTLEY, SENCER, BOYSTER,
and HARINGFIELD.*

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Price of my life! now, if the devil have bones,
These dice are made of his. Was ever such
A cast seen in this age? Could any gull
In Europe, saving myself, fling such a cast?

BOYSTER.

Ay.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

No.

BOYSTER.

Yes.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

But I say no: I have lost an hundred pound,
And I will have my saying.

BOYSTER.

I have lost another hundred, I'll have mine.
Ay, yes, I flung a worse,—a worse by odds.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

I cry you mercy, sir; losers may speak;
I'll not except 'gainst you: but let me see
Which of these two that pocket up our cash
Dares contradict me?

SENCER.

Sir, not I:
I say you have had bad casting.

HARINGFIELD.

So say I.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

I say this hat's not made of wool:
Which of you all dares say the contrary?

SENCER.

It may be 'tis a beaver.

HARINGFIELD.

Very likely so: 'tis not wool, but a plain beaver.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

'Tis wool, but which of you dares say so?—[*Aside.*] I would fain pick a quarrel with them, to get some of my money again; but the slaves now they have got it, are too wise to part with it. I say it is not black.

HARINGFIELD.

So say we too.

BOYSTER.

'Tis false: his cap's of wool; 'tis black and wool, and wool and black.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

I have nought to say to losers. Have I nothing left to set at a cast? Ay, finger, must you be set in gold, and not a jot of silver in my purse? A bale^[1] of fresh dice! Ho, come at this ring!

SENCER.

Fie, Master Chartley! 'tis time to give over.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

That's the winner's phrase. Hold me play, or he that hath uncrowned me, I'll take a speedy order with him.

BOYSTER.

Fresh dice! This jewel I will venture more:
Take this and all. I'll play in spite of luck.

HARINGFIELD.

Since you will needs, trip for the dice. I see it is hard to go a winner from this company.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

The dice are mine. This diamond I value at twenty marks:[\[2\]](#) I'll venture it at a throw.

HARINGFIELD.

'Tis set you.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Then at all. All's mine. Nay, Master Boyster, I bar you: let us work upon the winners. Gramercy, cinques! Nay, though I owe you no quarrel, yet you must give me leave to draw.

HARINGFIELD.

I had rather you should draw your sword
Than draw my money thus.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Again, sweet dice. Nay, I bar swearing: gentlemen, let's play patiently. Well, this at the candlestick, so— [*He throws out.*]

BOYSTER.

Now, dice, at all. Todo, quoth the Spaniard.

SENCER.

Here's precious luck.

BOYSTER.

Why, *via*! I think 'tis quicksilver; it goes and comes so fast: there's life in this.

HARINGFIELD.

He passes all with treys.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

With treys, how say by that? Oh, he's old dog at bowls and treys!

SENCER.

Lend me some money: be my half one cast.
I'll once out-brave this gamester with a throw.
So, now the dice are mine, wilt be my half?

HARINGFIELD.

I will.

SENCER.

Then once I'll play the frank gamester.
Let me but see how much you both can make,
And I'll cast at all, all, every cross.[\[3\]](#)

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Now, bless us all, what will you every cross?

SENCER.

I will not leave myself one cross to bless me.

BOYSTER.

I set.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

And so do I.

SENCER.

Why, then, at all. How! [*He flings out.*]

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Nay, swear not; let's play patiently.

SENCER.

Damned dice! did ever gamester see the like?

BOYSTER.

Never, never.

SENCER.

Was ever known such casting?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Drunk nor sober, I ne'er saw a man cast worse.

SENCER.

I'll prove this hat of mine an helmet. Which of you here dares say the contrary?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

As fair an helmet as any man in Europe needs to wear.

SENCER.

Chartley, thy hat is black.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Upon better recollection, 'tis so indeed.

SENCER.

I say 'tis made of wool.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

True, my losing had took away my senses,
Both of seeing and feeling; but better luck
Hath brought them to their right temper.
But come—a pox of dice! 'tis time to give over.

SENCER.

All times are times for winners to give over,
But not for them that lose. I'll play till midnight,
But I will change my luck.

HARINGFIELD.

Come, come, you shall not.
Give over; tush, give over; do, I pray,
And choose the fortune of some other hour:
Let's not, like debauched fellows, play our clothes,
Belts, rapiers, nor our needful ornaments:
'Tis childish, not becoming gentlemen.
Play was at first ordained to pass the time;
And, sir, you but abuse the use of play
To employ it otherwise.

SENCER.

You may persuade me.
For once I'll leave a loser.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Then come, put on your helmet; let's leave this abominable game, and
find out some better exercise. I cannot endure this chafing when men
lose.

SENCER.

And there's not a more testy waspish companion than thyself when thou
art a loser, and yet thou must be vexing others with "Play patiently,
gentlemen, and let's have no swearing."

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

A sign that I can give good counsel better than take it: but say, where be
the prettiest wenches, my hearts?

SENCER.

Well remembered; this puts me in mind of an appointment I had with a
gentlewoman of some respect.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

I have you, sir, I have you; but I think you will never have her: 'tis Gratiana, the knight's daughter in Gracious Street.[\[4\]](#) Have I touched you?

SENCER.

You have come somewhat near me, but touched me not. Master Haringfield, will you bear me company thither? Have you seen the gentlewoman, Master Chartley?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Never, sir.

SENCER.

How have you heard of her?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

That she hath as other women have; that she goes for a maid, as others do, &c.[\[5\]](#)

SENCER.

I can assure you she is a proper gentlewoman.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Then, if she have you, she is like to have a proper gentleman.

SENCER.

You should tell them so that know it not. Adieu, gentlemen.

[Exeunt SENCER and HARINGFIELD.]

BOYSTER.

I am glad yet they go so lightly away.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

What will you do, Master Boyster?

BOYSTER.

Somewhat.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

You will not acquaint me with your business?

BOYSTER.

No. I am in love; my head is full of proclamations. There is a thing called a virgin. Nature hath showed her art in making her. Court her I cannot, but I'll do as I may.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Do you go or stay, sir?

BOYSTER.

Go. [*Exit.*

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

You before, I'll follow.—He thinks, with his blunt humour, to enter as far as I with my sharp. No, my true Trojan, no: there is a fair, sweet, modest rogue, her name is Luce; with this dandiprat, this pretty little ape's face, is yon blunt fellow in love; and no marvel, for she hath a brow bewitching, eyes ravishing, and a tongue enchanting; and, indeed, she hath no fault in the world but one, and that is, she is honest; and were it not for that, she were the only sweet rogue in Christendom. As I live, I love her extremely, and to enjoy her would give anything; but the fool stands in her own light, and will do nothing without marriage. But what should I do marrying? I can better endure gyves than bands of matrimony. But in this meditation, I am glad I have won my money again. Nay, and she may be glad of it too; for the girl is but poor, and in my pocket I have laid up a stock for her,—'tis put to use already. And if I meet not with a dice-house or an ordinary by the way, no question but I may increase it to a sum. Well, I'll unto the Exchange to buy her some pretty novelty: that done, I'll visit my little rascal, and solicit instantly. [*Exit.*

SCENE II.—*Before the Goldsmith's Shop.*

Enter LUCE at work upon a laced handkerchief, and JOSEPH.

LUCE.

Where is my father, Joseph?

JOSEPH.

Mistress, above,
And prays you to attend below a little.

LUCE.

I do not love to sit thus publicly;
And yet upon the traffic of our wares
Our provident eyes and presence must still wait.
Do you attend the shop, I'll ply my work.
I see my father is not jealous of me,
That trusts me to the open view of all.
The reason is, he knows my thoughts are chaste,
And my care such, as that it needs the awe
Of no strict overseer.

Enter BOYSTER.

BOYSTER.

Yonder's Luce.—Save thee!

LUCE.

And you too, sir; you're welcome; want you aught,
I pray, in which our trade may furnish you?

BOYSTER.

Yes.

LUCE.

Joseph, show the gentleman—

BOYSTER.

'Tis here that I would buy.

LUCE.

What do you mean, sir? speak, what is't you lack?
I pray you wherefore do you fix your eyes
So firmly in my face? What would you have?

BOYSTER.

Thee.

LUCE.

Me!

BOYSTER.

Yes, thee.

LUCE.

Your pleasure is to jest, and so I take it.
Pray give me leave, sir, to intend[6] my work.

BOYSTER.

You are fair.

LUCE.

You flout me.

BOYSTER.

You are, go to, you are;
I'd vex him that should say the contrary.

LUCE.

Well, you may say your pleasure.

BOYSTER.

I love thee.

LUCE.

Oh, sir!

BOYSTER.

As I live, I do.

LUCE.

Now, as I am a true maid,
The most religious oath that I dare swear,
I hold myself indebted to your love;
And I am sorry there remains in me
No power how to requite it.

BOYSTER.

Love me; prithee now, do, if thou canst.

LUCE.

I cannot.

BOYSTER.

Prithee, if thou canst.

LUCE.

Indeed I cannot.

BOYSTER.

Yet ask thine heart, and see what may be done.

LUCE.

In troth, I am sorry you should spend a sigh
For my sake unrequited, or a tear,—
Ay, or a word.

BOYSTER.

'Tis no matter for my words, they are not many and those not very wise
ones neither.

LUCE.

Yet I beseech you spend no more in vain.
I scorn you not; disdain's as far from me
As are the two poles distant: therefore, sir,

Because I would not hold you in suspense,
But tell you what at first to trust unto,
Thus in a word, I must not fancy[7] you.

BOYSTER.

Must not!

LUCE.

I cannot, nor I may not.

BOYSTER.

I am gone:

Thou hast given me, Luce, a bone to gnaw upon. [*Exit.*]

LUCE.

Alas, that beauty should be sought of more
Than can enjoy it! Might I have my wish,
I would seem fair but only in his eye
That should possess me in a nuptial tie.

Enter Young CHARTLEY, with gloves, ring, purse, &c.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Morrow, Luce; in exchange of this kiss, see what I have brought thee
from the Exchange.

LUCE.

What mean you, sir, by this?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Guess that by the circumstance: here's a ring, wear't for my sake; twenty
angels, pocket them, you fool. Come, come, I know thou art a maid: say
nay, and take them.[8]

LUCE.

Sweet Master Chartley, do not fasten on me
More than with ease I can shake off: your gift
I reverence, yet refuse; and I pray tell me,

Why do you make so many errands hither,
Send me so many letters, fasten on me
So many favours? What's your meaning in't?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Hark in thine ear, I'll tell thee;—nay, hear me out. Is't possible so soft a body should have so hard a soul? Nay, now I know my penance; you will be angry, and school me for tempting your modesty: a fig for this modesty! it hinders many a good man from many a good turn, and that's all the good it doth. If thou but knew'st, Luce, how I love thee, thou wouldst be far more tractable. Nay, I bar chiding when you speak; I'll stop thy lips if thou dost but offer an angry word—by this hand, I'll do't, and with this hand too. Go to now, what say you?

LUCE.

Sir, if you love me, as you say you do,
Show me the fruits thereof.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

The stock I can; thou mayst see the fruits hereafter.

LUCE.

Can I believe you love me, when you seek
The shipwreck of mine honour?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Honour! there's another word to flap in a man's mouth! Honour! what shouldst thou and I stand upon our honour, that were neither of us yet Right Worshipful?

LUCE.

I am sorry, sir, I have lent so large an ear
To such a bad discourse; and I protest
After this hour never to do the like.
I must confess, of all the gentlemen
That ever courted me, you have possessed
The best part in my thoughts: but this coarse language
Exiles you quite from thence. Sir, had you come,

Instead of changing this mine honest name
Into a strumpet's, to have honoured me
With the chaste title of a modest wife,
I had reserved an ear for all your suits;
But since I see your rudeness finds no limit,
I leave you to your lust.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

You shall not, Luce.

LUCE.

Then keep your tongue within more moderate bounds.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

I will,—as I am virtuous, I will.—[*Aside.*] I told you the second word would be marriage. It makes a man forfeit his freedom, and makes him walk ever after with a chain at his heels, or a jackanapes hanging at his elbow. Marriage is like Dædalus's labyrinth, and, being once in, there's no finding the way out. Well, I love this little property most intolerably, and I must set her on the last, though it cost me all the shoes in my shop. —Well, Luce, thou seest my stomach is come down: thou hast my heart already; there's my hand.

LUCE.

But in what way?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Nay, I know not the way yet, but I hope to find it hereafter, by your good direction.

LUCE.

I mean, in what manner? in what way?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

In the way of marriage, in the way of honesty, in the way that was never gone yet. I hope thou art a maid, Luce?

LUCE.

Yes, sir; and I accept it: in exchange
Of this your hand, you shall receive my heart.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

A bargain, and there's earnest on thy lips.

LUCE.

I'll call my father, sir, to witness it.
See, here he comes.

Enter LUCE's Father, a plain Citizen.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Father, save you! You have happened of an untoward son-in-law; here I am, how do you like me?

LUCE'S FATHER.

Sir, I was nearer than you were aware,
And overheard both sum and circumstance.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

[*Aside.*] Then I perceive you are an old eavesdropper.—But what do you think of it, father?

LUCE'S FATHER.

I entertain the motion with all love,
And I rejoice my daughter is preferred
And raised to such a match; I heard the contract,
And will confirm it gladly: but pray, sir,
When shall the merry day be?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Marry, even to-morrow by that we can see: nay, we'll lose no more time;
I'll take order for that.

LUCE.

Stay but a month.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

A month! thou canst not hire me to't. Why, Luce, if thou beest hungry, canst thou stay a month from meat? Nay, if I see my diet before me, I love to fall to when I have a stomach. Here, buy thee a new smock; let's have a new bed too, and look it be strong; there's a box of rings and jewels, lay them up. Ha, sirrah! methinks the very name of wedlock hath brought me to a night-cap already, and I am grown civil on the sudden. There's more money for dishes, platters, ladles, candlesticks, &c., as I shall find them set down in the inventory.

LUCE'S FATHER.

But whom shall we invite unto the wedding?

Enter 2nd LUCE in the habit of a Page; she retires.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Ay, thereby hangs a tale. We will have no more at our marriage but myself, to say, "I take thee, Luce;" thou to say, "I, Luce, take thee, Robin;" the vicar to put us together; and you, father, to play the clerk, and cry "Amen."

LUCE'S FATHER.

Your reason for that?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

I would not for a world it should be known to my friends, or come to my father's ear. It may be ten thousand pounds out of my way. For the present, therefore, this is my conceit:[\[9\]](#) let us be married privately, and Luce shall live like a maid still, and bear the name. 'Tis nothing, Luce: it is a common thing in this age to go for a maid, and be none. I'll frequent the house secretly. Fear not, girl; though I revel abroad o' days, I'll be with thee to bring[\[10\]](#) o' nights, my little whiting-mop.[\[11\]](#)

LUCE.

But so I may incur a public scandal,
By your so oft frequenting to my chamber.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Scandal! what scandal? Why, to stop the mouth of all scandal, after some few days do I appear in my likeness, married man and honest housekeeper, and then what becomes of your scandal? Come, send for Master Vicar; and what we do, let's do suddenly.

2ND LUCE.

Cold comfort for me. [*Aside.*]

LUCE.

If you purpose to be so privately married, I know one excellent at such an exploit. Are you not acquainted with the Wise-woman of Hogsdon?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Oh, the witch, the beldam, the hag of Hogsdon?

LUCE.

The same, but I hold her to be of no such condition. I will anon make a step thither, and punctually acquaint her with all our proceedings: she is never without a Sir John[\[12\]](#) at her elbow, ready for such a stratagem.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Well, be't so, then.

[*Exeunt all except 2nd LUCE.*]

2ND LUCE.

Heigh-ho! have I disguised myself, and stolen out of the country thus far, and can light of no better news to entertain me? Oh, this wild-headed, wicked Chartley, whom nothing will tame! To this gallant was I, poor gentlewoman, betrothed, and the marriage day appointed; but he, out of a fantastic and giddy humour, before the time prefixed, posts up to London. After him come I thus habited, and you see my welcome—to be an ear-witness of his second contracting. Modesty would not suffer me to discover myself, otherwise I should have gone near to have marred the match. I heard them talk of Hogsdon, and a wise-woman, where these aims shall be brought to action. I'll see if I can insinuate myself into her service; that's my next project: and now good luck of my side! [*Exit.*]

ACT THE SECOND.

SCENE I.—*Before the Wise-woman's House.*

Enter the Wise-woman, a Countryman with a urinal, two Citizens' Wives, TABER, and a Kitchen-maid.

WISE-WOMAN.

Fie, fie! what a toil and a moil it is
For a woman to be wiser than all her neighbours!
I pray, good people, press not too fast upon me;
Though I have two ears, I can hear but one at once.
You with the urine.

Enter 2nd LUCE in Boy's clothes; she stands aside.

COUNTRYMAN.

Here, forsooth, mistress.

WISE-WOMAN.

And who distilled this water?

COUNTRYMAN.

My wife's limbeck, if it please you.

WISE-WOMAN.

And where doth the pain hold her most?

COUNTRYMAN.

Marry, at her heart, forsooth.

WISE-WOMAN.

Ay, at her heart, she hath a griping at her heart?

COUNTRYMAN.

You have hit it right.

WISE-WOMAN.

Nay, I can see so much in the urine.

2ND LUCE.

Just so much as is told her. [*Aside.*

WISE-WOMAN.

She hath no pain in her head, hath she?

COUNTRYMAN.

No, indeed, I never heard her complain of her head.

WISE-WOMAN.

I told you so, her pain lies all at her heart;

Alas, good heart! but how feels she her stomach?

COUNTRYMAN.

Oh, queasy[13] and sick at stomach.

WISE-WOMAN.

Ay, I warrant you, I think I can see as far into a mill-stone as another. You have heard of Mother Nottingham, who for her time was prettily well skilled in casting of waters; and after her, Mother Bomby; and then there is one Hatfield in Pepper Alley, he doth pretty well for a thing that's lost. There's another in Coleharbour, that's skilled in the planets. Mother Sturton, in Golden Lane, is for fore-speaking;[14] Mother Phillips, of the Bankside, for the weakness of the back; and then there's a very reverend matron on Clerkenwell Green, good at many things. Mistress Mary on the Bankside is for 'recting a figure;[15] and one (what do you call her?) in Westminster, that practiseth the book and the key, and the sieve and the shears: and all do well, according to their talent. For myself, let the world speak. Hark you, my friend, you shall take— [*She whispers.*

2ND LUCE.

'Tis strange the ignorant should be thus fooled!

What can this witch, this wizard, or old trot,

Do by enchantment, or by magic spell?

Such as profess that art should be deep scholars.

What reading can this simple woman have?
'Tis palpable gross foolery.

[*Exit Countryman.*

WISE-WOMAN.

Now, friend, your business?

TABER.

I have stolen out of my master's house, forsooth, with the kitchen-maid, and I am come to know of you whether it be my fortune to have her or no.

WISE-WOMAN.

And what's your suit, lady?

KITCHEN-MAID.

Forsooth, I come to know whether I be a maid or no.

WISE-WOMAN.

Why, art thou in doubt of that?

KITCHEN-MAID.

It may be I have more reason than all the world knows.

TABER.

Nay, if thou comest to know whether thou be'st a maid or no, I had best ask to know whether I be with child or no.

WISE-WOMAN.

Withdraw into the parlour there; I'll but talk with this other gentlewoman, and I'll resolve you presently.

TABER.

Come, Cicely, if she cannot resolve thee, I can; and in the case of a maidenhead do more than she, I warrant thee.

[*Exeunt TABER and Kitchen-maid.*

1ST CITIZEN WIFE.

Forsooth, I am bold, as they say——

WISE-WOMAN.

You are welcome, gentlewoman.

1ST CITIZEN WIFE.

I would not have it known to my neighbours that I come to a wise-woman for any thing, by my truly.

WISE-WOMAN.

For should your husband come and find you here——

1ST CITIZEN WIFE.

My husband, woman! I am a widow.

WISE-WOMAN.

Where are my brains? 'Tis true, you are a widow; and you dwell—let me see, I can never remember that place.

1ST CITIZEN WIFE.

In Kent-street.

WISE-WOMAN.

Kent-street, Kent-street! and I can tell you wherefore you come.

1ST CITIZEN WIFE.

Why, and say true?

WISE-WOMAN.

You are a wag, you are a wag: why, what do you think now I would say?

1ST CITIZEN WIFE.

Perhaps to know how many husbands I should have.

WISE-WOMAN.

And if I should say so, should I say amiss?

1ST CITIZEN WIFE.

I think you are a witch.

WISE-WOMAN.

In, in: I'll but read a little of Ptolemy and Erra Pater^[16]; and when I have cast a figure, I'll come to you presently. [*Exeunt Citizens' Wives.*] Now, wag, what wouldst thou have?

2ND LUCE.

[*Aside.*] If this were a wise-woman, she could tell that without asking. Now methinks I should come to know whether I were a boy or a girl.—Forsooth, I lack a service.

WISE-WOMAN.

By my fidelity, and I want a good trusty lad.

2ND LUCE.

[*Aside.*] Now could I sigh, and say “Alas! this is some bawd trade-fallen, and out of her wicked experience is come to be reputed wise.” I'll serve her, be't but to pry into the mystery of her science.

WISE-WOMAN.

A proper stripling, and a wise, I warrant him.—Here's a penny for thee, I'll hire thee for a year by the Statute of Winchester;^[17] prove true and honest, and thou shalt want nothing that a good boy—

2ND LUCE.

Here, wise-woman, you are out again: I shall want what a good boy should have, whilst I live.—Well, here I shall live both unknown, and my sex unsuspected. But whom have we here?

Enter HARINGFIELD, and Young CHARTLEY half drunk.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Come, Haringfield, now we have been drinking of Mother Red-cap's ale, let us now go make some sport with the wise-woman.

HARINGFIELD.

We shall be thought very wise men of all such as shall see us go in to the wise-woman's.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

See, here she is. How now, witch! How now, hag! How now, beldam! You are the wise-woman, are you? and have wit to keep yourself warm enough, I warrant you.

WISE-WOMAN.

Out, thou knave!

2ND LUCE.

And will these wild oats never be sown? [*Aside.*]

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

You enchantress, sorceress, she-devil! you Madam Hecate, Lady Proserpine! you are too old, you hag, now, for conjuring up spirits yourself; but you keep pretty young witches under your roof, that can do that.

WISE-WOMAN.

I or my family conjure up any spirits! I defy thee, thou young hare-brained—

HARINGFIELD.

Forbear him till he have his senses about him, and I shall then hold thee for a wise-woman indeed: otherwise, I shall doubt thou hast thy name for nothing. Come, friend, away, if thou lovest me.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Away, you old dromedary! I'll come one of these nights, and make a racket amongst your she-caterwaulers.

HARINGFIELD.

I prithee let's be civil.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Out of my sight, thou she-mastiff!

[*Exeunt* Young CHARTLEY *and* HARINGFIELD.

2ND LUCE.

Patience, sweet mistress.

WISE-WOMAN.

Now, bless me, he hath put me into such a fear, as makes all my bones to dance and rattle in my skin: I'll be revenged on that swaggering companion.

2ND LUCE.

Mistress, I wish you would; he's a mere mad-cap, and all his delight is in misusing such reverend matrons as yourself.

WISE-WOMAN.

Well, what's thy name, boy?

2ND LUCE.

I am even little better than a turnbroach, for my name is Jack.

WISE-WOMAN.

Honest Jack, if thou couldst but devise how I might cry quittance with this cutting Dick[18] I will go near to adopt thee my son and heir.

2ND LUCE.

Mistress, there is a way, and this it is:
To-morrow morning doth this gentleman
Intend to marry with one Mistress Luce,
A goldsmith's daughter; do you know the maid?

WISE-WOMAN.

My daughter, and a pretty smug-faced girl. I had a note but late from her, and she means to be with me in the evening: for I have bespoke Sir Boniface to marry her in the morning.

2ND LUCE.

Do but prevent this gallant of his wife,
And then your wrongs shall be revenged at full.

WISE-WOMAN.

I'll do't, as I am matron; ay, and show him a new trick for his learning.

Enter BOYSTER.

BOYSTER.

Morrow.

WISE-WOMAN.

You're welcome, sir.

BOYSTER.

Art wise?

2ND LUCE.

He should be wise, because he speaks few words.

WISE-WOMAN.

I am as I am, and there's an end.

BOYSTER.

Canst conjure?

WISE-WOMAN.

Oh, that's a foul word! but I can tell you your fortune, as they say; I have some little skill in palmistry, but never had to do with the devil.

BOYSTER.

And had the devil never anything to do with thee? thou look'st somewhat like his dam. Look on me: canst tell what I ail?

WISE-WOMAN.

Can you tell yourself? I should guess you be mad, or not well in your wits.

BOYSTER.

Thou'rt wise, I am so: men being in love are mad, and I being in love am so.

WISE-WOMAN.

Nay, if I see your complexion once, I think I can guess as near as another.

BOYSTER.

One Mistress Luce I love; know'st thou her, grannam?

WISE-WOMAN.

As well as the beggar knows his dish. Why, she is one of my daughters.

BOYSTER.

Make her my wife, I'll give thee forty pieces.

2ND LUCE.

Take them, mistress, to be revenged on Chartley.

WISE-WOMAN.

A bargain; strike me luck. Cease all your sorrow;
Fair Luce shall be your bride betimes to-morrow.

BOYSTER.

Thou'rt a good grannam; and, but that thy teeth stand like hedge-stakes in thy head, I'd kiss thee. [*Exit.*]

WISE-WOMAN.

Pray will you in? Come hither, Jack; I have a new trick come into my head: wilt thou assist me in't?

2ND LUCE.

If it concern the crossing of the marriage with Mistress Luce, I'll do't, whate'er it be.

WISE-WOMAN.

Thou shalt be tired like a woman. Can you make a curtsy, take small strides, simper, and seem modest? methinks thou hast a woman's voice already.

2ND LUCE.

Doubt not of me, I'll act them naturally.

WISE-WOMAN.

I have conceited to have Luce married to this blunt gentleman, she mistaking him for Chartley; and Chartley shall marry thee, being a boy, and take thee for Luce. Will't not be excellent?

2ND LUCE.

Oh, super, super-excellent!

WISE-WOMAN.

Play but thy part as I'll act mine. I'll fit him with a wife, I warrant him.

2ND LUCE.

And a wife I'll warrant him.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—A Room in Sir HARRY'S House.

Enter Sir HARRY and TABER.

SIR HARRY.

Ha, then thou sawest them whispering with my daughter?

TABER.

I saw them, if it shall please you, not whisper, but—

SIR HARRY.

How then, thou knave!

TABER.

Marry, sir knight, I saw them in sad^[19] talk; but to say they were directly whispering, I am not able.

SIR HARRY.

Why, Taber, that sad talk was whispering.

TABER.

Nay, they did not greatly whisper, for I heard what was said, and what was said I have the wit to keep to myself.

SIR HARRY.

What said the unthrift, Taber? tell me, knave;
Tell me, good knave, what did the unthrift say?

TABER.

I am loth to be called in question about men and women's matters, but as soon as ever he saw your daughter I heard what was spoke.

SIR HARRY.

Here, sirrah, take thy quarter's wages afore-hand,
And tell me all their words, and what their greeting
Was at their first encounter; hold thine hand.

TABER.

Thanks, noble sir; and now I'll tell you. Your daughter being walking to take the air of the fields, and I before her, whom should we meet just in the nick—

SIR HARRY.

Just in the nick, man!

TABER.

In the highway I meant, sir.

SIR HARRY.

Ha, and what conference passed betwixt them, Taber?

TABER.

As well as my pipe can utter, you shall know, sir. This gentleman meeting with my young mistress full butt—imagine you were she, and I young Master Sencer; now there you come, and here I meet you; he comes in this manner, and puts off his hat in this fashion.

SIR HARRY.

Ay, but what said he?

TABER.

“Be with you,[\[20\]](#) fair gentlewoman;” and so goes quite away, and scarce so much as once looked back: and if this were language to offer to a young lady, judge you.

SIR HARRY.

But spake he nothing else?

TABER.

Nothing, as I am true.

SIR HARRY.

Why, man, all this was nothing.

TABER.

Yes, sir, it was as much as my quarter's wages afore-hand.

Enter SENCER, HARINGFIELD, and GRATIANA.

GRATIANA.

Here are two gentlemen, with great desire,
Crave conference with my father. Here he is:
Now, gallants, you may freely speak your minds.

SENCER.

Save you, sir! my name is Sencer; I am a Northamptonshire gentleman,
born to a thousand pound land by the year: I love your daughter, and I am
come to crave your good-will.

SIR HARRY.

Have you my daughter's, that you covet mine?

SENCER.

No, sir, but I hope in time I shall have.

SIR HARRY.

So hope not I, sir. Sir, my daughter's young,
And you a gentleman unknown. Sencer! ha, Sencer?
Oh, sir, your name I now remember well;
'Tis ranked 'mongst unthrifths, dicers, swaggerers, and drunkards:
Were not you brought before me, some month since,
For beating of the watch? by the same token,
I sent you to the Counter.[\[21\]](#)

SENCER.

I confess myself to have been in that action, but note the cause, sir: you
could not have pleased me so much, in giving me a piece of gold, as at
the same time to help me to that Counter.

SIR HARRY.

Why, sir, what cause had you to beat the watch,
And raise a midnight tumult in the streets?

SENCER.

Nay, but hear me, sweet Sir Harry. Being somewhat late at supper at the Mitre, the doors were shut at my lodging; I knocked at three or four places more; all were a-bed, and fast; inns, taverns, none would give me entertainment. Now, would you have had me despaired, and lain in the streets? No, I bethought me of a trick worth two of that, and presently devised, having at that time a charge of money about me, to be lodged, and safely too.

SIR HARRY.

As how, I pray you?

SENCER.

Marry, thus: I had knocked my heels against the ground a good while, knew not where to have a bed for love or money. Now, what did I, but, spying the watch, went and hit the constable a good souse on the ear, who provided me of a lodging presently? and the next day, being brought before your worship, I was then sent thither back again, where I lay three or four days without control.

SIR HARRY.

Oh, you're a gallant! Is that gentleman
A suitor too?

HARINGFIELD.

I am a suitor in my friend's behalf,
No otherwise. I can assure you, sir,
He is a gentleman descended well,
Derived from a good house, well qualified,
And well possessed; but that which most should move you,
He loves your daughter.

GRATIANA.

[*Aside.*] But were I to choose
Which of these two should please my fancy best,
I sooner should affect this gentleman,
For his mild carriage and his fair discourse,
Than my hot suitor. Ruffians I detest;

A smooth and square behaviour likes me most.

SENCER.

What say you to me, lady?

GRATIANA.

You had best ask my father what I should say.

SENCER.

Are you angry, sweet lady, that I asked your father's consent?

GRATIANA.

No; if you can get his consent to marry him, shall it displease me?

HARINGFIELD.

Indeed you therein much forget yourself,
To sound her father ere you tasted her.[\[22\]](#)
You should have first sought means for her goodwill,
And after compassed his.

SIR HARRY.

He can prevail with neither.—Gentlemen,
If you will come to revel, you are welcome;
If to my table, welcome; if to use me
In any grateful office, welcome too;
But, if you come as suitors, there's the door.

SENCER.

The door!

SIR HARRY.

I say the door.

SENCER.

Why, sir, tell not me of your door, nor going out of it. Your company is fair and good, and so is your daughter's; I'll stay here this twelvemonth, ere I'll offer to trouble your door.

SIR HARRY.

Sir, but you shall not.—Taber! where's that knave?

SENCER.

Why, sir, I hope you do not mean to make us dance, that you call for a tabor.

HARINGFIELD.

Nay, Master Sencer, do not urge the knight;
He is incensed now; choose a fitter hour,
And tempt his love in that. Old men are testy;
Their rage, if stood against, grows violent,
But, suffered and forborne, confounds itself.

SIR HARRY.

Where's Taber?

TABER. [*Coming forward.*]

At hand, noble master.

SIR HARRY.

Show them the door.

TABER.

That I will,—and take money too, if it please them.

SENCER.

Is thy name Taber?

TABER.

I am so yclept, sir.

SENCER.

And, Taber, are you appointed to give us Jack Drum's entertainment?[\[23\]](#)

TABER.

Why, sir, you do not play upon me.

SENCER.

Though I cannot, yet I have known an hare that could. But, knight, thou dost not forbid us thine house?

SIR HARRY.

Yes, and forewarn it too.

SENCER.

But, by thy favour, we may choose whether we will take any warning or no. Well, farewell, old knight! though thou forbid'st me thine house, I'll honour thee, and extol thee; and, though thou keep'st me from thy daughter, thou shalt not hinder me to love her and admire her, and, by thy favour, sometimes to see her. A cat may look at a king, and so may I at her. Give me thine hand, knight; the next time I come into thy company, thou shalt not only bid me welcome, but hire me to stay with thee, and thy daughter.

SIR HARRY.

When I do that enjoy my full consent
To marry Gratiana.

SENCER.

'Tis a match; strike me luck. Wife that may be, farewell; father-in-law that must be, adieu. Taber, play before my friend and I will dance after.

[Exeunt SENCER, HARINGFIELD and TABER.]

SIR HARRY.

When I receive thee gladly to mine house,
And wage thy stay, thou shalt have Gratiana,
Doubt not thou shalt. Here's a strange humourist
To come a-wooing. *[Re-enter TABER.]* Taber, are they gone?

TABER.

I have played them away, if it please your worship; and yonder at the door attends a schoolmaster; you sent for him, if you remember, to teach my little young master and mistress.

SIR HARRY.

A proper scholar; pray him to come near.

Enter Sir[\[24\]](#) *BONIFACE.*

SIR BONIFACE.

Eques honoratus, ave salutatus! non video quid est in tergo, sed salve, bona virgo.

SIR HARRY.

Sir, you may call me nicknames: if you love me,
Speak in your mother-tongue; or, at the least,
If learning be so much allied unto you,
That Latin unawares flows from your lips,
To make your mind familiar with my knowledge,
Pray utter it in English: what's your name?

SIR BONIFACE.

Sit faustum tibi omen.
I'll tell you my *nomen*.

SIR HARRY.

Will you tell it to no men?
I'll entertain none ere I know their names.
Nay, if you be so dainty of your name,
You are not for my service.

SIR BONIFACE.

Intende, vir nobilis.

SIR HARRY.

Not for twenty nobles:
Trust me, I will not buy your name so dear.

SIR BONIFACE.

O ignorantia! what it is to deal with stupidity? Sir Henry, Sir Henry, hear me one word: I see, *Preceptor legit, vos vero negligitis.*

TABER.

I think he saith we are a company of fools and nidgets;[\[25\]](#) but I hope you shall not find us such, Master Schoolmaster.

SIR HARRY.

Friend, friend, to cut off all vain circumstance,
Tell me your name, and answer me directly,
Plainly, and to my understanding too,
Or I shall leave you. Here's a deal of gibberish!

SIR BONIFACE.

Vir bone——

SIR HARRY.

Nay, nay, make me no bones,[\[26\]](#) but do't.

SIR BONIFACE.

Then, in plain vulgar English, I am called Sir Boniface Absee.

SIR HARRY.

Why, this is somewhat like, Sir Boniface!
Give me thine hand; thou art a proper man,
And in my judgment, a great scholar too.
What shall I give thee by the year?

SIR BONIFACE.

I'll trust, sir, to your generosity;
I will not bargain, but account myself,
Mille et mille modis, bound to you.

SIR HARRY.

I cannot leave my mills; they're farmed already:
The stipend that I give shall be in money.

TABER.

Sure, sir, this is some miller that comes to undermine you, in the shape of a schoolmaster.

GRATIANA.

You both mistake the scholar.

SIR HARRY.

I understand my English, that I know;
What's more than modern doth surpass my reach.
Sir Boniface, come to me two days hence,
You shall receive an answer; I have now
Matters of some import that trouble me,
Thou shouldst be else despatched.

TABER.

Sir Boniface, if you come to live in our house, and be a familist amongst us, I shall desire your better acquaintance; your name and my physiognomy should have some consanguinity, good Sir Boniface.

SIR BONIFACE.

Quomodo vales, quomodo vales.

TABER.

Go with you to the ale-house? I like the motion well; I'll make an excuse out of doors and follow you. I am glad yet, we shall have a good-fellow come into the house amongst us.

SIR BONIFACE.

Vale, vir magne.

SIR HARRY.

You shall not have me at Saint Magnes, my house is here in Gracious-street.

SIR BONIFACE.

I know it, sweet knight, I know it. Then, *virgo formosa et Domine gratiose valete.*

SIR HARRY.

Ay, in Gracious-street you shall hear of me, Sir Boniface.

[*Exit Sir BONIFACE.*]

He shall instruct my children; and to thee,

Fair Gratiana, read the Latin tongue.

TABER.

Who shall? Sir Bawdy-face?

SIR HARRY.

Sir Boniface, you fool.

TABER.

His name is so hard to hit on.

SIR HARRY.

Come, daughter, if things fall out as I intend,
My thoughts shall peace have, and these troubles end.

[Exeunt.]

ACT THE THIRD.

SCENE I.—*A Room in the Wise-woman's House.*

Enter 2nd LUCE, in woman's apparel, and the Wise-woman.

WISE-WOMAN.

Jack, thou art my boy.

2ND LUCE.

Mistress!

WISE-WOMAN.

I'll be a mother to thee, no mistress. Come, lad, I must have thee sworn to the orders of my house, and the secrets thereof.

2ND LUCE.

As I am an honest lad, I am yours to command. But, mistress, what mean all these women's pictures, hanged here in your withdrawing-room?

WISE-WOMAN.

I'll tell thee, boy—marry, thou must be secret. When any citizens or young gentlemen come hither, under a colour to know their fortunes, they look upon these pictures, and which of them they best like, she is ready with a wet finger.[\[27\]](#) Here they have all the furniture belonging to a private-chamber,—bed, bed-fellow, and all. But mum! thou knowest my meaning, Jack.

2ND LUCE.

But I see, coming and going, maids, or such as go for maids, some of them as if they were ready to lie down, sometimes two or three delivered in one night; then suddenly leave their brats behind them, and convey themselves into the city again:—what becomes of their children?

WISE-WOMAN.

Those be kitchen-maids, and chamber-maids, and sometimes good men's daughters, who, having caught a clap,[\[28\]](#) and growing near their time, get leave to see their friends in the country, for a week or so: then hither they come, and for a matter of money here they are delivered. I have a midwife or two belonging to the house, and one Sir Boniface, a deacon, that makes a shift to christen the infants; we have poor, honest, and secret neighbours, that stand for common gossips.[\[29\]](#) But dost not thou know this?

2ND LUCE.

Yes, now I do; but what after becomes of the poor infants?

WISE-WOMAN.

Why, in the night we send them abroad, and lay one at this man's door, and another at that, such as are able to keep them; and what after becomes of them, we inquire not. And this is another string to my bow.

2ND LUCE.

[Aside.] Most strange, that woman's brain should apprehend
Such lawless, indirect, and horrid means
For covetous gain! How many unknown trades
Women and men are free of, which they never
Had charter for!

But, mistress, are you so cunning as you make yourself? you can neither write nor read: what do you with those books you so often turn over?

WISE-WOMAN.

Why, tell[\[30\]](#) the leaves; for to be ignorant, and seem ignorant, what greater folly!

2ND LUCE.

[Aside.] Believe me, this is a cunning woman; neither hath she her name for nothing, who out of her ignorance can fool so many that think themselves wise.—But wherefore have you built this little closet close to the door, where sitting, you may hear every word spoken by all such as ask for you?

WISE-WOMAN.

True, and therefore I built it. If any knock, you must to the door and question them, to find what they come about,—if to this purpose, or to that. Now, they ignorantly telling thee their errand, which I, sitting in my closet, overhear, presently come forth, and tell them the cause of their coming, with every word that hath passed betwixt you in private; which they admiring, and thinking it to be miraculous, by their report I become thus famous.

2ND LUCE.

This is no trade, but a mystery; and, were I a wise-woman, as indeed I am but a foolish boy, I need not live by your service. But, mistress, we lose ourselves in this discourse: is not this the morning in which I should be married?

WISE-WOMAN.

Now, how had I forgot myself! Mistress Luce promised to be with me half an hour ago, but masked and disguised, and so shalt thou be too: here's a black veil to hide thy face against the rest come.

[2nd LUCE puts on the veil.]

Enter Sir BONIFACE.

SIR BONIFACE.

Sit tibi bona dies, salus et quies.

WISE-WOMAN.

Into the withdrawing-room, Sir Boniface.

SIR BONIFACE.

Without any compunction, I will make the conjunction. *[Exit.]*

WISE-WOMAN.

Now keep thy countenance, boy.

2ND LUCE.

Fear not me; I have as good a face in a mask as any lady in the land could wish to have. But to my heart,—he comes, or he comes not—now am I in

a pitiful perplexity, until I see the event of all.

WISE-WOMAN.

No more Jack now, but Mistress Luce.

2ND LUCE.

I warrant you, mistress.—That it happens so luckily, that my name should be Luce too, to make the marriage more firm!

Enter Young CHARTLEY disguised, and in a visard.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

My honey-sweet hag, where's Luce?

WISE-WOMAN.

Here, sweetheart, but disguised and veiled, as you are visarded.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

But what's the reason we are thus hoodwinked?

WISE-WOMAN.

No discovery of yourselves for a million! There's Sir Boniface within—shall he blab who you are? besides, there's a young heir that hath stolen a lord's daughter from the Court, and would not have their faces seen for a world. Cannot you be content to fare well, and keep your own counsel? And see, yonder they come.

Enter, severally, BOYSTER visarded and LUCE masked.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Gramercy, my sugar-candy sweet Trot!

WISE-WOMAN.

Mum, no more words.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

If the great heir and the young lady be so dainty of their complexions, they shall see, my sweet Luce, we can visard it with the best of them.

LUCE. [*Looking at BOYSTER.*]

That gentleman, by the wise-woman's description, should be Master Chartley.

BOYSTER.

That gallant wench, if my grannam fable not, should be Luce; but what be those other?

WISE-WOMAN.

You wrong me but to ask. Who but a young heir, and a lady of the Court? That's Luce; take her, and keep your promise.

BOYSTER.

Pocas palabras.[\[31\]](#)

WISE-WOMAN.

That's Chartley; take him, Luce.

LUCE.

But who be they?

WISE-WOMAN.

A lord and lady. Shall Sir Boniface stay?
Rather than so, strive who should lead the way.

[Exeunt CHARTLEY with 2nd LUCE, BOYSTER with LUCE.]

WISE-WOMAN.

Now, Jack my boy, keep thine own counsel and countenance, and I shall cry quittance with my young gallant. Well, by this time Sir Boniface is at his book. But because there is a mistake, known only to my boy and myself, the marriage shall be no sooner ended but I'll disturb them by some sudden outcry, and that too before they have leisure to unmask, and make known themselves one to another; for, if the deceit were known, I should fall into the danger of that young mad rascal. And now this double apprehension of the lord and the lady shall fetch me off from all. I know it is Sir Boniface's custom to make short work, and hath dispatched by this. And now, wise-woman, try if thou canst bestir thyself like to a mad-

woman.—Shift for yourselves! Warrants and pursuivants! Away!
warrants and pursuivants! shift for yourselves!

*Re-enter, as affrighted and amazed, Young CHARTLEY, BOYSTER, Sir
BONIFACE, LUCE, and 2nd LUCE.*

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

I'll take this way.

BOYSTER.

I this.

[Exeunt Young CHARTLEY and BOYSTER.]

SIR BONIFACE.

Curro, curris, cucurri: my cheeks are all murrey,[\[32\]](#) and I am gone in an
hurry. *[Exit.]*

LUCE.

O Heaven! what shall become of me?

2ND LUCE.

I know what shall become of me already.

WISE-WOMAN.

O sweet daughter, shift clothes with this lady. Nay, as thou lovest thy
credit and mine, change habits—*[They change their outer garments.]*—
So, if thou be'st taken in her garments, finding the mistake will let thee
pass; and should they meet her in thine, not knowing her, would no way
question her; and this prove to both your securities and my safety.

LUCE.

As fast as I can, good mother. So, madam, farewell. *[Exit.]*

2ND LUCE.

All happy joys betide you! *[Exit.]*

WISE-WOMAN.

Ha, ha! let me hold my sides, and laugh. Here were even a plot to make a play on, but that Chartley is so fooled by my boy Jack: well, he'll make a notable wag, I'll warrant him. All the jest will be, if Boyster should meet with him in Luce's habit, which he hath now on, he would think himself merely gulled and cheated; and should Chartley meet with Luce as she is now robed, he would be confident he had married her. Let me see how many trades have I to live by: first, I am a wise-woman, and a fortune-teller, and under that I deal in physic and fore-speaking, in palmistry, and recovering of things lost; next, I undertake to cure mad folks; then I keep gentlewomen lodgers, to furnish such chambers as I let out by the night; then I am provided for bringing young wenches to bed; and, for a need, you see I can play the match-maker.

She that is but one, and professeth so many,

May well be termed a wise-woman, if there be any. [*Exit.*]

SCENE II.—*Before the Wise-woman's House.*

Enter BOYSTER.

BOYSTER.

Why run away, and leave my wench behind? I'll back. What have warrants and pursuivants to do with me? with me! why should I budge? why should I wear mask or visard? If lords or ladies offend, let lords and ladies answer. Let me better bethink me. Why should I play at hoodman-blind?[\[33\]](#) Hum: why marry *in tenebris*? ha! is there no trick in it? If my grannam should make me a younger brother now, and, instead of Luce, pop me off with some broken commodity, I were finely served: most sure I am to be in for better and worse; but with whom, Heaven and my grannam knows.

Enter 2nd LUCE, half-dressed and masked.

2ND LUCE.

I am stolen out of doors, to see if I can meet my husband, with whom I purpose to make some sport, ere I suddenly disclose myself. What's he?

BOYSTER.

Heyday, what have we here? an hobberdehoy! Come hither, you.

2ND LUCE.

'Tis Mistress Luce's husband, I'll not leave him thus.

BOYSTER.

What art thou?

2ND LUCE.

Do you not know me?

BOYSTER.

That mask and robe I know.

2ND LUCE.

I hope so, or else I were in a woe[\[34\]](#) case.

BOYSTER.

That mask, that gown I married.

2ND LUCE.

Then you have no reason, but to enjoy both them and me too, and so you are like; I should be loth to divorce man and wife.

BOYSTER.

I am fooled. But what cracked ware are you, forsooth?

2ND LUCE.

I belong to the old gentlewoman of the house.

BOYSTER.

I'll set her house on fire. I am finely bobbed.[\[35\]](#)

2ND LUCE.

But I hope you will not bob me.

BOYSTER.

No, I'se warrant thee. What art thou? girl or boy?

2ND LUCE.

Both, and neither; I was a lad last night, but in the morning I was conjured into a lass; and, being a girl now, I shall be translated to a boy anon. Here's all I can at this time say for myself. Farewell. [*Exit.*]

BOYSTER.

Yes, and be hanged withal! O for some gunpowder to blow up this witch, this she-cat, this damned sorceress! Oh, I could tear her to fitters[\[36\]](#) with my teeth! Yet I must be patient, and put up all, lest I be made a jeer to such as know me. Fooled by a boy! Go to! of all the rest, the girl Luce must not know it. [*Exit.*]

Enter Young CHARTLEY and his Man, and LUCE, meeting.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

So, now am I the same man I was yesterday. Who can say I was disguised? or who can distinguish my condition now, or read in my face, whether I be a married man or a bachelor?

LUCE.

Who's that?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Luce?

LUCE.

Sweet husband, is it you?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

The news?

LUCE.

Never so frightened in my days.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

What's become of the lord and the lady?

LUCE.

The lord fled after you; the lady stayed,
Who, masked and half-unready, ran fast after
Her poor affrighted husband. Now all's quiet.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

This storm is then well past, and now convey yourself home as privately as you can; and see you make this known to none but your father.

LUCE.

I am your wife and servant. [*Exit.*]

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

The name of Luce hath been ominous to me: one Luce I should have married in the country, and, just the night before, a toy[37] took me in the head, and mounting my horse, I left capons, ducks, geese, poultry,

wildfowl, father, and bride, and all, and posted up to London, where I have ever since continued bachelor, till now. And now—

Enter GRATIANA in haste, a Serving-man before her, and TABER after her.

GRATIANA.

Nay, on, I prithee, fellow, on! my father will wonder where I have been visiting. Now, what had I forgot! Taber, there's money; go to the goldsmith's, bid him send me my fan, and make a quick return. On, fellow, on.

[Exeunt GRATIANA and Serving-man.]

TABER.

Her fan at the goldsmith's! now had I forgot to ask her his name, or his sign; but I will after to know. *[Exit.]*

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Sirrah, go call me back that serving-man,
And ask him what's the gentlewoman's name.

SERVING-MAN.

I shall. Ho, you, friend, you!

Re-enter TABER.

TABER.

Who's that calls?

SERVING-MAN.

'Twas I.

TABER.

Your business? You should be one, though not of my cognisance, yet of my condition,—a serving-creature, as I take it: pray what's your will with me?

SERVING-MAN.

Pray, sir, what might I call that gentlewoman, on whom you were attendant?

TABER.

You may call her what you please; but if you call her otherwise than in the way of honesty, you may perchance hear on't.

SERVING-MAN.

Nay, be not offended: I say, what do you call her?

TABER.

Why, sir, I call her as it shall best please me; sometimes young lady, sometimes young mistress; and what hath any man to do with that?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Are you so captious, sirrah? What's her name?
Speak, and be brief.

TABER.

Ay, marry, sir, you speak to purpose, and I can resolve you: her name is Gratiana. But all this while I have forgot my mistress' fan. [*Exit.*]

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Gratiana! oft have I heard of her, but saw her not till now: 'tis a pretty wench, a very pretty wench,—nay, a very, very, very pretty wench. But what a rogue am I, of a married man—nay, that have not been married this six hours, and to have my shittle-wits run a wool-gathering already! What would poor Luce say if she should hear of this? I may very well call her poor Luce, for I cannot presume of five pounds to her portion. What a coxcomb was I, being a gentleman, and well derived, to match into so beggarly a kindred! What needed I to have grafted in the stock of such a choke-pear, and such a goodly popering[[38](#)] as this to escape me! Escape me, said I? if she do, she shall do it narrowly. But I am married already, and therefore it is not possible, unless I should make away my wife, to compass her. Married! why, who knows it? I'll outface the priest, and then there is none but she and her father, and their evidence is not good in law; and if they put me in suit, the best is, they are poor, and cannot follow it. Ay, marry, sir, a man may have some credit by such a

wife as this. I could like this marriage well, if a man might change away his wife, still as he is a-weary of her, and cope^[39] her away like a bad commodity; if every new moon a man might have a new wife, that's every year a dozen. But this "Till death us do part" is tedious. I will go a-wooing to her, I will; but how shall I do for jewels and tokens? Luce hath mine in her custody, money and all. Tush, I'll juggle them from her well enough. See, here she comes.

Enter LUCE and her Father.

LUCE.

Here is my husband; I pray move him in it.

LUCE'S FATHER.

It toucheth both our reputations nearly;
For by his oft repair, now whilst the marriage
Is kept from public knowledge, your good name
May be by neighbours hardly censured of.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Thou'rt sad, thou'rt sad, Luce: what, melancholy already, ere thou hast had good cause to be merry, and knew'st what sport was!

LUCE.

I have great reason, when my name is tossed
In every gossip's mouth, and made a bye-word
Unto such people as it least concerns.
Nay, in my hearing, as they pass along,
Some have not spared to brand my modesty,
Saying, "There sits she whom young Chartley keeps:
There hath he entered late, betimes gone forth."
Where I with pride was wont to sit before,
I'm now with shame sent blushing from the door.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Alas, poor fool! I am sorry for thee, but yet cannot help thee, as I am a gentleman. Why, say, Luce, thou lovest now forty shillings worth of

credit, stay but a time, and it shall bring thee in a thousand pounds worth of commodity.

LUCE'S FATHER.

Son, son, had I esteemed my profit more
Than I have done my credit, I had now
Been many thousands richer; but you see,
Truth and good dealing bear an humble sail.
That little I enjoy, it is with quiet,
Got with good conscience, kept with good report;
And that I still shall labour to preserve.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

But do you hear me?

LUCE'S FATHER.

Nothing I'll hear that tends unto the ruin
Of mine or of my daughter's honesty.
Shall I be held a broker to lewd lust,
Now in my wane of years?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Will you but hear me?

LUCE'S FATHER.

Not in this case. I that have lived thus long,
Reported well, esteemed a welcome guest
At every burthened table, there respected,
Now to be held a pander to my daughter!
That I should live to this!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

But hark you, father!

LUCE'S FATHER.

A bawd to mine own child!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Father!

LUCE'S FATHER.

To my sweet Luce!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Father!

LUCE'S FATHER.

Deal with me like a son, then call me father.

I that have had the tongues of every man

Ready to crown my reputation,

The hands of all my neighbours to subscribe

To my good life, and such as could not write

Ready with palsied and unlettered fingers

To set their scribbling marks—

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Why, father-in-law!

LUCE'S FATHER.

Thou hadst a mother, Luce—'tis woe with me

To say thou hadst, but hast not; a kind wife,

And a good nurse she was: she, had she lived

To hear my name thus canvassed, and thus tossed,

Seven years before she died, I had been a widower

Seven years before I was. Heaven rest her soul!

She is in Heaven, I hope. [*He wipes his eyes.*]

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Why, so now, these be good words: I knew these storms would have a shower, and then they would cease. Now, if your anger be over, hear me.

LUCE'S FATHER.

Well, say on, son.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Stay but a month, 'tis but four weeks—nay, 'tis February, the shortest month of the year—and in that time I shall be at full age; and the land being entailed, my father can disinherit me of nothing. Is your spleen down now? Have I satisfied you? Well, I see you choleric hasty men are the kindest when all is done. Here's such wetting of handkerchiefs! he weeps to think of his wife; she weeps to see her father cry! Peace, fool! we shall else have thee claim kindred of the woman killed with kindness.
[\[40\]](#)

LUCE'S FATHER.

Well, son, my anger's past; yet I must tell you,
It grieves me that you should thus slight it off,
Concerning us in such a dear degree.
In private be it spoke, my daughter tells me
She's both a wife and maid.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

That may be helped.—Now, Luce, your father's pacified, will you be pleased? I would endure a quarter's punishment for thee, and wilt not thou suffer a poor month's penance for me? 'Tis but eight and twenty days, wench; thou shalt fare well all the time, drink well, eat well, lie well: come, one word of comfort at the latter end of the day.

LUCE.

Yours is my fame, mine honour, and my heart
Linked to your pleasure, and shall never part.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Gramercy, wench; thou shalt wear this chain no longer for that word; I'll multiply the links in such order that it shall have light to shine about thy neck oftener than it doth: this jewel—a plain Bristowe[\[41\]](#) stone, a counterfeit. How base was I, that coming to thee in the way of marriage, courted thee with counterfeit stones! Thou shalt wear right, or none. Thou hast no money about thee, Luce?

LUCE.

Yes, sir, I have the hundred pounds that you gave me to lay up last.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Fetch it.—[*Exit* LUCE.]—Let me see, how much branched[42] satin goes to a petticoat? and how much wrought velvet to a gown? then for a beaver for the city, and a black bag for the country: I'll promise her nothing, but if any such trifles be brought home, let her not thank me for them. [*Re-enter* LUCE *with the bag.*] Gramercy, Luce.—Nay, go in, Gravity and Modesty; ten to one but you shall hear of me ere you see me again.

LUCE'S FATHER.

I know you kind; impute my hasty language
Unto my rage, not me.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Why, do not I know you, and do not I know her? I doubt you'll wish shortly that I had never known either of you: now, what sayst thou, my sweet Luce?

LUCE.

My words are yours, so is my life: I am now
Part of yourself, so made by nuptial vow.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

What a pagan am I, to practise such villainy against this honest Christian! If Gratiana did not come into my thoughts, I should fall into a vein to pity her. But now that I talk of her, I have a tongue to woo her, tokens to win her; and that done, if I do not find a trick both to wear her and weary her, it may prove a piece of a wonder.—Thou seest, Luce, I have some store of crowns about me: there are brave things to be bought in the city; Cheapside and the Exchange afford variety and rarity. This is all I will say now, but thou mayst hear more of me hereafter. [*Exit.*]

LUCE.

Heaven speed you where you go, sir! Shall we in?
Though not from scandal, we live free from sin.

LUCE'S FATHER.

I'll in before. [*Exit.*]

Enter BOYSTER.

BOYSTER.

I am still in love with Luce, and I would know
An answer more directly. Fie, fie! this love
Hangs on me like an ague, makes me turn fool,
Coxcomb, and ass. Why should I love her, why?
A rattle-baby, puppet, a slight toy.
And now I could go to buffets with myself,
And cuff this love away. But see, that's Luce.

LUCE.

I cannot shun him, but I'll shake him oft.

BOYSTER.

Morrow.

LUCE.

As much to you.

BOYSTER.

I'll use few words—canst love me?

LUCE.

'Deed, sir, no.

BOYSTER.

Why, then, farewell; the way I came, I'll go. [*Exit.*

LUCE.

This is no tedious courtship; he's soon answered;
So should all suitors else be, were they wise;
For, being repulsed, they do but waste their days
In thankless suits, and superficial praise.

Re-enter BOYSTER.

BOYSTER.

Swear that thou wilt not love me.

LUCE.

Not, sir, for any hate I ever bare you,
Or any foolish pride or vain conceit,
Or that your feature doth not please mine eye,
Or that you are not a brave gentleman,
But for concealèd reasons I am forced
To give you this cold answer, and to swear
I must not: then with patience pray forbear.

BOYSTER.

Even farewell then. [*Exit.*

LUCE.

The like to you; and, save your hopes in me,
Heaven grant you your best wishes! All this strife
Will end itself, when I am known a wife. [*Exit.*

ACT THE FOURTH.

SCENE I.—*A Room in Sir HARRY's House.*

Enter Sir HARRY, HARINGFIELD, GRATIANA, with others.

SIR HARRY.

I am satisfied, good Master Haringfield,
Touching your friend; and since I see you have left
His dangerous company, I limit^[43] you
To be a welcome guest unto my table.

HARINGFIELD.

You have been always noble.

Enter TABER.

SIR HARRY.

Taber, the news with thee?

TABER.

May it please thee, right worshipful, to understand that there are some at the gate who dance a turn or two without, and desire to be admitted to speak with you within.

SIR HARRY.

The scholar, is it not?

TABER.

Nay, sir, there are two scholars, and they are spouting Latin one against the other; and in my simple judgment the stranger is the better scholar, and is somewhat too hard for Sir Boniface: for he speaks louder, and that you know is ever the sign of the most learning, and he also hath a great desire to serve your worship.

SIR HARRY.

Two scholars! my house hath not place for two.
Thus it shall be. Taber, admit them both;
We, though unlearned, will hear them two dispute,
And he that of the two seems the best read
Shall be received, the other quite cashiered.

HARINGFIELD.

In that you show but justice: in all persons
Merit should be regarded.

*Enter TABER, ushering in Sir BONIFACE, and SENCER, disguised like a
pedant.*

SIR BONIFACE.

Venerabiles magistri, absint vobis capistri.

SENCER.

Et tu, domine calve, iterum atque iterum salve. Amo amas amavi. Sweet
lady, Heaven save ye!

SIR HARRY.

This approves him to be excellent, but I thank my breeding I understand
not a word.
You tongue-men, you whose wealth lies in your brains,
Not in your budgets, hear me. Be it known,
My house affords room for one schoolmaster,
But not for more; and I am thus resolved:
Take you that side, gentle Sir Boniface,
And, sir, possess you that.
He of you two in arguing proves the best,
To him will I subscribe. Are you agreed?

SIR BONIFACE.

Nec animo, nec corde, nec utroque.

SENCER.

No more of that *nec corde*. Noble knight, he wishes you *nec corde*; think of that.

SIR HARRY.

A cord about my neck, Sir Boniface!
Speak, do you use me well?

SIR BONIFACE.

Domine, cur rogas?

SENCER.

Is this to be endured,—to call a knight
Cur, rogue and ass?

SIR HARRY.

I find myself abused.

HARINGFIELD.

Yet patience, good Sir Harry, and hear more.
Pray, Sir Boniface, of what university were you of?

SIR BONIFACE.

I was student in Brazenose.

HARINGFIELD.

A man might guess so much by your pimples.
And of what place were you?

SENCER.

Petrus dormit securus; I was, sir, of Peterhouse.[\[44\]](#)

SIR BONIFACE.

Natus eram in Woxford, and I proceeded[\[45\]](#) in Oxford.

SENCER.

Est mihi bene nostrum, thou wouldst say, in Gotham; for my part, Sir Harry, I can read service and marry, *Que genus et flexum*, though I go in Genes[\[46\]](#) fustian; *scalpellum et charta*, I was not brought up at plough

and cart; I can teach *Qui mihi*, and neither laugh nor tee-hee; *sed as in presenti*, if your worship at this present, *Iste, ista, istud*, will do me any good, to give me *legem pone* in gold or in money, *Piper atque papaver*, I'll deserve it with my labour.

HARINGFIELD.

But when go you to dispute?

SIR BONIFACE.

Nominativo hic prediculus, his words are most ridiculous; but *tu* thou, *qui* the which, deridest those that be rich, *construe hanc sententiam*, construe me this sentence: *Est modus in rebus, sunt certi denique fines*.

SENCER.

Est modus in rebus, there is mud in the rivers; *sunt certi denique fines*, and certain little fishes.

SIR HARRY.

I warrant you he hath his answer ready.

SIR BONIFACE.

Dii boni boni.

HARINGFIELD.

He'll give you more bones than those to gnaw on, Sir Boniface.

SENCER.

Kartere Moosotropos poluphiltate phile poetatis Tes Logikes retoon, ouch elachiste sophoon. That is as much as to say, in our *materna lingua*, I will make you, Sir Boniface, confess yourself an ass in English, speak open and broad words, for want of Latin, and *denique* entreat me to resolve such questions as I shall ask you in our modern tongue.

SIR HARRY.

Confess himself an ass? speak obscene words?
After entreat thee to resolve thy questions?
Do that; possess the place.

SENCER.

Di do and dum: no more words but mum:

SIR BONIFACE.

Noble Sir Harry, *numquam sic possit?*

SIR HARRY.

Sir Boniface is sick already and calls for a posset; no marvel, being so threatened.

SENCER.

You, Boniface, decline me I am a no after the first conjugation, *amo amavi, vocito vocitavi, Titubo Titubavi?*

SIR BONIFACE.

I am not the preceptor to a pupil,
But can decline it; mark, Sir Timothy.
I am a no.

SENCER.

Bene bene.

SIR BONIFACE.

I am an as.

SENCER.

Most true, most true, *vos estis, ut ego sum testis*, that what he confessed is as true as the *pestis*.

SIR HARRY.

This scholar works by magic; he hath made him confess himself an ass.

SIR BONIFACE.

Per has meas manus, vir, tu es insanus.

SENCER.

I'll make him fret worse yet. Sir Boniface, *quid est grammatica?*

SIR BONIFACE.

Grammatica est ars.

SIR HARRY.

Fie, fie! no more of these words, good Sir Boniface.

SENCER.

Attend again, proceed me with this verse of reverend Cato: *Si deus est animus.*

SIR BONIFACE.

Nobis ut carmina dicunt.

TABER.

Di—— quotha! out on him for a beastly man!

SIR HARRY.

I would not have him teach my children so for more than I am worth.

SIR BONIFACE.

O! but reverend Sir Harry, you must *subaudi*.

SIR HARRY.

I'll never be so bawdy whilst I live, nor any of mine, I hope.

SIR BONIFACE.

O! *Propria quæ maribus.*

SIR HARRY.

Ay, Boniface, it is those marrow-bones
That make you talk so broadly!

SIR BONIFACE.

Venerabilis vir, homo ille est ebrius.

SIR HARRY.

What doth he mean by that?

SENCER.

He saith I can speak Hebrew.

SIR HARRY.

I believe't:
But if Sir Boniface still con these lessons,
He'll speak the French tongue perfect.

SENCER.

Now to the last; I'll task Sir Boniface
But with an easy question. Tell me, sir,
What's Latin for this earth?

SIR BONIFACE.

Facile and easy, more fit for the pupil than the preceptor. What's Latin for this earth? *Tellus*.

SENCER.

Tell you? no, sir, it belongs to you to tell me.

SIR BONIFACE.

I say *tellus* is Latin for the earth.

SENCER.

And I say, I will not tell you what is Latin for the earth, unless you yield me victor.

SIR HARRY.

You have no reason: good Sir Timothy,
The place is yours.

HARINGFIELD.

He hath deserved it well.

SENCER.

But I'll deserve it better: why, this fellow
Is frantic; you shall hear me make him speak
Idly and without sense. I'll make him say
His nose was husband to a Queen.

[*He whispers* Sir HARRY.]

SIR HARRY.

Sir Timothy, not possible.

TABER.

He will not speak it for shame.

SENCER.

That you shall hear. Magister Boniface.

SIR BONIFACE.

Quid ais, domine Timothy?

SENCER.

Who was Pasiphe's husband, Queen of Crete?

SIR BONIFACE.

Who knows not that? Why, Minos was her husband.

SENCER.

That his nose was; did I not tell you so?

SIR BONIFACE.

I say that Minos was.

SENCER.

That his nose was—ha, ha!

SIR HARRY.

I'll not believe it.—

Sir Boniface, there are a brace of angels;

You are not for my turn. Sir Timothy,

You are the man shall read unto my daughter

The Latin tongue, in which I am ignorant.

Confess yourself an ass; speak bawdy words;

And after to talk idly! Hence, away!

You shall have my good word, but not my pay.

SIR BONIFACE.

Opus est usus; Sir Timothy, you abuse us.
I swear by a noun, had I thy hose down,
Qui, quæ, quod, I would so smoke thee with the rod,
Ille, illa, illud, until I fetched blood.
But, *nobiles vaiete*, remain in *quiete*.

[*Exeunt* Sir BONIFACE *and* TABER.]

SIR HARRY.

Sir Timothy, there is some gold in earnest,
I like you well; take into your tuition
My daughter Gratiana. [*Re-enter* TABER.] The news, Taber?

TABER.

Of another gallant, noble sir, that pretends to have business both with you
and my mistress.

SIR HARRY.

Admit him.

Enter Young CHARTLEY *very gallant, with* GRATIANA.

TABER.

Lusty Juventus, [\[47\]](#) will it please you to draw near?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Noble knight, whilst you peruse that [*Hands* Sir HARRY *a letter*], sweet
lady, tell me how you like this? [*Kisses* GRATIANA.]

GRATIANA.

You press so suddenly upon me, sir,
I know not what to answer.

SENCER.

[*Aside.*] Mad Chartley! what makes Desperation here?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

To the word wooer let me add the name speeder; my father hath written to your father, and the cause of his writing at this present is to let you understand that he fears you have lived a maid too long; and therefore, to prevent all diseases incident to the same, as the green sickness and others, he sent me, like a skilful physician, to take order with you against all such maladies. If you will not credit me, list but how fervently my father writes in my behalf.

SIR HARRY.

[*Reads.*] “He is my only son, and she, I take it, your only daughter. What should hinder then to make a match between them?” Well, ’tis well, ’tis good, I like it. “I will make her jointure three hundred pounds a year.”

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

How say you by that, sweet lady? three hundred pounds a year, and a proper man to boot?

SIR HARRY.

All’s good, I like it; welcome, Master Chartley.
Thou, Gratiana, art no child of mine
Unless thou bidst him welcome. This I presume
To be your father’s hand?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

[*Aside.*] But I’ll be sworn he never writ it.

SIR HARRY.

And this his seal at arms?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Or else I understand it very poorly. But, lady,
In earnest of further acquaintance, receive this chain,
These jewels, hand and heart.

SIR HARRY.

Refuse no chain nor jewels, heart nor hand,
But in exchange of these bestow thyself,
Thine own dear self, upon him.

GRATIANA.

Myself on him, whom I till now ne'er saw?
Well, since I must, your will's to me a law.

SENCER.

Nay, then, 'tis time to speak. Shall I stand here waiting like a coxcomb,
and see her given away before my face? Stay your hand, Sir Harry; and
let me claim my promise.

SIR HARRY.

My promise I'll perform, Sir Timothy;
You shall have all your wages duly paid.

SENCER.

I claim fair Gratiana by your promise.
No more Sir Timothy, but Sencer now.
You promised me when you received my service,
And with your liberal hand did wage my stay,
To endow me freely with your daughter's love.
That promise now I claim.

SIR HARRY.

Mere cozenage, knavery:
I tied myself to no conditions
In which such guile is practised. Come, son Chartley:
To cut off all disasters incident
To these proceedings, we will solemnise
These nuptial rites with all speed possible.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Farewell, good Sir Timothy; farewell, learned Sir Timothy.

[Exeunt all but SENCER.]

SENCER.

Why, and farewell, learned Sir Timothy.
For now Sir Timothy and I am two:
Boast on, brag on, exalt, exalt thyself,

Swim in a sea of pleasure and content
Whilst my bark suffers wreck! I'll be revenged.
Chartley, I'll cry *vindicta* for this scorn;
Next time thou goest, it must be with thy horn. [*Exit.*

SCENE II.—*The Street outside the Goldsmith's Shop.*

Enter BOYSTER.

BOYSTER.

I am mad, and know not at what;
I could swagger, but know not with whom;
I am at odds with myself, and know not why:
I shall be pacified, and cannot tell when;
I would fain have a wife, but cannot tell where;
I would fasten on Luce, but cannot tell how.
How; where; when; why; whom; what.
Feeding sure makes me lean, and fasting fat.

Enter LUCE and JOSEPH.

LUCE.

Not all this while once see me!

JOSEPH.

His occasions
Perhaps enforce his absence.

LUCE.

His occasions!
Unless he find occasion of new love,
What could enforce such absence from his spouse?
Am I grown foul and black since my espousals?
It should not seem so; for the shop is daily
Customed with store of chapmen, such as come
To cheapen love. O no, I am myself!
But Chartley he is changed.

JOSEPH.

You know that gentleman.

LUCE.

Escape him if thou canst.

BOYSTER.

He cannot. I arrest you.

LUCE.

At whose suit?

BOYSTER.

Not at mine own, that's dashed; I love thee not.
Thou art a Spaniard, gipsy, a mere blackamoor:
Again I say I love thee not.

LUCE.

A blackamoor, a gipsy!
Sure I am changed indeed, and that's the cause
My husband left me so; this gentleman
Once termed me beautiful. How look I, Joseph?

JOSEPH.

As well as e'er you did—fat, fresh, and fair.

BOYSTER.

You lie, boy; pocket that, and now be gone.

JOSEPH.

And what shall then become of my mistress?

BOYSTER.

I'll wait upon your mistress.

LUCE.

I know you will not wait on such a gipsy.

BOYSTER.

Yes, Luce, on such a gipsy. Boy, *abi, abi*.

JOSEPH.

Abide, sir! you need not fear that; I have no purpose to leave her.

BOYSTER.

Now you are going to the wedding-house.
You are bid to be a bridesmaid, are you not?

LUCE.

What wedding, sir, or whose?

BOYSTER.

Why, Chartley's. Luce, hath he been thy friend so long,
And would not bid thee to wait on his bride?
Why look'st thou red and pale, and both, and neither?

LUCE.

To Master Chartley's bridals? Why, to whom
Should he be married?

BOYSTER.

To Grace of Gracious-street.

LUCE.

To Gratiana!
Beshrew you, sir, you do not use me well,
To buzz into mine ears these strange untruths:
I tell you, sir, 'tis as impossible
They two should match, as Earth and Heaven to meet.

BOYSTER.

You'll not believe it? Pray then hark within
The nuptial music echoing to their joys.
But you give credit to no certainties:
I told you but a tale, a lie, a fable,
A monstrous, a notorious idle untruth—
That you were black, and that I loved you not—
And you could credit that!

[*Enter Sir HARRY, HARINGFIELD, Young CHARTLEY leading GRATIANA by
the arm, TABER, and Attendants.*]

Who's tell-troth now?
Know you that man, or know you that fine virgin
Whom by the arm he leads?

LUCE.

I'll not endure't.—Heaven give you joy, sir!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

I thank you. Luce!

[She faints.]

SIR HARRY.

Look to the maid; she faints.

[BOYSTER holds her up.]

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Grace, come not near her, Grace.
Father, keep off; on, gentlemen, apace.
She's troubled with the falling sickness, for
Oft hath she fallen before me.

SIR HARRY.

Nay, if it be no otherwise, on, gentlemen,
Let those with her strive to recover her.
Keep off; the disease is infectious.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

If it were in a man, it were nothing, but the falling sickness in a woman is dangerous. *[Enter LUCE's Father.]* My tother father-in-law! Now shall I be utterly shamed. If he assure to know me, I'll outface him.

LUCE'S FATHER.

Son, you're well met.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

How, fellow!

LUCE'S FATHER.

I cry you mercy, sir.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

No harm done, friend, no harm done.

[*Exeunt* Sir HARRY, HARINGFIELD, Young CHARTLEY, *and* GRATIANA.]

LUCE'S FATHER.

If he, he could not but have known me there,
Yet he was wondrous like him.

BOYSTER.

How cheer you, Luce? whence grew this passion?

LUCE.

Pardon me, sir, I do not know myself:
I am apt to swoond, and now the fit is passed me.
I thank you for your help. Is Master Chartley
Vanished so soon?

BOYSTER.

Yes; and to supply his place, see where thy father comes.

LUCE'S FATHER.

He hath not such a suit; besides, this gallant
Led by the arm a bride, a lusty bride!
How much might I have wronged the gentleman
By craving his acquaintance! This it is
To have dim eyes. Why looks my daughter sad?—
I cry you mercy, sir; I saw not you.

BOYSTER.

I would I had not seen you at this time neither. Farewell. [*Exit.*]

LUCE.

If he be gone, then let me vent my grief.
Father, I am undone!

LUCE'S FATHER.

Forbid it, Heaven!

LUCE.

Disgraced, despised, discarded, and cast off.

LUCE'S FATHER.

How, mine own child?

LUCE.

My husband, O my husband!

LUCE'S FATHER.

What of him?

LUCE.

Shall I the shower of all my grief at once
Pour out before you? Chartley, once my husband,
Hath left me to my shame. Him and his bride
I met within few minutes.

LUCE'S FATHER.

Sure 'twas they;
I met them too: 'twas he; base villain, Jew!
I'll to the wedding board, and tell him so:
I'll do't as I am a man.

LUCE.

Be not so rash.

LUCE'S FATHER.

I'll live and die upon him;
He's a base fellow, so I'll prove him too.
Joseph, my sword!

LUCE.

This rashness will undo us.

LUCE'S FATHER.

I'll have my sword;
It hath been twice in France, and once in Spain,
With John-a-Gaunt; when I was young like him
I had my wards, and foins, and quarter-blows,
And knew the way into St. George's Fields[48]
Twice in a morning. Tuttle, Finsbury,
I knew them all. I'll to him: where's my sword?

LUCE.

Or leave this spleen, or you will overthrow
Our fortunes quite; let us consult together
What we were best to do.

LUCE'S FATHER.

I'll make him play at leap-frog! Well, I hear thee.

LUCE.

I cannot prove our marriage; it was secret,
And he may find some cavil in the law.

LUCE'S FATHER.

I'll to him with no law, but Stafford law.[49]
I'll ferret the false boy—nay, on, good Luce.

LUCE.

Part of your spleen if you would change to counsel,
We might revenge us better.

LUCE'S FATHER.

Well, I hear thee.

LUCE.

To claim a public marriage at his hands
We want sufficient proof, and then the world
Will but deride our folly, and so add
Double disgrace unto my former wrong.
To law with him—he hath a greater purse,

And nobler friends. How then to make it known?

LUCE'S FATHER.

Is this his damasked kirtle fringed with gold,
His black bag, and his beaver? 'Tis well yet
I have a sword.

LUCE.

And I have a project in my brain begot,
To make his own mouth witness to the world
My innocence, and his incontinence.
Leave it to me, I'll clear myself from blame,
Though I the wrong, yet he shall reap the shame.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE III.—*Outside the Wise-woman's House.*

Enter SENCER like a Serving-man.

SENCER.

Now or never, look about thee, Sencer: to-morrow is the marriage day, which to prevent lies not within the compass of my apprehension; therefore I have thus disguised myself, to go to the looming woman's, the fortune-teller's, the anything, the nothing. This over-against Mother Redcap's is her house; I'll knock.

Enter 2nd LUCE in Boy's clothes.

2ND LUCE.

Who's there? What would you have?

SENCER.

I would speak with the wise gentlewoman of the house.

2ND LUCE.

Oh, belike you have lost somewhat.

SENCER.

You are in the wrong, sweet youth.

2ND LUCE.

I am somewhat thick of hearing; pray speak out.

SENCER.

I say I have not lost anything, but wit and time, and neither of those she can help me to.

2ND LUCE.

Then you belike are crossed in love, and come to know what success you shall have.

SENCER.

Thou hast hit it, sweet lad; thou hast hit it.

2ND LUCE.

What is it you say, sir?

SENCER.

Thou hast hit it.

2ND LUCE.

I pray come in; I'll bring you to my mistress.

[Exeunt.

Enter LUCE and JOSEPH.

LUCE.

This is the house; knock, Joseph; my business craves dispatch.

JOSEPH.

Now am I as angry as thou art timorous; and now to vent on the next thing I meet—Oh, 'tis the door. *[Knocks.*

Re-enter 2nd LUCE.

2ND LUCE.

Who's there? What are you?

LUCE.

A maid and a wife.

2ND LUCE.

And that would grieve any wench to be so; I know that by myself, not Luce.

LUCE.

Boy, where's your mistress?

2ND LUCE.

In some private talk with a gentleman. I'll fetch her to you presently.
[Exit.]

LUCE.

If she and you see me not, I am but dead;
I shall be made a by-word to the world,
The scorn of women, and my father's shame.

Enter the Wise-woman and SENCER, followed by 2nd LUCE.

WISE-WOMAN.

You tell me your name is Sence; I knew it before: and that Chartley is to be married, I could have told it you.

2ND LUCE.

Married to-morrow,—O me!

SENCER.

Ay, but you tell me that Chartley before to-morrow shall be disappointed of his wife; make that good, thou shalt have twenty angels.

WISE-WOMAN.

I'll do't: stand aside; I'll have but a word or two with this gentlewoman, and I am for you presently.

LUCE.

O mother, mother!

[They whisper.]

2ND LUCE.

My husband marry another wife to-morrow! O changeable destiny! no sooner married to him, but instantly to lose him! Nor doth it grieve me so much that I am a wife, but that I am a maid too; to carry one of them well is as much as any is bound to do, but to be tied to both is more than flesh and blood can endure.

WISE-WOMAN.

Well, trust to me, and I will set all things straight.

Enter BOYSTER.

BOYSTER.

Where's this witch, this hag, this beldam, this wizard? And have I found thee!—thus then will I tear, mumble, and maul thee!

WISE-WOMAN.

Help, help!—an if you be a gentleman!

SENCER.

Forbear this rudeness; he that touches her,
Draws against me.

BOYSTER.

Against you, sir! apply thou; [\[50\]](#) that shall be tried.

ALL.

Help, help! part them, help!

SENCER.

With patience hear her speak.

BOYSTER.

Now, trot, now, grannam, what canst thou say for thyself?—What, Luce here! Be patient, and put up thou; she must not see the end.

SENCER.

Then truce of all sides; if we come for counsel,
Let us with patience hear it.

LUCE.

Then first to me.

WISE-WOMAN.

You would prevent young Chartley's marriage? you shall: hark in your ear. [*Whispers.*]

LUCE.

It pleaseth me.

WISE-WOMAN.

You forestall Gratiana's wedding? 'tis but thus. [*Whispers.*

SENCER.

I'll do't.

WISE-WOMAN.

You would enjoy Luce as your wife, and lie with her to-morrow night?
Hark in your ear. [*Whispers.*

BOYSTER.

Fiat!

WISE-WOMAN.

Away! you shall enjoy him, you are married, Luce, away! you shall see
Chartley discarded from Gratiana. Sencer, begone! And if I fail in any of
these or the rest, I lay myself open to all your displeasures.

BOYSTER.

Farewell till soon!

WISE-WOMAN.

You know your meeting-place.

ALL.

We do.

WISE-WOMAN.

You shall report me wise and cunning too.

[*Exeunt all except 2nd LUCE.*

2ND LUCE.

I'll add one night more to the time I have said;
I have not many, I hope, to live a maid. [*Exit.*

SCENE IV.—A Room in Sir HARRY's House.

Enter Sir BONIFACE, and TABER carrying a trencher of broken meat and a napkin.

TABER.

Fie, fie, what a time of trouble is this! To-morrow is my mistress to be married, and we serving-men are so puzzled.

SIR BONIFACE.

The dinner's half done, and before I say grace,
And bid the old knight and his guest proface.[\[51\]](#)
A medicine from your trencher, good Master Taber,
As good a man as e'er was Sir Saber:
Well, think it no shame: men of learning and wit
Say study gets a stomach; friend Taber, a bit.

TABER.

Lick clean, good Sir Boniface, and save the scraper a labour.

Enter SENCER like a Serving-man.

SIR BONIFACE.

But soft, let me ponder:
Know you him that comes yonder?

TABER.

Most heartily welcome; would you speak with any here?

SENCER.

Pray is the young gentleman of the house at leisure?

TABER.

Mean you the bridegroom, Master Chartley?

SENCER.

I have a letter for him. You seem to be a gentleman yourself; acquaint him with my attendance, and I shall rest yours in all good offices.

TABER.

Sir Boniface, pray keep the gentleman company. I will first acquaint your lips with the virtue of the cellar. *[Exit]*.

SIR BONIFACE.

Adesdem, come near, and taste of our beer.
Welcome, *sine dole*, for *puntis te vole*.

SENCER.

When I taste of your liquor,
Gramercy, Master Vicar.

Re-enter TABER with a bowl of beer and a napkin.

TABER.

Most heartily welcome: your courtesy, I beseech you; ply it off, I entreat you. Pray, Sir Boniface, keep the gentleman company, till I acquaint my young master with his business. *[Exit]*.

SIR BONIFACE.

Taber, I shall *beso las manus*.[\[52\]](#)

[They dissemble one to another.]

SENCER.

A vostre servitor.

Enter HARINGFIELD.

HARINGFIELD.

Hey! what art thou?

SENCER.

A hanger-on, if it please you.

HARINGFIELD.

And I a shaker-off: I'll not bear your gallows;
You shall not hang on me.

[*Enter Young CHARTLEY with his napkin as from dinner.*]

Oh, Master Bridegroom!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Gentlemen, the ladies call upon you to dance; they will be out of measure displeased, if, dinner being done, you be not ready to lead them a measure.

HARINGFIELD.

Indeed, women love not to be scanted of their measure.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Fie, Sir Boniface! have you forgot yourself? Whilst you are in the hall, there's never a whetstone for their wits in the parlour.

SIR BONIFACE.

I will enter and set an edge upon their ingenies.

[*Exeunt Sir BONIFACE and HARINGFIELD.*]

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

[*To SENCER, who hands him a letter.*] To me, sir! from whom? A letter! To her "most dear, most loving, most kind friend Master Chartley, these be delivered." Sure from some wench or other. I long to know the content.

SENCER.

[*Aside.*] Now to cry quittance with you for my "farewell, learned Sir Timothy."

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Good news, as I live! there's for thy pains, my good Sir Pandarus.[\[53\]](#) Hadst thou brought me word my father had turned up his heels, thou couldst scarcely have pleased me better. [*Reads.*] "Though I disclaim the name of wife, of which I account myself altogether unworthy, yet let me claim some small interest in your love. This night I lie at the house where we were married—the Wise-Woman's I mean—where my maidenhead is

to be rifled: bid fair for it, and enjoy it; see me this night or never. So may you, marrying Gratiana, and loving me, have a sweet wife and a true friend. This night or never. Your *quondam* wife, hereafter your poor sweetheart, no other, Luce.” So, when I am tired with Gratiana, that is when I am past grace with her, I can make my rendezvous. I’ll not slip this occasion, nor sleep till I see her. Thou art an honest lad, and mayst prove a good pimp in time. Canst thou advise me what colour^[54] I may have to compass this commodity?

SENCER.

Sir, she this night expects you, and prepares a costly banquet for you.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

I’ll go, although the devil and mischance look big.

SENCER.

Feign some news that such a piece of land is fallen to you, and you must instantly ride to take possession of it; or, which is more probable, cannot you persuade them you have received a letter that your father lies a-dying?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

You rogue, I would he did; but the name of that news is called “too good to be true.”

SENCER.

And that if ever you will see him alive, you must ride post into the country?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Enough: if ever I prove knight-errant thou shalt be mine own proper squire. For this, thou hast fitted me with a plot. Do but wait here; note how I will manage it.—Taber, my horse, for I must ride to-night.

Re-enter TABER.

TABER.

To-night, sir!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

So tell my bride and father: I have news that quite confounds my senses.

[*Exit* TABER.]

Enter Sir HARRY, GRATIANA, *and* HARINGFIELD.

GRATIANA.

How, ride to-night! the marriage day to-morrow,
And all things well provided for the feast!
Oh, tell me, sweet, why do you look so pale?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

My father, O my father!

GRATIANA.

What of him?

SIR HARRY.

What of your father, son?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

If ever I will hear his agèd tongue
Preach to me counsel, or his palsy hand
Stroke my wild head and bless me, or his eyes
Drop tear by tear, which they have often done
At my misgoverned rioting youth—
What should I more?—if ever I would see
That good old man alive—Oh, oh!

SENCER.

[*Aside.*] Go thy ways, for thou shalt ha't.

GRATIANA.

But do you mean to ride?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Ay, Grace, all this night.

SENCER.

[*Aside.*] Not all the night without alighting, sure:
You'll find more in't than to get up and ride.

HARINGFIELD.

The gentleman's riding-boots and spurs. Why, Taber!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Nay, Grace, now's no time to stand on scrupulous parting. Knewest thou my business—

SENCER.

[*Aside.*] As she shall know it.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

And how I mean this night to toil myself—

SENCER.

[*Aside.*] Marry hang, you brock[\[55\]](#)!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Thou wouldst bemoan my travel.

SENCER.

[*Aside.*] I know 'twould grieve her.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

You, father, Grace, good Master Haringfield,
You, sir, and all, pray for me, gentlemen,
That in this dark night's journey I may find
Smooth way, sweet speed, and all things to my mind.

SIR HARRY.

We'll see my son take horse.

GRATIANA.

But I will stay:
I want the heart to see him post away.

[*Exeunt* Young CHARTLEY, Sir HARRY *and* HARINGFIELD.

SENCER.

Save you, gentlewoman! I have a message to deliver to one Mistress Gratiana; this should be the knight's house, her father.

GRATIANA.

It is: the message that you have to her
You may acquaint me with, for I am one
That knows the inside of her thoughts.

SENCER.

Are you the lady?

GRATIANA.

Sir, I am the poor gentlewoman.

SENCER.

There is a cunning woman dwells not far,
At Hogsdon, lady, famous for her skill.
Besides some private talk that much concerns
Your fortunes in your love, she hath to show you,
This night, if it shall please you walk so far
As to her house, an admirable suit
Of costly needlework, which if you please
You may buy under-rate for half the value
It cost the making; about six o'clock
You may have view thereof, but otherwise,
A lady that hath craved the sight thereof
Must have the first refusal.

GRATIANA.

I'll not fail her.
My husband being this day rid from home,
My leisure fitly serves me.

SENCER.

Thank you, mistress. At six o'clock.

GRATIANA.

I will not fail the hour. [*Exit.*]

SENCER.

Now to Sir Harry; his is the next place,
To meet at Hogsdon his fair daughter Grace. [*Exit.*

ACT THE FIFTH.

SCENE I.—*A Street near Sir HARRY'S House.*

Enter Old Master CHARTLEY *and three or four* Serving-men.

OLD CHARTLEY.

Good Heaven! this London is a stranger grown,
And out of my acquaintance; this seven years
I have not seen Paul's steeple, or Cheap Cross.[\[56\]](#)

1ST SERVING-MAN.

Sir—

OLD CHARTLEY.

Hast thou not made inquiry for my son?

1ST SERVING-MAN.

Yes, sir, I have asked about everywhere for him, but cannot hear of him.

OLD CHARTLEY.

Disperse yourselves; inquire about the taverns, ordinaries, bowl-alleys,
tennis-courts, gaming-houses; for there, I fear, he will be found.

1ST SERVING-MAN.

But where shall we hear of your worship again?

OLD CHARTLEY.

At Grace Church by the Conduit, near Sir Harry.
But stay, leave off a while your bootless search.
Had e'er man such a wild brain to his sorrow,
Of such small hope, who, when he should have married
A fair, a modest, and a virtuous maid,
Rich and revenued well, and even the night
Before the marriage day took horse, rode thence,

Whither Heaven knows? Since the distracted virgin
Hath left her father's house, but neither found,
Yet in their search we have measured out much ground.

Enter Sir HARRY and SENCER.

SENCER.

Your worship will be there?

SIR HARRY.

Yes, not to fail,
At half an hour past six, or before seven.

SENCER.

You shall not find us at six and at seven, I'll warrant you: good health to
your worship.

SIR HARRY.

Farewell, good fellow;
At the Wise-woman's house (I know it well:
Perhaps she knows some danger touching me).
I'll keep mine hour.

[Exit SENCER.]

OLD CHARTLEY.

Sir Harry,
A hand, a hand; to baulk you it were sin.
I shall be bold to make your house mine inn.

SIR HARRY.

Brother Chartley, I am glad to see you.

OLD CHARTLEY.

Methinks, Sir Harry, you look strangely on me.
And do not bid me welcome with an heart.

SIR HARRY.

And blame me not to look amazedly
To see you here.

OLD CHARTLEY.

Why me?

SIR HARRY.

Come, come, you're welcome.
And now I'll turn my strangeness to true joy.
I am glad to see you well, and safe recovered
Of your late grievous sickness.

OLD CHARTLEY.

The strange amazed looks that you cast off
You put on me; and blame me not to wonder
That you should talk of sickness to sound men.
I thank my stars I did not taste the grief
Of inward pain or outward malady
This seven years day.

SIR HARRY.

But by your favour, brother,
Then let me have my wonder back again.

OLD CHARTLEY.

Before I quite part with it, let me know
Why you the name of brother put upon me
In every clause—a name as strange to me
As my recovered sickness.

SIR HARRY.

You are pleasant,
And it becomes you well: welcome again,
The rather you are come just to the wedding.

OLD CHARTLEY.

What wedding, sir?

SIR HARRY.

That you should ask that question!
Why, of my daughter Grace.

OLD CHARTLEY.

Is Grace bestowed? Of whom, I pray?

SIR HARRY.

Of whom but of your son.
I wonder, brother Chartley, and my friend,
You should thus play on me.

OLD CHARTLEY.

But by your favour,
Were you ten knights, Sir Harry—take me with you[57]—
My son match with your daughter! my consent
Not worthy to be craved!

SIR HARRY.

Nay, then I see
You'll stir my patience; know this forward match
Took its first birth from you.

OLD CHARTLEY.

From me?

SIR HARRY.

From you.
Peruse this letter: know you your own hand?
'Twas well that I reserved your hand a witness
Against your tongue. You had best deny the jointure
Of the three hundred pounds made to my daughter;
'Tis that I know you aim at; but your seal— [*Shows him letter.*]

OLD CHARTLEY.

Shall not make me approve it: I deny
This seal for mine, nor do I vouch that hand.
Your daughter and the dower, letter and all,

I quite disclaim. Sir Harry, you much wrong me.

SIR HARRY.

I can bear more than this; heap wrong on wrong,
And I'll support it all; I for this time
Will cast my spleen behind me. And yet hear me:
This letter your son Chartley, as from you,
Delivered me. I like the motion well.

OLD CHARTLEY.

My spleen is further thrown aside than yours,
And I am full as patient, and yet hear me;
My son's contracted to another maid.
Nay, I am patient still—yet that I writ
This letter, sealed this impress, I deny.

SIR HARRY.

Why, then, the jack^[58] your hand did counterfeit?

OLD CHARTLEY.

Why, then, he did so. Where's that unthrift, speak?

SIR HARRY.

Some hour ago, he mounted and rid post
To give you visit, whom he said lay sick
Upon your death-bed.

OLD CHARTLEY.

You amaze me, sir.
It is an ill presage; hereon I see
Your former salutation took its ground,
To see me safe recovered of my sickness.

SIR HARRY.

Indeed it did. Your welcome is a subject
I cannot use too oft; welcome again.
I am sorry you this night must sup alone,
For I am elsewhere called about some business,

Concerning what I know not. Hours run on—
I must to Hogsdon; high time I were gone. [*Exit.*

OLD CHARTLEY.

Perhaps to the Wise-woman's; she may tell me
The fortunes of my son. This accident
Hath bred in me suspicion and strange fears.
I will not sup alone, but I protest,
'Mongst some this night I'll play the intruding guest.

[*Exit with Serving-men.*

SCENE II.—*The Principal Room in the Wise-woman's House, leading to several small rooms, all of which look into it.*

Enter the Wise-woman, SENCER as a Serving-man, LUCE and her Father, and 2nd LUCE in Boy's clothes.

WISE-WOMAN.

But will Sir Harry come?

SENCER.

Presume he will,
And Chartley too.

LUCE'S FATHER.

I'll have the knave by the ears.

LUCE.

Nay, patience, sir; leave your revenge to me.

Enter BOYSTER.

BOYSTER.

Grannam, I am come according to promise.

WISE-WOMAN.

And welcome to the best hole that I have in Hogsdon.

BOYSTER.

Good even.

LUCE.

Thanks, sir, a good even may it prove,
That each may reap the fruits of their own love!

2ND LUCE.

That shall be my prayer too.

BOYSTER.

Come, what shall's do?

WISE-WOMAN.

Withdraw; I'll place you all in several rooms,
Where sit, see, but say nothing.

[They withdraw. Exeunt Wise-woman and 2nd LUCE.]

Enter TABER, ushering GRATIANA.

TABER.

Here, sweet mistress; I know the place well ever since I was here to know
my fortune.

GRATIANA.

Call me some half an hour hence.

[Exit TABER.]

Re-enter the Wise-woman and 2nd LUCE.

WISE-WOMAN.

Your ladyship is most lovingly welcome. A low stool for the
gentlewoman, boy. I made bold to send to you to take view of such a
piece of work as I presume you have seldom seen the like.

GRATIANA.

Of whose doing, I pray?

WISE-WOMAN.

A friend of yours and mine. Please you withdraw,
I'll bring you to't.

2ND LUCE.

Mistress!

WISE-WOMAN.

One calls, sweet lady; I shall do you wrong,

But pray you think my little stay not long.

[GRATIANA *withdraws, exeunt the others.*

SCENE III.—*An Inner Room in the same.*

Enter SENCER, Sir HARRY, and LUCE.

SENCER.

Here, sir, in this retiring chamber.

SIR HARRY.

Gramercy, friend. How now? what's here to do?
A pretty wench and a close chamber too!

LUCE.

That you have so much graced my mother's house
With your desired presence, worthy knight,
Receive a poor maid's thanks. Who's there? a chair
And cushion for Sir Harry.

SIR HARRY.

Thanks, most fair.

LUCE.

Please you but a few minutes here to stay,
Till my return, I'll not be long away.

SENCER.

The gentlewoman will wait on you by and by, sir.

[Exeunt LUCE and SENCER.]

SIR HARRY.

And I'll attend her, friend.
Of all those doubts I long to know the end.

SCENE IV.—*The Principal Room in the same.*

Enter the Wise-woman, SENCER and LUCE. To them enter 2nd LUCE and Old CHARTLEY.

2ND LUCE.

The knight you seek was here, or will be straight,
And, if you be the man you name yourself,
You are most welcome, and you shall not back
Till you have seen Sir Harry.

OLD CHARTLEY.

Gentle youth,
I saw him enter here, and under privilege
Of his acquaintance made I bold to stay.

2ND LUCE.

And you are welcome, sir; sit down, I pray.

[Takes him into one of the inner rooms.]

WISE-WOMAN.

Now they are placed in several rooms, that look into this one. Were
Chartley come we had all our company.

SENCER.

Hark, there's one knocks; 'tis Chartley, on my life.

LUCE.

One of you let him in, whilst I prepare me
To entertain his coming.

[Exeunt SENCER and Wise-woman.]

Enter Young CHARTLEY, ushered in by SENCER, who retires.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

What, old acquaintance Luce! Not a word? yet some lip-labour if thou lovest me.

GRATIANA. [*In an inner room.*]

My husband![\[59\]](#)

SIR HARRY. [*In another inner room.*]

What, young Chartley!

OLD CHARTLEY. [*Also in an inner room.*]

How! my son!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Come, come away with this wailing in woe; if thou put'st finger in the eye a little longer, I shall plunge in pain too presently.

LUCE.

O husband, husband!

GRATIANA.

Husband!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

What say'st thou, my sweet wife?

GRATIANA.

Wife! O my heart!

2ND LUCE.

[*Aside.*] In that name wife I claim a poor child's part.

LUCE.

O husband, how have you used me!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Nay, how do I mean to use thee, but as a man should use his wife?

GRATIANA.

I hope he doth not mean to use her so.

2ND LUCE.

[*Aside.*] I hope so too.

BOYSTER. [*In an inner room.*]

My grannam is a witch.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Nay, Luce, sweet wife, leave weeping if thou lovest me.

LUCE.

Oh, can you blame me, knowing that the fountain
Of all these springs took their first head from you?
You know, you too well know, not three days since
Are past since we were married.

GRATIANA.

Married! I can endure no longer.

SIR HARRY.

It cannot be.

OLD CHARTLEY.

It is not possible.

BOYSTER.

I'll be even with thee for this, old grannam.

LUCE.

And though we wanted witness upon earth,
Yet Heaven bears record of our nuptial tie.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Tush, when we meet in Heaven let's talk of that.
Nay, come, you ass, you fool, what's past is past;
Though man and wife, yet I must marry now
Another gallant; here's thy letter, Luce,
And this night I intend to lodge with thee.

2ND LUCE.

[*Aside.*] I'll scratch her eyes out first, although I love her.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Prithee be merry.

I have made a gull of Grace, and old Sir Harry
Thinks me a great way off. I told the knight
My father lay a-dying, took post-horse,
Rid out of Holborn, turned by Islington,
So hither, wench, to lodge all night with thee.

2ND LUCE.

[*Aside.*] Here's one saith nay to that.

OLD CHARTLEY.

Was that your journey?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Why, [\[60\]](#) I have too much Grace already.

BOYSTER.

Thou hast no grace at all.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Nay, let's to bed; if thou couldst but imagine how I love thee, Luce!

LUCE.

How is it possible you can love me, and go about to marry another?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Dost thou not know she's rich? Why, you fool, as soon as I have got her
dower, it is but giving her a dram, or a pill to purge melancholy, to make
her turn up her heels, and then with all that wealth come I to live with
thee, my sweet rascal.

GRATIANA. [*Coming from the inner room.*]

She thanks you, and is much beholding to you.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

I am betrayed!

GRATIANA.

Art thou my suitor? wouldst thou marry me,
And thy first wife alive? then poison me,
To purchase my poor dower?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

What shall I say, or think, or do? I am at a nonplus.

GRATIANA.

Hast thou the face, thou brazen impudence,
To look upon me?—past grace!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Thou canst not properly call me past Grace, for I never enjoyed thee yet.
I cannot tell whether I blush or no, but I have now at this time more
Grace than I can tell what to do with.

GRATIANA.

Who drew thee to this folly?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Who but the old dotard thy father, who when I was honestly married to a
civil maid, he persuaded me to leave her? I was loth at first, but after
entreating, urging, and offering me large proffers, I must confess I was
seduced to come a-wooing to thee.

GRATIANA.

My father, villain!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Ay, thy father, Grace. And were he here would justify it to the old
dotard's face.

Enter Sir HARRY.

SIR HARRY.

Vile boy, thou dar'st not be so impudent!
When did I meet thee, seek or sue to thee?
When? Name the day, the month, the hour, the year.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Plots, plots! I can but cry you mercy both. Say that I have done you wrong, I can be but sorry for it. But, indeed, to clear you, and lay the fault where it ought to be, all this comes from mine own father in the country, who hearing I had married with Luce, sends me word, of his blessing, [\[61\]](#) to be divorced from her, and to come a suitor to your daughter. I think you have his hand and seal to show.

Enter Old CHARTLEY.

OLD CHARTLEY.

My hand and seal! When was that letter writ?

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Heyday, if you get one word more of me to-night but scurvy looks, I'll give you leave to hang me.

SIR HARRY.

Vile boy!

OLD CHARTLEY.

Ungracious villain!

GRATIANA.

Treacherous youth!

SIR HARRY.

No grace at all!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

No Grace.

OLD CHARTLEY.

This is bad company who hath seduced thee!
Speak, on my blessing, who hath thus misled thee?
But no more lies, I charge thee.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Bad company hath been the shame of me. I was as virtuously given as any youth in Europe, till I fell into one Boyster's company; 'tis he that hath done all the harm upon me.

BOYSTER.

[*Aside.*] I!

OLD CHARTLEY.

And if he should deny it?

Enter BOYSTER.

BOYSTER.

What then? you'd cry him mercy.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

I had best bite out my tongue, and speak no more. What shall I do, or what shall I say? There is no outfacing them all. Gentlemen, fathers, wives, or what else, I have wronged you all. I confess it that I have—what would you more? Will any of you rail of me? I'll bear it. Will any of you beat me? So they strike not too hard, I'll suffer it. Will any of you challenge me? I'll answer it. What would you have me say or do? One of these I have married, the other I have betrothed, yet both maids for me. Will you have me take one, and leave the tother? I will. Will you have me keep them both? I will.

Enter LUCE's Father.

LUCE'S FATHER.

Perjured! not mine.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

What, you here too? Nay, then, I see all my good friends are met together. Wilt thou have me, Luce? I am thy husband, and had I not loved thee better than Grace, I had not disappointed the marriage day to-morrow.

LUCE.

Lascivious! no.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Wilt thou have me, Grace?—for had I not loved thee better than Luce, I would never after I had married her been contracted to thee.

GRATIANA.

Inconstant! no.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Then, neither married man, widower, nor bachelor, what's to be done? Here's even the proverb verified—between two stools, the tail goes to ground.

SIR HARRY.

Now I bethink me, this our meeting here is wondrous strange. Call in the gentlewoman that owns this house.

Enter SENCER no longer disguised, and the Wise-woman.

BOYSTER.

Old trot, I'll trounce thee.

Here is the marriage proved 'twixt Luce and Chartley:

Witch, this was not your promise.

WISE-WOMAN.

Have patience, and in the end we'll pay you all. Your worships are most heartily welcome. I made bold to send for you, and you may see to what end, which was to discover unto you the wild vagaries of this wanton wag-pasty—a wild oats I warrant him—and, Sir Harry, that your daughter hath scaped this scouring, thank this gentleman, and then make of him as he deserves.

SIR HARRY.

Oh, I remember him.

GRATIANA.

He never pleased mine eye so well as now.
I know his love, and he in Chartley's place
My favour shall possess.

SENCER.

Thanks, my sweet Grace.

SIR HARRY.

Ay, and the more the inconstant youth to spite,
Sencer, I give her thee in Chartley's sight.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

There's one gone already; but this is my wife, and her I'll keep in spite
both of the devil and his dam.

WISE-WOMAN.

Not from her lawful husband!

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

That am I.

WISE-WOMAN.

That is the gentleman [*pointing to BOYSTER*],—accept him, Luce; and you
the like of her—nay, I'll make it good. This gentleman married you
visarded, you him disguised, mistaking him for Chartley, which none but
my boy Jack was privy to: after she changed her habit with him, as you
with Jack; and you in Mistress Luce's habit—

LUCE.

May I believe you, mother?

WISE-WOMAN.

This be your token.

BOYSTER.

Her that I married, I wrung twice by the finger.

LUCE.

Of that token, my hand was sensible.

BOYSTER.

And ere the clamorous and loud noise begun,
I whispered to her thus— [*Whispers.*

LUCE.

You are the man.

BOYSTER.

Thanks, grannam; what thou promised thou hast done.

LUCE'S FATHER.

And, leaving him, I take you for my son.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Two gone! then where's the third? This makes me mad.
Where is my wife, then? for a wife I had.

WISE-WOMAN.

Not see thy wife? Come hither, Jack, my boy.
Nay, take him to thee, and with him all joy.

OLD CHARTLEY.

Well art thou served to be a general scorn
To all thy blood: and, if not for our sakes,
For thy soul's health and credit of the world,
Have some regard to me—to me thy father.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Enough, sir: if I should say I would become a new man, you would not take my word; if I should swear I would amend my life, you would not take mine oath; if I should bind myself to become an honest man, you would scarce take my bond.

OLD CHARTLEY.

I should do none of these.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Then see, sir: when to all your judgments I see me past grace, do I lay hold of grace, and here begin to retire myself. This woman hath lent me a glass, in which I see all my imperfections, at which my conscience doth more blush inwardly than my face outwardly; and now I dare confidently undertake for myself I am honest.

2ND LUCE.

Then I dare confidently undertake to help you to a wife who desires to have an honest man or none. Look on me well: simple though I stand here, I am your wife. Blush not at your folly, man. Perhaps I have more in me than you expect from me.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Knavery and riot, both which are now to me foreign.

2ND LUCE.

You and I have been better acquainted, and yet search me not too far, lest you shame me; look on me well—nay better, better yet;—I'll assure you I left off a petticoat when I put on these breeches. What say you now? [*She scatters her hair.*]

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

First love, and best beloved!

2ND LUCE.

Let me be both or neither.

WISE-WOMAN.

[*Aside.*] My boy turned girl! I hope she'll keep my counsel. From henceforth I'll never entertain any servant but I'll have her searched.

OLD CHARTLEY.

Her love hath drawn her hither after him.—
My loving daughter, welcome! thou hast run

A happy course to see my son thus changed.

YOUNG CHARTLEY.

Father, call me once again your son, and, Sir Harry, me your friend;
Sencer, a hand, and Mistress Grace, a heart, in honourable love. Where I
have wronged you, Luce, forgive; impute my errors to my youth, not me.
With Grace I interchange an embrace; with you, Luce, a parting buss. I
wish you all joy. Divide my heart amongst you—thou my soul!

Nay, Mother Midnight, there's some love for you;
Out of thy folly, being reputed wise,
We, self-conceited, have our follies found:
Bear thou the name of all these comical acts.
Luce, Luce, and Grace—O covetous man! I see
I sought to engross what now sufficeth three,
Yet each one wife enough. One nuptial feast
Shall serve three bridals, where be thou chief guest!

[Exeunt.]

THE RAPE OF LUCRECE.

AN edition of *The Rape of Lucrece* was published in 1608; two other editions followed in 1609, and others again in 1630 and 1638. It was acted at the Red Bull in Clerkenwell. In the old copies neither the acts nor the scenes, excepting in the case of the senate scenes, are marked; in the present reprint the divisions are given, it is hoped, with approximate correctness.

To the READER.

IT hath been no custom in me of all other men (courteous readers) to commit my plays to the press; the reason though some may attribute to my own insufficiency, I had rather subscribe, in that, to their severe censure, than by seeking to avoid the imputation of weakness, to incur greater suspicion of honesty: for, though some have used a double sale of their labours, first to the stage, and after to the press, for my own part I here proclaim myself ever faithful in the first, and never guilty of the last. Yet since some of my plays have (unknown to me, and without any of my direction) accidentally come into the printer's hands, and therefore so corrupt and mangled (copied only by the ear) that I have been as unable to know them as ashamed to challenge them, this therefore I was the willinger to furnish out in his native habit: first being by consent; next because the rest have been so wronged, in being published in such savage and ragged ornaments. Accept it, courteous gentlemen, and prove as favourable readers as we have found you gracious auditors.

Yours, T. H.

DRAMATIS PERSONÆ.

SERVIUS, King of Rome.

TARQUIN the Proud.

The two Sons of TARQUIN:

ARUNS,

SEXTUS,

BRUTUS JUNIOR.

COLLATINUS, otherwise COLLATINE.

HORATIUS COCLES.

MUTIUS SCEVOLA.

LUCRETIUS.

VALERIUS.

POPPLICOLA.

PORSENNA, King of the Tuscans.

PORSENNA'S Secretary.

The Priest of Apollo.

Two Sentinels.

Senators.

Serving-man.

Clown.

LUCRECE, Wife of COLLATINUS.

TULLIA, Wife of TARQUIN.

MIRABLE, LUCRECE'S Maid.

SCENE.—ROME and its outskirts, DELPHI, and ARDEA.

THE RAPE OF LUCRECE.

ACT THE FIRST.

SCENE I.—*The Senate-house.*

Enter TARQUIN, TULLIA, SEXTUS, ARUNS, LUCRETIVS, VALERIUS,
POPLICOLA, *and* Senators *before them.*

TULLIA.

Withdraw; we must have private conference
With our dear husband.

[Exeunt all except TARQUIN and TULLIA.]

TARQUIN.

What wouldst thou, wife?

TULLIA.

Be what I am not; make thee greater far
Than thou canst aim to be.

TARQUIN.

Why, I am Tarquin.

TULLIA.

And I am Tullia—what of that?
What diapason's more in Tarquin's name
Than in a subject's? or what's Tullia
More in the sound than to become the name
Of a poor maid or waiting gentlewoman?
I am a princess both by birth and thoughts,
Yet all's but Tullia. There's no resonance
In a bare style; my title bears no breadth,

Nor hath it any state. O me, I'm sick!

TARQUIN.

Sick, lady!

TULLIA.

Sick at heart.

TARQUIN.

Why, my sweet Tullia?

TULLIA.

To be a queen I long, long, and am sick;
With ardency my hot appetite's a-fire,
Till my swollen fervour be deliverèd
Of that great title queen. My heart's all royal,
Not to be circumscribed in servile bounds.
While there's a king that rules the peers of Rome,
Tarquin makes legs, [\[1\]](#) and Tullia curtsies low,
Bows at each nod, and must not near the state
Without obeisance. Oh! I hate this awe;
My proud heart cannot brook it.

TARQUIN.

Hear me, wife.

TULLIA.

I am no wife of Tarquin's if not king:
Oh, had Jove made me man, I would have mounted
Above the base tribunals of the earth,
Up to the clouds, for pompous sovereignty.
Thou art a man: oh, bear my royal mind,
Mount heaven, and see if Tullia lag behind.
There is no earth in me, I am all fire;
Were Tarquin so, then should we both aspire.

TARQUIN.

O Tullia, though my body taste of dulness,

My soul is winged to soar as high as thine;
But note what flags our wings,—forty-five years
The king thy father hath protected Rome.

TULLIA.

That makes for us: the people covet change;
Even the best things in time grow tedious.

TARQUIN.

'Twould seem unnatural in thee, my Tullia,
The reverend king thy father to depose.

TULLIA.

A kingdom's quest makes sons and fathers foes.

TARQUIN.

And but by Servius' fall we cannot climb;
The balm[2] that must anoint us is his blood.

TULLIA.

Let's lave our brows then in that crimson flood;
We must be bold and dreadless: who aspires,
Mounts by the lives of fathers, sons, and sires.

TARQUIN.

And so must I, since, for a kingdom's love,
Thou canst despise a father for a crown.
Tarquin shall mount, Servius be tumbled down,
For he usurps my state, and first deposed
My father in my swathèd infancy,
For which he shall be countant:[3] to this end
I have sounded all the peers and senators,
And, though unknown to thee, my Tullia,
They all embrace my faction; and so they
Love change of state, a new king to obey.

TULLIA.

Now is my Tarquin worthy Tullia's grace,

Since in my arms I thus a king embrace.

TARQUIN.

The king should meet this day in parliament
With all the Senate and Estates^[4] of Rome.
His place will I assume, and there proclaim
All our decrees in royal Tarquin's name.

[Flourish.

Re-enter SEXTUS, ARUNS, LUCRETIVS, VALERIUS, COLLATINE, *and*
Senators.

LUCRETIVS.

May it please thee, noble Tarquin, to attend
The king this day in the high Capitol?

TULLIA.

Attend!

TARQUIN.

We intend this day to see the Capitol.
You knew our father, good Lucretius?

LUCRETIVS.

I did, my lord.

TARQUIN.

Was not I his son?
The queen my mother was of royal thoughts,
And heart pure as unblemished innocence.

LUCRETIVS.

What asks my lord?

TARQUIN.

Sons should succeed their fathers: but anon
You shall hear more; high time that we were gone.

[Flourish. Exeunt all but COLLATINE and VALERIUS.]

COLLATINE.

There's moral sure in this, Valerius:
Here's model, yea, and matter too to breed
Strange meditations in the provident brains
Of our grave fathers: some strange project lives
This day in cradle that's but newly born.

VALERIUS.

No doubt, Collatine, no doubt, here's a giddy and drunken world; it reels;
it hath got the staggers; the commonwealth is sick of an ague, of which
nothing can cure her but some violent and sudden affrightment.

COLLATINE.

The wife of Tarquin would be a queen—nay, on my life, she is with child
till she be so.

VALERIUS.

And longs to be brought to bed of a kingdom. I divine we shall see
scuffling to-day in the Capitol.

COLLATINE.

If there be any difference among the princes and Senate, whose faction
will Valerius follow?

VALERIUS.

Oh, Collatine, I am a true citizen, and in this I will best show myself to
be one, to take part with the strongest. If Servius o'ercome, I am
liegeman to Servius; and if Tarquin subdue, I am for *vive* Tarquinius.

COLLATINE.

Valerius, no more, this talk does but keep us from the sight of this
solemnity: by this the princes are entering the Capitol: come, we must
attend.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—*The same.*

Enter TARQUIN, TULLIA, SEXTUS, ARUNS, LUCRETIVS *on one side*: BRUTUS
meeting them on the other very humorously.[\[5\]](#)

TARQUIN.

This place is not for fools, this parliament
Assembles not the strains of idiotism,
Only the grave and wisest of the land:
Important are the affairs we have in hand.
Hence with that mome.[\[6\]](#)

LUCRETIVS.

Brutus, forbear the presence.

BRUTUS.

Forbear the presence! why, pray?

SEXTUS.

None are admitted to this grave concourse
But wise men. Nay, good Brutus.

BRUTUS.

You'll have an empty parliament then.

ARUNS.

Here is no room for fools.

BRUTUS.

Then what makest thou here, or he, or he? O Jupiter! if this command be kept strictly, we shall have empty benches: get you home, you that are here, for here will be nothing to do this day. A general concourse of wise men! 'twas never seen since the first chaos. Tarquin, if the general rule have no exceptions, thou wilt have an empty consistory.

TULLIA.

Brutus, you trouble us.

BRUTUS.

How powerful am I, you Roman deities, that am able to trouble her that troubles a whole empire! Fools exempted, and women admitted! laugh, Democritus.[\[7\]](#) But have you nothing to say to madmen?

TARQUIN.

Madmen have here no place.

BRUTUS.

Then out of doors with Tarquin. What's he that may sit in a calm valley, and will choose to repose in a tempestuous mountain, but a madman? that may live in tranquillous pleasures, and will seek out a kingdom's care, but a madman? who would seek innovation in a commonwealth in public, or be overruled by a curst[\[8\]](#) wife in private, but a fool or a madman? Give me thy hand, Tarquin; shall we two be dismissed together from the Capitol?

TARQUIN.

Restrain his folly.

TULLIA.

Drive the frantic hence.

ARUNS.

Nay, Brutus.

SEXTUS.

Good Brutus.

BRUTUS.

Nay, soft, soft, good blood of the Tarquins, let's have a few cold words first, and I am gone in an instant. I claim the privilege of the nobility of Rome, and by that privilege my seat in the Capitol. I am a lord by birth, my place is as free in the Capitol as Horatius, thine; or thine, Lucretius; thine, Sextus; Aruns, thine; or any here: I am a lord, and you banish all the lord fools from the presence. You'll have few to wait upon the king, but gentlemen. Nay, I am easily persuaded then—hands off! since you will not have my company, you shall have my room.

[*Aside.*] My room indeed; for what I seem to be
Brutus is not, but born great Rome[9] to free.
The state is full of dropsy, and swollen big
With windy vapours, which my sword must pierce,
To purge the infected blood bred by the pride
Of these infested bloods. Nay, now I go;
Behold, I vanish, since 'tis Tarquin's mind:
One small fool goes, but great fools leaves behind. [*Exit.*

LUCRETIOUS.

'Tis pity one so generously[10] derived
Should be deprived his best induements thus,
And want the true directions of the soul.

TARQUIN.

To leave these dilatory trifles, lords,
Now to the public business of the land.
Lords, take your several places.

LUCRETIOUS.

Not, great Tarquin,
Before the king assume his regal throne,
Whose coming we attend.

TULLIA.

He's come already.

LUCRETIOUS.

The king?

TARQUIN.

The king.

COLLATINE.

Servius?

TARQUIN.

Tarquinius.

LUCRETIUS.

Servius is king.

TARQUIN.

He was: by power divine[11]

The throne that long since he usurped is mine.

Here we enthrone ourselves, cathedral state,

Long since detained us, justly we resume;

Then let our friends and such as love us cry,

Live Tarquin, and enjoy this sovereignty!

ALL.

Live Tarquin and enjoy this sovereignty!

[Flourish.

Enter VALERIUS.

VALERIUS.

The king himself, with such confederate peers

As stoutly embrace his faction, being informed

Of Tarquin's usurpation, armèd comes

Near to the entrance of the Capitol.

TARQUIN.

No man give place; he that dares to arise

And do him reverence, we his love despise.

Enter SERVIUS, HORATIUS, SCEVOLA, and Soldiers.

SERVIUS.

Traitor!

TARQUIN.

Usurper!

SERVIUS.

Descend.

TULLIA.

Sit still.

SERVIUS.

In Servius' name, Rome's great imperial monarch,
I charge thee, Tarquin, disenthroned thyself,
And throw thee at our feet, prostrate for mercy.

HORATIUS.

Spoke like a king.

TARQUIN.

In Tarquin's name, now Rome's imperial monarch,
We charge thee, Servius, make free resignation
Of that arched wreath thou hast usurped so long.

TULLIA.

Words worth an empire.

HORATIUS.

Shall this be brooked, my sovereign?
Dismount the traitor.

SEXTUS.

Touch him he that dares.

HORATIUS.

Dares!

TULLIA.

Dares.

SERVIUS.

Strumpet, no child of mine!

TULLIA.

Dotard, and not my father!

SERVIUS.

Kneel to thy king.

TULLIA.

Submit thou to thy queen.

SERVIUS.

Insufferable treason! with bright steel
Lop down these interponents that withstand
The passage to our throne.

HORATIUS.

That Cocles dares.

SEXTUS.

We with our steel guard Tarquin and his chair.

SCEVOLA.

A Servius!

ARUNS.

A Tarquin!

[They fight; SERVIUS is slain.]

TARQUIN.

Now are we king indeed; our awe is builded
Upon this royal base, the slaughtered body
Of a dead king; we by his ruin rise
To a monarchal throne.

TULLIA.

We have our longing;
My father's death gives me a second life
Much better than the first; my birth was servile,
But this new breath of reign is large and free:
Welcome, my second life of sovereignty!

LUCRETIVS.

I have a daughter, but, I hope, of mettle
Subject to better temperature; should my Lucrece
Be of this pride, these hands should sacrifice
Her blood unto the gods that dwell below;
The abortive brat should not out-live my spleen.
But Lucrece is my daughter, this my queen.

TULLIA.

Tear off the crown that yet empales the temples
Of our usurping father—quickly, lords—
And in the face of his yet bleeding wounds
Let us receive our honours.

TARQUIN.

The same breath
Gives our state life, that was the usurper's death.

TULLIA.

Here then by Heaven's hand we invest ourselves:
Music, whose loftiest tones grace princes crowned,
Unto our novel coronation sound.

[Flourish. VALERIUS leads forward HORATIUS and SCEVOLA.]

TARQUIN.

Whom doth Valerius to our state present?

VALERIUS.

Two valiant Romans; this Horatius Cocles,
This gentleman called Mutius Scevola,
Who, whilst King Servius wore the diadem,
Upheld his sway and princedom by their loves;
But he being fallen, since all the peers of Rome
Applaud King Tarquin in his sovereignty,
They with like suffrage greet your coronation.

HORATIUS.

This hand, allied unto the Roman crown,

Whom never fear dejected or cast low,
Lays his victorious sword at Tarquin's feet,
And prostrates with that sword allegiance.
King Servius' life we loved, but, he expired,
Great Tarquin's life is in our hearts desired.

SCEVOLA.

Who, whilst he rules with justice and integrity,
Shall with our dreadless hands our hearts command,
Even with the best employments of our lives.
Since fortune lifts thee, we submit to fate:
Ourselves are vassals to the Roman state.

TARQUIN.

Your rooms were empty in our train of friends,
Which we rejoice to see so well supplied:
Receive our grace, live in our clement favours,
In whose submission our young glory grows
To his ripe height: fall in our friendly train,
And strengthen with your loves our infant reign.

HORATIUS.

We live for Tarquin.

SCEVOLA.

And to thee alone,
Whilst Justice keeps thy sword and thou thy throne.

TARQUIN.

Then are you ours. And now conduct us straight
In triumph through the populous streets of Rome
To the king's palace, our majestic seat.
Your hearts, though freely proffered, we entreat.

[*Music.*

As they march, TULLIA treads on SERVIUS's dead body and pauses.

TULLIA.

What block is that we tread on?

LUCRETIOUS.

'Tis the body
Of your deceased father, madam queen;
Your shoe is crimsoned with his vital blood.

TULLIA.

No matter; let his mangled body lie,
And with his base confederates strew the streets,
That, in disgrace of his usurped pride,
We o'er his trunk may in our chariot ride;
For, mounted like a queen, 'twould do me good
To wash my coach-*naves*[\[12\]](#) in my father's blood.

LUCRETIOUS.

Here's a good child!

TARQUIN.

Remove it, we command,
And bear his carcase to the funeral pile,
Where, after this dejection, let it have
His solemn and due obsequies. Fair Tullia,
Thy hate to him grows from thy love to us;
Thou show'st thyself in this unnatural strife
An unkind daughter, but a loving wife.
But on unto our palace: this blest day,
A king's increase grows by a king's decay.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE III.—*A Public Place in Rome.*

Enter BRUTUS.

BRUTUS.

Murder the king! a high and capital treason.
Those giants that waged war against the gods,
For which the o'erwhelmed mountains hurled by Jove
To scatter them, and give them timeless[13] graves,
Was not more cruel than this butchery,
This slaughter made by Tarquin. But the queen!
A woman—fie, fie! did not this she-parricide
Add to her father's wounds? and when his body
Lay all besmeared and stained in the blood royal,
Did not this monster, this infernal hag,
Make her unwilling charioteer drive on,
And with his shod wheels crush her father's bones,
Break his crazed skull, and dash his sparkled[14] brains
Upon the pavements, whilst she held the reins?
The affrighted sun at this abhorred object
Put on a mask of blood, and yet she blushed not.
Jove, art thou just? hast thou reward for piety,
And for offence no vengeance? or canst punish
Felons, and pardon traitors? chastise murderers,
And wink at parricides? if thou be worthy,
As well we know thou art, to fill the throne
Of all eternity, then with that hand
That flings the trifurk[15] thunder, let the pride
Of these our irreligious monarchisers
Be crowned in blood. This makes poor Brutus mad,—
To see sin frolic, and the virtuous sad.

Enter SEXTUS and ARUNS.

ARUNS.

Soft, here's Brutus; let us acquaint him with the news.

SEXTUS.

Content. Now, cousin Brutus.

BRUTUS.

Who, I your kinsman! though I be of the blood of the Tarquins, yet no cousin, gentle prince.

ARUNS.

And why so, Brutus? scorn you our alliance?

BRUTUS.

No; I was cousin to the Tarquins when they were subjects, but dare claim no kindred as they are sovereigns; Brutus is not so mad, though he be merry, but he hath wit enough to keep his head on his shoulders.

ARUNS.

Why do you, my lord, thus lose your hours, and neither profess war nor domestic profit? the first might beget you love, the other riches.

BRUTUS.

Because I would live. Have I not answered you? because I would live. Fools and madmen are no rubs [\[16\]](#) in the way of usurpers; the firmament can brook but one sun, and for my part I must not shine: I had rather live an obscure black than appear a fair white to be shot at. The end of all is, I would live. Had Servius been a shrub, the wind had not shook him: or a madman, he had not perished. I covet no more wit nor employment than as much as will keep life and soul together—I would but live.

ARUNS.

You are satirical, cousin Brutus: but to the purpose. The king dreamt a strange and ominous dream last night, and, to be resolved of the event, my brother Sextus and I must to the oracle.

SEXTUS.

And, because we would be well accompanied, we have got leave of the king that you, Brutus, shall associate us, for our purpose is to make a merry journey on't.

BRUTUS.

So you'll carry me along with you to be your fool, and make you merry.

SEXTUS.

Not our fool, but—

BRUTUS.

To make you merry: I shall, nay, I would make you merry, or tickle you till you laugh. The oracle! I'll go to be resolved of some doubts private to myself: nay, princes, I am so much endeared both to your loves and companies, that you shall not have the power to be rid of me. What limits have we for our journey?

SEXTUS.

Five days, no more.

BRUTUS.

I shall fit me to your preparations. But one thing more: goes Collatine along?

SEXTUS.

Collatine is troubled with the common disease of all new-married men; he's sick of the wife: his excuse is, forsooth, that Lucrece will not let him go: but you, having neither wife nor wit to hold you, I hope will not disappoint us.

BRUTUS.

Had I both, yet should you prevail with me above either.

ARUNS.

We shall expect you.

BRUTUS.

Horatius Cocles and Mutius Scevola are not engaged in this expedition?

ARUNS.

No, they attend the king. Farewell.

BRUTUS.

Lucretius stays at home too, and Valerius?

SEXTUS.

The palace cannot spare them.

BRUTUS.

None but we three?

SEXTUS.

We three.

BRUTUS.

We three; well, five days hence.

SEXTUS.

You have the time, farewell.

[Exeunt SEXTUS and ARUNS.]

BRUTUS.

The time I hope cannot be circumscribed
Within so short a limit; Rome and I
Are not so happy. What's the reason then,
Heaven spares his rod so long? Mercury, tell me.
I have't, the fruit of pride is yet but green,
Not mellow; though it grows apace, it comes not
To his full height: Jove oft delays his vengeance,
That when it haps 't may prove more terrible.
Despair not, Brutus, then, but let thy country
And thee take this last comfort after all:
Pride, when thy fruit is ripe 't must rot and fall.
But to the oracle. *[Exit.]*

ACT THE SECOND.

SCENE I.—*A Street in Rome.*

Enter HORATIUS COCLES *and* MUTIUS SCEVOLA.

HORATIUS.

I would I were no Roman.

SCEVOLA.

Cocles, why?

HORATIUS.

I am discontented, and dare not speak my thoughts.

SCEVOLA.

What, shall I speak them for you?

HORATIUS.

Mutius, do.

SCEVOLA.

Tarquin is proud.

HORATIUS.

Thou hast them.

SCEVOLA.

Tyrannous.

HORATIUS.

True.

SCEVOLA.

Insufferably lofty.

HORATIUS.

Thou hast hit me.

SCEVOLA.

And shall I tell thee what I prophesy
Of his succeeding rule?

HORATIUS.

No, I'll do't for thee:
Tarquin's ability will in the weal
Beget a weak unable impotence;
His strength make Rome and our dominions weak,
His soaring high make us to flag our wings,
And fly close by the earth; his golden feathers
Are of such vastness, that they spread like sails,
And so becalm us that we have not air
Able to raise our plumes, to taste the pleasures
Of our own elements.

SCEVOLA.

We are one heart;
Our thoughts and our desires are suitable.

HORATIUS.

Since he was king he bears him like a god,
His wife like Pallas, or the wife of Jove;
Will not be spoke to without sacrifice,
And homage sole due to the deities.

Enter LUCRETIUS.

SCEVOLA.

What haste with good Lucretius?

LUCRETIUS.

Haste, but small speed.
I had an earnest suit unto the king,
About some business that concerns the weal

Of Rome and us; 'twill not be listened to.
He has took upon him such ambitious state
That he abandons conference with his peers,
Or, if he chance to endure our tongues so much
As but to hear their sonance, he despises
The intent of all our speeches, our advices,
And counsel, thinking his own judgment only
To be approved in matters military,
And in affairs domestic; we are but mutes,
And fellows of no parts, viols unstrung,
Our notes too harsh to strike in princes' ears.
Great Jove amend it!

HORATIUS.

Whither will you, my lord?

LUCRETIOUS.

No matter where,
If from the court. I'll home to Collatine
And to my daughter Lucrece: home breeds safety,
Danger's begot in court; a life retired
Must please me now perforce: then, noble Scevola,
And you my dear Horatius, farewell both.
Where industry is scorned let's welcome sloth.

Enter COLLATINE.

HORATIUS.

Nay, good Lucretius, do not leave us thus.
See, here comes Collatine; but where's Valerius?
How does he taste these times?

COLLATINE.

Not giddily like Brutus, passionately
Like old Lucretius with his tear-swollen eyes;
Not laughingly like Mutius Scevola,
Nor bluntly like Horatius Cocles here;
He has usurped a stranger garb of humour,

Distinct from these in nature every way.

LUCRETIVS.

How is he relished? can his eyes forbear
In this strange state to shed a passionate tear?

SCEVOLA.

Can he forbear to laugh with Scevola,
At that which passionate weeping cannot mend?

HORATIUS.

Nay, can his thought shape aught but melancholy
To see these dangerous passages of state?
How is he tempered, noble Collatine?

COLLATINE.

Strangely; he is all song, he's ditty all,
Note that: Valerius hath given up the court,
And weaned himself from the king's consistory,
In which his sweet harmonious tongue grew harsh.
Whether it be that he is discontent,
Yet would not so appear before the king,
Or whether in applause of these new edicts,
Which so distaste the people, or what cause
I know not, but now he's all musical.
Unto the council chamber he goes singing,
And whilst the king his wilful edicts makes,
In which none's tongue is powerful save the king's,
He's in a corner, relishing strange airs.
Conclusively, he's from a toward hopeful gentleman,
Transhaped to a mere ballater,[\[17\]](#) none knowing
Whence should proceed this transmutation.

Enter VALERIUS.

HORATIUS.

See where he comes. Morrow, Valerius.

LUCRETIVS.

Morrow, my lord.

VALERIUS.

[Sings.] When Tarquin first in court began,
And was approvèd king,
Some men for sudden joy 'gan weep,
But I for sorrow sing.

SCEVOLA.

Ha, ha! how long has my Valerius
Put on this strain of mirth, or what's the cause?

VALERIUS.

[Sings.] Let humour change and spare not;
Since Tarquin's proud, I care not;
His fair words so bewitchèd my delight,
That I doted on his sight:
Now he is changed, cruel thoughts embracing,
And my deserts disgracing.

HORATIUS.

Upon my life he's either mad or love-sick.
Oh, can Valerius, but so late a statesman,
Of whom the public weal deserved so well,
Tune out his age in songs and canzonets,
Whose voice should thunder counsel in the ears
Of Tarquin and proud Tullia? Think, Valerius,
What that proud woman Tullia is; 'twill put thee
Quite out of tune.

VALERIUS.

[Sings.] Now what is love I will thee tell:
It is the fountain and the well,
Where pleasure and repentance dwell;
It is perhaps the sansing[18] bell,
That rings all in to heaven or hell;
And this is love, and this is love, as I hear tell.

Now what is love I will you show:
A thing that creeps and cannot go,
A prize that passeth to and fro,
A thing for me, a thing for moe,[\[19\]](#)
And he that proves shall find it so;
And this is love, and this is love, sweet friend, I trow.

LUCRETIVS.

Valerius, I shall quickly change thy cheer,
And make thy passionate eyes lament with mine.
Think how that worthy prince, our kinsman king,
Was butchered in the marble Capitol:
Shall Servius Tullius unregarded die
Alone of thee, whom all the Roman ladies,
Even yet with tear-swollen eyes, and sorrowful souls,
Compassionate, as well he merited?
To these lamenting dames what canst thou sing,
Whose grief through all the Roman temples ring?

VALERIUS.

[*Sings.*] Lament, ladies, lament!
Lament the Roman land!
The king is fra thee hent
Was doughty on his hand.

We'll gang into the kirk,
His dead corpse we'll embrace,
And when we see him dead,
We aye will cry alas!—Fa la!

HORATIUS.

This music mads me; I all mirth despise.

LUCRETIVS.

To hear him sing draws rivers from mine eyes.

SCEVOLA.

It pleaseth me; for since the court is harsh,
And looks askance on soldiers, let's be merry,
Court ladies, sing, drink, dance, and every man
Get him a mistress, coach it in the country,
And taste the sweets of it. What thinks Valerius
Of Scevola's last counsel?

VALERIUS.

[*Sings.*] Why, since we soldiers cannot prove,
And grief it is to us therefore,
Let every man get him a love,
To trim her well, and fight no more;
That we may taste of lovers' bliss,
Be merry and blithe, embrace and kiss,
That ladies may say, Some more of this;
That ladies may say, Some more of this.

Since court and city both grow proud,
And safety you delight to hear,
We in the country will us shroud,
Where lives to please both eye and ear:
The nightingale sings jug, jug, jug,
The little lamb leaps after his dug,
And the pretty milk-maids they look so smug,
And the pretty milk-maids, &c.

Come, Scevola, shall we go and be idle?

LUCRETIUS.

I'll in to weep.

HORATIUS.

But I my gall to grate.

SCEVOLA.

I'll laugh at time, till it will change our fate.

[*Exeunt all but* COLLATINE.]

COLLATINE.

Thou art not what thou seem'st, Lord Scevola;
Thy heart mourns in thee, though thy visage smile;
And so does thy soul weep, Valerius,
Although thy habit sing; for these new humours
Are but put on for safety, and to arm them
Against the pride of Tarquin, from whose danger,
None great in love, in counsel, or opinion,
Can be kept safe: this makes me lose [\[20\]](#) my hours
At home with Lucrece, and abandon court.

Enter Clown.

CLOWN.

Fortune, I embrace thee, that thou hast assisted me in finding my master;
the gods of good Rome keep my lord and master out of all bad company!

COLLATINE.

Sirrah, the news with you?

CLOWN.

Would you ha' court news, camp news, city news, or country news, or
would you know what's the news at home?

COLLATINE.

Let me know all the news.

CLOWN.

The news at court is, that a small leg and a silk stocking is in the fashion
for your lord, and the water that God Mercury makes [\[21\]](#) is in request
with your lady. The heaviness of the king's wine makes many a light
head, and the emptiness of his dishes many full bellies; eating and
drinking was never more in use; you shall find the baddest legs in boots,
and the worst faces in masks. They keep their old stomachs still: the
king's good cook hath the most wrong; for that which was wont to be
private only to him is now usurped among all the other officers; for now
every man in his place, to the prejudice of the master cook, makes bold to
lick his own fingers.

COLLATINE.

The news in the camp?

CLOWN.

The greatest news in the camp is that there is no news at all; for being no camp at all, how can there be any tidings from it?

COLLATINE.

Then for the city?

CLOWN.

The senators are rich, their wives fair, credit grows cheap, and traffic dear, for you have many that are broke; the poorest man that is may take up what he will, so he will be but bound—to a post till he pay the debt. There was one courtier lay with twelve men's wives in the suburbs, and pressing farther to make one more cuckold within the walls, and being taken with the manner,[\[22\]](#) had nothing to say for himself but this—he that made twelve made thirteen.

COLLATINE.

Now, sir, for the country?

CLOWN.

There is no news there but at the ale-house; there's the most receipt. And is it not strange, my lord, that so many men love ale that know not what ale is?

COLLATINE.

Why, what is ale?

CLOWN.

Why, ale is a kind of juice made of the precious grain called malt; and what is malt? Malt's M A L T; and what is M A L T? M much, A ale, L little, T thrift; that is, much ale, little thrift.

COLLATINE.

Only the news at home, and I have done?

CLOWN.

My lady must needs speak with you about earnest business, that concerns her nearly, and I was sent in all haste to entreat your lordship to come away.

COLLATINE.

And couldst thou not have told me? Lucrece stay,
And I stand trifling here! Follow, away!

CLOWN.

Ay, marry, sir, the way into her were a way worth following, and that's the reason that so many serving-men that are familiar with their mistresses have lost the name of servitors, and are now called their masters' followers. Rest you merry!

[Music.

SCENE II.—*The Temple at Delphi.*

*Enter APOLLO'S Priests, with tapers; after them, ARUNS, SEXTUS, and
BRUTUS, with their oblations, all kneeling before the Oracle.*

PRIEST.

O thou Delphian god, inspire
Thy priests, and with celestial fire
Shot from thy beams crown our desire,
That we may follow,
In these thy true and hallowed measures,
The utmost of thy heavenly treasures,
According to the thoughts and pleasures
Of great Apollo.

Our hearts with inflammations burn,
Great Tarquin and his people mourn,
Till from thy temple we return,
With some glad tiding.
Then tell us, shall great Rome be blest,
And royal Tarquin live in rest,
That gives his high-ennobled breast
To thy safe guiding?

ORACLE.

Then Rome her ancient honours wins,
When she is purged from Tullia's sins.

BRUTUS.

Gramercies, Phœbus, for these spells!
Phœbus alone, alone excels.

SEXTUS.

Tullia perhaps sinned in our grandsire's death,
And hath not yet by reconciliation made
Atone with Phœbus, at whose shrine we kneel;

Yet, gentle priest, let us thus far prevail,
To know if Tarquin's seed shall govern Rome,
And by succession claim the royal wreath?
Behold me, younger of the Tarquins' race,
This elder Aruns, both the sons of Tullia;
This Junius Brutus, though a madman, yet
Of the high blood of the Tarquins.

PRIEST.

Sextus, peace.
Tell us, O thou that shin'st so bright,
From whom the world receives his light,
Whose absence is perpetual night,
Whose praises ring:
Is it with Heaven's applause decreed,
When Tarquin's soul from earth is freed,
That noble Sextus shall succeed
In Rome as king?

BRUTUS.

Ay, oracle, hast thou lost thy tongue?

ARUNS.

Tempt him again, fair priest.

SEXTUS.

If not as king, let Delphian Phœbus yet
Thus much resolve us: who shall govern Rome,
Or of us three bear great'st pre-eminence?

PRIEST.

Sextus, I will.
Yet, sacred Phœbus, we entreat,
Which of these three shall be great
With largest power and state replete,
By the Heaven's doom?[\[23\]](#)
Phœbus, thy thoughts no longer smother.

ORACLE.

He that first shall kiss his mother
Shall be powerful, and no other
Of you three in Rome.

SEXTUS.

Shall kiss his mother!

[BRUTUS *falls*.

BRUTUS.

Mother Earth, to thee
An humble kiss I tender.

ARUNS.

What means Brutus?

BRUTUS.

The blood of the slaughtered sacrifice made this floor as slippery as the place where Tarquin treads; 'tis glassy and as smooth as ice: I was proud to hear the oracle so gracious to the blood of the Tarquins, and so I fell.

SEXTUS.

Nothing but so? then to the oracle.
I charge thee, Aruns,—Junius Brutus, thee,—
To keep the sacred doom of the oracle
From all our train, lest when the younger lad
Our brother, now at home, sits dandled
Upon fair Tullia's lap, this understanding,
May kiss our beauteous mother, and succeed.

BRUTUS.

Let the charge go round.
It shall go hard but I'll prevent^[24] you, Sextus.

SEXTUS.

I fear not the madman Brutus; and for Aruns, let me alone to buckle^[25] with him: I'll be the first at my mother's lips for a kingdom.

BRUTUS.

If the madman have not been before you, Sextus. If oracles be oracles, their phrases are mystical; they speak still in clouds. Had he meant a natural mother he would not ha' spoke it by circumstance.

SEXTUS.

Tullia, if ever thy lips were pleasing to me, let it be at my return from the oracle.

ARUNS.

If a kiss will make me a king, Tullia, I will spring to thee, though through the blood of Sextus.

BRUTUS.

Earth, I acknowledge no mother but thee; accept me as thy son, and I shall shine as bright in Rome as Apollo himself in his temple at Delphos.

SEXTUS.

Our superstitions ended, sacred priest,
Since we have had free answer from the gods,
To whose fair altars we have done due right,
And hallowed them with presents acceptable,
Let's now return, treading these holy measures
With which we entered great Apollo's temple.
Now, Phœbus, let thy sweet-tuned organs sound,
Whose sphere-like music must direct our feet
Upon the marble pavement. After this
We'll gain a kingdom by a mother's kiss.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE III.—*The Senate-house.*

Enter TARQUIN, TULLIA, *and* COLLATINE, SCEVOLA, HORATIUS, LUCRETIUS,
VALERIUS, Nobles.

TARQUIN.

Attend us with your persons, but your ears
Be deaf unto our counsels.

[The Lords fall off on either side and attend.]

TULLIA.

Farther yet.

TARQUIN.

Now, Tullia, what must be concluded next?

TULLIA.

The kingdom you have got by policy
You must maintain by pride.

TARQUIN.

Good.

TULLIA.

Those that were late of the king's faction
Cut off, for fear they prove rebellious.

TARQUIN.

Better.

TULLIA.

Since you gain nothing by the popular love,
Maintain by fear your princedom.

TARQUIN.

Excellent;

Thou art our oracle, and, save from thee,
We will admit no counsel. We obtained
Our state by cunning; it must be kept by strength;
And such as cannot love we'll teach to fear:
To encourage which, upon our better judgment,
And to strike greater terror to the world,
I have forbid thy father's funeral.

TULLIA.

No matter.

TARQUIN.

All capital causes are by us discussed,
Traversed,[\[26\]](#) and executed without counsel:
We challenge too, by our prerogative,
The goods of such as strive against our state;
The freest citizens, without attain, [\[27\]](#)
Arraign, or judgment, we to exile doom;
The poorer are our drudges, rich our prey,
And such as dare not strive our rule obey.

TULLIA.

Kings are as gods, and divine sceptres bear;
The gods command, for mortal tribute, fear;
But, royal lord, we that despise their love,
Must seek some means how to maintain this awe.

TARQUIN.

By foreign leagues, and by our strength abroad.
Shall we, that are degreed above our people,
Whom Heaven hath made our vassals, reign with them?
No; kings, above the rest tribunaled high,
Should with no meaner than with kings ally:
For this we to Mamilius Tusculan,
The Latin king, ha' given in marriage
Our royal daughter; now his people's ours:
The neighbour princes are subdued by arms;
And whom we could not conquer by constraint,

Them we have sought to win by courtesy.
Kings that are proud, yet would secure their own,
By love abroad shall purchase fear at home.

TULLIA.

We are secure, and yet our greatest strength
Is in our children: how dare treason look
Us in the face, having issue? Barren princes
Breed danger in their singularity;
Having none to succeed, their claim dies in them.
But when, in topping [\[28\]](#) one, three Tarquins more,
Like hydras' heads, grow to revenge his death,
It terrifies black treason.

TARQUIN.

Tullia's wise
And apprehensive! Were our princely sons
Sextus and Aruns back returned safe,
With an applausive answer of the gods
From the oracle, our state were able then,
Being gods ourselves, to scorn the hate of men.

Enter SEXTUS, ARUNS, and BRUTUS.

SEXTUS.

Where's Tullia?

ARUNS.

Where's our mother?

HORATIUS.

Yonder, princes,
At council with the king.

TULLIA.

Our sons returned!

SEXTUS.

Royal mother!

ARUNS.

Renowned queen!

SEXTUS.

I love her best,
Therefore will Sextus do his duty first.

ARUNS.

Being eldest in my birth, I'll not be youngest
In zeal to Tullia.

BRUTUS.

To't, lads!

ARUNS.

Mother, a kiss.

SEXTUS.

Though last in birth, let me be first in love.
A kiss, fair mother.

ARUNS.

Shall I lose my right?

SEXTUS.

Aruns shall down, were Aruns twice my brother,
If he presume 'fore me to kiss my mother.

ARUNS.

Ay, Sextus, think this kiss to be a crown, thus would we tug for't.

SEXTUS.

Aruns, thou must down.

TARQUIN.

Restrain them, lords.

BRUTUS.

Nay, to't, boys! Oh, 'tis brave!
They tug for shadows, I the substance have.

ARUNS.

Through armèd gates, and thousand swords I'll break
To show my duty: let my valour speak.
[Breaks from the Nobles and kisses her.]

SEXTUS.

O Heavens! you have dissolved me.

ARUNS.

Here I stand,
What I ha' done to answer with this hand.

SEXTUS.

O all ye Delphian gods, look down and see
How for these wrongs I will revenged be!

TARQUIN.

Curb in the proud boys' fury; let us know
From whence this discord riseth.

TULLIA.

From our love.
How happy are we in our issue now,
Whenas our sons even with their bloods contend
To exceed in duty! We accept your zeal:
This your superlative degree of kindness
So much prevails with us, that to the king
We engage our own dear love 'twixt his incensement
And your presumption; you are pardoned both.
And, Sextus, though you failed in your first proffer,
We do not yet esteem you least in love:
Ascend and touch our lips.

SEXTUS.

Thank you, no.

TULLIA.

Then to thy knee we will descend thus low.

SEXTUS.

Nay, now it shall not need. How great's my heart!

ARUNS.

In Tarquin's crown thou now hast lost thy part.

SEXTUS.

No kissing now. Tarquin, great queen, adieu!
Aruns, on earth we ha' no foe but you.

TARQUIN.

What means this their unnatural enmity?

TULLIA.

Hate, born from love.

TARQUIN.

Resolve us then, how did the gods accept
Our sacrifice? how are they pleased with us?
How long will they applaud our sovereignty?

BRUTUS.

Shall I tell the king?

TARQUIN.

Do, cousin, with the process of your journey.

BRUTUS.

I will. We went from hither when we went from hence, arrived thither when we landed there, made an end of our prayers when we had done our orisons, when thus quoth Phœbus: "Tarquin shall be happy whilst he is blest, govern while he reigns, wake when he sleeps not, sleep when he wakes not, quaff when he drinks, feed when he eats, gape when his

mouth opens, live till he die, and die when he can live no longer.” So Phœbus commends him to you.

TARQUIN.

Mad Brutus still. Son Aruns, what say you?

ARUNS.

That the great gods, to whom the potent king
Of this large empire sacrificed by us,
Applaud your reign, commend your sovereignty:
And by a general synod grant to Tarquin
Long days, fair hopes, majestic government.

BRUTUS.

Adding withal, that to depose the late king, which in others had been arch-treason, in Tarquin was honour; what in Brutus had been usurpation, in Tarquin was lawful succession; and for Tullia, though it be parricide for a child to kill her father, in Tullia it was charity by death to rid him of all his calamities. Phœbus himself said she was a good child—and shall not I say as he says?—to tread upon her father’s skull,
Sparkle his brains upon her chariot-wheel,
And wear the sacred tincture of his blood
Upon her servile shoe. But more than this,
After his death deny him the due claim
Of all mortality, a funeral,
An earthen sepulchre—this, this, quoth the oracle,
Save Tullia none would do.

TULLIA.

Brutus, no more,
Lest with the eyes of wrath and fury incensed
We look into thy humour: were not madness
And folly to thy words a privilege,
Even in thy last reproof of our proceedings
Thou hadst pronounced thy death.

BRUTUS.

If Tullia will send Brutus abroad for news, and after at his return not endure the telling of it, let Tullia either get closer ears, or get for Brutus a stricter tongue.

TULLIA.

How, sir!

BRUTUS.

God be wi' ye. [*Exit.*]

TARQUIN.

Alas, 'tis madness—pardon him—not spleen;
Nor is it hate, but frenzy. We are pleased
To hear the gods propitious to our prayers.
But whither's Sextus gone? resolve us, Cocles;
We saw thee in his parting follow him.

HORATIUS.

I heard him say, he would straight take his horse
And to the warlike Sabines, enemies
To Rome and you.

TARQUIN.

Save them we have no opposites.
Dares the proud boy confederate with our foes?
Attend us, lords; we must new battle wage,
And with bright arms confront the proud boy's rage.

[*Exeunt all but* LUCRETIUS, COLLATINE, HORATIUS, VALERIUS, *and*
SCEVOLA.]

HORATIUS.

Had I as many souls as drops of blood
In these branched veins, as many lives as stars
Stuck in yond azure roof, and were to die
More deaths than I have wasted weary minutes
To grow to this, I'd hazard all and more
To purchase freedom to this bondaged Rome.

I'm vexed to see this virgin conqueress
Wear shackles in my sight.

LUCRETIOUS.

Oh, would my tears
Would rid great Rome of these prodigious fears!

Re-enter BRUTUS.

BRUTUS.

What, weeping-ripe, Lucretius! possible? Now lords, lads, friends, fellows, young madcaps, gallants, and old courtly ruffians, all subjects under one tyranny, and therefore should be partners of one and the same unanimity, shall we go single ourselves by two and two, and go talk treason? then 'tis but his yea, and my nay, if we be called to question. Or shall's go use some violent bustling to break through this thorny servitude? or shall we every man go sit like a man in desperation, and with Lucretius weep at Rome's misery. Now am I for all things, anything, or nothing. I can laugh with Scevola, weep with this good old man, sing "Oh hone hone" with Valerius, fret with Horatius Cocles, be mad like myself, or neuterize with Collatine. Say, what shall's do?

HORATIUS.

Fret.

VALERIUS.

Sing.

LUCRETIOUS.

Weep.

SCEVOLA.

Laugh.

BRUTUS.

Rather let's all be mad,
That Tarquin he still reigneth, Rome's still sad.

COLLATINE.

You are madmen all that yield so much to passion;
You lay yourselves too open to your enemies,
That would be glad to pry into your deeds,
And catch advantage to ensnare our lives;
The king's fear, like a shadow, dogs you still,
Nor can you walk without it. I commend
Valerius most, and noble Scevola,
That what they cannot mend, seem not to mind.
By my consent let's all wear out our hours
In harmless sports: hawk, hunt, game, sing, drink, dance,
So shall we seem offenceless and live safe
In danger's bloody jaws: where [\[29\]](#) being humorous,
Cloudy, and curiously inquisitive
Into the king's proceedings, there armed fear
May search into us, call our deeds to question,
And so prevent all future expectation
Of wished amendment. Let us stay the time,
Till Heaven have made them ripe for just revenge,
When opportunity is offered us,
And then strike home; till then do what you please:
No discontented thought my mind shall seize.

BRUTUS.

I am of Collatine's mind now. Valerius, sing us a bawdy song, and make's
merry: nay, it shall be so.

VALERIUS.

Brutus shall pardon me.

SCEVOLA.

The time that should have been seriously spent in the state-house, I ha'
learnt securely to spend in a wenching-house, and now I profess myself
anything but a statesman.

HORATIUS.

The more thy vanity.

LUCRETIVS.

The less thy honour.

VALERIUS.

The more his safety, and the less his fear.

[Sings.] She that denies me, I would have;

Who craves me, I despise:

Venus hath power to rule mine heart,

But not to please mine eyes.

Temptations offered, I still scorn;

Denied, I cling them still.

I'll neither glut mine appetite,

Nor seek to starve my will.

Diana, double clothed, offends;

So Venus, naked quite:

The last begets a surfeit, and

The other no delight.

That crafty girl shall please me best

That no, for yea, can say,

And every wanton willing kiss

Can season with a nay.

BRUTUS.

We ha' been mad lords long, now let us be merry lords. Horatius, maugre thy melancholy, and Lucretius, in spite of thy sorrow, I'll have a song. A subject for the ditty?

HORATIUS.

Great Tarquin's pride and Tullia's cruelty.

BRUTUS.

Dangerous; no.

LUCRETIVS.

The tyrannies of the court, and vassalage of the city.

SCEVOLA.

Neither. Shall I give the subject?

BRUTUS.

Do, and let it be of all the pretty wenches in Rome.

SCEVOLA.

It shall: shall it, shall it, Valerius?

VALERIUS.

Anything according to my poor acquaintance and little conversance.

BRUTUS.

Nay, you shall stay, Horatius; Lucretius, so shall you; he removes himself from the love of Brutus that shrinks from my side till we have had a song of all the pretty suburbians:[\[30\]](#) sit round. When, Valerius?

VALERIUS.

[Sings.] Shall I woo the lovely Molly,
She's so fair, so fat, so jolly?
But she has a trick of folly,
Therefore I'll ha' none of Molly.

No, no, no, no, no, no;
I'll have none of Molly, no, no, no.

Oh, the cherry lips of Nelly,
They are red and soft as jelly;
But too well she loves her belly,
Therefore I'll have none of Nelly.

No, no, &c.

What say you to bonny Betty?
Ha' you seen a lass so pretty?
But her body is so sweaty,
Therefore I'll ha' none of Betty.

No, no, &c.

When I dally with my Dolly,
She is full of melancholy;
Oh, that wench is pestilent holly;[\[31\]](#)
Therefore I'll have none of Dolly.

No, no, &c.

I could fancy lovely Nanny,
But she has the loves of many,
Yet herself she loves not any,
Therefore I'll have none of Nanny.
No, no, &c.

In a flax shop I spied Rachel,
Where she her flax and tow did hatchel;[\[32\]](#)
But her cheeks hang like a satchel,
Therefore I'll have none of Rachel.
No, no, &c.

In a corner I met Biddy,
Her heels were light, her head was giddy;
She fell down, and somewhat did I,
Therefore I'll have none of Biddy.
No, no, &c.

BRUTUS.

The rest we'll hear within. What offence is there in this, Lucretius? what hurt's in this, Horatius? is it not better to sing with our heads on than to bleed with our heads off? I ne'er took Collatine for a politician till now. Come, Valerius; we'll run over all the wenches in Rome, from the community of lascivious Flora to the chastity of divine Lucrece; come, good Horatius.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE IV.—*A Room in the House of COLLATINE.*

Enter LUCRECE, Maid, and Clown.

LUCRECE.

A chair.

CLOWN.

A chair for my lady. Mistress Mirable, do you not hear my lady call?

LUCRECE.

Come near, sir; be less officious
In duty, and use more attention.—
Nay, gentlewoman, we exempt not you
From our discourse, you must afford an ear
As well as he to what we ha' to say.

MAID.

I still remain your handmaid.

LUCRECE.

Sirrah, I ha' seen you oft familiar
With this my maid and waiting gentlewoman,
As casting amorous glances, wanton looks,
And privy becks savouring incontinence:
I let you know you are not for my service
Unless you grow more civil.

CLOWN.

Indeed, madam, for my own part I wish Mistress Mirable well, as one fellow servant ought to wish to another, but to say that ever I flung any sheep's eyes in her face—how say you, Mistress Mirable, did I ever offer it?

LUCRECE.

Nay, mistress, I ha' seen you answer him

With gracious looks and some uncivil smiles,
Retorting eyes, and giving his demeanour
Such welcome as becomes not modesty.
Know henceforth there shall no lascivious phrase,
Suspicious look, or shadow of incontinence,
Be entertained by any that attend
On Roman Lucrece.

MAID.

Madam, I!

LUCRECE.

Excuse it not, for my premeditate thought
Speaks nothing out of rashness nor vain hearsay,
But what my own experience testifies
Against you both; let then this mild reproof
Forewarn you of the like: my reputation,
Which is held precious in the eyes of Rome,
Shall be no shelter to the least intent
Of looseness; leave all familiarity,
And quite renounce acquaintance, or I here
Discharge you both my service.

CLOWN.

For my own part, madam, as I am a true Roman by nature, though no Roman by my nose, I never spent the least lip-labour on Mistress Mirable, never so much as glanced, never used any winking or pinking, never nodded at her—no, not so much as when I was asleep; never asked her the question so much as what's her name: if you can bring any man, woman, or child, that can say so much behind my back as "For he did but kiss her, for I did but kiss her, and so let her go," let my Lord Collatine, instead of plucking my coat, pluck my skin over my ears and turn me away naked, that wheresoever I shall come I may be held a raw serving-man hereafter.

LUCRECE.

Sirrah, you know our mind.

CLOWN.

If ever I knew what belongs to these cases, or yet know what they mean; if ever I used any plain dealing, or were ever worth such a jewel, would I might die like a beggar! If ever I were so far read in my grammar as to know what an interjection is, or a conjunction copulative, would I might never have good of my *qui quæ quod*! Why, do you think, madam, I have no more care of myself, being but a stripling, than to go to it at these years? Flesh and blood cannot endure it; I shall even spoil one of the best faces in Rome with crying at your unkindness.

LUCRECE.

I ha' done. See if you can spy your lord returning from the court, and give me notice what strangers he brings home with him.

CLOWN.

Yes, I'll go: but see, kind man, he saves me a labour.

[*Exeunt.*]

SCENE V.—*Outside the House of COLLATINE.*

Enter COLLATINE, VALERIUS, HORATIUS, and SCEVOLA.

HORATIUS.

Come, Valerius, let's hear, in our way to the house of Collatine, that you went late hammering of concerning the taverns in Rome.

VALERIUS.

Only this, Horatius.

[*Sings.*] The gentry to the King's Head,
The nobles to the Crown,
The knights unto the Golden Fleece,
And to the Plough the clown;
The churchman to the Mitre,
The shepherd to the Star,
The gardener hies him to the Rose,
To the Drum the man of war;
To the Feathers ladies you; the Globe
The sea-man doth not scorn;
The usurer to the Devil, and
The townsman to the Horn;
The huntsman to the White Hart,
To the Ship the merchants go;
But you that do the Muses love
The sign called River Po.
The banquerout to the World's End,
The fool to the Fortune hie;
Unto the Mouth the oyster-wife,
The fiddler to the Pie,
The punk unto the Cockatrice,
The drunkard to the Vine,
The beggar to the Bush, then meet
And with Duke Humphrey dine.[\[33\]](#)

Enter LUCRECE and Clown.

COLLATINE.

Fair Lucrece, I ha' brought these lords from court
To feast with thee. [*To Clown*] Sirrah, prepare us dinner.

[*Exit Clown.*]

LUCRECE.

My lord is welcome, so are all his friends.
The news at court, lords?

HORATIUS.

Madam, strange news:
Prince Sextus by the enemies of Rome
Was nobly used, and made their general;
Twice hath he met his father in the field,
And foiled him by the warlike Sabines' aid:
But how hath he rewarded that brave nation,
That in his great disgrace supported him?
I'll tell you, madam: he since the last battle
Sent to his father a close messenger
To be received to grace, withal demanding
What he should do with those his enemies.
Great Tarquin from his son receives this news,
Being walking in his garden; when the messenger
Importuned him for answer, the proud king
Lops with his wand the heads of poppies off,
And says no more; with this uncertain answer
The messenger to Sextus back returns,
Who questions of his father's words, looks, gesture:
He tells him that the haughty speechless king
Did to the heads of poppies, which bold Sextus
Straight apprehends, cuts off the great men's heads,
And, having left the Sabines without govern,
Flies to his father, and this day is welcomed
For this his traitorous service by the king,
With all due solemn honours to the court.

SCEVOLA.

Courtesy strangely requited; this none but the son of Tarquin would have enterprised.

VALERIUS.

I like it, I applaud it; this will come to somewhat in the end; when Heaven has cast up his account, some of them will be called to a hard reckoning. For my part, I dreamt last night I went a-fishing.

[Sings.] Though the weather jangles
With our hooks and our angles,
Our nets be shaken, and no fish taken;
Though fresh cod and whiting
Are not this day biting,
Gurnet, nor conger, to satisfy hunger,
Yet look to our draught.
Hale the main bowling;
The seas have left their rolling,
The waves their huffing, the winds their puffing:
Up to the top-mast, boy,
And bring us news of joy;
Here's no demurring, no fish is stirring,
Yet something we have caught.

COLLATINE.

Leave all to Heaven.

Re-enter Clown.

CLOWN.

My lords, the best plum-porridge in all Rome cools for your honours; dinner is piping hot upon the table, and if you make not the more haste you are like to have but cold cheer: the cook hath done his part, and there's not a dish on the dresser but he has made it smoke for you; if you have good stomachs, and come not in while the meat is hot, you'll make hunger and cold meet together.

COLLATINE.

My man's a rhetorician, I can tell you,
And his conceit is fluent. Enter, lords;

You must be Lucrece' guests, and she is scant
In nothing, for such princes must not want.

[Exeunt all except VALERIUS and Clown.]

CLOWN.

My lord Valerius, I have even a suit to your honour. I ha' not the power to
part from you without a relish, a note, a tone; we must get an air betwixt
us.

VALERIUS.

Thy meaning?

CLOWN.

Nothing but this.

[Sings.] John for the king has been in many ballads,
John for the king down dino,
John for the king has eaten many salads,
John for the king sings hey ho. [\[34\]](#)

VALERIUS.

Thou wouldst have a song, wouldst thou not?

CLOWN.

And be everlastingly bound to your honour. I am now forsaking the
world and the devil, and somewhat leaning towards the flesh; if you
could but teach me how to choose a wench fit for my stature and
complexion, I should rest yours in all good offices.

VALERIUS.

I'll do that for thee. What's thy name?

CLOWN.

My name, sir, is Pompey.

VALERIUS.

Well then, attend.

[Sings.] Pompey, I will show thee the way to know

A dainty dapper wench.

First see her all bare, let her skin be rare,
And be touched with no part of the French.

Let her eye be clear, and her brows severe.
Her eye-brows thin and fine;

But if she be a punk, and love to be drunk,
Then keep her still from the wine.

Let her stature be mean, and her body clean,
Thou canst not choose but like her;

But see she ha' good clothes, with a fair Roman nose,
For that's the sign of a striker.

Let her legs be small, but not used to sprawl,
Her tongue not too loud nor cocket.[\[35\]](#)

Let her arms be strong, and her fingers long,
But not used to dive in pocket.

Let her body be long, and her back be strong,
With a soft lip that entangles,

With an ivory breast, and her hair well dressed
Without gold lace or spangles.

Let her foot be small, clean-legged withal,
Her apparel not too gaudy;

And one that hath not been in any house of sin,
Nor place that hath been bawdy.

CLOWN.

But, God's me! am I trifling here with you, and dinner cools o' the table,
and I am called to my attendance! O my sweet Lord Valerius!

[Exeunt.]

ACT THE THIRD.

SCENE I.—*The Senate-house.*

Enter TARQUIN, PORSENNA, TULLIA, SEXTUS, *and* ARUNS.

TARQUIN.

Next King Porsenna, whom we tender dearly,
Welcome, young Sextus! thou hast to our yoke
Suppressed the neck of a proud nation,
The warlike Sabines, enemies to Rome.

SEXTUS.

It was my duty, royal emperor,
The duty of a subject and a son.
We at our mother's intercession likewise
Are now atoned with Aruns, whom we here
Receive into our bosom.

TULLIA.

This is done
Like a kind brother and a natural son.

ARUNS.

We interchange a royal heart with Sextus,
And graft us in your love.

TARQUIN.

Now, King Porsenna,
Welcome once more to Tarquin and to Rome.

PORSENNA.

We are proud of your alliance: Rome is ours,
And we are Rome's; this our religious league
Shall be carved firm in characters of brass,

And live for ever to succeeding times.

TARQUIN.

It shall, Porsenna. Now this league's established,
We will proceed in our determined wars,
To bring the neighbour nations under us.
Our purpose is to make young Sextus general
Of all our army, who hath proved his fortunes,
And found them full of favour. We'll begin
With strong Ardea;—ha' you given in charge
To assemble all our captains, and take muster
Of our strong army?

ARUNS.

That business is dispatched.

SEXTUS.

We have likewise sent
For all our best commanders, to take charge
According to their merit,—Lord Valerius,
Lord Brutus, Cocles, Mutius Scevola,
And Collatine,—to make due preparation
For such a gallant siege.

TARQUIN.

This day you shall set forward. Sextus, go,
And let us see your army march along
Before this king and us, that we may view
The puissance of our host prepared already
To lay high-reared Ardea waste and low.

SEXTUS.

I shall, my liege.

TULLIA.

Aruns, associate him.

ARUNS.

A rival with my brother in his honours.

[Exeunt ARUNS and SEXTUS.]

TARQUIN.

Porsenna shall behold the strength of Rome,
And body of the camp, under the charge
Of two brave princes, to lay hostile siege
Against the strongest city that withstands
The all-commanding Tarquin.

PORSENNA.

'Tis an object
To please Porsenna's eye.

[Soft march.]

TARQUIN.

The host is now
Upon their march. You from this place may see
The pride of all the Roman chivalry.

*Enter SEXTUS, ARUNS, BRUTUS, COLLATINE, VALERIUS, SCEVOLA, COCLES,
with Soldiers, drum and colours. They march over the stage, and
congee to the King and Queen.*

PORSENNA.

This sight's more pleasing to Porsenna's eye
Than all our rich Attalia's [\[36\]](#) pompous feasts
Or sumptuous revels: we are born a soldier,
And in our nonage sucked the milk of war.
Should any strange fate lour upon this army,
Or that the merciless gulf of confusion
Should swallow them, we, at our proper charge,
And from our native confines, vow supply
Of men and arms to make these numbers full.

TARQUIN.

You are our royal brother, and in you
Tarquin is powerful and maintains his awe.

TULLIA.

The like Porsenna may command of Rome.

PORSENNA.

But we have in your fresh varieties
Feasted too much, and kept ourself too long
From our own seat: our prosperous return
Hath been expected by our lords and peers.

TARQUIN.

The business of our wars thus forwarded,
We ha' best leisure for your entertainment,
Which now shall want no due solemnity.

PORSENNA.

It hath been beyond both expectation
And merit; but in sight of Heaven I swear,
If ever royal Tarquin shall demand
Use of our love, 'tis ready stored for you
Even in our kingly breast.

TARQUIN.

The like we vow
To King Porsenna. We will yet a little
Enlarge your royal welcome with rarities,
Such as Rome yields: that done, before we part,
Of two remote dominions make one heart.
Set forward then. Our sons wage war abroad,
To make us peace at home: we are of ourself.
Without supportance; we all fate defy:
Aidless, and of ourself, we stand thus high.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—*The Camp before Ardea.*

Enter two Soldiers meeting as in the watch.

1ST SOLDIER.

Stand, who goes there?

2ND SOLDIER.

A friend.

1ST SOLDIER.

Stir not, for if thou dost I'll broach thee straight upon this pike. The word?

2ND SOLDIER.

Porsenna.

1ST SOLDIER.

Pass;—stay, who walks the round to-night? the general, or any of his captains?

2ND SOLDIER.

Horatius hath the charge; the other chieftains
Rest in the general's tent; there's no commander
Of any note, but revel with the prince:
And I amongst the rest am charged to attend
Upon their rouse.

1ST SOLDIER.

Pass freely; I this night must stand 'twixt them and danger. The time of night?

2ND SOLDIER.

The clock last told eleven.

1ST SOLDIER.

The powers celestial

That have took Rome in charge, protect it still!
Again good-night. [*Exit 2nd Soldier.*] Thus must poor soldiers do;
Whilst their commanders are with dainties fed,
And sleep on down, the earth must be our bed. [*Exit.*

SCENE III.—*Inside SEXTUS's Tent. A banquet prepared.*

*Enter SEXTUS, ARUNS, BRUTUS, VALERIUS, HORATIUS, SCEVOLA, and
COLLATINE.*

SEXTUS.

Sit round: the enemy is pounded[37] fast
In their own folds; the walls made to oppugn
Hostile incursions become a prison,
To keep them fast for execution;
There's no eruption to be feared.

BRUTUS.

What shall's do? Come, a health to the general's health; and Valerius, that
sits the most civilly, shall begin it; I cannot talk till my blood be mingled
with this blood of grapes. Fill for Valerius. Thou shouldst drink well, for
thou hast been in the German wars; if thou lovest me, drink *upse freeze*.
[38]

SEXTUS.

Nay, since Brutus has spoke the word, the first health shall be imposed on
you, Valerius; and if ever you have been Germanized, let it be after the
Dutch fashion.

VALERIUS.

The general may command.

BRUTUS.

He may; why else is he called the commander?

SEXTUS.

We will entreat Valerius.

VALERIUS.

Since you will needs enforce a high-German health, look well to your
heads, for I come upon you with this Dutch tassaker[39]: if you were of a

more noble science than you are, it will go near to break your heads round.

[Sings a Dutch song.]

O mork giff men ein man,
Skerry merry vip,
O mork giff men ein man
Skerry merry vap.
O mork giff men ein man,
That tik die ten long o drievean can,
Skerry merry vip, and skerry merry vap,
And skerry merry runke ede bunk,
Ede hoore was a hai dedle downe
Dedle drunke a:
Skeery merry runke ede bunk, ede hoor was drunk a.

O daughter yeis ein alto kleene,
Skerry merry vip,
O daughter yeis ein alto kleene,
Skerry merry vap.
O daughter yeis ein alto kleene,
Ye molten slop, ein yert aleene
Skeery merry vip, and skerry merry vap
And skerry merry runk ede bunk,
Ede hoore was a hey dedle downe
Dedle drunke a:
Skeery merry, runk ede bunk, ede hoor was drunk a.

SEXTUS.

Gramercies, Valerius; came this high-German health as double as his double ruff, I'd pledge it.

BRUTUS.

Were it in Lubeck or double-double beer, their own natural liquor, I'd pledge it were it as deep as his ruff: let the health go round about the board, as his band goes round about his neck. I am no more afraid of this Dutch fashion than I should be of the heathenish invention.

COLLATINE.

I must entreat you spare me, for my brain brooks not the fumes of wine;
their vaporous strength offends me much.

HORATIUS.

I would have none spare me, for I'll spare none. Collatine will pledge no
health unless it be to his Lucrece.

SEXTUS.

What's Lucrece but a woman? and what are women
But tortures and disturbance unto men?
If they be foul they're odious, and if fair,
They're like rich vessels full of poisonous drugs,
Or like black serpents armed with golden scales:
For my own part, they shall not trouble me.

BRUTUS.

Sextus, sit fast; for I proclaim myself a woman's champion, and shall
unhorse thee else.

VALERIUS.

For my own part, I'm a married man, and I'll speak to my wife to thank
thee, Brutus.

ARUNS.

I have a wife too, and I think the most virtuous lady in the world.

SCEVOLA.

I cannot say but that I have a good wife too, and I love her: but if she
were in heaven, beshrew me if I would wish her so much hurt as to desire
her company upon earth again; yet, upon my honour, though she be not
very fair, she is exceeding honest.

BRUTUS.

Nay, the less beauty, the less temptation to despoil her honesty.

SCEVOLA.

I should be angry with him that should make question of her honour.

BRUTUS.

And I angry with thee if thou shouldst not maintain her honour.

ARUNS.

If you compare the virtues of your wives, let me step in for mine.

COLLATINE.

I should wrong my Lucrece not to stand for her.

SEXTUS.

Ha, ha! all captains, and stand upon the honesty of your wives! Is't possible, think you,
That women of young spirit and full age,
Of fluent wit, that can both sing and dance,
Read, write, such as feed well and taste choice cates,
That straight dissolve to purity of blood,
That keep the veins full, and inflame the appetite,
Making the spirit able, strong, and prone,—
Can such as these, their husbands being away
Employed in foreign sieges or elsewhere,
Deny such as importune them at home?
Tell me that flax will not be touched with fire,
Nor they be won to what they most desire!

BRUTUS.

Shall I end this controversy in a word?

SEXTUS.

Do, good Brutus.

BRUTUS.

I hold some holy, but some apt to sin;
Some tractable, but some that none can win;
Such as are virtuous, gold nor wealth can move;
Some vicious of themselves are prone to love;
Some grapes are sweet and in the garden grow,
Others unpruned turn wild neglected so;
The purest ore contains both gold and dross,

The one all gain, the other nought but loss;
The one disgrace, reproach, and scandal taints,
The other angels and sweet-featured saints.

COLLATINE.

Such is my virtuous Lucrece.

ARUNS.

Yet she for virtue is not comparable to the wife of Aruns.

SCEVOLA.

And why may not mine be ranked with the most virtuous?

HORATIUS.

I would put in for a lot, but a thousand to one I shall draw but a blank.

VALERIUS.

I should not show I loved my wife, not to take her part in her absence: I
hold her inferior to none.

ARUNS.

Save mine.

VALERIUS.

No, not to her.

BRUTUS.

Oh, this were a brave controversy for a jury of women to arbitrate!

COLLATINE.

I'll hazard all my fortunes on the virtues
Of divine Lucrece. Shall we try them thus?
It is now dead of night; let's mount our steeds;
Within this two hours we may reach to Rome,
And to our houses all come unprepared,
And unexpected by our high-praised wives.
She of them all that we find best employed,
Devoted, and most huswife-exercised,

Let her be held most virtuous, and her husband
Win by the wager a rich horse and armour.

ARUNS.

A hand on that.

VALERIUS.

Here's a helping hand to that bargain.

HORATIUS.

But shall we to horse without circumstance?

SCEVOLA.

Scevola will be mounted with the first.

SEXTUS.

Then mount cheval! Brutus, this night take you the charge of the army.
I'll see the trial of this wager: 'twould do me good to see some of them
find their wives in the arms of their lovers, they are so confident in their
virtues. Brutus, we'll interchange goodnight; be thou but as provident
o'er the army as we (if our horses fail not) expeditious in our journey. To
horse, to horse!

ALL.

Farewell, good Brutus.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE IV.—A Room in the House of COLLATINE.

Enter LUCRECE and her two Maids.

LUCRECE.

But one hour more, and you shall all to rest.
Now that your lord is absent from this house,
And that the master's eye is from his charge,
We must be careful, and with providence
Guide his domestic business; we ha' now
Given o'er all feasting and left revelling,
Which ill becomes the house whose lord is absent;
We banish all excess till his return,
In fear of whom my soul doth daily mourn.

1ST MAID.

Madam, so please you to repose yourself
Within your chamber; leave us to our tasks;
We will not loiter, though you take your rest.

LUCRECE.

Not so; you shall not overwatch yourselves
Longer than I wake with you; for it fits
Good huswives, when their husbands are from home,
To eye their servants' labours, and in care
And the true manage^[40] of his household state,
Earliest to rise, and to be up most late.
Since all his business he commits to me,
I'll be his faithful steward till the camp
Dissolve, and he return; thus wives should do,
In absence of their lords be husbands too.

2ND MAID.

Madam, the Lord Turnus his man was thrice for you here, to have
entreated you home to supper; he says his lord takes it unkindly he could
not have your company.

LUCRECE.

To please a loving husband, I'll offend
The love and patience of my dearest friend.
Methinks his purpose was unreasonable,
To draw me in my husband's absence forth
To feast and banquet; 'twould have ill become me
To have left the charge of such a spacious house
Without both lord and mistress.
I am opinioned thus: wives should not stray
Out of their doors, their husbands being away.
Lord Turnus shall excuse me.

1ST MAID.

Pray, madam, set me right into my work.

LUCRECE.

Being abroad, I may forget the charge
Imposed me by my lord, or be compelled
To stay out late, which, were my husband here,
Might be without distaste, but he from hence,
With late abroad, there can no excuse dispense.
Here, take your work again, a while proceed,
And then to bed; for whilst you sew I'll read.

[They retire.]

Enter SEXTUS, ARUNS, VALERIUS, COLLATINE, HORATIUS, and SCEVOLA.

ARUNS.

I would have hazarded all my hopes, my wife had not been so late a-revelling.

VALERIUS.

Nor mine at this time of night a-gambolling.

HORATIUS.

They wear so much cork under their heels, they cannot choose but love to caper.

SCEVOLA.

Nothing does me good, but that if my wife were watching, all theirs were wantoning, and if I ha' lost, none can brag of their winnings.

SEXTUS.

Now, Collatine, to yours; either Lucrece must be better employed than the rest, or you content to have her virtues rank with the rest.

COLLATINE.

I am pleased.

HORATIUS.

Soft, soft, let's steal upon her as upon the rest, lest having some watchword at our arrival, we may give her notice to be better prepared: nay, by your leave, Collatine, we'll limit you no advantage.

COLLATINE.

See, lords, thus Lucrece revels with her maids:
Instead of riot, quaffing, and the practice
Of high lavoltoes[\[41\]](#) to the ravishing sound
Of chambering music, she, like a good huswife,
Is teaching of her servants sundry chares.—
Lucrece!

LUCRECE. [*Coming forward.*]

My lord and husband, welcome, ten times welcome.
Is it to see your Lucrece you thus late
Ha' with your person's hazard left the camp,
And trusted to the danger of a night
So dark, and full of horror?

ARUNS.

Lords, all's lost.

HORATIUS.

By Jove, I'll buy my wife a wheel,[\[42\]](#) and make her spin for this trick.

SCEVOLA.

If I make not mine learn to live by the prick of her needle for this, I'm no Roman.

COLLATINE.

Sweet wife, salute these lords; thy continence
Hath won thy husband a Barbarian horse
And a rich coat of arms.

LUCRECE.

Oh, pardon me; the joy to see my lord
Took from me all respect of their degrees.
The richest entertainment lives with us,
According to the hour, and the provision
Of a poor wife in the absence of her husband,
We prostrate to you; howsoever mean,
We thus excuse't,—Lord Collatine away,
We neither feast, dance, quaff, riot, nor play.

SEXTUS.

If one woman among so many bad may be found good, if a white wench may prove a black swan, it is Lucrece; her beauty hath relation to her virtue, and her virtue correspondent to her beauty, and in both she is matchless.

COLLATINE.

Lords, will you yield the wager?

ARUNS.

Stay, the wager was as well which of our wives was fairest too; it stretched as well to their beauty as to their continence. Who shall judge that?

HORATIUS.

That can none of us, because we are all parties. Let Prince Sextus determine it, who hath been with us, and been an eye-witness of their beauties.

VALERIUS.

Agreed.

SCEVOLA.

I am pleased with the censure of Prince Sextus.

ARUNS.

So are we all.

COLLATINE.

I commit my Lucrece wholly to the dispose of Sextus.

SEXTUS.

And Sextus commits him wholly to the dispose of Lucrece.

I love the lady and her grace desire,

Nor can my love wrong what my thoughts admire.

Aruns, no question but your wife is chaste

And thrifty, but this lady knows no waste.

Valerius, yours is modest, something fair;

Her grace and beauty are without compare.

Thine, Mutius, well disposed, and of good feature,

But the world yields not so divine a creature.

Horatius, thine a smug lass and graced well,

But amongst all, fair Lucrece doth excel.

Then our impartial heart and judging eyes

This verdict gives,—fair Lucrece wins the prize.

COLLATINE.

Then, lords, you are indebted to me a horse and armour.

ALL.

We yield it.

LUCRECE.

Will you taste such welcome, lords, as a poor unprovided house can yield?

SEXTUS.

Gramercy, Lucrece, no; we must this night sleep by Ardea walls.

LUCRECE.

But, my lords, I hope my Collatine will not so leave his Lucrece.

SEXTUS.

He must: we have but idled from the camp, to try a merry wager about their wives, and this at the hazard of the King's displeasure, should any man be missing from his charge. The powers that govern Rome make divine Lucrece for ever happy! Good-night.

SCEVOLA.

But, Valerius, what thinkest thou of the country girls from whence we came, compared with our city wives whom we this night have tried?

VALERIUS.

Scevola, thou shalt hear.

[*Sings.*] O yes, room for the crier,
Who never yet was found a liar!
O ye fine smug country lasses,
That would for brooks change crystal glasses,
And be transhaped from foot to crown,
And straw-beds change for beds of down;
Your partlets turn into rebatoes,[\[43\]](#)
And 'stead of carrots eat potatoes;
Your frontlets[\[44\]](#) lay by, and your rails,[\[45\]](#)
And fringe with gold your daggled tails:
Now your hawk-noses shall have hoods
And billements[\[46\]](#) with golden studs;
Straw-hats shall be no more bongraces[\[47\]](#)
From the bright sun to hide your faces;
For hempen smocks to help the itch,
Have linen, sewed with silver stitch;
And wheresoe'er they chance to stride,
One bare before to be their guide.

O yes, room for the crier,
Who never yet was found a liar!

LUCRECE.

Will not my husband repose this night with me?

HORATIUS.

Lucrece shall pardon him: we ha' took our leaves of our wives, nor shall Collatine be before us, though our ladies in other things come behind

you.

COLLATINE.

I must be swayed: the joys and the delights
Of many thousand nights meet all in one,
To make my Lucrece happy!

LUCRECE.

I am bound to your strict will. To each good-night.

SEXTUS.

To horse, to horse! [*Aside.*] Lucrece, we cannot rest
Till our hot lust embosom in thy breast.

[*Exeunt all but LUCRECE.*

LUCRECE.

With no unkindness we should our lords upbraid;
Husbands and kings must always be obeyed.
Nothing save the high business of the state,
And the charge given him at Ardea's siege,
Could ha' made Collatine so much digress
From the affection that he bears his wife;
But subjects must excuse when kings claim power.
But, leaving this, before the charm of sleep
Seize with his downy wings upon my eyes,
I must go take account among my servants
Of their day's task; we must not cherish sloth.
No covetous thought makes me thus provident,
But to shun idleness, which, wise men say,
Begets rank lust, and virtue beats away. [*Exit.*

SCENE V.—*The Road to Ardea.*

Enter SEXTUS, ARUNS, HORATIUS, BRUTUS, SCEVOLA, *and* VALERIUS.

HORATIUS.

Return to Rome now we are in the midway to the camp!

SEXTUS.

My lords, 'tis business that concerns my life:
To-morrow, if we live, we'll visit thee.

VALERIUS.

Will Sextus enjoin me to accompany him?

SCEVOLA.

Or me?

SEXTUS.

Nor you, nor any: 'tis important business
And serious occurrences that call me.
Perhaps, lords, I'll commend you to your wives.
Collatine, shall I do you any service to your Lucrece?

COLLATINE.

Only commend me.

SEXTUS.

What, no private token to purchase our kind welcome?

COLLATINE.

Would royal Sextus would but honour me
To bear her a slight token.

SEXTUS.

What?

COLLATINE.

This ring.

SEXTUS.

As I am royal I will see't delivered.
[*Aside.*] This ring to Lucrece shall my love convey,
And in this gift thou dost thy bed betray.
To-morrow we shall meet.—This night, sweet fate,
May I prove welcome, though a guest ingrate! [*Exit.*]

ARUNS.

He's for the city, we for the camp. The night makes the way tedious and melancholy; prithee a merry song to beguile it.

VALERIUS.

[*Sings.*] There was a young man and a maid fell in love,
Terry derry ding, terry derry ding, terry derry dino.
To get her good will he often did——[48]
Terry derry ding, terry derry ding, langtido dille.
There's many will say, and most will allow,
Terry derry ding, terry derry ding, &c.,
There's nothing so good as a terry derry ding, &c.
I would wish all maids before they be sick,
Terry derry, &c.
To inquire for a young man that has a good——
Terry derry, &c.

SCEVOLA.

Nay, my lord, I heard them all have a conceit of an Englishman—a strange people, in the western islands—one that for his variety in habit, humour, and gesture, puts down all other nations whatsoever; a little of that, if you love me.

VALERIUS.

Well, Scevola, you shall.

[*Sings.*][49] The Spaniard loves his ancient slop,
The Lombard his Venetian,
And some like breechless women go—
The Russ, Turk, Jew, and Grecian;

The thrifty Frenchman wears small waist,
The Dutch his belly boasteth;
The Englishman is for them all,
And for each fashion coasteth.
The Turk in linen wraps his head,
The Persian his in lawn too;
The Russ with sables furs his cap,
And change will not be drawn to;
The Spaniard's constant to his block;
The French, inconstant ever;
But, of all felts that can be felt,
Give me your English beaver.

The German loves his cony-wool,[\[50\]](#)
The Irishman his shag[\[51\]](#) too;
The Welsh his monmouth[\[52\]](#) loves to wear,
And of the same will brag too;
Some love the rough, and some the smooth,
Some great, and others small things;
But oh, your lecherous Englishman,
He loves to deal in all things.

The Russ drinks quass; Dutch, Lubeck beer,
And that is strong and mighty;
The Briton, he metheglin quaffs;
The Irish, aquavitæ;
The French affects the Orleans grape,
The Spaniard tastes his sherry;
The English none of these can scape,
But he with all makes merry.

The Italian in her high chapine,[\[53\]](#)
Scotch lass, and lovely frau too,
The Spanish donna, French madame,
He will not fear to go to;
Nothing so full of hazard dread,
Nought lives above the centre,

No fashion, health, no wine, nor wench,
On which he dare not venture.

HORATIUS.

Good Valerius, this has brought us even to the skirts of the camp. Enter,
lords.

[Exeunt.]

ACT THE FOURTH.

SCENE I.—*A Room in the House of COLLATINE.*

Enter SEXTUS, LUCRECE *and* Attendants.

LUCRECE.

This ring, my lord, hath oped the gates to you;
For, though I know you for a royal prince,
My sovereign's son, and friend to Collatine,
Without that key you had not entered here.—
More lights, and see a banquet straight provided.
My love to my dear husband shall appear
In the kind welcome that I give his friend.

SEXTUS.

[*Aside.*] Not love-sick, but love-lunatic, love-mad:
I am all fire, impatience, and my blood
Boils in my heart, with loose and sensual thoughts.

[*Enter Servants, who set out a banquet.*

LUCRECE.

A chair for the prince,
May't please your highness sit?

SEXTUS.

Madam, with you.

LUCRECE.

It will become the wife of Collatine
To wait upon your trencher.

SEXTUS.

You shall sit:

Behind us at the camp we left our state;
We are but your guest—indeed, you shall not wait.
[*Aside.*] Her modesty hath such strong power o'er me,
And such a reverence hath fate given her brow,
That it appears a kind of blasphemy
To have any wanton word harsh in her ears.
I cannot woo, and yet I love 'bove measure;
'Tis force, not suit, must purchase this rich treasure.

LUCRECE.

Your highness cannot taste such homely cates?

SEXTUS.

Indeed, I cannot feed. [*Aside.*] But on thy face:
Thou art the banquet that my thoughts embrace.

LUCRECE.

Knew you, my lord, what free and zealous welcome
We tender you, your highness would presume
Upon your entertainment. Oft, and many times,
I have heard my husband speak of Sextus' valour,
Extol your worth, praise your perfection,
Ay, dote upon your valour, and your friendship
Prize next his Lucrece.

SEXTUS.

[*Aside.*] O impious lust,
In all things base, disrespectful, and unjust!
Thy virtue, grace, and fame I must enjoy,
Though in the purchase I all Rome destroy.—
Madam, if I be welcome as your virtue
Bids me presume I am, carouse to me
A health unto your husband.

LUCRECE.

A woman's draught, my lord, to Collatine!

SEXTUS.

Nay, you must drink off all.

LUCRECE.

Your grace must pardon
The tender weakness of a woman's brain.

SEXTUS.

It is to Collatine.

LUCRECE.

Methinks 'twould ill become the modesty
Of any Roman lady to carouse,
And drown her virtues in the juice of grapes.
How can I show my love unto my husband
To do his wife such wrong? By too much wine
I might neglect the charge of this great house
Left solely to my keep; else my example
Might in my servants breed encouragement
So to offend, both which were pardonless;
Else to your grace I might neglect my duty,
And slack obeisance to so great a guest;
All which being accidental unto wine,
Oh, let me not so wrong my Collatine!

SEXTUS.

We excuse you. [*Aside.*] Her perfections, like a torrent
With violence breaks upon me, and at once
Inverts and swallows all that's good in me.
Preposterous Fates, what mischiefs you involve
Upon a caitiff prince, left to the fury
Of all grand mischief! hath the grandame world
Yet mothered such a strange abortive wonder,
That from her virtues should arise my sin?
I am worse than what's most ill, deprived all reason,
My heart all fiery lust, my soul all treason.

LUCRECE.

My lord, I fear your health, your changing brow

Hath shown so much disturbance. Noble Sextus,
Hath not your venturous travel from the camp,
Nor the moist rawness of this humorous[54] night
Impaired your health?

SEXTUS.

Divinest Lucrece, no. I cannot eat.

LUCRECE.

To rest then.—
A rank of torches, there, attend the prince!

SEXTUS.

Madam, I doubt I am a guest this night
Too troublesome, and I offend your rest.

LUCRECE.

This ring speaks for me, that next Collatine
You are to me most welcome; yet, my lord,
Thus much presume,—without this from his hand,
Sextus this night could not have entered here;
No, not the king himself.
My doors the daytime to my friends are free,
But in the night the obdure gates are less kind;
Without this ring they can no entrance find.—
Lights for the prince!

SEXTUS.

A kiss, and so good-night—nay, for your ring's sake, deny not that.

LUCRECE.

Jove give your highness soft and sweet repose!

SEXTUS.

And thee the like, with soft and sweet content!—
My vows are fixed, my thoughts on mischief bent. [*Exit.*]

LUCRECE.

'Tis late; so many stars[55] shine in this room,
By reason of this great and princely guest,
The world might call our modesty in question,
To revel thus, our husband at the camp.
Haste, and to rest; save in the prince's chamber,
Let not a light appear.—My heart's all sadness.
Jove, unto thy protection I commit
My chastity and honour; to thy keep
My waking soul I give, whilst my thoughts sleep.

[*Exeunt.*

SCENE II.—*Another Room in the same.*

Enter Clown and a Serving-man.

CLOWN.

Soft, soft; not too loud; imagine we were now going on the ropes with eggs at our heels; he that hath but a creaking shoe I would he had a crick in his neck; tread not too hard for disturbing[56] Prince Sextus.

SERVING-MAN.

I wonder the prince would ha' none of us stay in his chamber and help him to bed.

CLOWN.

What an ass art thou to wonder! there may be many causes: thou know'st the prince is a soldier, and soldiers many times want shift: who can say whether he have a clean shirt on or no? for any thing that we know he hath used staves-acre[57] o' late, or hath ta'en a medicine to kill the itch. What's that to us? we did our duty to proffer our service.

SERVING-MAN.

And what should we enter farther into his thoughts? Come, shall's to bed? I am as drowsy as a dormouse, and my head is as heavy as though I had a night-cap of lead on.

CLOWN.

And my eyes begin to glue themselves together. I was till supper was done altogether for your repast, and now after supper I am only for your repose: I think, for the two virtues of eating and sleeping, there's never a Roman spirit under the cope of Heaven can put me down.

Enter MIRABLE.

MIRABLE.

For shame! what a conjuring and caterwauling keep you here, that my lady cannot sleep! you shall have her call by and by, and send you all to

bed with a witness.

CLOWN.

Sweet Mistress Mirable, we are going.

MIRABLE.

You are too loud; come, every man dispose him to his rest, and I'll to mine.

SERVING-MAN.

Out with your torches.

CLOWN.

Come, then, and every man sneak into his kennel.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE III.—LUCRECE'S *Bedchamber*.

Enter SEXTUS, with a drawn sword and a lighted taper.

SEXTUS.

Night, be as secret as thou art close, as close
As thou art black and dark! thou ominous queen
Of tenebrous silence, make this fatal hour
As true to rape as thou hast made it kind
To murder and harsh mischief! Cynthia, mask thy cheek,
And, all you sparkling elemental fires,
Choke up your beauties in prodigious fogs,
Or be extinct in some thick vaporous clouds,
Lest you behold my practice! I am bound
Upon a black adventure, on a deed
That must wound virtue, and make beauty bleed.
Pause, Sextus, and, before thou runn'st thyself
Into this violent danger, weigh thy sin.
Thou art yet free, beloved, graced in the camp,
Of great opinion[58] and undoubted hope,
Rome's darling, in the universal grace
Both of the field and Senate, where these fortunes
Do make thee great in both. Back! yet thy fame
Is free from hazard, and thy style from shame.
O Fate! thou hast usurped such power o'er man
That where thou plead'st thy will no mortal can
On then, black mischief! hurry me the way;
Myself I must destroy, her life betray;
The hate of king and subject, the displeasure
Of prince and people, the revenge of noble,
And the contempt of base, the incurred vengeance
Of my wronged kinsman Collatine, the treason
Against divinest Lucrece—all these total curses,
Foreseen not feared, upon one Sextus meet,
To make my days harsh—so this night be sweet!
No jar of clock, no ominous hateful howl

Of any starting hound, no horse-cough breathed from the entrails
Of any drowsy groom, wakes this charmed silence
And starts this general slumber. Forward still:
To make thy lust live, all thy virtues kill.

[*He draws a curtain; LUCRECE is discovered in bed.*]

Here, here, behold! beneath these curtains lies
That bright enchantress that hath dazed my eyes.
Oh, who but Sextus could commit such waste
On one so fair, so kind, so truly chaste?
Or like a ravisher thus rudely stand,
To offend this face, this brow, this lip, this hand?
Or at such fatal hours these revels keep,
With thought once to defile thy innocent sleep?
Save in this breast, such thoughts could find no place,
Or pay with treason her kind hospitable grace;
But I am lust-burnt all, bent on what's bad,
That which should calm good thought makes Tarquin mad.—
Madam! Lucrece!

LUCRECE.

Who's that? O me! beshrew you!

SEXTUS.

Sweet, 'tis I.

LUCRECE.

What I?

SEXTUS.

Make room.

LUCRECE.

My husband Collatine?

SEXTUS.

Thy husband's at the camp.

LUCRECE.

Here is no place for any man save him.

SEXTUS.

Grant me that grace.

LUCRECE.

What are you?

SEXTUS.

Tarquin, and thy friend, and must enjoy thee.

LUCRECE.

Heaven such sins defend![\[59\]](#)

SEXTUS.

Why do you tremble, lady? cease this fear:
I am alone; there's no suspicious ear
That can betray this deed: nay, start not, sweet.

LUCRECE.

Dream I, or am I full awake? oh, no!
I know I dream to see Prince Sextus so.
Sweet lord, awake me, rid me from this terror.
I know you for a prince, a gentleman,
Royal and honest, one that loves my lord,
And would not wreck a woman's chastity
For Rome's imperial diadem. Oh, then,
Pardon this dream; for, being awake, I know
Prince Sextus, Rome's great hope, would not for shame
Havoc his own worth, or despoil my fame.

SEXTUS.

I'm bent on both; my thoughts are all on fire:
Choose thee; thou must embrace death or desire.
Yet do I love thee. Wilt thou accept it?

LUCRECE.

No.

SEXTUS.

If not thy love, thou must enjoy thy foe.
Where fair means cannot, force shall make my way:
By Jove, I must enjoy thee!

LUCRECE.

Sweet lord, stay.

SEXTUS.

I'm all impatience, violence and rage,
And, save thy bed, nought can this fire assuage.
Wilt love me?

LUCRECE.

No, I cannot.

SEXTUS.

Tell me why?

LUCRECE.

Hate me, and in that hate first let me die.

SEXTUS.

By Jove, I'll force thee!

LUCRECE.

By a god you swear
To do a devil's deed. Sweet lord, forbear.
By the same Jove I swear, that made this soul,
Never to yield unto an act so foul.
Help, help!

SEXTUS.

These pillows first shall stop thy breath,
If thou but shriekest: hark how I'll frame thy death—

LUCRECE.

For death I care not, so I keep unstained

The uncrazed[\[60\]](#) honour I have yet maintained.

SEXTUS.

Thou canst keep neither, for if thou but squeakest
Or lett'st the least harsh noise jar in my ear,
I'll broach thee on my steel; that done, straight murder
One of thy basest grooms, and lay you both,
Grasped arm in arm, on thy adulterate bed,
Then call in witness of that mechal[\[61\]](#) sin.
So shalt thou die, thy death be scandalous,
Thy name be odious, thy suspected body
Denied all funeral rites, and loving Collatine
Shall hate thee even in death: then save all this,
And to thy fortunes add another friend,
Give thy fears comfort, and these torments end.

LUCRECE.

I'll die first; and yet hear me. As you're noble,
If all your goodness and best generous thoughts
Be not exiled your heart, pity, oh, pity
The virtues of a woman; mar not that
Cannot be made again; this once defiled,
Not all the ocean waves can purify
Or wash my stain away: you seek to soil
That which the radiant splendour of the sun
Cannot make bright again. Behold my tears;
Oh, think them pearlèd drops, distilled from the heart
Of soul-chaste Lucrece; think them orators,
To plead the cause of absent Collatine,
Your friend and kinsman.

SEXTUS.

Tush, I am obdure.

LUCRECE.

Then make my name foul, keep my body pure.
Oh, prince of princes, do but weigh your sin;
Think how much I shall lose, how small you win.

I lose the honour of my name and blood,
Loss Rome's imperial crown cannot make good;
You win the world's shame and all good men's hate—
Oh, who would pleasure buy at such dear rate?
Nor can you term it pleasure, for what's sweet
Where force and hate, jar and contention meet?
Weigh but for what 'tis that you urge me still:
To gain a woman's love against her will.
You'll but repent such wrong done a chaste wife,
And think that labour's not worth all your strife,
Curse your hot lust, and say you have wronged your friends;
But all the world cannot make me amends.
I took you for a friend; wrong not my trust,
But let these chaste tears quench your fiery lust.

SEXTUS.

No; those moist tears, contending with my fire
Quench not my heat, but make it climb much higher:
I'll drag thee hence.

LUCRECE.

Oh!

SEXTUS.

If thou raise these cries,
Lodged in thy slaughtered arms some base groom dies.
And Rome, that hath admired thy name so long,
Shall blot thy death with scandal from my tongue.

LUCRECE.

Jove guard my innocence!

SEXTUS.

Lucrece, thou'rt mine,
In spite of Jove and all the powers divine.

[He bears her out.]

SCENE IV.—*An Anteroom in COLLATINE’S House.*

Enter a Serving-man.

SERVING-MAN.

What’s o’clock, trow? my lord bade me be early ready with my gelding, for he would ride betimes in the morning: now had I rather be up an hour before my time than a minute after, for my lord will be so infinitely angry if I but oversleep myself a moment that I had better be out of my life than in his displeasure: but soft, some of my Lord Collatine’s men lie in the next chamber; I care not if I call them up, for it grows towards day. What, Pompey, Pompey!

Enter Clown.

CLOWN.

Who is that calls?

SERVING-MAN.

’Tis I.

CLOWN.

Who’s that, my Lord Sextus his man?—what a pox make you up before day?

SERVING-MAN.

I would have the key of the gate to come at my lord’s horse in the stable.

CLOWN.

I would my Lord Sextus and you were both in the hay-loft, for Pompey can take none of his natural rest among you; here’s e’en “Ostler, rise, and give my horse another peck of hay.”

SERVING-MAN.

Nay, good Pompey, help me to the key of the stable.

CLOWN.

Well, Pompey was born to do Rome good in being so kind to the young prince's gelding, but if for my kindness in giving him pease and oats he should kick me, I should scarce say "God-a-mercy, horse." But come, I'll go with thee to the stable.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE V.—SEXTUS's *Chamber in* COLLATINE's *House*.

SEXTUS *and* LUCRECE *discovered*.

SEXTUS.

Nay, weep not, sweet, what's done is past recall.
Call not thy name in question, by this sorrow,
Which is yet without blemish; what hath passed
Is hid from the world's eye, and only private
'Twixt us. Fair Lucrece, pull not on my head
The wrath of Rome; if I have done thee wrong,
Love was the cause; thy fame is without blot,
And thou in Sextus hast a true friend got.
Nay, sweet, look up; thou only hast my heart;
I must be gone, Lucrece; a kiss and part.

LUCRECE.

Oh! [*She flings from him and exit.*]

SEXTUS.

No? Peevish dame, farewell! then be the bruite
Of thy own shame, which Tarquin would conceal;
I am armed 'gainst all can come; let mischief frown,
With all his terror, armed with ominous fate;
To all their spleens a welcome I'll afford,
With this bold heart, strong hand and my good sword. [*Exit.*]

SCENE VI.—*The Camp at Ardea.*

Enter BRUTUS, VALERIUS, HORATIUS, ARUNS, SCEVOLA, *and* COLLATINE.

BRUTUS.

What, so early, Valerius, and your voice not up yet? thou wast wont to be my lark, and raise me with thy early notes.

VALERIUS.

I was never so hard set yet, my lord, but I had ever a fit of mirth for my friend.

BRUTUS.

Prithee, let's hear it then while we may, for I divine thy music and my madness are both short-lived; we shall have somewhat else to do ere long, we hope, Valerius.

HORATIUS.

Jove send it!

VALERIUS.

[*Sings.*] Pack, clouds, away, and welcome, day!
With night we banish sorrow;
Sweet air, blow soft; mount, lark, aloft,
To give my love good-morrow.
Wings from the wind, to please her mind,
Notes from the lark I'll borrow;
Bird, prune thy wing, nightingale, sing,
To give my love good-morrow.
To give my love good-morrow,
Notes from them all I'll borrow.

Wake from thy nest, robin red-breast;
Sing, birds, in every furrow,
And from each bill let music shrill
Give my fair love good-morrow;

Blackbird and thrush, in every bush,
Stare,[\[62\]](#) linnet, and cock-sparrow,
You pretty elves, amongst yourselves,
Sing my fair love good-morrow.
To give my love good-morrow,
Sing, birds, in every furrow.

BRUTUS.

Methinks our wars go not well forwards, Horatius: we have greater enemies to bustle with than the Ardeans, if we durst but front them.

HORATIUS.

Would it were come to fronting!

BRUTUS.

Then we married men should have the advantage of the bachelors, Horatius, especially such as have revelling wives, those that can caper in the city while their husbands are in the camp. Collatine, why are you so sad? the thought of this should not trouble you, having a Lucrece to your bedfellow.

COLLATINE.

My lord, I know no cause of discontent, yet cannot I be merry.

SCEVOLA.

Come, come, make him merry; let's have a song in praise of his Lucrece.

VALERIUS.

Content.

[Sings.] On two white columns arched she stands;
Some snow would think them, sure,
Some crystal, other lilies stripped,
But none of those so pure.

This beauty when I contemplate,
What riches I behold!
'Tis roofed within with virtuous thoughts,
Without, 'tis thatched with gold.

Two doors there are to enter at:
The one I'll not inquire,
Because concealed; the other seen,
Whose sight inflames desire.

Whether the porch be coral clear,
Or with rich crimson lined,
Or rose-leaves, lasting all the year,
It is not yet divined.

Her eyes not made of purest glass,
Or crystal, but transpareth;
The life of diamonds they surpass,
Their very sight ensnareth.

That which without we rough-cast call,
To stand 'gainst wind and weather,
For its rare beauty equals all
That I have named together.

For, were it not by modest art
Kept from the sight of skies,
It would strike dim the sun itself,
And daze the gazer's eyes.

The case so rich, how may we praise
The jewel lodged within?
To draw their praise I were unwise,
To wrong them it were sin.

ARUNS.

I should be frolic if my brother were but returned to the camp.

HORATIUS.

And, in good time, behold Prince Sextus.

Enter SEXTUS.

ALL.

Health to our general.

SEXTUS.

Thank you.

BRUTUS.

Will you survey your forces, and give order for a present assault? Your soldiers long to be tugging with the Ardeans.

SEXTUS.

No.

COLLATINE.

Have you seen Lucretia, my lord? how fares she?

SEXTUS.

Well; I'll to my tent.

ARUNS.

Why, how now! what's the matter, brother?

[Exeunt ARUNS and SEXTUS.]

BRUTUS.

"Thank you." "No." "Well; I'll to my tent." Get thee to thy tent, and a coward go with thee, if thou hast no more spirit to a speedy encounter.

VALERIUS.

Shall I go after him, and know the cause of his discontent?

SCEVOLA.

Or I, my lord?

BRUTUS.

Neither; to pursue a fool in his humour is the next way to make him more humorous. I'll not be guilty of his folly; thank you, no! Before I wish him

health again when he is sick of the sullens, may I die, not like a Roman,
but like a runagate!

SCEVOLA.

Perhaps he's not well.

BRUTUS.

Well, then, let him be ill.

VALERIUS.

Nay, if he be dying, as I could wish he were, I'll ring out his funeral peal;
and this it is.

Come, list and hark;
The bell doth toll,
For some but now
Departing soul.
And was not that
Some ominous fowl,
The bat, the night-
Crow, or screech-owl?
To these I hear
The wild wolf howl
In this black night
That seems to scowl.
All these my black-
Book shall enroll,
For hark! still, still
The bell doth toll
For some but now
Departing soul.

SCEVOLA.

Excellent, Valerius. But is not that Collatine's man?

Enter Clown.

VALERIUS.

The news with this hasty post?

CLOWN.

Did nobody see my lord Collatine? Oh! my lady commends her to you; here's a letter.

COLLATINE.

Give it me.

CLOWN.

Fie upon't! never was poor Pompey so overlaboured as I have been. I think I have spurred my horse such a question, that he is scarce able to wig or wag his tail for an answer; but my lady bade me spare for no horse-flesh, and I think I have made him run his race.

BRUTUS.

Cousin Collatine, the news at Rome?

COLLATINE.

Nothing but what you all may well partake.
Read here, my lord, [BRUTUS *reads the letter*.
“Dear lord, if ever thou wilt see thy Lucrece,
Choose of the friends which thou affectest best,
And, all important business set apart,
Repair to Rome. Commend me to Lord Brutus,
Valerius, Mutius, and Horatius;
Say I entreat their presence, where my father
Lucretius shall attend them. Farewell, sweet!
The affairs are great, then do not fail to meet.”

BRUTUS.

I'll thither as I live. [*Exit*.

COLLATINE.

I though I die. [*Exit*.

SCEVOLA.

To Rome with expeditious wings we'll fly. [*Exit*.

HORATIUS.

The news, the news? if it have any shape
Of sadness, if some prodigy have chanced
That may beget revenge, I'll cease to chafe,
Vex, martyr, grieve, torture, torment myself,
And tune my humour to strange strains of mirth.
My soul divines some happiness: speak, speak;
I know thou hast some news that will create me
Merry and musical, for I would laugh,
Be new transhaped. I prithee sing, Valerius,
That I may air with thee.

VALERIUS.

[Sings.]—

I'd think myself as proud in shackles
As doth the ship in all her tackles;
The wise man boasts no more his brains
Than I'd insult in gyves and chains;
As creditors would use their debtors,
So could I toss and shake my fetters;
But not confess: my thoughts should be
In durance fast as those kept me.
And could, when spite their hearts environs,
Then dance to the music of my irons.

Now tell us what's the project of thy message?

CLOWN.

My lords, the princely Sextus has been at home, but what he hath done
there I may partly mistrust, but cannot altogether resolve you: besides,
my lady swore me that whatsoever I suspected I should say nothing.

VALERIUS.

If thou wilt not say thy mind, I prithee sing thy mind, and then thou
mayst save thine oath.

CLOWN.

Indeed, I was not sworn to that; I may either laugh out my news or sing
'em, and so I may save mine oath to my lady.

HORATIUS.

How's all at Rome, that with such sad presage
Disturbèd Collatine and noble Brutus
Are hurried from the camp with Scevola,
And we with expedition 'mongst the rest,
Are charged to Rome? Speak, what did Sextus there
With thy fair mistress?

VALERIUS.

Second me, my lord, and we'll urge him to disclose it.

CATCH. [\[63\]](#)

VALERIUS.

Did he take fair Lucrece by the toe, man?

HORATIUS.

Toe, man?

VALERIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha ha, man!

HORATIUS.

And further did he strive to go, man?

CLOWN.

Go, man?

HORATIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha, man, fa derry derry down, ha fa derry dino!

VALERIUS.

Did he take fair Lucrece by the heel, man?

CLOWN.

Heel, man?

VALERIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha, man!

HORATIUS.

And did he further strive to feel, man?

CLOWN.

Feel, man?

HORATIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha, man, ha fa derry, &c.

VALERIUS.

Did he take the lady by the shin, man?

CLOWN.

Shin, man?

VALERIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha, man!

HORATIUS.

Further too would he have been, man?

CLOWN.

Been, man?

HORATIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha, man, ha fa derry, &c.

VALERIUS.

Did he take the lady by the knee, man?

CLOWN.

Knee, man?

VALERIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha, man!

HORATIUS.

Farther than that would he be, man?

CLOWN.

Be, man?

HORATIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha, man, hey fa derry, &c.

VALERIUS.

Did he take the lady by the thigh, man?

CLOWN.

Thigh, man?

VALERIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha, man!

HORATIUS.

And now he came it somewhat nigh, man.

CLOWN.

Nigh, man?

HORATIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha, man, hey fa derry, &c.

VALERIUS.

But did he do the tother thing, man?

CLOWN.

Thing, man?

VALERIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha, man!

HORATIUS.

And at the same had he a fling, man?

CLOWN.

Fling, man?

HORATIUS.

Ay, man.

CLOWN.

Ha ha ha ha, man, hey fa derry, &c.

[*Exeunt.*

ACT THE FIFTH.

SCENE I.—*A Room in the House of COLLATINE.*

A table and a chair covered with black. Enter LUCRECE and her Maid.

LUCRECE.

Mirable.

MAID.

Madam.

LUCRECE.

Is not my father, old Lucretius, come yet?

MAID.

Not yet.

LUCRECE.

Nor any from the camp?

MAID.

Neither, madam.

LUCRECE.

Go, begone,
And leave me to the truest grief of heart
That ever entered any matron's breast:
Oh!

MAID.

Why weep you, lady? alas! why do you stain
Your modest cheeks with these offensive tears?

LUCRECE.

Nothing, nay, nothing. O you powerful gods,

That should have angels guardants on your throne,
To protect innocence and chastity! oh, why
Suffer you such inhuman massacre
On harmless virtue? wherefore take you charge
On sinless souls, to see them wounded thus
With rape or violence? or give white innocence
Armour of proof 'gainst sin, or by oppression
Kill virtue quite, and guerdon base transgression.
Is it my fate above all other women,
Or is my sin more heinous than the rest,
That amongst thousands, millions, infinites,
I, only I, should to this shame be born,
To be a stain to women, nature's scorn?
Oh!

MAID.

What ails you, madam? truth, you make me weep
To see you shed salt tears: what hath oppressed you?
Why is your chamber hung with mourning black,
Your habit sable, and your eyes thus swollen
With ominous tears? Alas! what troubles you?

LUCRECE.

I am not sad; thou didst deceive thyself;
I did not weep, there's nothing troubles me;
But wherefore dost thou blush?

MAID.

Madam, not I.

LUCRECE.

Indeed thou didst,
And in that blush my guilt thou didst betray.
How cam'st thou by the notice of my sin?

MAID.

What sin?

LUCRECE.

My blot, my scandal, and my shame.
O Tarquin, thou my honour didst betray;
Disgrace no time, no age can wipe away!
Oh!

MAID.

Sweet lady, cheer yourself; I'll fetch my viol,
And see if I can sing you fast asleep;
A little rest would wear away this passion.

LUCRECE.

Do what thou wilt, I can command no more.
Being no more a woman, I am now
Devote to death, and an inhabitant
Of the other world: these eyes must ever weep
Till fate hath closed them with eternal sleep.

*Enter BRUTUS, COLLATINUS, HORATIUS, SCEVOLA, and VALERIUS on one
side, LUCRETIUS on the other.*

LUCRETIUS.

Brutus!

BRUTUS.

Lucretius!

LUCRECE.

Father!

COLLATINE.

Lucrece!

LUCRECE.

Collatine!

BRUTUS.

How cheer you, madam? how is't with you, cousin?

Why is your eye deject and drowned in sorrow?
Why is this funeral black, and ornaments
Of widowhood? resolve me, cousin Lucrece.

HORATIUS.

How fare you, lady?

LUCRETIUS.

What's the matter, girl?

COLLATINE.

Why, how is't with you, Lucrece? tell me, sweet,
Why dost thou hide thy face, and with thy hand
Darken those eyes that were my suns of joy,
To make my pleasures flourish in the spring?

LUCRECE.

O me!

VALERIUS.

Whence are these sighs and tears?

SCEVOLA.

How grows this passion?

BRUTUS.

Speak, lady; you are hemmed in with your friends.
Girt in a pale of safety, and environed
And circled in a fortress of your kindred.
Let not those drops fall fruitless to the ground,
Nor let your sighs add to the senseless wind.
Speak, who hath wronged you?

LUCRECE.

Ere I speak my woe,
Swear you'll revenge poor Lucrece on her foe.

BRUTUS.

Be his head arched with gold.

HORATIUS.

Be his hand armed
With an imperial sceptre.

LUCRETIVS.

Be he great
As Tarquin, throned in an imperial seat.

BRUTUS.

Be he no more than mortal, he shall feel
The vengeful edge of this victorious steel.

LUCRECE.

Then seat you, lords, whilst I express my wrong.
Father, dear husband, and my kinsmen lords,
Hear me; I am dishonoured and disgraced,
My reputation mangled, my renown
Disparaged,—but my body, oh, my body!

COLLATINE.

What, Lucrece?

LUCRECE.

Stained, polluted, and defiled.
Strange steps are found in my adulterate bed,
And, though my thoughts be white as innocence,
Yet is my body soiled with lust-burnt sin,
And by a stranger I am strumpeted,
Ravished, enforced, and am no more to rank
Among the Roman matrons.

BRUTUS.

Yet cheer you, lady, and restrain these tears.
If you were forced the sin concerns not you;
A woman's born but with a woman's strength.
Who was the ravisher?

HORATIUS.

Ay, name him, lady:
Our love to you shall only thus appear,
In the revenge that we will take on him.

LUCRECE.

I hope so, lords. 'Twas Sextus, the king's son.

ALL.

How! Sextus Tarquin!

LUCRECE.

That unprincely prince,
Who guest-wise entered with my husband's ring.
This ring, O Collatine! this ring you sent
Is cause of all my woe, your discontent.
I feasted him, then lodged him, and bestowed
My choicest welcome; but in dead of night
My traitorous guest came armed unto my bed,
Frighted my silent sleep, threatened, and prayed
For entertainment: I despised both.
Which hearing, his sharp-pointed scimitar
The tyrant bent against my naked breast.
Alas! I begged my death; but note his tyranny:
He brought with him a torment worse than death,
For, having murdered me, he swore to kill
One of my basest grooms, and lodge him dead
In my dead arms, then call in testimony
Of my adultery, to make me hated,
Even in my death, of husband, father, friends,
Of Rome, and all the world. This, this, O princes,
Ravished and killed me at once.

COLLATINE.

Yet comfort, lady;
I quit thy guilt, for what could Lucrece do
More than a woman? hadst thou died polluted
By this base scandal, thou hadst wronged thy fame:

And hindered us of a most just revenge.

ALL.

What shall we do, lords?

BRUTUS.

Lay your resolute hands
Upon the sword of Brutus; vow and swear,
As you hope meed for merit from the gods,
Or fear reward for sin from devils below,
As you are Romans, and esteem your fame
More than your lives, all humorous toys set off,
Of madding, singing, smiling, and what else,
Revive your native valours, be yourselves,
And join with Brutus in the just revenge
Of this chaste ravished lady;—swear!

ALL.

We do.

LUCRECE.

Then with your humours here my grief ends too:
My stain I thus wipe off, call in my sighs,
And in the hope of this revenge, forbear
Even to my death to fall [\[64\]](#) one passionate tear;
Yet, lords, that you may crown my innocence
With your best thoughts, that you may henceforth know
We are the same in heart we seem in show,
And though I quit my soul of all such sin, [*The Lords whisper.*
I'll not debar my body punishment.
Let all the world learn of a Roman dame,
To prize her life less than her honoured fame. [*Stabs herself.*

LUCRETIVS.

Lucrece!

COLLATINE.

Wife!

BRUTUS.

Lady!

SCEVOLA.

She hath slain herself.

VALERIUS.

Oh, see yet, lords, if there be hope of life.

BRUTUS.

She's dead: then turn your funeral tears to fire
And indignation; let us now redeem
Our misspent time, and overtake our sloth
With hostile expedition. This, great lords,
This bloody knife, on which her chaste blood flowed,
Shall not from Brutus till some strange revenge
Fall on the heads of Tarquins.

HORATIUS.

Now's the time
To call their pride to count. Brutus, lead on;
We'll follow thee to their confusion.

VALERIUS.

By Jove, we will! the sprightly youth of Rome,
Tricked up in plumèd harness, shall attend
The march of Brutus, whom we here create
Our general against the Tarquins.

SCEVOLA.

Be it so.

BRUTUS.

We embrace it. Now, to stir the wrath of Rome,
You, Collatine and good Lucretius,
With eyes yet drowned in tears, bear that chaste body
Into the market-place; that horrid object
Shall kindle them with a most just revenge.

HORATIUS.

To see the father and the husband mourn
O'er this chaste dame, that have so well deserved
Of Rome and them; then to infer the pride,
The wrongs and the perpetual tyranny
Of all the Tarquins, Servius Tullius' death,
And his unnatural usage by that monster
Tullia, the queen; all these shall well concur
In a combined revenge.

BRUTUS.

Lucrece, thy death we'll mourn in glittering arms
And plumèd casques. Some bear that reverend load
Unto the Forum, where our force shall meet
To set upon the palace, and expel
This viperous brood from Rome: I know the people
Will gladly embrace our fortunes. Scevola,
Go you and muster powers in Brutus' name.
Valerius, you assist him instantly,
And to the 'mazèd people speak
The cause of this concourse.

VALERIUS.

We go.

[Exeunt VALERIUS and SCEVOLA.]

BRUTUS.

And you, dear lords, whose speechless grief is boundless,
Turn all your tears, with ours, to wrath and rage.
The hearts of all the Tarquins shall weep blood
Upon the funeral hearse, with whose chaste body
Honour your arms, and to the assembled people
Disclose her innocent wounds. Gramercies, lords!

[A great shout and a flourish with drums and trumpets within.]
That universal shout tells me their words
Are gracious with the people, and their troops
Are ready embattled, and expect but us

To lead them on. Jove give our fortunes speed!
We'll murder murder, and base rape shall bleed.

[Exeunt.]

SCENE II.—*The Outskirts of Rome.*

Alarum. Enter TARQUIN and TULLIA flying, pursued by BRUTUS and the Romans with drums and colours. PORSENNA, ARUNS and SEXTUS meet and join with TARQUIN and TULLIA. BRUTUS and the Romans advance; they make a stand.

BRUTUS.

Even thus far, tyrant, have we dogged thy steps,
Frighting thy queen and thee with horrid steel.

TARQUIN.

Lodged in the safety of Porsenna's arms,
Now, traitor Brutus, we dare front thy pride.

HORATIUS.

Porsenna, thou'rt unworthy of a sceptre,
To shelter pride, lust, rape, and tyranny,
In that proud prince and his confederate peers.

SEXTUS.

Traitors to Heaven, to Tarquin, Rome and us!
Treason to kings doth stretch even to the gods,
And those high gods that take great Rome in charge
Shall punish your rebellion.

COLLATINE.

O devil Sextus, speak not thou of gods,
Nor cast those false and feignèd eyes to Heaven,
Whose rape the furies must torment in hell
Of Lucrece—Lucrece!

SCEVOLA.

Her chaste blood still cries
For vengeance to the ethereal deities.

LUCRETIVS.

Oh, 'twas a foul deed, Sextus!

VALERIUS.

And thy shame
Shall be eternal and outlive her fame.

ARUNS.

Say Sextus loved her, was she not a woman?
Ay, and perhaps was willing to be forced.
Must you, being private subjects, dare to ring
War's loud alarum 'gainst your potent king?

PORSENNA.

Brutus, therein thou dost forget thyself,
And wrong'st the glory of thine ancestors,
Staining thy blood with treason.

BRUTUS.

Tuscan, know
The Consul Brutus is their powerful foe.

TARQUIN, TULLIA, &C.

Consul!

HORATIUS.

Ay, Consul; and the powerful hand of Rome
Grasps his imperial sword: the name of king
The tyrant Tarquins have made odious
Unto this nation, and the general knee
Of this our warlike people now low bends
To royal Brutus, where the king's name ends.

BRUTUS.

Now, Sextus, where's the oracle? when I kissed
My mother earth it plainly did foretell
My noble virtues did thy sin exceed,
Brutus should sway, and lust-burnt Tarquin bleed.

VALERIUS.

Now shall the blood of Servius fall as heavy
As a huge mountain on your tyrant heads,
O'erwhelming all your glory.

HORATIUS.

Tullia's guilt
Shall be by us revenged, that, in her pride,
In blood paternal her rough coach-wheels dyed.

LUCRETIVS.

Your tyrannies—

SCEVOLA.

Pride—

COLLATINE.

And my Lucrece' fate,
Shall all be swallowed in this hostile hate.

SEXTUS.

O Romulus! thou that first reared yon walls
In sight of which we stand, in thy soft bosom
Is hanged the nest in which the Tarquins build;
Within the branches of thy lofty spires
Tarquin shall perch, or where he once hath stood
His high built airy shall be drowned in blood.
Alarum then! Brutus, by Heaven I vow
My sword shall prove thou ne'er wast mad till now.

BRUTUS.

Sextus, my madness with your lives expires;
Thy sensual eyes are fixed upon that wall
Thou ne'er shalt enter; Rome confines you all.

PORSENNA.

A charge then!

TARQUIN.

Jove and Tarquin!

HORATIUS.

But we cry a Brutus!

BRUTUS.

Lucrece, fame, and victory!

[Exeunt.]

SCENE III.—A Bridge across the Tiber.

*Alarum. The Romans are beaten off. Enter BRUTUS, HORATIUS,
VALERIUS, SCEVOLA, LUCRETIOUS and COLLATINE.*

BRUTUS.

Thou Jovial hand, hold up thy sceptre high,
And let not justice be oppressed with pride!
O you Penates; leave not Rome and us
Grasped in the purple hands of death and ruin!
The Tarquins have the best.

HORATIUS.

Yet stand; my foot is fixed upon this bridge.
Tiber, thy archèd streams shall be changed crimson
With Roman blood before I budge from hence.

SCEVOLA.

Brutus, retire; for if thou enter Rome
We are all lost. Stand not on valour now,
But save thy people; let's survive this day,
To try the fortunes of another field.

VALERIUS.

Break down the bridge, lest the pursuing enemy
Enter with us and take the spoil of Rome.

HORATIUS.

Then break behind me; for, by Heaven, I'll grow
And root my foot as deep as to the centre,
Before I leave this passage!

LUCRETIOUS.

Come, you're mad.

COLLATINE.

The foe comes on, and we in trifling here,
Hazard ourself and people.

HORATIUS.

Save them all;
To make Rome stand, Horatius here will fall.

BRUTUS.

We would not lose thee; do not breast thyself
'Gainst thousands; if thou front'st them thou art ringed
With million swords and darts, and we behind
Must break the bridge of Tiber to save Rome.
Before thee infinite [\[65\]](#) gaze on thy face
And menace death; the raging streams of Tiber
Are at thy back to swallow thee.

HORATIUS.

Retire;
To make Rome live, 'tis death that I desire.

BRUTUS.

Then farewell, dead Horatius! think in us
The universal arm of potent Rome
Takes his last leave of thee in this embrace.

[All embrace him.]

HORATIUS.

Farewell!

ALL.

Farewell!

BRUTUS.

These arches all must down
To interdict their passage through the town.

[Exeunt all except HORATIUS.]

Alarum. Enter TARQUIN, PORSENNA, and ARUNS, with their pikes and targeters.

ALL.

Enter, enter, enter.

[A noise of knocking down the bridge, within.

HORATIUS.

Soft, Tarquin! see a bulwark to the bridge,
You first must pass; the man that enters here
Must make his passage through Horatius' breast;
See, with this target do I buckler [\[66\]](#) Rome,
And with this sword defy the puissant army
Of two great kings.

PORSENNA.

One man to face an host!
Charge, soldiers! of full forty thousand Romans
There's but one daring hand against your host,
To keep you from the sack or spoil of Rome.
Charge, charge!

ARUNS.

Upon them, soldiers!

[Alarum.

Enter SEXTUS and VALERIUS above, at opposite sides.

SEXTUS.

O cowards, slaves, and vassals! what, not enter!
Was it for this you placed my regiment
Upon a hill, to be the sad spectator
Of such a general cowardice? Tarquin, Aruns,
Porsenna, soldiers, pass Horatius quickly,
For they behind him will devolve the bridge,
And raging Tiber, that's impassable,

Your host must swim before you conquer Rome.

VALERIUS.

Yet stand, Horatius; bear but one brunt more;
The archèd bridge shall sink upon his piles,
And in his fall lift thy renown to Heaven.

SEXTUS.

Yet enter!

VALERIUS.

Dear Horatius, yet stand,
And save a million by one powerful hand.

[Alarum; the bridge falls.]

ALL.

Charge, charge, charge!

SEXTUS.

Degenerate slaves! the bridge is fallen, Rome's lost.

VALERIUS.

Horatius, thou art stronger than their host;
Thy strength is valour, theirs are idle braves,
Now save thyself, and leap into the waves.

HORATIUS.

Porsenna, Tarquin, now wade past your depths
And enter Rome. I feel my body sink
Beneath my ponderous weight; Rome is preserved,
And now farewell; for he that follows me
Must search the bottom of this raging stream.
Fame, with thy golden wings renown my crest!
And, Tiber, take me on thy silver breast! *[Exit.]*

PORSENNA.

He's leapt off from the bridge and drowned himself.

SEXTUS.

You are deceived; his spirit soars too high
To be choked in with the base element
Of water; lo! he swims, armed as he is,
Whilst all the army have discharged their arrows,
Of which the shield upon his back sticks full. [*Shout and flourish.*
And hark, the shout of all the multitude
Now welcomes him a-land! Horatius' fame
Hath checked our armies with a general shame.
But come, to-morrow's fortune must restore
This scandal, which I of the gods implore.

PORSENNA.

Then we must find another time, fair prince,
To scourge these people, and revenge your wrongs.
For this night I'll betake me to my tent. [*Exit.*

TARQUIN.

And we to ours; to-morrow we'll renown
Our army with the spoil of this rich town.

[*Exeunt.*

SCENE IV.—*Inside PORSENNA'S Tent.*

Enter PORSENNA.

PORSENNA.

Our secretary!

Enter Secretary.

SECRETARY.

My lord.

PORSENNA.

Command lights and torches in our tent,

[*Enter Soldiers with Torches.*]

And let a guard engirt our safety round,

Whilst we debate of military business.

Come, sit and let's consult.

Enter SCEVOLA, disguised.

SCEVOLA.

[*Aside.*] Horatius famous for defending Rome,

But we ha' done nought worthy Scevola,

Nor of a Roman: I in this disguise

Have passed the army and the puissant guard

Of King Porsenna: this should be his tent;

And in good time, now fate direct my strength

Against a king, to free great Rome at length.

[*Stabs the Secretary in mistake for PORSENNA.*]

SECRETARY.

Oh, I am slain! treason, treason!

PORSENNA.

Villain, what hast thou done?

SCEVOLA.

Why, slain the king.

PORSENNA.

What king?

SCEVOLA.

Porsenna.

PORSENNA.

Porsenna lives to see thee tortured,
With plagues more devilish than the pains of hell.

SCEVOLA.

O too rash Mutius, hast thou missed thy aim!
And thou, base hand, that didst direct my poniard
Against a peasant's breast, behold, thy error
Thus I will punish: I will give thee freely
Unto the fire, nor will I wear a limb
That with such rashness shall offend his lord.

[Thrusts his hand into the fire.]

PORSENNA.

What will the madman do?

SCEVOLA.

Porsenna, so,—
Punish my hand thus, for not killing thee.
Three hundred noble lads beside myself
Have vowed to all the gods that patron Rome
Thy ruin for supporting tyranny;
And, though I fail, expect yet every hour
When some strange fate thy fortunes will devour.

PORSENNA.

Stay, Roman; we admire thy constancy,
And scorn of fortune. Go, return to Rome,—

We give thee life,—and say, the King Porsenna,
Whose life thou seek'st, is in this honourable.
Pass freely; guard him to the walls of Rome;
And, were we not so much engaged to Tarquin,
We would not lift a hand against that nation
That breeds such noble spirits.

SCEVOLA.

Well, I go,
And for revenge take life even of my foe. [*Exit.*

PORSENNA.

Conduct him safely. What, three hundred gallants
Sworn to our death, and all resolved like him!
We must be provident: to-morrow's fortunes
We'll prove for Tarquin; if they fail our hopes,
Peace shall be made with Rome. But first our secretary
Shall have his rites of funeral; then our shield
We must address next for to-morrow's field. [*Exit.*

SCENE V.—A Public Place in Rome.

Enter BRUTUS, HORATIUS, VALERIUS, COLLATINE, *and* LUCRETIUS,
marching.

BRUTUS.

By thee we are consul, and still govern Rome,
Which but for thee had been despoiled and ta'en,
Made a confusèd heap of men and stones,
Swimming in blood and slaughter; dear Horatius,
Thy noble picture shall be carved in brass,
And fixed for thy perpetual memory
In our high Capitol.

HORATIUS.

Great consul, thanks!
But, leaving this, let's march out of the city,
And once more bid them battle on the plains.

VALERIUS.

This day my soul divines we shall live free
From all the furious Tarquins. But where's Scevola?
We see not him to-day.

Enter SCEVOLA.

SCEVOLA.

Here, lords, behold me handless as you see.
The cause—I missed Porsenna in his tent,
And in his stead killed but his secretary.
The 'mazèd king, when he beheld me punish
My rash mistake with loss of my right hand,
Unbegged, and almost scorned, he gave me life,
Which I had then refused, but in desire
To 'venge fair Lucrece' rape.

[Soft alarum.

HORATIUS.

Dear Scevola,
Thou hast exceeded us in our resolve:
But will the Tarquins give us present battle?

SCEVOLA.

That may ye hear; the skirmish is begun
Already 'twixt the horse.

LUCRETIOUS.

Then, noble consul,
Lead our main battle [\[67\]](#) on.

BRUTUS.

O Jove, this day
Balance our cause, and let the innocent blood
Of rape-stained Lucrece crown with death and horror
The heads of all the Tarquins! See, this day
In her cause do we consecrate our lives,
And in defence of justice now march on.
I hear their martial music: be our shock
As terrible as are the meeting clouds
That break in thunder! yet our hopes are fair,
And this rough charge shall all our loss repair.

[Exeunt. Alarum, battle within.

SCENE VI.—*Outside Rome.*

Enter PORSENNA and ARUNS.

PORSENNA.

Yet grow our lofty plumes unflagged with blood,
And yet sweet pleasure wantons in the air.
How goes the battle, Aruns?

ARUNS.

'Tis even balanced.
I interchanged with Brutus, hand to hand,
A dangerous encounter; both are wounded,
And, had not the rude press divided us,
One had dropped down to earth.

PORSENNA.

'Twas bravely fought.
I saw the king your father free his person
From thousand Romans that begirt his state,
Where flying arrows thick as atoms sung
About his ears.

ARUNS.

I hope a glorious day.
Come, Tuscan king, let's on them.

[Alarum.

Enter HORATIUS and VALERIUS.

HORATIUS.

Aruns, stay!
That sword, that late did drink the consul's blood,
Must with his keen fang tire upon [\[68\]](#) my flesh,
Or this on thine.

ARUNS.

It spared the consul's life
To end thy days in a more glorious strife.

VALERIUS.

I stand against thee, Tuscan!

PORSENNA.

I for thee!

HORATIUS.

Where'er I find a Tarquin, he's for me.

[Alarum. They fight; ARUNS is slain, PORSENNA driven off.]

*Alarum. Enter TARQUIN with an arrow in his breast, TULLIA with him,
pursued by COLLATINE, LUCRETIVS, SCEVOLA.*

TARQUIN.

Fair Tullia, leave me; save thy life by flight,
Since mine is desperate; behold, I am wounded
Even to the death. There stays within my tent
A wingèd jennet, mount his back and fly;
Live to revenge my death, since I must die.

TULLIA.

Had I the heart to tread upon the bulk [\[69\]](#)
Of my dead father, and to see him slaughtered,
Only for love of Tarquin and a crown,
And shall I fear death more than loss of both?
No, this is Tullia's fame,—rather than fly
From Tarquin, 'mongst a thousand swords she'll die.

COLLATINE, LUCRETIVS, AND SCEVOLA.

Hew them to pieces both.

TARQUIN.

My Tullia save,

And o'er my caitiff head those meteors wave!

COLLATINE.

Let Tullia yield then.

TULLIA.

Yield me, cuckold! no;
Mercy I scorn; let me the danger know.

SCEVOLA.

Upon them, then!

VALERIUS.

Let's bring them to their fate,
And let them perish in the people's hate.

TULLIA.

Fear not, I'll back thee, husband.

TARQUIN.

But for thee,
Sweet were the hand that this charged soul could free!
Life I despise. Let noble Sextus stand
To avenge our death. Even till these vitals end,
Scorning my own, thy life will I defend.

TULLIA.

And I'll, sweet Tarquin, to my power guard thine.
Come on, ye slaves, and make this earth divine!

[Alarum. TARQUIN and TULLIA are slain.]

Enter BRUTUS all bloody.

BRUTUS.

Aruns, this crimson favour, for thy sake,
I'll wear upon my forehead masked with blood,
Till all the moisture in the Tarquins' veins

Be spilt upon the earth, and leave thy body
As dry as the parched summer, burnt and scorched
With the canicular stars.

HORATIUS.

Aruns lies dead
By this bright sword that towered about his head.

COLLATINE.

And see, great consul, where the pride of Rome
Lies sunk and fallen.

VALERIUS.

Beside him lies the queen,
Mangled and hewn amongst the Roman soldiers.

HORATIUS.

Lift up their slaughtered bodies; help to rear them
Against this hill in view of all the camp:
This sight will be a terror to the foe,
And make them yield or fly.

BRUTUS.

But where's the ravisher,
Injurious Sextus, that we see not him?

[Short alarum.

Enter SEXTUS.

SEXTUS.

Through broken spears, cracked swords, unbowelled steeds,
Flawed armours, mangled limbs, and battered casques,
Knee-deep in blood, I ha' pierced the Roman host
To be my father's rescue.

HORATIUS.

'Tis too late;

His mounting pride's sunk in the people's hate.

SEXTUS.

My father, mother, brother! Fortune, now
I do defy thee; I expose myself
To horrid danger; safety I despise:
I dare the worst of peril; I am bound
On till this pile of flesh be all one wound.

VALERIUS.

Begirt him, lords; this is the ravisher;
There's no revenge for Lucrece till he fall.

LUCRETIVS.

Seize Sextus, then—

SEXTUS.

Sextus defies you all!
Yet will you give me language ere I die?

BRUTUS.

Say on.

SEXTUS.

'Tis not for mercy, for I scorn that life
That's given by any; and, the more to add
To your immense unmeasurable hate,
I was the spur unto my father's pride;
'Twas I that awed the princes of the land;
That made thee, Brutus, mad, these discontent:
I ravished the chaste Lucrece; Sextus, I,—
Thy daughter,—and thy wife,—Brutus, thy cousin,—
Allied, indeed, to all; 'twas for my rape
Her constant [\[70\]](#) hand ripped up her innocent breast:
'Twas Sextus did all this.

COLLATINE.

Which I'll revenge.

HORATIUS.

Leave that to me.

LUCRETIVS.

Old as I am, I'll do't.

SCEVOLA.

I have one hand left yet, of strength enough
To kill a ravisher.

SEXTUS.

Come all at once—ay, all!
Yet hear me, Brutus; thou art honourable,
And my words tend to thee: my father died
By many hands; what's he 'mongst you can challenge
The least, ay, smallest honour in his death?
If I be killed amongst this hostile throng,
The poorest snaky[71] soldier well may claim
As much renown in royal Sextus' death
As Brutus, thou, or thou, Horatius:
I am to die, and more than die I cannot;
Rob not yourselves of honour in my death.
When the two mightiest spirits of Greece and Troy
Tugged for the mastery, Hector and Achilles,
Had puissant Hector, by Achilles' hand,
Died in a single monomachy,[72] Achilles
Had been the worthy; but, being slain by odds,
The poorest Myrmidon had as much honour
As faint Achilles in the Trojan's death.

BRUTUS.

Hadst thou not done a deed so execrable
That gods and men abhor, I'd love thee, Sextus,
And hug thee for this challenge breathed so freely.
Behold, I stand for Rome as general:
Thou of the Tarquins dost alone survive,
The head of all these garboils,[73] the chief actor
Of that black sin, which we chastise by arms.—

Brave Romans, with your bright swords be our lists,
And ring us in; none dare to offend the prince
By the least touch, lest he incur our wrath:
This honour do your consul, that his hand
May punish this arch-mischief, that the times
Succeeding may of Brutus thus much tell,—
By him pride, lust, and all the Tarquins fell.

SEXTUS.

To ravish Lucrece, cuckold Collatine,
And spill the chastest blood that ever ran
In any matron's veins, repents me not
So much as to have wronged a gentleman
So noble as the consul in this strife.
Brutus, be bold! thou fight'st with one scorns[74] life.

BRUTUS.

And thou with one that less than his renown
Prizeth his blood, or Rome's imperial crown.

[Alarum; a fierce fight with sword and target; then a pause.]

BRUTUS.

Sextus, stand fair: much honour shall I win
To revenge Lucrece, and chastise thy sin.

SEXTUS.

I repent nothing, may I live or die;
Though my blood fall, my spirit shall mount on high.

*[Alarum; they fight with single swords, and, being deadly wounded
and panting for breath, they strike at each other with their
gauntlets and fall.]*

HORATIUS.

Both slain! O noble Brutus, this thy fame
To after ages shall survive; thy body
Shall have a fair and gorgeous sepulchre,

For whom the matrons shall in funeral black
Mourn twelve sad moons—thou that first governed Rome,
And swayed the people by a consul's name.
These bodies of the Tarquins we'll commit
Unto the funeral pile. You, Collatine,
Shall succeed Brutus in the consul's place,
Whom with this laurel-wreath we here create.
[*Crowning him with laurel.*]
Such is the people's voice; accept it, then.

COLLATINE.

We do; and may our power so just appear,
Rome may have peace, both with our love and fear.
But soft, what march is this?

Flourish. Enter PORSENNA, COLLATINE, and Soldiers.

PORSENNA.

The Tuscan King, seeing the Tarquins slain,
Thus armed and battled, offers peace to Rome,
To confirm which, we'll give you present hostage;
If you deny, we'll stand upon our guard,
And by the force of arms maintain our own.

VALERIUS.

After so much effusion and large waste
Of Roman blood, the name of peace is welcome:
Since of the Tarquins none remain in Rome,
And Lucrece' rape is now revenged at full,
'Twere good to entertain Porsenna's league.

COLLATINE.

Porsenna we embrace, whose royal presence
Shall grace the consul to the funeral pile.
March on to Rome. Jove be our guard and guide,
That hath in us 'venged rape, and punished pride!

[*Exeunt.*]

To the Reader.

Because we would not that any man's expectation should be deceived in the ample printing of this book, lo, Gentle Reader, we have inserted these few songs, which were added by the stranger that lately acted Valerius his part, in form following.

The Cries of Rome.

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;
First they go up street, and then they go down.

Round and sound, all of a colour; buy a very fine marking stone, marking stone; round and sound, all of a colour; buy a very fine marking stone, a very very fine!

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;
First they go up street, and then they go down.

Bread and—meat—bread—and meat, for the ten—der—mercy of God, to the poor pris—ners of Newgate, four—score and—ten—poor—prisoners!

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;
First they go up street, and then they go down.

Salt—salt—white Wor—stershire salt!

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;
First they go up street, and then they go down.

Buy a very fine mouse-trap, or a tormentor for your fleas!

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;
First they go up street, and then they go down.

Kitchen-stuff, maids!

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;
First they go up street, and then they go down.

Ha' you any wood to cleave?

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;

First they go up street, and then they go down.

I ha' white radish, white hard lettuce, white young onions!

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;

First they go up street, and then they go down.

I ha' rock-sampier, rock-sampier! [\[75\]](#)

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;

First they go up street, and then they go down.

Buy a mat, a mil-mat, mat, or a hassock for your pew, a stopple for your close-stool, or a pesock to thrust your feet in!

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;

First they go up street, and then they go down.

Whiting, maids, whiting!

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;

First they go up street, and then they go down.

Hot fine oat-cakes, hot!

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;

First they go up street, and then they go down.

Small-coals here!

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;

First they go up street, and then they go down.

Will you buy any milk to-day?

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;

First they go up street, and then they go down.

Lanthorn and candle-light here! Maid, a light here!

Thus go the cries in Rome's fair town;

First they go up street, and then they go down.

Here lies a company of very poor women in the dark dungeon, hungry,
cold, and comfortless night and day! Pity the poor women in the dark
dungeon!

Thus go the cries where they do house them;
First they come to the grate, and then they go louse them.

The Second Song.

“Arise, arise, my Juggy, my Puggy,
Arise, get up, my dear;
The weather is cold, it blows, it snows;
Oh, let me be lodgèd here.
My Juggy, my Puggy, my honey, my cony,
My love, my dove, my dear;
Oh, oh, the weather is cold, it blows, it snows,
Oh, oh, let me be lodgèd here.”

“Begone, begone, my Willy, my Billy,
Begone, begone, my dear;
The weather is warm, 'twill do thee no harm;
Thou canst not be lodgèd here.
My Willy, my Billy, my honey, my cony,
My love, my dove, my dear;
Oh, oh, the weather is warm, 'twill do thee no harm
Oh oh, thou canst not be lodgèd here.”

“Farewell, farewell, my Juggy, my Puggy,
Farewell, farewell, my dear;
Then will I begone from whence that I came,
If I cannot be lodgèd here.
My Juggy, my Puggy, my honey, my cony,
My love, my dove, my dear;
Oh, oh, then will I begone, from whence that I came,
Oh, oh, if I cannot be lodgèd here.”

“Return, return, my Willy, my Billy,

Return, my dove and my dear;
The weather doth change, then seem not strange;
Thou shalt be lodgèd here.
My Willy, my Billy, my honey, my cony,
My love, my dove, my dear;
Oh, oh, the weather doth change, then seem not strange,
Oh, oh, and thou shalt be lodgèd here.”

FOOTNOTES

INTRODUCTION FOOTNOTES.

[1] “So compared by the Fathers,” Heywood explains in the margin.

[2] Prefixed to his *Apology for Actors* (1612).

[3] Until recently, Heywood’s plays were only accessible piecemeal and in parts. Dodsley’s collection contained two; Dilke’s contained three, and Baldwyn’s two. Between 1842 and 1851, the Old Shakespeare Society produced altogether twelve; while Mr. Halliwell in 1853 printed the *Lancashire Witches* separately. At last, in 1874 Mr. John Pearson issued a complete edition in six volumes. Since that date another play in MS. by Heywood, *The Captives*, was discovered and printed by Mr. A. H. Bullen in the last volume of his *Old Plays* (1885).

[4] With this main-plot Heywood has interwoven a subordinate and independent story. To dwell upon this under-plot would be superfluous. Yet I may point out that it is borrowed from an Italian Novella by Illicini, the incidents of which Heywood carefully transferred to English scenes. In like manner *The Captive*, consists of a main-plot borrowed from the *Mostellaria* of Plautus and an under-plot adapted from a novella of the Neapolitan, *Masuccio*. See my *Shakspeare’s Predecessors* (p. 462), and a letter written by me to the *Academy* (Dec. 12, 1885).

A WOMAN KILLED WITH KINDNESS FOOTNOTES.

[1] **“The Shaking of the Sheets”** a popular tune to which many ballads were set. Here a *double entente* is intended.

[2] **“In a good time that man both wins and woos, That takes his wife down in her wedding shoes.”** a proverbial saying.

[3] **frets** the points at which a string is to be stopped in a lute or guitar. —Halliwell.

[4] **hoigh** out of all bounds.

[5] **angels** gold coins.

[6] **be stirring early with the lark to-morrow** did Heywood remember Shakespeare’s “Stir with the lark to-morrow, gentle Norfolk”?

[7] **crash** a merry bout.

[8] **“Rogero”, “The Beginning of the World”, “John come kiss me now.”**... the tunes here mentioned are all more or less familiar from other passages in the old dramatists.

[9] **sowse** we have here a number of not very intelligible terms borrowed from falconry. “At the sowse” was said of a bird when the hawk swooped straight down upon it.

[10] **gets** booty.

[11] **jesses** the short leather straps round the hawk’s legs.

[12] **querre** perhaps from the German *quer*=oblique.

[13] **merlin** a small species of hawk.

[14] **attach** arrest.

[15] **seen** versed.

[16] **censured on** to censure, in legal language, means to pass judgment on.

[17] **enter over the stage** they evidently pass through the gallery above and leave the stage to Wendoll.

[18] **to bring him on his way** *i.e.* to accompany him.

[19] **beholding** beholden.

[20] **miching** sneaking or stealing into.

[21] **bed-roll** *i.e.* bead roll.

[22] **from the grate** alluding obviously to the debtors’ prisons; the lines remind us at once of *Pickwick*.

[23] **wooden knife** with which the scraps were swept into the voider or basket.

[24] **carpet** *i.e.* table-cover.

[25] **play the good husband** *i.e.* be frugal.

[26] **before your beard** *i.e.* before you had a beard.

[27] **make-bate** promoter of quarrels.

[28] **a pair of cards** *i.e.* pack of cards.

[29] **well said** *i.e.* well done.

[30] **noddy** said to have been something like cribbage; of the other games mentioned accounts are easily accessible, while it would be superfluous to comment on the various quibbles.

[31] **quean** in the now obsolete sense of a whore.

[32] **cross** piece of money.

[33] **remember** *i.e.* remind.

[34] **leese** or lese, *i.e.* lose.

[35] **expectation** “execution” in the early eds.

[36] **disease** inconvenience.

[37] **two flight-shot** *i.e.* two bow-shots.

[38] **cast beyond the moon** a proverbial expression for anything extravagant or out of reach.

[39] **patience perforce** “patience perforce,” a phrase when some evil must be endured.—*Halliwell*.

[40] **like the angel’s hand, Hast stayed me from a bloody sacrifice** alluding to Gen. xxii. 10, 11.

[41] **uncivil kern** “kern” signified in general any uncivilised person: used especially of the Irish.

[42] **one denier** a penny.

[43] **resolve** satisfy.

[44] **rebato** a species of ruff for the neck: the wire would be used to stiffen it.

[45] **manors** a quibble on “manners” and “manors.”

[46] During this and some following speeches Wendoll evidently remains unseen.

[47] **kept this coil** *i.e.* made this trouble.

[48] **gotten those perfect tongues** *i.e.* acquired those tongues perfectly (French, German and Italian).

[49] **atoned** reconciled.

[50] **once more** meaning probably ‘Kiss me once more.’

[51] **filled** ‘filled’ is equivalent perhaps to ‘filled in,’ *i.e.* on the tomb.

THE FAIR MAID OF THE WEST FOOTNOTES.

[1] *Elizabethan Literature*, p. 284.

[2] **(Prologue)** Only spoken at court-performances of the play.

[3] **Roughman** “Ruffman” in the old edition, in which, also, “Fawcett” is spelled “Forset.”

[4] **mutes personated** *i.e. mutæ personæ*.

[5] **my lord** the Earl of Essex.

[6] **the fleet’s bound for the Islands** the so-called “Island Voyage” (1597) was against the Azores and Spanish East and West Indies.

[7] **Cales** Cadiz.

[8] **carracks** large vessels: the word is of Spanish etymology.

[9] **bush** *i.e.* the ivy-bush, hung up outside taverns.

[10] **adamant** magnet.

[11] **Graves wine** *i.e.* from the Graves district of Gascony, so called from the pebbly character of the soil, and to-day celebrated for its red, but more especially for its white wines.

[12] **snick-up** a term of contempt, as much as to say, “Go and be hanged.”

[13] **roaring** blustering.

[14] **Bettrice** the name, perhaps, of some ballad heroine.

[15] **dumb show** “intended to denote the departure of the General (the Earl of Essex) and his followers.”—*Collier*.

[16] **your years** *i.e.* term of apprenticeship.

[17] **corn grew to be at a high rate** we learn from Stow that in 1596 wheat was six, seven, and eight shillings per bushel; the dearth continued and increased in 1597.—*Collier*.

[18] **the Mermaid** a room in the tavern.

[19] **ruddocks** gold coins.

[20] **be-tall** a quibble on the German *bezahlen*, to pay.

[21] **Fayal** in the Azores.

[22] **atone** reconcile.

[23] **Mary Ambree** a famous English heroine, with whom Long Meg is sometimes associated.

[24] **untruss that point** untie that lace.

- [25] **Little Davy, Cutting Dick** contemporary bravos of note.
- [26] **prick-song** music noted down.
- [27] **capricious** witty.
- [28] **jowl of ling** the fish so-called, which had been served to the guests in the Portcullis.
- [29] **skillets** small metal pots.
- [30] **sod** boiled.
- [31] **pitch** height: properly a hawking term.
- [32] **motion** propose.
- [33] **king's lieutenant** more properly, queen's lieutenant.
- [34] **dissolutely** he means "resolutely." Slender makes the same blunder (*Mer. Wives*, i., 1).
- [35] **craze** burst.
- [36] **brave** fine.
- [37] **Aragoosa** query "Saragossa," which produces a large quantity of common wine.
- [38] **peter-see-me** a sweet Spanish wine from the Pedro Ximenes grape.
- [39] **charnico** a sweet wine grown in the neighbourhood of Lisbon.
- [40] **bastard** bastard was the name of a sweet Mediterranean wine: a time-honoured joke.
- [41] **punks** prostitutes.
- [42] **table** picture.
- [43] **ging** the old form of "gang."
- [44] **I sound it not** *i.e.*, I cannot fathom your meaning.
- [45] **engines** all instruments of torture.
- [46] **bragging Thrasos** *i.e.* boasters, Thraso being a braggart in one of Terence's plays.
- [47] **censures** sentences.
- [48] **taste** test.
- [49] **changed my copy** made a complete change.
- [50] **ging** gang.
- [51] **conceit** idea.
- [52] **poor-john** salt-fish.
- [53] **hautboys long** *i.e.* they are to play for some time so as to admit of fresh stage arrangements for the coming scenes.
- [54] **carvel** or caravel, a small light ship.

[55] **vail** lower.

[56] **ought** owned.

[57] **fights** defences placed round a vessel to protect the combatants.

[58] **you that made Paul's to stink** an allusion to the unsavoury exploit of a Spaniard, often referred to at this period.

[59] **peruse** examine.

[60] **habited** dressed.

[61] **commerce** intercourse.

[62] From Kyd's oft-referred-to *Spanish Tragedy*.

[63] **angels** *i.e.* coins.

[64] **cunning quiddit** subtle point.

[65] **generosity** *i.e.* people well-born.

[66] **moorian** negro: perhaps a play on the word "murrain" is intended.

THE ENGLISH TRAVELLER FOOTNOTES.

[1] **Histrio-Mastix** by William Prynne: published in 1633. The full title of this bitter Puritan treatise was *Histrio-Mastix, the Player's Scourge, or Actor's Tragædie*.

[2] **censure** judge.

[3] **censure** judgment.

[4] **where** *i.e.* whereas.

[5] **jack** which made the spit turn; it had been recently introduced.

[6] **buttery hatch** a term still used in the Universities.

[7] **speck ... whig** a species of inferior drink, made from whey, and drunk by the lower classes in place of small beer. The exact nature of "speck" is unknown.

[8] **indenture** bond.

[9] **burnt wine** burnt wine, it will be remembered, was much affected by Pepys.

[10] **consort** *i.e.*, concert.

[11] **reaks** pranks.

[12] **lanching** *i.e.*, lancing.

[13] **soul** the dark spongy substance inside a fowl's back.—*Halliwell*.

[14] **shrewd** sharp or bitter.

[15] **alfarez** ensigns (Spanish).

[16] **rebellings** *i.e.* ravelins (Sp. *rebellin*).

[17] **possess** inform.

[18] **novel** *i.e.* novelty.

[19] "This piece of pleasant exaggeration gave rise to the title of Cowley's Latin play, *Naufragium Jocularè*, and furnished the idea of the best scene in it."—*Charles Lamb*.

[20] **atone** make up, appease.

[21] **bill** a kind of halbert, carried by the watchmen of the period.

[22] **Bermoothes** "Bermoothes" is the usual form of "Bermudas" in the old dramatists.

[23] **durance** confinement.

[24] **prodigious** *i.e.* portentous.

[25] **countervail** counterbalance.

- [26] **break their day** fail to pay at the appointed time.
- [27] **use** interest.
- [28] **grange** the word seems to have implied “loneliness.”
- [29] **happiness** good fortune.
- [30] **motion** proposal.
- [31] **singularity** singleness.
- [32] **mechal** adulterous.
- [33] **private me no privates** like Shakespeare’s “but me no buts.”
- [34] **attach** charge with.
- [35] **bottle** bundle; Cotgrave has: “*boteler*, to botle or bundle up, to make into botles or bundles.”
- [36] **Privy** *i.e.* Privy Council.
- [37] **disable** disparage.
- [38] **picked** pitched.
- [39] **mainprize** a technical term: a writ of mainprize was sent to the sheriff, directing him to take sureties for a prisoner.
- [40] **shrievalty** it was customary for the sheriff to have posts in front of his house, to which notices were affixed.
- [41] **Chavelah?** the clown’s form of the French phrase *qui va là?*
- [42] **banquet** *i.e.* a dessert.
- [43] **whilst I find something to say to this** he refers to the bottle.
- [44] **orators** this must be taken as a verb.
- [45] **no quarrels to unkindness** no quarrels are so bitter as those caused by unkindness.
- [46] **goes in at one door, and comes out at another** the old stage was wanting in moveable scenery. The audience had to suppose that when Young Geraldine re-entered, he was outside Mistress Wincott’s chamber.
- [47] **tester** a sixpence.
- [48] **rot-gut** cheap ale.
- [49] **fox you all** make you all drunk.
- [50] **like brave Orlando** alluding to “Orlando Furioso.”
- [51] **gullery** trickery.
- [52] **withdraw** the old edition adds “behind the arras.”
- [53] **windings and indents** schemes, shifts.
- [54] **piece** gun.
- [55] **Fortune play-house** the first theatre of this name, built by Henslowe and Alleyn, was burnt down in 1621: another theatre was erected

on the site in 1622, and in old views of the latter a rudely carved figure, presumably of Fortune, is noticeable on the front of the house.—(See frontispiece to Dekker's Plays in this series.)

[56] **voted** *i.e.* chosen.

[57] **green rushes** with which floors were usually covered by way of carpet.

[58] **fear** ? sin.

[59] **presently** immediately.

THE WISE-WOMAN OF HOGSDON FOOTNOTES.

[1] **bale** pair.

[2] **twenty marks** a mark was worth 13s. 4d.

[3] **cross** coins bearing a cross on the reverse, hence various quibbles.

[4] **Gracious Street** *i.e.* Gracechurch Street.

[5] “&c.,” here and elsewhere, means that the actor may add more to the same effect, if he please.

[6] **to intend** *i.e.* attend to.

[7] **fancy** love.

[8] **say nay, and take them** “maids say nay, and take it,” was a proverbial saying.

[9] **conceit** idea.

[10] **I’ll be with thee to bring...** in this phrase—of which Dyce says that no satisfactory explanation has been given—“to bring,” has apparently the force of “wholly” or “thoroughly.”

[11] **little whiting-mop** young whiting.

[12] **a Sir John** a priest.

[13] **queasy** squeamish.

[14] **fore-speaking** bewitching; or, possibly, prophesying.—*Halliwell*.

[15] **’recting a figure** the practice of astrology.

[16] **Erra Pater** usually the name of a certain mythical astrologer of the “Wandering Jew” type; sometimes, however, as here, applied to an almanac.

[17] **Statute of Winchester** the celebrated Statute passed in 1285: to what clause in the Statute reference is made is not clear.

[18] **cutting Dick** a bully of the time: “cutting” often has the sense of “swaggering.”

[19] **sad** serious.

[20] **be with you** *i.e.* God be with you.

[21] **the Counter** there were two prisons of this name, one in Wood Street, the other in the Poultry.

[22] **tasted her** tested her disposition.

[23] **Jack Drum’s entertainment** “Tom or John Drum’s Entertainment, a phrase signifying ill-treatment, or turning an unwelcome

guest out of doors.”—*Halliwell*.

[24] **Sir Boniface** “sir” was applied to all University men who had taken their B.A. degree.

[25] **nidgets** idiots.

[26] **no bones** *i.e.* no difficulties.

[27] **ready with a wet finger** *i.e.* with as much ease as any light substance is caught up by moistening one’s finger.

[28] **catched a clap** met with a mischance.

[29] **common gossips** sponsors.

[30] **tell** count over.

[31] **pocas palabras** “few words.”

[32] **murrey** a dark red colour.—*Halliwell*.

[33] **play at hoodman-blind** blind man’s buff.

[34] **in a woe** sorrowful.

[35] **bobbed** tricked.

[36] **fitters** pieces.

[37] **a toy** whim.

[38] **choke-pear ... popering** a pear brought from Poperingues in Flanders; the choke-pear was a coarse variety.

[39] **cope** chop or exchange.

[40] **the woman killed with kindness** an obvious allusion to Heywood’s own masterpiece.

[41] **Bristowe stone** more usually called a “Bristol diamond.”

[42] **branched** figured.

[43] **limit** *i.e.* appoint.

[44] **I was, sir, of Peterhouse** there is a tradition that Heywood himself was a Fellow of Peterhouse, Cambridge.

[45] **I proceeded in Oxford** *i.e.* to his degree, his college, as he tells us, being Brazenose.

[46] **Genes** Genoese.

[47] **Lusty Juventus** there is an old interlude entitled *Lusty Juventus*, printed about the year 1560.

[48] **St. George’s Fields ... Tuttle, Finsbury** he mentions three well-known duelling resorts.

[49] **Stafford law** “he has had a trial in Stafford Court” was a way of saying “he has been beaten or ill-treated,” *Cotgrave*. Florio uses the expression “Stafford-law”=*braccasca licenza*.

[50] **apply thou** defend yourself.

[51] *i.e.* much good may it do you!

[52] **beso las manus** kiss the hands.

[53] **Sir Pandarus** Pandarus was the prince of go-betweens; hence the word “pander.”

[54] **colour** excuse.

[55] **brock** a term of contempt; a brock is a badger.

[56] **Cheap Cross** at Cheapside, with a statue of the Virgin on it. It was removed in 1643, by Puritan influence, on account of the reverence which it received from Catholics.

[57] **take me with you** *i.e.* let me understand.

[58] **jack** crafty fellow.

[59] It is to be understood that the occupants of the various inner rooms see and hear all that transpires between Young Chartley and Luce without being themselves seen or heard.

[60] Is not a speech lost here?

[61] *i.e.* on pain of losing his blessing.

THE RAPE OF LUCRECE FOOTNOTES.

[1] **makes legs** bows.

[2] **balm** the consecrated oil used at coronations. Shakespeare has the expression: "'Tis not the balm, the sceptre and the ball."

[3] **be countant** *i.e.* held accountant.

[4] **estates** nobles.

[5] **humorously** oddly.

[6] **mome** blockhead.

[7] **laugh, Democritus** the laughing philosopher of Abdera:

Perpetuo risu pulmonem agitare solebat
Democritus.—*Juvenal*, x., 33-4.

[8] **curst** shrewish.

[9] "Rome" was pronounced like "room."

[10] **generously** of such noble blood.

[11] **he was: by power divine** the old editions miss the point by reading "he was by power divine."

[12] **coach-naves** wheels, properly part of the axle.

[13] **timeless** untimely. This passage is corrupt.

[14] **sparkled** scattered.

[15] **trifurk** three-forked.

[16] **ruhs** obstacles: originally a term used at the game of bowls.

[17] **ballater** maker of ballads

[18] **sansing bell** *i.e.* sanctus bell.

[19] **moe** more; *i.e.* others.

[20] **lose** waste.

[21] **the water that God Mercury makes** *i.e.* a cosmetic lotion containing mercury.

[22] **being taken with the manner** caught in the act. Cowel says, "manner or mainour denotes the thing that a thief taketh or stealeth."

[23] **doom** decree.

[24] **prevent** forestall.

[25] **buckle** contend.

[26] **traversed** thoroughly examined.

[27] **attaint** accusation.

[28] **topping** lopping off.

[29] **where** *i.e.* whereas.

[30] **suburbians** the suburbs of London were formerly the chief resort of loose women.

[31] **holly** holy.

[32] **hatchel** heckle or dress.

[33] **with Duke Humphrey dine** *i.e.* not dine at all. “This phrase is said to have arisen from part of the public walks in Old St. Paul’s called Duke Humphrey’s walk, where those who were without the means of defraying their expenses at a tavern were accustomed to walk in hope of procuring an invitation.”—*Halliwell*.

[34] **hey ho** a favourite ballad-burden.

[35] **cocket** pert.

[36] **Attalia** Heywood was probably thinking of Horace’s *Attalicæ condiciones*.

[37] **pounded** *i.e.* penned up.

[38] **upse freeze** strong beer, imported from Friesland: hence to drink *upse freeze* was to drink hard.

[39] **tassaker** from *tasse*? Hence a cup or goblet.

[40] **manage** management.

[41] **lavoltoes** a dance in the course of which the woman, after being turned round several times, sprang up as high as she could with her partner’s assistance.

[42] **wheel** *i.e.* a spinning-wheel.

[43] **rebatoes** *i.e.* turn your ruffs into loose collars.

[44] **frontlets** forehead-bands.

[45] **rails** short mantles.

[46] **billements** head and neck ornaments.

[47] **bongraces** shades to preserve the complexion.

[48] There is no dash in the original; the singer evidently substituted the refrain for the omitted word.

[49] This song also occurs in Heywood’s *Challenge for Beauty*.

[50] **cony-wool** rabbit skin.

[51] **shag** rough hair.

[52] **monmouth** a kind of flat cap.

[53] **chapine** chapines were shoes with very high soles, worn by ladies to make them look tall.

[54] **humorous** damp.

[55] **stars** *i.e.* candles.

[56] **tread not too hard for disturbing** *i.e.* lest you should disturb.

[57] **staves-acre** a kind of larkspur used to kill lice.

[58] **opinion** reputation.

[59] **defend** forbid.

[60] **uncrazed** unbroken.

[61] **mechal** adulterous.

[62] **stare** starling.

[63] This catch, which jokes in such a ribald fashion over Tarquin's crime, furnishes a pointed example of the way in which the dramatists of the period pandered to the tastes of the less refined among their audiences.

[64] **to my death to fall** to let fall, as often to be found in Shakespeare.

[65] **infinite** *i.e.* infinite numbers.

[66] **buckler** defend.

[67] **battle** battalion.

[68] **tire** tear, like a beast or bird of prey.

[69] **bulk** body.

[70] **constant** resolute.

[71] **snaky** "snake" was often used as a term of contempt.

[72] **single monomachy** "single monomachy" is rather an absurd pleonasm.

[73] **garboils** tumults.

[74] **with one scorns** *i.e.* that scorns.

[75] **rock-sampier** samphire.

TRANSCRIBER'S NOTES.

The six volume *Dramatic Works of Thomas Heywood*, published by J. Pearson in 1874, was consulted for many of the corrections listed below.

is used in the text-only edition of this ebook to indicate bolded text.

Alterations to the text:

Omit drop caps and other decorations.

Speaker names: expand, make uniform, and place on line separate from dialogue.

Minor formatting changes to some stage directions.

Relabel footnote markers, collect footnotes at the end of the text, and add an entry to the TOC.

Add The Red Bull Theatre to TOC.

[Introduction]

Change (Such words as “*trifulk*,” ... “*tenébrous*,”) to *trifurk* and *tenebrous*, respectfully.

[A Woman Killed with Kindness]

(a2s1) “and therefore grateful. *Pr’ythee*, Nan,” to *Prythee*.

(a2s3) “*Whay* say’st thou, metal?” to *What*.

(a3s2) “*T’was* but a thankless office” to *’Twas*.

(a4s3) “As you love, me sir,” relocate first comma after *me*.

(a4s3) “Come, Nan, I *pr’ythee* let us sup within.” to *prythee*.

[The Fair Maid of the West]

(a1s3) “Enter Spencer, Captain *Goolack*” to *Goodlack*.

(a5s1) “I will have no *commèrce* with Mullisheg,” to *commerce*.

[The English Traveller]

(a2s1) “*W ee ntreat* you,” to *We entreat*.

(a2s2) “Why *dos’t* not thou fly too?” to *dost*.

(a3s1) “And is my present joy, if their *aspéct*” to *aspect*.

(a4s3) “On two unmatched for sordid *villany*” to *villainy*.

[The Wise Woman of Hogsdon]

(a3s1) “make short work, and *h’ath* dispatched by this” to *hath*.

(a4s2) “Well, I hear thee,” change second comma to a period.

[The Rape of Lucrece]

(a3s1) “The host is now/Upon their march....” change the speaker from Lucretius to Tarquin. (Lucretius never entered this scene).

(a3s5) “Terry, derry, &c.” (3rd to last line in song) delete the first comma.

(a5s1) “and guerdon base *trangression*.” to *transgression*.

[End of Text]

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THOMAS
HEYWOOD ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the

collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with

this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official

version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, “Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation.”
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.

- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES

EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a)

distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact

links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility: www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.



[back](#)